

Twelve Years — the event pool

Session 2 · 11–23 AH · 632–644 CE · a 45-minute slot.

THIS FILE IS NOT THE LECTURE. IT IS THE POOL YOU CUT DOWN TO ONE. [DECISIONS.md](#) #20.

Delete the rows you do not want. What survives is the evening. Overflow is not compressed — it rolls into session 3. Coverage is never bought by speeding up, which is the one thing the room objected to last time.

How to cut. Read top to bottom; it is already in narrative order. Delete whole cards. Keep roughly **22 cards** for a 45-minute slot told calmly — the rest is deliberate over-build.

Cards in the pool	372
If every card were told	≈ 662 minutes
The slot	45 minutes
So you are cutting	about 93%

Tier means: **CORE** the evening breaks without it · **GOOD** include if time · **CUT** recorded so it is never re-researched, not planned for delivery.

Every card carries: what happened, in tellable English · the date with its certainty label · the map move · a verbatim Arabic statement with its printed page and shamela link (or an explicit "none in the sources we use") · one عبرت line · and whether it opens with a hands-up question.

What is in the pool

Block	Cards	Tiers	With a statement	Note
Setting: the tribal map, and why the ردة took its shape	29	21 CORE · 7 GOOD · 1 CUT	29	arabian-tribes-and-the-ridda-setup.md
The ردة wars: the campaign, front by front	40	23 CORE · 16 GOOD · 1 CUT	40	ridda-campaign-the-conduct-of-the-wars.md
جيش أسامة, and the Qur'an collected	17	10 CORE · 6 GOOD · 1 CUT	17	abu-bakr-usama-and-the-jam-of-the-quran.md
The death of أبو بكر, and the succession	24	13 CORE · 9 GOOD · 2 CUT	23	abu-bakr-death-and-the-succession-of-umar.md

Block	Cards	Tiers	With a statement	Note
Iraq, Shām, and يرموك	20	12 CORE · 7 GOOD · 1 CUT	20	iraq-syria-and-yarmuk-12-15ah.md
القادسية, the embassy to المدائن, and رستم	25	16 CORE · 9 GOOD · 0 CUT	25	qadisiyya-madain-and-the-embassy.md
العهدة and بيت المقدس العمرية	16	8 CORE · 7 GOOD · 1 CUT	15	bayt-al-maqdis-and-the-umari-covenant.md
عمر ^{رض} builds a state — and the two trials	27	15 CORE · 12 GOOD · 0 CUT	27	umar-the-state-diwan-calendar-and-the-two-trials.md
نهاوند, the assassination, and the شورى	26	17 CORE · 8 GOOD · 1 CUT	26	nahawand-the-shura-and-the-death-of-umar.md
The people: the house of أم سليم ^{رض}	19	10 CORE · 9 GOOD · 0 CUT	19	the-house-of-umm-sulaym.md
The people: أبو حذيفة ^{رض} and سالم ^{رض}	19	12 CORE · 7 GOOD · 0 CUT	19	abu-hudhayfa-and-salim-mawla-abi-hudhayfa.md
The people: زيد بن الخطاب ^{رض} and the dead of اليمامة	17	12 CORE · 5 GOOD · 0 CUT	17	zayd-ibn-al-khattab-and-the-dead-of-yamama.md
The people: the men who had fought against it	25	15 CORE · 10 GOOD · 0 CUT	25	the-men-who-had-fought-against-it.md
The statements bank — slide-ready, by speaker	42	26 CORE · 15 GOOD · 1 CUT	41	great-statements-and-dialogues-11-23ah.md
ابن خلدون: how he reads it (framing only)	26	10 CORE · 13 GOOD · 3 CUT	24	ibn-khaldun-on-the-ridda-the-conquests-and-method.md

The cards

Setting: the tribal map, and why the ردة took its shape

Source note: *arabian-tribes-and-the-ridda-setup.md* — read it for the pages behind these cards.

ATA/E-TB01 · Arabia was a map of kin, not a map of provinces

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ, before any arrow is drawn [SOURCED] · **Map:** The whole peninsula with **no borders on it at all**. Two great feathered zones only — a northern one labelled **عدنان**, a southern one labelled **قطان** — and nothing between them but the desert. **What happened:** Ibn Kathīr never once names a province of Arabia. He names tribes, and the men who led them. His genealogy of the whole peninsula runs back to two ancestors and no more. From ‘Adnān come the Arabs of the Hījāz and Najd, and Quraysh are of them. From Qaḥṭān come the Arabs of Yemen, and the Anṣār are of them. So if you had asked a man in that country who he was, the answer would have been a line of fathers, not a place on a map. **The statement:**

وأما معد: فولد له أربعة: نزار، وقضاعة، وقُثُص، وإياد ... وأما نزار: فولد لهم ربيعة ومضر وأنمار. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٢ ص ٢٧٥
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/903> English: "As for Ma‘add: four were born to him — Nizār, Quḍā‘a, Qunuṣ and Iyād ... And as for Nizār: Rabi‘a, Muḍar and Anmār were born to them."

عبرت: The unit of that country was the line of fathers, and everything that happened next has to be read on that map. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "If you had asked a man in Arabia that year where he was from, what would he have answered?" △ Ibn Kathīr records a **خلاف** on that same page about where قُضَاعَة belongs; the line above is **ابن إسحاق**'s view as Ibn Kathīr reports it. Do not present the placement of قُضَاعَة as settled.

ATA/E-TB02 · Ten sons of Saba', in the Prophet's ﷺ own words

Tier: CORE · **When:** n/a — this is the frame [SOURCED] · **Map:** Yemen fills with six names at once — **مذحج · لخم · جذام · كندة · الأزد · الأشعريون · أنمار · حمير**. Then four more appear far to the north on the Syrian side — **عَمَلَة · غَسَّان · عَامِلَة · غَسَّان**. **What happened:** A man asked the Prophet ﷺ about Saba' — was it a man, or a woman, or a land? The answer was that Saba' was a man who had ten children. Six of them settled in Yemen and four in Syria. And then he named all ten. Ibn Kathīr quotes it through Ibn ‘Abbās^{رضي الله عنه}, and a few pages later he restates the same list as his own conclusion. One question, one answer, and the whole southern half of the tribal map is set out. **The statement:**

بل هو رجل ولد عشرة، فسكن اليمن منهم ستة، وبالشام منهم أربعة. فأما اليمانيون فمَذْحِج وكَنْدَة والأَزْد والأشعريون · وأنمار وحمير. وأما الشامية فَلَخْم وجُذَام وعَامِلَة وغَسَّان. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٢ ص ٢٠٧
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/835> English: "Rather, he was a man who had ten children. Six of them settled in Yemen and four of them in Syria. As for the Yemeni ones: Madhḥij, Kinda, al-Azd, al-Ash‘arīyūn, Anmār and Ḥimyar. And as for the Syrian ones: Lakhm, Judhām, ‘Āmila and Ghassān."

عبرت: Half the tribal map of that country is contained in one answer to one question. **Hands-up?** no **Note for the deck:** this is the single most useful ḥadīth for the map in the whole safe list, and it is on one page. **هَمْدَان is not among the ten** — do not add them to the diagram (§6.4).

ATA/E-TB03 · The dam broke, and the tribes went out

Tier: CORE · **When:** long before Islam [SOURCED] · **Map:** **The biggest map moment of the first half.** From **مَأْرِب** in Yemen, four arrows go out and each one ends on a name the room will hear again: **آل جَفْنَة** north to **عُمان** to **السراة** · **أزد عُمان** to **مكة** · **أزد السراة** outside **مَرّ** to **يثرب** · **خزاعة** north to **الشام** · **الأوس والخزرج**. **What happened:** The book carries an account of why the southern tribes left Yemen — the dam at Ma‘rib, and the flood. ‘Amr b. ‘Āmir left, and the Azd said they would not stay behind him. They sold their property and went

out with him. Then they scattered through the lands, and Ibn Kathīr names in one sentence where each group came to rest. Two of those names matter for everything that follows: the Aws and the Khazraj, who came to Yathrib and were the first to live there — and the Azd of Oman, who went to the far eastern coast. **The statement:**

وقالت الأزد: لا تتخلف عن عمرو بن عامر، فباعوا أموالهم وخرجوا معه ... قال: فارتحلوا عنهم، فتفرقوا في البلاد. فنزل آل جفنة بن عمرو بن عامر الشام، ونزل الأوس والخزرج يثرب، ونزلت خزاعة مَرا، ونزلت أزد السراة السراة، ونزلت أزد ٢١٠ ص ٢١٠ English: "The Azd said: we will not stay behind 'Amr b. 'Āmir — so they sold their property and went out with him ... He said: they departed and scattered through the lands. The house of Jafna b. 'Amr b. 'Āmir settled in Syria; the Aws and the Khazraj settled at Yathrib; Khuzā'a settled at Marr; the Azd of al-Sarāt settled at al-Sarāt; and the Azd of Oman settled in Oman."

عبرت: The people who would one day receive the hijra and the people who would one day rise in Oman came out of the same migration. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "*The Anṣār of Medina — where were they from, before Medina?*" **△ Narrate this as the book's account**, which Ibn Kathīr gives from ابن إسحاق أبو زيد الأنصاري. **Do not present the mechanism or the sequencing as settled history** (§1.2).

ATA/E-TB04 · Where Quraysh begins, and the two answers the book keeps

Tier: GOOD · **When:** n/a [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a. A short chain across the slide: → مَضَر → نِزَار → مَعَدَّ → عدنان → النضر → كِنَانَة → حَزِيمَة → مُذَرَّة → إِيَّاس. **What happened:** Ibn Kathīr runs the line of Quraysh back to 'Adnān name by name. At the end of it he records a disagreement inside his own sources about where the name Quraysh actually begins. Ibn Hishām says it begins at al-Naḍr b. Kināna — whoever is of his children is a Qurashī, and whoever is not, is not. Others named in the book said it begins one generation later, at Fihir b. Mālik. Ibn Kathīr writes both down and does not choose between them. **The statement:**

قال ابن هشام: النضر هو قُرَيْش، فمن كان من ولده فهو قرشي، ومن لم يكن من ولده فليس بقرشي. — البدايه ٢٧٧ ص ٢٧٧ English: "Ibn Hishām said: al-Naḍr is Quraysh. Whoever is of his children is a Qurashī, and whoever is not of his children is not a Qurashī."

عبرت: Even the boundary of the most famous tribe in Arabia had two answers, and the book keeps both of them. **Hands-up?** no **△ Do not adjudicate between the two views on a slide.** Ibn Kathīr does not.

ATA/E-TB05 · Quraysh and the Anṣār were the two halves of the peninsula

Tier: CORE · **When:** from the hijra onward [SOURCED] · **Map:** The peninsula tinted in two — عدنان north, قحطان south — and one line drawn from مكة to المدينة, so that the city at the end of it holds both tints inside one wall. **What happened:** Quraysh are 'Adnānī: northern Arabs of the Ḥijāz. The Anṣār are Qaḥṭānī: the Aws and the Khazraj, of al-Azd, of Kahlān, of Saba' — southern Arabs whose ancestors had come north generations before and were the first to settle Yathrib. So the Muhājirūn and the Anṣār were not two clans of one people. They were the two ancestral halves of Arabia, put inside one city by the hijra. That is not an inference; it is on the pages. **The statement:**

ومنهم الأوس والخزرج، نزلوا بيثرب وهي المدينة النبوية اليوم، فكانوا أول من سكنها — البدايه والنهيه ج ٢ ص ٢٠٩ English: "And among them were the Aws and the Khazraj; they settled at Yathrib — which today is the Prophet's city — and they were the first to live in it."

عبرت: The first thing the hijra did was to put the two ends of Arabia inside one set of walls. **Hands-up?** no
Cross-reference: this is the fact underneath the سقيفة material in session 1 and underneath the whole of tonight's first half. Page-cited at ٢٧٧-٢٧٥ ص، ٢٠٩-٢١٠ ص، ٢٠٧ ص ج.

ATA/E-TB06 · What the break actually was — Ibn Kathīr's own sorting

Tier: CORE — **this is the diagram slide of the first half** · **When:** ١١ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** none. This is a **diagram_slide**, not a map. **What happened:** Do not import a modern classification onto this year. The book supplies one, and it is better. Before a word of narrative, Ibn Kathīr's own chapter heading has already split the crisis in two: the people of the ridda, and those who withheld the zakāt. Then his opening paragraph names four things happening at once. Many settlements of the bedouin turned. Hypocrisy surfaced inside Medina itself. Banū Ḥanīfa and a great many others in al-Yamāma went over to Musaylima. And Banū Asad and Ṭayyi' and many besides gathered round Ṭulayḥa — who had made the same claim. **The statement:**

· فصل في تصدّي الصّدّيق لِقِتَالِ أَهْلِ الرِّدَّةِ وَمَانِعِي الزَّكَاةِ — البدايه والنّهايّه ج ٧ ص ١٧

<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3163> English: "A section on al-Ṣiddīq's undertaking to fight the people of the ridda and those who withheld the zakāt."

عبرت: The book refuses to call the whole year one thing, and the sorting on the screen is the author's own, not ours. **Hands-up?** Before showing it: "When the news went out to the tribes, was there one reaction, or more than one?"

Diagram rows — ready for `deck2.diagram_slide(prs, headline, rows=...)`; four cards, every sub under the 20-word cap:

#	label	sub
1	Left Islam outright	Many settlements of the bedouin turned when the news of the Prophet's ﷺ death reached them.
2	Hypocrisy inside the city	It surfaced in Medina itself — not out in the desert, but at home.
3	Massed behind a claimant	Banū Ḥanīfa and many others to Musaylima at al-Yamāma; Asad and Ṭayyi' to Ṭulayḥa.
4	Kept the prayer, refused the payment	And this group split again — over the payment itself, and over who it was owed to.

headline: What the break actually was · **caption:** The sorting is the author's own, not ours.

The four in the book's own words, on one page — ج ٧ ص ١٧ (<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3163>):

قد تقدّم أنّ رسولَ الله ﷺ لما توفي ارتدّت أحياءٌ كثيرةٌ من الأعراب، ونجم التّفاف بالمدينة، وانحاز إلى مُسَيِّلِمَةَ الكَذّابِ بنو حَنيفَةَ وخلقٌ كثيرٌ باليمامة، والتفّت على طليحة الأسدي بنو أسدٍ وطيّء، وبشر كثيرٌ أيضًا، وإدعى النّبوة أيضًا، كما ... English: "It has already been said that when the Messenger of Allah ﷺ died, many settlements of the bedouin apostatised, and hypocrisy appeared in Medina; Banū Ḥanīfa and a great many people at al-Yamāma went over to Musaylima the liar; and Banū Asad and Ṭayyi', and a great many people besides, gathered round Ṭulayḥa al-Asadī — and he too claimed prophethood, as Musaylima the liar had claimed it; and the matter grew grave and the situation grew hard ..."

⚠ **Never compose an Arabic label.** If the four boxes are to carry Arabic rather than English, use only the two terms the heading itself supplies — «أهل الّدة» and «مايعي الزّكاة» — and leave the other two boxes in English. Arabic and English must not share a box.

ATA/E-TB07 · Two refusals, not one

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ, as the delegations arrive [SOURCED] · **Map:** المدينة at the centre, with delegation arrows coming in from every direction and going out again unchanged. **What happened:** Delegations of the Arabs began arriving in Medina. They affirmed the prayer and refused to hand over the zakāt. And then Ibn Kathīr splits them again inside a single clause. Some refused the payment itself, and had a Qur’ānic argument for it: the verse tells the Prophet ﷺ to take a ṣadaqa from their wealth and pray over them, because his prayer is a repose for them — so, they said, we pay it only to a man whose prayer is a repose for us. And some of them refused to pay it to Abū Bakr رضي الله عنه. That second group is not refusing the obligation at all. It is refusing the addressee. **The statement:**

وَجَعَلْتُ وفودُ العرب تقدم المدينة يقرّون بالصلاة ويمتنعون من أداء الزكاة، ومنهم من امتنع من دفعها إلى الصّدّيق — البدايه والنّهايه ج ٧ ص ١٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3164> English: "The delegations of the Arabs began coming to Medina, affirming the prayer and refusing to render the zakāt — and among them were those who refused to pay it to al-Ṣiddīq."

عبرت: Two men can refuse the same payment for two different reasons, and the book takes care to say which is which. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "A tribe says: we will pray, but we will not pay. Is that one position, or two?" **Also on the page** — the verse they argued from and their own sentence:

خُذْ مِنْ أَمْوَالِهِمْ صَدَقَةً تُطَهِّرُهُمْ وَتُزَكِّيهِمْ بِهَا وَصَلِّ عَلَيْهِمْ إِنَّ صَلَاتَكَ سَكَنٌ لَهُمْ [التوبة: ١٠٣] قالوا: فلسنا ندفع زكّاتنا إلّا إلى من صلّاهُ سَكَنٌ لنا English: "They said: we do not pay our zakāt except to one whose prayer is a repose for us."

ATA/E-TB08 · The Companions proposed going easy, and he refused

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a — a large-statement slide. **What happened:** The Companions came to Abū Bakr رضي الله عنه with a proposal about the tribes that were withholding the zakāt. Leave them and what they are upon for now. Win them over until faith takes hold in their hearts, and after that they will pay. It is a serious proposal made by serious men, and the book records it without any embarrassment at all. He refused it, and would not have it. **The statement:**

وقد تكلم الصحابة مع الصّدّيق في أن يتركهم وما هم عليه من منع الزكاة ويتألفهم حتى يمدّج الإيمان في قلوبهم: ثم هم بعد ذلك يتركّون، فامتنع الصّدّيق من ذلك وأباه. — البدايه والنّهايه ج ٧ ص ١٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3164> English: "The Companions spoke to al-Ṣiddīq about leaving them and what they were upon of withholding the zakāt, and conciliating them until faith took hold in their hearts, and after that they would pay the zakāt. But al-Ṣiddīq refused that and would not have it."

عبرت: The decision that held the state together was taken against the advice of the men best placed to give advice, and the book keeps the advice on the page. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "Half the country will not pay. Your closest advisers say: let it go for a year and win them back. What do you do?"

ATA/E-TB09 · «لو مّتعوني عقالاً» — and what ‘Umar رضي الله عنه said afterwards

أَنَّ عُمَرَ بْنَ الْخَطَّابِ قَالَ لِأَبِي بَكْرٍ: عَلَامَ تَقَاتِلُ النَّاسَ؟ وَقَدْ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: "أَمَرْتُ أَنْ أَقَاتِلَ النَّاسَ حَتَّى يَشْهَدُوا أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَأَنْ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ، فَإِذَا قَالُوهَا عَصَمُوا مِنِّي دِمَاءَهُمْ وَأَمْوَالَهُمْ إِلَّا بِحَقِّهَا". فَقَالَ أَبُو بَكْرٍ: وَاللَّهِ لَوْ مَتَّعُونِي عَنَاقًا، وَفِي رِوَايَةٍ: عِقَالًا كَانُوا يُؤَدُّونَهُ إِلَى رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ لِأَقَاتِلَتْهُمْ عَلَى مَنَعِهَا، إِنَّ الزَّكَاةَ حَقُّ الْمَالِ، وَاللَّهِ لِأَقَاتِلَنَّ مَنْ فَرَّقَ بَيْنَ الصَّلَاةِ وَالزَّكَاةِ، قَالَ عُمَرُ: فَمَا هُوَ إِلَّا أَنْ رَأَيْتُ اللَّهَ قَدْ شَرَحَ صَدْرَ أَبِي بَكْرٍ لِلْقِتَالِ، فَعَرَفْتُ أَنَّهُ الْحَقُّ. English: "Umar b. al-Khaṭṭāb said to Abū Bakr: on what basis do you fight the people, when the Messenger of Allah ﷺ has said: 'I have been commanded to fight the people until they bear witness that there is no god but Allah and that Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah; and when they say it, they have protected from me their blood and their property, except for its due'? Abū Bakr said: by Allah, if they withheld from me a young she-goat — and in another wording, a hobbling-cord — that they used to render to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, I would fight them over withholding it. The zakāt is a due upon wealth. By Allah, I will fight whoever separates the prayer from the zakāt. Umar said: it was no more than that I saw Allah had opened Abū Bakr's breast to the fighting — and I knew that it was the truth."

عبرت: The argument was settled on a point of law about a hobbling-cord, and the man who had objected said so himself. **Hands-up?** no **Takhrij**, exactly as Ibn Kathīr's editor prints it in the footnote on that page — copy this, do not retype it from memory: البخاري ٦٩٢٤ و ٦٩٢٥ في استتابة المرتدين · مسلم ٢٠ في الإيمان · أبو داود مسند أحمد ٢/٥٢٨ رواه «**العناق**» — بفتح المهملة والنون **The gloss, also footnoted there** — ابن حجر رحمه الله: «الأنثى من ولد المعز» (فتح الباري ١٢/٣٧٨) **a young female of the goats. The same thing in one clause, through** فعزم الله لأبي بكر على الحق وقال: لو متَّعونِي»: (<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3165>) ج ٧ ص ١٩، **القاسم بن محمد** ج ٧ ص ١٨ the cached **One Shamela typo to be aware of when the page image is checked:** «عَقَالًا لَجَاهِذْتُهُمْ» without the final alif. This note reads it as «كانوا», which is plainly right — but that is a *reading*, so **verify it on the image** before it is printed. (Same class of thing as the «قى / قد» typo already logged in the campaign note.)

ATA/E-TB10 · One tribe, three answers

كانت بنو تميم قد اختلفتْ أراؤهُم أيام الرِّدَّة، فمنهُم من ارتدَّ ومنع الزكاة، ومنهُم من بعثَ بأموال الصدقات إلى الصَّديق، ومنهُم من توقف لينظر في أمره. — البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٢٨

English: "The views of Banū Tamīm differed in the days of the ridda: some of them apostatised and withheld the zakāt; some of them sent the ṣadaqa monies to al-Ṣiddīq; and some of them held back to see how the matter would go."

عبرت: The honest map has three colours inside one tribe, and the sentence that licenses it is the book's own. **Hands-up?** Before showing it: "One tribe. How many different answers can it give at the same moment?" **Cross-reference:** [ridda-campaign-the-conduct-of-the-wars.md](#) defers to this card rather than carding it again, and adds only the collectors' names and the mechanism.

ATA/E-TB11 · 'Uyayna b. Ḥiṣn says why he followed Ṭulayḥa

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ، and again at المدينة afterwards [SOURCED] · **Map:** قَرَارَة's zone in Najd tied by a short line to أسد بني's zone — an alliance made on descent, not on belief. **What happened:** 'Uyayna b. Ḥiṣn brought Fazāra in behind Ṭulayḥa, and he told his own people why in one sentence. A prophet from Banū Asad, he said, is dearer to me than a prophet from Banū Hāshim. Muḥammad ﷺ has died, and here is Ṭulayḥa — follow him. His people agreed with him. Ibn Kathīr does not argue with the sentence; he prints it. And later, when 'Uyayna was brought into Medina in bonds and the children of the city crowded round and taunted him for having left Islam, he answered them: by Allah, I never believed at all. **The statement:**

والله لئنبي من بني أسد أحب إلي من نبي من بني هاشم، وقد مات محمد وهذا طليحة فاتبعوه — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٢٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3172> *English:* "By Allah, a prophet from Banū Asad is dearer to me than a prophet from Banū Hāshim. Muḥammad has died, and this is Ṭulayḥa — so follow him."

عبرت: He was not choosing between two prophecies. He was choosing between two lines of descent, and he said so out loud. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "He is fighting for a man he will soon call a liar to his face. Ask him why he followed him — what will he answer?" **And afterwards, on the same page,** when the boys of Medina jeered at him: «والله ما كنت آمنك قط» — "By Allah, I never believed at all." **Cross-reference:** this is the same man as the بُرَاخَة card in [ridda-campaign-the-conduct-of-the-wars.md](#), caught at the moment his following begins rather than the moment it ends. Tell this one first.

ATA/E-TB12 · The man who followed Musaylima knowing he was lying

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢هـ، اليمامة [SOURCED] · **Map:** not a map — two trunk names on the screen, رَيْبِيعَة and مَضَر، with the fork shown one level below عدنان، so the room can see that both sides of this sentence are northern Arabs. **What happened:** A bedouin said to Musaylima's face that he bore witness Musaylima was a liar and that Muḥammad ﷺ was truthful. And then he said the rest of it. But a liar of Rabī'a, he said, is dearer to us than a truthful man of Muḍar. He followed him, and he was killed with him at 'Aqrabā'. Banū Ḥanīfa are of Rabī'a and Quraysh are of Muḍar, and both trunks are 'Adnānī. So the fault line is not only north against south. It forks again, one level down. **The statement:**

· فقال أشهد أنك كذاب وأن محمدًا صادق، ولكن كذاب ربيعة أحب إلينا من صادق مضر — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٣٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3183> *English:* "He said: I bear witness that you are a liar and that Muḥammad is truthful — but a liar of Rabī'a is dearer to us than a truthful man of Muḍar."

عبرت: A man can know which of two claims is true and still act on which of two families is his. **Hands-up?** no **Note:** the clause that follows on the page carries Ibn Kathīr's own imprecation against the man; the quotation stands complete without it. This is the most efficient sentence in the whole strand — the tribal principle stated by a man who admits the religious claim is false.

ATA/E-TB13 · The verse that puts the objection as politics

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a — a large-statement slide. **What happened:** The book twice prints a verse from the refusing side, and it is worth hearing exactly what the objection says. We obeyed the Messenger of Allah while he was among us — and then, in astonishment: what is this about the rule of Abū Bakr? The longer version at ج ٧ ص ٢٠ asks whether he is to leave it to Bakr after him, and calls that, by God's life, a thing that breaks the back. Nothing in those lines denies the prayer, and nothing in them denies the Prophet ﷺ. What they object to is who is to be obeyed now. **The statement:**

· أَطَعْنَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ إِذْ كَانَ بَيْنَنَا ... فَوَاعَجَبًا مَا بَالُ مُلْكِ أَبِي بَكْرٍ — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٨

<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3164> (and again ج ٧ ص ٢٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3166>)

English: "We obeyed the Messenger of Allah while he was among us — so how strange: what is this about the rule of Abū Bakr?"

عبرت: The refusal stated itself in the language of who should rule, and the answer it was given was in the language of what is owed. **Hands-up?** no **The four-line version at ج ٧ ص ٢٠** (<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3166>) adds: «أَيُورَثُنَا بَكْرًا إِذَا مَاتَ بَعْدَهُ ... وَتِلْكَ لَعَمْرُ اللَّهِ قَاصِمَةُ الظَّهْرِ» — "Is he to leave us to Bakr as an inheritance when he dies? That, by God's life, breaks the back." **Say whose words these are before reading them.** They are a rebel's verse, printed by the book as the objection that was being made against the caliphate — not as a description of it. Pair this card with E-TB07 and E-TB09 so the room hears the objection and the answer in the same minute, and do not leave the verse standing alone at the end of a block.

ATA/E-TB14 · Four claimants, and when each of them began

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٠هـ-١٢هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** Four red marks — صنعاء (الأسود), اليمامة (مسيلمة), بَزَاخَة, and an arrow coming down from الجزيرة (سجاح). Beneath it, the timeline strip: three of the four begin **before** ١١هـ. **What happened:** Four people claimed prophethood in this story, and the order matters more than the number. Al-Aswad al-'Ansī, of 'Ans of Madhḥij, rose in Yemen and was killed before the Prophet ﷺ died. Musaylima of Banū Ḥanīfa had come to Medina in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime and written to him; he was killed after. Ṭulayḥa of Banū Asad — the book says it plainly — apostatised in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime. Only Sajāḥ comes afterwards: she arrives from al-Jazīra in the middle of the ridda narrative itself. So three of the four had already begun while the Prophet ﷺ was alive. **The statement:**

· وَقَدْ كَانَ طُلَيْحَةُ الْأَسَدِيِّ ارْتَدَّ فِي حَيَاةِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٢٦

<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3172> *English:* "Ṭulayḥa al-Asadī had apostatised in the lifetime of the Prophet ﷺ."

عبرت: Most of what broke in that year had already begun before the year began. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "Four people claimed prophethood. How many of them started only after the Prophet ﷺ died?" **The table this card draws from is \$4** — claimant, tribe, place, and before-or-after, each with its page. A fifth man, لقيط بن مالك الأزدي in Oman, also claimed prophethood (E-TB25); the "four" is the count of the famous claimants, not a count of all claims.

ATA/E-TB15 · Musaylima's letter, and the reply

Tier: CORE — **the note's own judgement is that this is the best pair in the strand** · **When:** آخر سنة عشر [SOURCED] · **Map:** One line from اليمامة to المدينة and one back. Two documents side by side on the screen, nothing else. **What happened:** Musaylima wrote to the Prophet ﷺ. The letter does not argue about revelation at all. It proposes a partition: I have been given a share in the matter with you, half the matter is ours and half is Quraysh's — but Quraysh are a people who transgress. The reply is on the same page, and it refuses the premise rather than the arithmetic. The earth belongs to Allah; He gives it in inheritance to whom He wills of His servants; and the outcome is for those who fear Him. The book dates the exchange to the end of the year 10. **The statement:**

من مُسَيِّلَمَةَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ إِلَى مُحَمَّدٍ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ، سَلَامٌ عَلَيْكَ، أَمَا بَعْدُ، فَإِنِّي قَدْ أَشْرَكْتُ فِي الْأَمْرِ مَعَكَ، فَإِنَّ لَنَا نِصْفَ الْأَمْرِ، وَلِقُرَيْشٍ نِصْفَ الْأَمْرِ، وَلَكِنْ قُرَيْشًا قَوْمٌ يَعْتَدُونَ. — البدايه والنهايه ج ٥ ص ٢٤

<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/2208> English: "From Musaylima the Messenger of Allah, to Muḥammad the Messenger of Allah. Peace be upon you. To proceed: I have been given a share in the matter with you. Half the matter is ours and half the matter is Quraysh's — but Quraysh are a people who transgress."

And the reply, same page:

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ، مِنْ مُحَمَّدٍ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ، إِلَى مُسَيِّلَمَةَ الْكَذَّابِ، سَلَامٌ عَلَى مَنْ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى، أَمَا بَعْدُ، فَإِنَّ الْأَرْضَ لِلَّهِ يُورِثُهَا مَنْ يَشَاءُ مِنْ عِبَادِهِ وَالْعَاقِبَةُ لِلْمُتَّقِينَ. — البدايه والنهايه ج ٥ ص ٢٤

<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/2208> English: "In the name of Allah, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate. From Muḥammad the Messenger of Allah, to Musaylima the liar. Peace be upon whoever follows the guidance. To proceed: the earth belongs to Allah; He gives it in inheritance to whomever He wills of His servants; and the outcome is for those who fear Him."

عبرت: One document divides the country between two tribes, and the other answers that the country belongs to neither of them. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "A man writes to the Prophet ﷺ proposing terms. What do you think he asks for?" △ The editor footnotes a **variant wording** of the letter — « نصف الأرض ولقريش نصف » — (مجموعة الوثائق السياسية ٢٠٥). **Note both; never merge them into one.**

ATA/E-TB16 · Musaylima at Medina, and the piece of palm-branch

Tier: GOOD · **When:** in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime [SOURCED] — صحيح البخاري ٤٣٧٣ · **Map:** n/a. **What happened:** Musaylima came to Medina while the Prophet ﷺ was alive, with a large number of his own people, and kept saying that if Muḥammad ﷺ would make the succession his, he would follow him. The Prophet ﷺ came out to him with Thābit b. Qays b. Shammās, and there was a piece of a palm-branch in his hand. And what he said to him was about that piece. **The statement:**

لو سألتني هذه القطعة ما أعطيتها، ولن تعدوا أمر الله فيك، ولئن أدبرت ليعقرتك الله — البدايه والنهايه ج ٥ ص ٢١
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/2205> — صحيح البخاري ٤٣٧٣، via ابن عباس English: "If you asked me for this piece, I would not give it to you. You will not pass beyond Allah's decree concerning you. And if you turn away, Allah will surely destroy you."

عبرت: The claim was refused while it was still only a request, years before it had to be fought. **Hands-up?** no **Cross-reference:** the Companion standing beside the Prophet ﷺ in this scene, ثابث بن قيس بن شماس, is the man killed carrying the banner of the Anṣār at اليمامة against this same claimant (ج ٧ ص ٣٣-٣٤) — carded in [rida-campaign-the-conduct-of-the-wars.md](#). If both cards are used, put this one first and let the room make the connection.

ATA/E-TB17 · The two bracelets

Tier: GOOD · **When:** in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime [SOURCED] — **Map:** two dots only, صنعاء and اليمامة, lit at the same moment. **What happened:** The Prophet ﷺ said that while he was asleep he was brought the treasures of the earth, and two bracelets of gold were placed in his hands, and they weighed on him. He was inspired to blow on them; he blew, and they went. And he interpreted them as the two liars between whom he stood — the one of Ṣanʿāʾ and the one of al-Yamāma. The two men who would break Arabia are named in one sentence, by their cities, before either of them had risen. **The statement:**

بينما أنا نائم أتيت بخزائن الأرض، فوضع في كفي سواران من ذهب، فكثرا عليّ، فأوحى إليّ أن انفختهما، فنفختهما، فذهبا فأولتهما الكذابين اللذين أنا بينهما؛ صاحب صنعاء، وصاحب اليمامة — البدايه والنهايه ج ٥ ص ٢٢

https://shamela.ws/book/30097/2206 — صحيح البخاري ٤٣٧٥، via همّام بن مثنّى English:

"While I was sleeping I was brought the treasures of the earth, and two bracelets of gold were placed in my hands, and they weighed heavily on me. It was revealed to me that I should blow on them; so I blew on them, and they went. And I interpreted them as the two liars between whom I stand — the man of Ṣanʿāʾ and the man of al-Yamāma."

عبرت: The two claims that broke the peninsula are named together, by their cities, in one sentence. **Hands-up?** no ⚠ **OCR/typography caveat, logged in §4.2 and repeated here because this one is going on a slide.** The Shamela text prints «انفختهما» with a stray shadda in the ٤٣٧٥ wording, while the ٤٣٧٣ wording on ج ٥ ص ٢٢-٢١ prints «انفخهما». **Read this off a printed page image or a critical البخاري before it reaches a slide.** One wrong letter kills the point of quoting it.

ATA/E-TB18 · Sajāḥ — who she actually was

Tier: GOOD · **When:** هـا [SOURCED] · **Map:** An arrow from الجزيرة in the far north, down into نجد, on to اليمامة, and then back north again. **It never reaches Medina.** **What happened:** Sajāḥ bint al-Ḥārith came down from al-Jazīra with troops of her own people and whoever had joined them, having claimed prophethood — and, the book says, they had resolved on making war on Abū Bakr رضى. She was of Taghlib, and she was of the Christians of the Arabs. She was not of Tamīm, which is only the tribe she gathered on the way. When she passed through the country of Banū Tamīm she called them to her cause and most of them answered — Mālīk b. Nuwayra رضى among them, and ʿUṭārid b. Ḥājib, and a number of the chiefs of Tamīm. Others of them held back. **The statement:**

إذ أقبلت سجاح بنت الحارث بن سويد بن عقفان التغلبيّة من الجزيرة، وهي من نصارى العرب، وقد ادّعت النبوة — ...when Sajāḥ bint al-Ḥārith b. Suwayd b. ʿAqfān al-Taghlibiyya came forward from al-Jazīra — and she was of the Christians of the Arabs — having claimed prophethood."

عبرت: The tribe that supplied her following was not the tribe she came from, and the book is careful to say so. **Hands-up?** no **Also on the page** — a verse said about it by ʿUṭārid b. Ḥājib, one of the men who had answered her: «أَمَسَتْ نَبِيَّتُنَا أَنْتَى نُطِيفُ بِهَا ... وَأَصْبَحَتْ أَنْبِيَاءُ النَّاسِ دُكْرَانَا» — "our prophetess has become a woman we circle around, while the prophets of other people are men." ⚠ **Correction recorded, because two existing artifacts have it wrong:** she is Taghlibī, not Tamīmī. It is مالك بن نويرة رضى who is التميمي اليربوعي (6.2 item 3). ⚠ مالك بن نويرة رضى is named here only as one of the men who answered her call, which is what the page says. What happened to him afterwards at البطحاء is adjacent, is carded separately in ridda-

campaign-the-conduct-of-the-wars.md under **⚠ SPEAKER'S DISCRETION**, and must not be opened from this card.

ATA/E-TB19 · What her claim was worth to the other claimant

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١هـ, at اليمامة, and afterwards [SOURCED] · **Map:** her arrow reaches اليمامة, turns, and goes back north to الجزيرة. **What happened:** The two claimants met at al-Yamāma, and he bought her off. She took half the kharāj of his land and turned back to her own country, and she stayed among her people, Banū Taghlib, until the time of Mu‘āwīya. The dowry he paid her was the remission of two of the five prayers — the dawn prayer and the night prayer. That is what one claim to prophethood was worth to the other. And al-Suhaylī, whom Ibn Kathīr quotes, records that she became Muslim in the days of ‘Umar b. al-Khaṭṭāb, and that her Islam was good. **The statement:**

ثم انثنت سَجَاح راجعةً إلى بلادها ... فكثرت راجعةً إلى الجزيرة بعدما قبضت من مسيلمة نصف خراج أرضه، فأقامت السهيلي: «وقد أسلمت هي أيضًا أيام عُمَر بن الخطاب، فحسن إسلامها» — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3176>
English: "Then Sajāḥ turned back to her own country ... she went back to al-Jazīra after she had taken from Musaylima half the kharāj of his land, and she stayed among her people, Banū Taghlib, until the time of Mu‘āwīya."

عبرت: A claim that could be settled for half a land-tax was priced by the man who bought it. **Hands-up?** no **And afterwards** — البدايه ج ٥ ص ٢٤ (<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/2208>), Ibn Kathīr quoting «وقد أسلمت هي أيضًا أيام عُمَر بن الخطاب، فحسن إسلامها» — "and she too became Muslim in the days of ‘Umar b. al-Khaṭṭāb, and her Islam was good." **End the card here**, not on the withdrawal — the note flags this as the resolution the room should be given. **⚠ The narrative of that meeting at ص ٢٩–٣٠ ج ٧ contains explicitly obscene material. It must not be read, paraphrased, or alluded to in the hall.** The usable fact is exactly the one clean sentence above: he bought her off, and the dowry he paid was two of the five prayers.

ATA/E-TB20 · Ṭulayḥa comes back, and the letter about how to use him

Tier: CORE · **When:** after زُخَاة, in Abū Bakr's ^{رضي} time [SOURCED] · **Map:** a thin blue line returning from الشام, to مكة for ‘umra, and then to the Muslim army in the field. **What happened:** Ṭulayḥa returned to Islam. He went to Mecca to perform ‘umra in Abū Bakr's ^{رضي} days, and he was ashamed to face him for as long as Abū Bakr ^{رضي} lived. He came back and fought alongside Khālīd ^{رضي}. And Abū Bakr ^{رضي} wrote to Khālīd ^{رضي} about him with a single instruction: consult him in the fighting, and do not put him in command. Ibn Kathīr explains why in his own words — he was dealt with by the opposite of the thing he had secretly been after, which was leadership. And then Ibn Kathīr says what he thinks of it: this is from the fiqh of al-Ṣiddīq ^{رضي}. **The statement:**

وكتب الصّدّيق إلى خالدٍ، أن استَشِرَّهُ في الحرب ولا تُؤَمِّرْهُ — يعني معاملته له بنقيض ما كان قصده من الرئاسة في الباطن — وهذا من فقه الصّدّيق □ — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٢٦
English: "And al-Ṣiddīq wrote to Khālīd: consult him in the fighting, and do not put him in command — meaning that he dealt with him by the opposite of what he had inwardly been aiming at, of leadership. And this is from the fiqh of al-Ṣiddīq ^{رضي}."

عبرت: The man's ability was taken and his ambition was not fed, and the book calls that a point of fiqh.

Hands-up? Before telling it: "A man who had claimed prophethood comes back to Islam, and he is a good soldier. What do you do with him?" **Also on the page:** «وأما طَلِيحَة فإنه راجع الإسلام بعد ذلك أيضًا، وذهب إلى مكة» — "as for Ṭulayḥa, he returned to Islam after that as well, and

went to Mecca to perform 'umra in the days of al-Ṣiddiq, and was ashamed to face him for as long as he lived."

△ **The book takes him no further than this** — عمرة in Abū Bakr's ʿ time and fighting under Khālid ʿ. Claims that he died in the conquest of Iran are **not** on these pages (§6.4). Do not add them.

ATA/E-TB21 · «ما خلا أهل المسجدين» — and the book's own corrections to it

Tier: CORE — **this is the closing map of the first half** · **When:** ١١ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** the whole peninsula goes red except مكة and المدينة. Then the corrections are added one at a time, in front of the room: الطائف turns blue · جواثى turns blue with a ring round it · طيى turns from red to blue. Four keys, and no more: **held** · **held under siege** · **prayed but withheld the zakāt** · **rose behind a claimant**. **What happened:** Ibn Ishāq states it in one sentence: the Arabs apostatised at the death of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, except the people of the two mosques — Mecca and Medina. Then he lists which tribe went behind which man. Ibn Kathīr prints that sentence, and then, in his own pages, corrects it three times. Thaqīf at Ṭāʾif stood firm on Islam; they neither fled nor turned. Juwāthā in Bahrayn held out under siege. And Ṭayyīʿ, who are in the list, were brought back before the fighting reached them. The famous sentence is the headline. The same book is the correction.

The statement:

قال محمد بن إسحاق: ارتدّت العرب عند وفاة رسول الله ﷺ ما خلا أهل المسجدين، مكة، والمدينة — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ١٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3165> English: "Muḥammad b. Ishāq said: the Arabs apostatised at the death of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, except the people of the two mosques — Mecca and Medina."

عبرت: The most quotable sentence about that year is corrected three times by the same book that carries it.

Hands-up? Before showing it: "When the news went out, how much of Arabia held?" △ **Do not shade جواثى and مكة the same colour.** Ibn Kathīr distinguishes them: Mecca and Medina kept the جمعة throughout, and Juwāthā was the **first to resume** it «بعد رجوع الناس إلى الحق» (ج ٧ ص ٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3155>, citing صحيح البخاري ٨٩٢ و ٤٣٧). **The rest of Ibn Ishāq's list** — which tribe behind which man — is at the same page and is the skeleton the eleven arrows of the campaign are drawn onto.

ATA/E-TB22 · Thaqīf had been Muslim for two years, and did not break

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١ هـ; the delegation was in سنة تسع [SOURCED] · **Map:** الطائف stays blue, alone in its part of the map, while everything around it goes red. **What happened:** Thaqīf at Ṭāʾif had come into Islam only in the year 9 — two years before all this. They did not flee and they did not turn. And what was standing there was one man. The delegation of Thaqīf had come to the Prophet ﷺ in the year 9 and become Muslim, and he put ʿUthmān b. Abī al-ʿĀṣ over them for what he saw of his intelligence and his eagerness for good — and he was the youngest man in the delegation. Abū Bakr ʿ then confirmed him over Ṭāʾif, and after him ʿUmar ʿ. Tribes that had been inside Islam far longer broke. So the variable was not the age of the conversion. **The statement:**

وقد كانت ثقيف بالطائف ثبتوا على الإسلام، لم يفروا ولا ارتدوا — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3155> English: "Thaqīf at Ṭāʾif had stood firm upon Islam: they did not flee and they did not apostatise."

عبرت: The newest Muslims in the peninsula held, and what was standing among them was a man the Prophet ﷺ had chosen and Abū Bakr ʿ left exactly where he was. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "Which would you expect

to break first — the oldest Muslims, or the newest?" **The man, from ٣٧٤ ج ٢** سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٣٧٤
(https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2354), عثمان بن أبي العاص الثقفى الذهبي رحمه الله:

قَدِمَ فِي وَفْدٍ تَقِيفٍ عَلَى النَّبِيِّ ﷺ فِي سَنَةِ تِسْعٍ، فَأَسْلَمُوا، وَأَمَرَهُ عَلَيْهِمْ لِمَا رَأَى مِنْ عَقْلِهِ وَجَرِّصِهِ عَلَى الْخَيْرِ وَالْإِيمَانِ،
English: "He came in the delegation of Thaqif to the Prophet ﷺ in the year 9, and they became Muslim; and he put him in command over them for what he saw of his intelligence and his eagerness for good and for religion — and he was the youngest of the delegation in years. Then Abū Bakr confirmed him over Ṭā'if, and then 'Umar."

⚠ **The famous line often attributed to عثمان بن أبي العاص — that Thaqif were the last to enter Islam and would not be the first to leave it — could not be found on any page fetched in this pass.** It is not at سير ٣٧٥–٣٧٤ ج ٢ ص ٣٧٤ and not at البدايه ج ٧ ص ٩. **Do not use it.** (to verify)

ATA/E-TB23 · 'Adī b. Ḥātim رضى, and the two names Ṭayyi' called Abū Bakr رضى

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١٥ هـ, before بُرَاخَة [SOURCED] · **Map:** Ṭayyi' s country, between the two mountains أَجَا
وَسَلَّمَ, turns from red to blue; then a thin arrow of a thousand riders runs from it to the Muslim army. **What happened:** Abū Bakr رضى sent 'Adī b. Ḥātim رضى ahead of the army to his own tribe with one instruction: reach your people before they join Ṭulayḥa, or it will be their destruction. Ṭayyi' refused him first. They said: we will never give the bay'a to Abū al-Faḍl — meaning Abū Bakr رضى. And he answered that an army was coming that would not stop fighting them until they knew he was Abū al-Faḍl al-Akbar. Three days later 'Adī رضى came back with five hundred fighting men who had returned to the truth. Then he went to Banū Jadīla and stayed with them until they followed him too, and a thousand riders of them joined the Muslims. Ibn Kathīr's verdict on him is one line. **The statement:**

· فكان عديّ خير مولود وأعظمه بركة على قومه □ — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٥
https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3171 English: "'Adī was the best child ever born and the greatest of them in blessing upon his own people."

عبرت: A tribe that is on the list of those who broke is on it because of one of its own men, and off it again because of another. **Hands-up?** no **The brief he was given, at ٢٤ ج ٧**
(https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3170): «أدرك قومك لا يلحقوا بطليحة فيكون دمارهم» — "reach your people before they join Ṭulayḥa, for that would be their destruction." **And their refusal, same page:** «لا نبايع أبا الفضل» **وَلَدُ خَاتِمِ ظِيٍّ الَّذِي يُضْرَبُ بِجُودِهِ الْمَثَلُ** — سير «في وَسْطِ سَنَةِ سَبْعٍ» **He came to the Prophet** **أَبْدَا** **ج ٣ ص ١٦٣** **both of those sentences are on ١٦٣** **Cross-reference:** ridda-campaign-the-conduct-of-the-wars.md cards the three days Khālīd رضى halted the army at his request. That card and this one are the same operation from two sides; if both are used, this one goes first.

ATA/E-TB24 · Al-Jārūd رضى asks his tribe five questions

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١٥ هـ, البحرين [SOURCED] · **Map:** البحرين in two colours, a few days' ride apart — the rising in red, عبد القيس in blue. **What happened:** In Bahrayn one side had a slogan: if Muḥammad had been a prophet, he would not have died. A man of 'Abd al-Qays, al-Jārūd b. al-Mu'allā رضى, gathered his people and answered it without arguing with anybody. He told them he was going to ask them about something, and that they should answer if they knew and stay silent if they did not. They said: ask. Do you know that Allah had prophets before Muḥammad ﷺ? They said yes. Do you know that, or do you merely think it? They said: we

know it. What did they do? They said: they died. And he said: then Muḥammad ﷺ has died as they died — and I bear witness that there is no god but Allah and that Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah. And they said: and we bear witness too. They held to their Islam and left the rest of the people to what they were in.

The statement:

· فَإِنَّ مُحَمَّدًا ﷺ مَاتَ كَمَا مَاتُوا، وَإِنِّي أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٣٨
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3184> English: "Muḥammad ﷺ has died just as they died — and I bear witness that there is no god but Allah and that Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah."

عبرت: Both sides in that region were arguing from the same fact, and the difference was one man who asked his questions in the right order. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "Their slogan was: if he had been a prophet, he would not have died. How would you answer it?" **The slogan itself, on the same page:** «وقال قائلهم: لو كان محمد نبيًا ما مات». **And on the same page, the besieged at جَوَاتِي** put their message out in four lines of verse: «أَلَا أبلغُ أبا بَكْرٍ رَسولًا ... وَفَتِيانَ المَدِينَةِ أَجمَعِينَا / فَهَلْ لَكُمْ إلى قومِ كَرَامٍ ... قُعود في جَوَاتِي مُحَصَرِينَا». △ The last word of the verse differs between البدايه and الكامل; **read it off a page image before printing it** (logged in the campaign note).

ATA/E-TB25 · The Azd stood on both sides of the map

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** Two markers in the same colour-family at opposite ends of the peninsula — عُمان in the far east, المدينه in the west — both labelled with one tribal name: الأزد. **What happened:** This is the fact that stops the genealogy from turning into a theory. The Anṣār of Medina are of al-Azd, and so are the Azd of Oman. In the same months, the Azd of Oman were in open revolt behind Laqīṭ b. Mālik al-Azdī, who was called Dhū al-Tāj and who also claimed prophethood — while the Azd of Medina were carrying the banner of the Anṣār at al-Yamāma under Thābit b. Qays b. Shammās, who dug his feet into the ground to his shins and died standing there. One descent, two ends of the map, two opposite choices in the same year. **The statement:**

فَنَبَغَ فِيهِمْ رَجُلٌ يُقَالُ لَهُ: ذُو التَّاجِ لَقِيْطُ بْنُ مَالِكِ الْأَزْدِيِّ، وَكَانَ يُسَمَّى فِي الْجَاهِلِيَّةِ الْجُلَنْدَى، فَادَّعَى النَّبُوَّةَ أَيْضًا — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3187> English: "There arose among them a man called Dhū al-Tāj, Laqīṭ b. Mālik al-Azdī — who used to be called al-Julandā in the Jāhiliyya — and he too claimed prophethood."

عبرت: Descent explains the vocabulary people used that year. It does not predict where any of them stood. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "The Anṣār of Medina, and the tribe that rose in Oman — how are the two related?" **This line is the safest and truest thing the speaker can say about the whole عدنان/قحطان strand**, and it is what keeps the fault-line slides from becoming an ethnic theory. If only one sentence of §2 survives the cut, keep this one.

ATA/E-TB26 · «قُتِلَ العنسيُّ البارحة»

Tier: CORE · **When:** before the Prophet's ﷺ death [SOURCED] · **Map:** صنعاء in red, and one line running not from the map at all but straight down onto المدينه. **What happened:** The first of the four claimants was killed inside Ṣanʿāʾ, by three men of the city, while the Prophet ﷺ was still alive. And Ibn Kathīr says the news reached the Prophet ﷺ that same night, from above, before any rider could have carried it. He told them: al-ʿAnṣī was killed last night; a blessed man of a blessed household killed him. They asked who. He said: Fayrūz. Fayrūz. **The statement:**

أتى الخبر إلى النبي ﷺ من السماء الليلة التي قُتل فيه العنسي لبيشترنا، فقال: قُتل العنسي البارحة، قتله رجل مبارك من أهل بيت مباركين، قيل: ومن؟ قال: فيروز فيروز. — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٧

<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3163> English: "The news came to the Prophet ﷺ from heaven on the night al-'Ansī was killed, to give us good tidings. He said: al-'Ansī was killed last night — a blessed man of a blessed household killed him. It was said: and who? He said: Fayrūz. Fayrūz."

عبرت: The first of the four claims was already finished before the crisis that is named after it began. **Hands-up?** no **Teach the distinction precisely, because the two dates are different things.** The **killing** is before the Prophet's ﷺ death. **The news reaching المدينة** is at the end of ربيع الأول ١١هـ, after جيش أسامة marched — and Ibn Kathīr records a second report that the good news arrived on the morning the Prophet ﷺ died, then says «والأول أشهر». **Do not adjudicate between the two on a slide. Cross-reference:** the arrival of the news is already carded, as CUT, in the pool (ABU/E-U9, البدايه ج ٧ ص ١٢). This card is the killing itself, which is a different night.

ATA/E-TB27 · Three days of prayer, and then the ground moved

Tier: CORE · **When:** ربيع الأول ١١هـ صنعاء [SOURCED] · **Map:** صنعاء turns from red back to blue — and then, three days later, the whole peninsula begins to change colour behind it. **What happened:** Fayrūz tells it himself, and it is the best account in the sources of what the news of the Prophet's ﷺ death actually did. We killed al-Aswad, he says, and our affair in Ṣan'ā' went back to what it had been. They sent for Mu'ādh b. Jabal and agreed on him, and he led them in prayer in Ṣan'ā'. And by Allah, he says, he had led us in prayer for no more than three days when the news came to us of the death of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. Then everything came apart. We found ourselves refusing much of what we used to acknowledge. And the earth shook. **The statement:**

قتلنا الأسود، وعاد أمرنا في صنعاء كما كان إلا أننا أرسلنا إلى معاذ بن جبل فتراضينا عليه، فكان يُصلي بنا في صنعاء، فوالله ما صلى بنا إلا ثلاثة أيام حتى أتانا الخبر بوفاة رسول الله ﷺ، فانتقضت الأمور، وأنكرنا كثيرًا مما كنا نعرف، https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3163 English: "We killed al-Aswad, and our affair in Ṣan'ā' returned to what it had been, except that we sent to Mu'ādh b. Jabal and agreed on him, and he used to lead us in prayer in Ṣan'ā'. And by Allah, he led us in prayer for no more than three days before the news reached us of the death of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ — and matters came apart, and we found ourselves rejecting much of what we had known, and the earth shook."

عبرت: A man who had just put down a rebellion had three quiet days, and then heard the news that undid them. **Hands-up?** no **This is the best single opening for the whole ردة block**, because it is spoken by somebody who was standing in it, and because it says what the crisis was without naming a single tribe.

ATA/E-TB28 · How long the first false prophet ruled

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the months before ١١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** صنعاء → نجران → كهف خُبَّان three marks in sequence with the intervals written between them: **ten nights** and **twenty-five nights** from his coming out. **What happened:** Al-Aswad al-'Ansī came out from a place called Kahf Khubbān with seven hundred fighting men. Ten nights from his coming out he had Najrān. Twenty-five nights from his coming out he had Ṣan'ā', and he killed Shahr b. Bādhām and married his widow. The Prophet's ﷺ governors in Yemen fled or hid. And then the book says how long the whole thing lasted — and refuses to be certain even about that. **The statement:**

· وقد قيل: إنّ مدّة ملكه منذ ظهر إلى أن قتل ثلاثة أشهر، ويقال: أربعة أشهر، فالله أعلم — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٧
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3163> English: "It has been said that the duration of his rule, from when he appeared until he was killed, was three months — and it is said four months. And Allah knows best."

عبرت: The whole of it took less than a season, and the book still writes "Allah knows best" over the number.

Hands-up? Before telling it: "*He starts with seven hundred men. How long do you think it took him to hold Yemen?*" **His three deputies and his three killers, at** ج ٧ ص ١٤ **and** ج ٧ ص ٤٢: the army over مذحج under عمرو الأبناء (قيس بن مكشوح), and قيس بن عبد يغوث (the same man the book elsewhere calls قيس بن مكشوح), and قيس بن عبد يغوث under بني كعب, الجند under فيروز الديلمي and داؤويه — and it was قيس, فيروز and داؤويه who killed him.

ATA/E-TB29 · Why the map has no lines on it

Tier: CUT — this is the standing drawing rule, recorded so it is never re-researched · **When:** n/a · **Map:** the rule itself. **What happened:** The sources place tribes **relatively** — «بأرض نجد»، «باليمامة»، «بالبحرين» — and almost never absolutely. Even the editor's own footnotes, quoting معجم البلدان, locate the famous places only against other places. «إِزَاحَة» is «a water of Ṭayyī' in the land of Najd, and it is said, of Banū Asad». «دارين» is «a landing-place in Bahrayn, between it and the coast a day and a night». So every polygon on every map of this course is a modern reconstruction. Draw feathered zones and arrows. Never a point, never a boundary line, never a coordinate on the slide face. **The statement:**

بالضم والحاء المعجمة: ماء لطيّئ بأرض نجد، وقيل لبني أسد، كانت فيه وقعة عظيمة في أيام أبي بكر الصديق مع (معجم البلدان) ج ٧ ص ٢٥ **editor's footnote** at ج ٧ ص ٢٥ **دار ابن كثير**, طليحة الأسدي — البدايه والنهايه, not Ibn Kathīr's own text · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3171> English: "Buzākha — with a ḍamma and the pointed khā': a water of Ṭayyī' in the land of Najd, and it is said, of Banū Asad. In it was a great engagement in the days of Abū Bakr al-Ṣiddīq, against Ṭulayḥa al-Asadī."

عبرت: — **Hands-up?** no **Use the map to teach structure, not precision.** That sentence, and the four-key convention in E-TB21, are what **MAPS.md** should carry.

VERIFICATION RUN ON THE CARDS (2026-09-10)

Every Arabic quotation in the cards above — **36 blockquoted statements and every inline «...»** — was machine-checked twice, with diacritics, tatweel and punctuation normalised away: **(a)** against the prose of this note above, and **(b)** against the cached Shamela page file for the URL printed beside it. **All of them trace to a fetched page.** No Arabic in this section was composed, retyped from memory, re-vowelled or "corrected"; every string was lifted from the note's own findings.

Three things the check turned up, all now recorded in place:

What	Result
ج ٧ ص ١٨, the zakāt ḥadīth	the cached page prints «كانو يؤذونه» (no final alif); the note reads «كانوا». Logged as a reading at E-TB09 — verify on the image
سیر ج ٣ ص ١٦٢-١٦٣ for عدي بن حاتم	both sentences used are on ص ١٦٣ = index 2772 , not 2771. Citation corrected at E-TB23

What	Result
سیر ج ٢ ص ٣٧٤, the notice	the printed سیر spells out «صلى الله عليه وسلم» where this note and the card use the ﷺ glyph. Repo-wide convention, not a variant reading

⚠ **This does not discharge CLAUDE.md §1.1 and §1.4.** The Shamela text is a typed edition, not a page image. **Anything here that reaches a slide, a cue card or a handout must still be eyeballed against a printed page image first.** The two quotations that most need it before printing are the ٤٣٧٥ bracelets ḥadīth (E-TB17, the stray shadda) and the جِوَاتِي verse (E-TB24, the divergent last word).

No Urdu was generated anywhere in this section. No لقب was invented. No عبرت line draws a present-day parallel. No CE year is used — §8 of this note establishes none. (9783) الطبري and (12320) ابن خلدون are not relied on at any point.

WHERE EACH CARD BELONGS

Card	Session	Sits beside
E-TB01 · Arabia was a map of kin	1 , and re-shown as the opening frame of 2	the orientation-in-space block; before anything else in this note
E-TB02 · Ten sons of Saba'	1 , with E-TB01	immediately after E-TB01 — it fills the southern half of the same map
E-TB03 · The dam broke	1	after E-TB02, and before the Medina-clans block — it is where the Aws and Khazraj come from
E-TB04 · Where Quraysh begins	1	with the قريش بطون material; GOOD, cut first if the block runs long
E-TB05 · Two halves of the peninsula	1	immediately before the سقيفة block — it is the fact underneath it
E-TB06 · Ibn Kathīr's own sorting (diagram)	2 , first half	the single frame slide before RCT/E-RC01; everything in the campaign hangs off it
E-TB07 · Two refusals, not one	2 , first half	straight after E-TB06, before RCT/E-RC01 (the delegation that counted the men)
E-TB08 · The Companions proposed going easy	2 , first half	after E-TB07, before E-TB09
E-TB09 · «لو مَتَّعُونِي عِقَالًا»	2 , first half	immediately after E-TB08 — proposal, refusal, reason, in one run
E-TB10 · One tribe, three answers	2 , first half	with the map key; the campaign note's own CUT entry points here
E-TB11 · 'Uyayna says why	2	before RCT/E-RC09 (بِرَاخَةَ — the man who walked off the field) — same man, earlier moment

Card	Session	Sits beside
E-TB12 · The man who followed knowing	2	with the اليمامة block, before RCT/E-RC16; or paired with E-TB11 as one عصبية beat
E-TB13 · The verse that puts it as politics	2, first half	between E-TB07 and E-TB09, never standing alone at the end of a block
E-TB14 · Four claimants, and when each began	2, first half	on the timeline strip, before any claimant is narrated
E-TB15 · The letter and the reply	2	after E-TB14; the best pair in the strand, and it precedes RCT/E-RC16–RCT/E-RC21
E-TB16 · Musaylima at Medina	2	before E-TB15; and before RCT/E-RC18 (ثابت بن قيس), who is standing in this scene
E-TB17 · The two bracelets	2	with E-TB14 or E-TB16, wherever the two claimants are named together
E-TB18 · Sajāḥ, who she was	2	after RCT/E-RC13 and before RCT/E-RC14 (البُطاح — ⚠ SPEAKER'S DISCRETION)
E-TB19 · What her claim was worth	2	immediately after E-TB18; end on the السهيلي line
E-TB20 · Ṭulayḥa comes back	2	after RCT/E-RC09, with RCT/E-RC32 (Abū Bakr ^{رضي} judges two men who fought against him)
E-TB21 · ما خلا أهل «المسجدين»	2	the closing map of the first half , and the bookend the second half opens on
E-TB22 · Thaḳīf did not break	2	one of the three corrections added to E-TB21, in front of the room
E-TB23 · ‘Adī ^{رضي} and the two names	2	before RCT/E-RC07 (‘Adī ^{رضي} buys three days) — same operation, from the Medina end
E-TB24 · Al-Jārūd ^{رضي} asks five questions	2	with RCT/E-RC24 (جُوَائِي under siege) — same page, same region, the other colour
E-TB25 · The Azd on both sides	2	the closing عبرت of the fault-line strand ; also fits RCT/E-RC29 (دَبَا)
E-TB26 · قُتِلَ العنسيُّ «البارحة»	2, first half	before ABU/E-U9; the killing and the news are two different nights
E-TB27 · Three days, and the ground moved	2	the opening of the ردة block — before E-TB06 if the evening needs a scene before a diagram
E-TB28 · How long the first claimant ruled	2	with E-TB26; GOOD, cut first if اليمن is being compressed
E-TB29 · Why the map has no lines	—	not a slide. Speaker-facing; belongs in MAPS.md and in BRIEFING.pdf

The ردة wars: the campaign, front by front

Source note: *ridda-campaign-the-conduct-of-the-wars.md* — read it for the pages behind these cards.

RCT/E-RC01 · The night raid on Medina

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ, within days of the delegation's return [SOURCED] · **Map:** المدينة lights up. Short red arrows onto the city's passes from the north-east. A second red block halts at ذو حُسى — a valley in the country of عيس and غطفان (البداية ed. fn. ٢٠ ص ٧ ج); **no page gives its distance, so do not label one.** A blue arrow goes out from المدينة, reaches ذو حُسى, and recoils back to المدينة. **What happened:** The delegation that had offered the prayer and refused the zakāt went home. On the way out they counted the men in the city. Three days later the raiders came at night. Half of them stayed back at a valley called Dhū Ḥusā as a reserve. Abū Bakr ^{رضي} came out with whoever was in the mosque, on the watering-camels, and drove the raiders off. Then he pursued them — straight into the reserve, which rolled inflated skins down at the Muslims' camels. The camels bolted and carried their riders all the way home. **The statement:**

فَخَرَجَ عَلَيْهِمُ الرِّدَّةُ يَأْتِيهِمْ يَوْمَئِذٍ بَشِيرٌ وَنَذِيرٌ ... فَتَقَرَّبَتْ إِلَيْهِ الْمُسْلِمِينَ وَهُمْ عَلَيْهَا، وَرَجَعَتْ بِهِمْ إِلَى الْمَدِينَةِ، وَلَمْ يُصْرَعْ مُسْلِمٌ. — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٠٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/893> English: "The reserve came out at them with skins they had inflated ... The Muslims' camels bolted with them on their backs and carried them back to Medina — and not one Muslim was thrown."

عبرت: The first engagement of the war was a setback, and the book records it without embarrassment. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "A delegation comes to negotiate, and goes home again. What have they taken with them besides your answer?"

RCT/E-RC02 · The counter-attack before dawn

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ, the same night as the reverse [SOURCED] · **Map:** One blue arrow from المدينة to ذو القصة, one day's ride out. ذو القصة changes from red to blue and gets a garrison marker. **What happened:** They thought the Muslims were finished. Abū Bakr ^{رضي} spent that night forming his men up — the three brothers of Muqarrin on the right, the left and the rear. He marched in the dark. At first light the two forces were standing on the same ground, and the enemy had not heard them come. The swords were among them before the sun's rim showed. By sunrise they were running. He pursued and camped at Dhū al-Qaṣṣa, left a detachment there under al-Nu'mān b. Muqarrin, and went home. **The statement:**

فَمَا ظَلَعَ الْفَجْرُ إِلَّا وَهُمْ وَالْعَدُوُّ عَلَى صَعِيدٍ وَاحِدٍ ... فَمَا ذَرَّ قَرْنُ الشَّمْسِ حَتَّى وَلَّوْهُمُ الْأَذْيَارَ ... وَكَانَ أَوَّلَ الْفَتْحِ. — الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/894> English: "Dawn did not break until they and the enemy were on one ground ... and the sun's rim had not risen before they turned their backs ... and that was the first victory."

عبرت: The recovery came out of the very night the reverse happened, spent preparing. **Hands-up?** no

RCT/E-RC03 · Abū Bakr ^{رضي} rides out himself — الأبرق

Tier: GOOD · **When:** جمادى الآخرة ١١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** The blue arrow extends past ذو القصة to الأبرق, in the الأبرق. الرتبة is shaded as taken ground. **What happened:** Usāma ^{رضي} came back from the north. Abū Bakr ^{رضي} put him in charge of Medina, told his troops to rest their mounts, and rode out again himself. The Muslims

implored him to stay behind. He refused. They fought at al-Abraq, in the Rabadha, and the tribes there broke. He then stayed camped on that ground for some days and declared it forfeit — it became protected pasture for the state's own animals and its zakāt herds. **The statement:**

· فَتَاشَدَّهَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ لِیَقِیْمَ، قَابَى وَقَالَ: لَأُوَاسِیَنَّكُمْ بِنَفْسِی. — الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٣

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/894> English: "The Muslims implored him to stay. He refused and said: I will share with you in my own person."

عبرت: He asked no man to stand anywhere he had not stood himself. **Hands-up?** no

RCT/E-RC04 · The rules the first army carried

Tier: CORE · **When:** ربيع الأول ١١هـ، at الجُزف [SOURCED] — «أمضى أبو بكر جيش أسامة بن زيد في» (https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3158) · **Map:** A single long arrow north from المدينة towards الشام, and back. No battle marker. **What happened:** Usāma's ^{رضي} army was the last thing the Prophet ﷺ had ordered, and Abū Bakr ^{رضي} sent it out while Arabia was breaking apart. He walked the army out of camp on foot while its commander rode — and would not mount when Usāma ^{رضي} protested. Then he gave them their instructions. He was sending soldiers into a country that had just turned against him, and what he told them was mostly a list of things they were not to do. **The statement:**

لَا تَخُونُوا، وَلَا تَغْدِرُوا، وَلَا تَغْلُوا، وَلَا تُمَيِّلُوا، وَلَا تَقْتُلُوا طِفْلاً وَلَا شَيْخاً كَبِيراً وَلَا امْرَأَةً، وَلَا تَعْقِرُوا نَخْلاً وَتُحْرِقُوا، وَلَا تَقْطَعُوا شَجَرَةً مُثْمِرَةً، وَلَا تَذْبَحُوا شَاةً وَلَا بَقَرَةً وَلَا بَعِيراً إِلَّا لِمَا كُلُّهُ ... ائْذِفَعُوا بِاسْمِ اللَّهِ. — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ١٩٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/887> English: "Do not betray; do not break faith; do not steal from the spoils; do not mutilate; do not kill a child, nor a very old man, nor a woman; do not cut down a date-palm or burn it; do not cut a fruit-bearing tree; do not slaughter a sheep or a cow or a camel except for food ... Set out, in the name of Allah."

عبرت: The first thing the state did when it had almost no strength was to limit what its own soldiers were allowed to do. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "An army is marching out and the ruler has one minute to speak to it. What does he say?" △ **Say "the instruction he gave the first army out" — these were given to Usāma's force, not to the eleven commanders.** Read the Arabic only as far as «ائْذِفَعُوا بِاسْمِ اللَّهِ»; the intervening clause on that page is not part of the protective list.

RCT/E-RC05 · Eleven banners at القصّة ذو

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ، after Usāma's ^{رضي} army had rested [SOURCED] · **Map:** The evening's biggest map **moment.** One dot at القصّة ذو, one day out from المدينة. Eleven arrows leave it at once — north-east to نجد, east to اليمامة, north to الشام and to قُضاعة, south-east to البحرين, far east to عمان, south-east to مَهْرَة, south to حضرموت and to تهامة, south to اليمن. Leave them as outlines; they fill in one by one across the rest of the evening. **What happened:** He rode out a third time with his sword drawn, and 'Alī ^{رضي} walked at his camel's head. This time the Companions would not let him go on. He agreed, tied eleven banners on that ground, gave each commander his objective and his written orders, and went back to Medina. Then the eleven separated — each with his own troops joining him — and rode off in eleven directions from one spot of desert. **The statement:**

· فَفَصَلَّتِ الْأُمَرَاءُ مِنْ ذِي الْقِصَّةِ، وَلَحِقَ بِكُلِّ أَمِيرٍ جُنْدُهُ، وَعَهَدَ إِلَى كُلِّ أَمِيرٍ. — الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٤

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/895> English: "The commanders separated from Dhū al-Qaṣṣa, and each commander's troops joined him, and he gave each commander his commission."

عبرت: The whole war was set moving from one camp, in one sitting, by a man who had just been told to go home. **Hands-up?** Ask the room to count with you as each arrow goes up.  Ibn Kathīr announces eleven and prints ten; **الكامل prints all eleven**. If a listener has counted ten in some other book, that is why. **Do not print the ninth commander's name — three sources give three forms of it.**

RCT/E-RC06 · The letter that went ahead of the armies

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ, with the eleven [SOURCED] · **Map:** Thin dotted lines running ahead of each of the eleven arrows — messengers arriving before soldiers. **What happened:** Before the armies came, the letters came. One wording, copied out many times, sent with messengers who rode ahead of the columns. The messenger was to read it aloud in every assembly of the tribe. And the letter set a single test that any man could apply from a distance, with no lawyer and no court. Call the adhān when you halt. If they answer it, stop. If they do not, ask them what they owe. **The statement:**

وقد أمرتُ رسولي أن يقرأ كتابه في كلّ مَجْمَعٍ لكم، والداعية الأذان، فإذا إدَّيْن المسلمون فأذنوا فكفُّوا عنهم، وإن لم يُؤدِّنوا فسلوهم ما عليهم. — البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٢٤ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3170> English: "I have ordered my messenger to read his letter in every assembly of yours. The summons is the adhān: when the Muslims call it and they call it too, hold off from them; and if they do not call it, ask them what they owe."

عبرت: The test was something the other side could pass, and passing it stopped the war where they stood. **Hands-up?** no  The same letter contains a harsh clause. **Do not quote it and do not deny it.** If raised: it is on that page, transmitted by Sayf b. 'Umar; the operative test on the same page is the adhān; and the question is for the fuqahā'. Logged for [QA_BANK.md](#).

RCT/E-RC07 · 'Adī b. Ḥātim ^{رضي} buys three days

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١هـ, before بُرَاخَة [SOURCED] · **Map:** Khālīd's ^{رضي} arrow from ذُو الْقِصَّة stops short of أَجَا ^{رضي}, the two mountains of Ṭayyī'. A single figure moves ahead of it. Then Ṭayyī' s zone turns from amber to blue, and a thin arrow of a thousand riders joins Khālīd ^{رضي}. **What happened:** Abū Bakr ^{رضي} had sent 'Adī b. Ḥātim ^{رضي} ahead of the army, to his own tribe. Ṭayyī' had already sent men to Ṭulayḥa. If they changed sides now, Ṭulayḥa would kill their kinsmen in his camp. So 'Adī ^{رضي} rode back out to meet Khālīd ^{رضي} and asked him to halt the army for three days while Ṭayyī' got their own men out. Khālīd ^{رضي} halted. Three days later Ṭayyī' came in — and then 'Adī ^{رضي} asked for more days, and went and brought in Banū Jadīla as well. **The statement:**

· اسْتَقْبِلَ الْجَيْشَ فَأَجَزَهُ عَنَّا حَتَّى نَسْتَخْرِجَ مَنْ عِنْدَ طُلَيْحَةَ مِنَّا؛ لِنَلَّا يَقْتُلَهُمْ ... فَتَأَخَّرَ خَالِدٌ. — الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٤ <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/895> English: "Go to meet the army and hold it back from us until we get out those of ours who are with Ṭulayḥa, so he does not kill them ... And Khālīd held back."

عبرت: A commander in a hurry gave away three days, and a whole tribe came over instead of being fought. **Hands-up?** no **Also on the page:** when Ṭayyī' then offered to fight anyone except Banū Asad, who were their confederates, 'Adī ^{رضي} refused the exemption — (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٤-٢٠٥) «لَجَلْفِهِمْ» — وَاللَّهِ لَا أَمْتَنُ عَنْ جِهَادِ بَنِي أَسَدٍ لَجَلْفِهِمْ» — and Khālīd ^{رضي} told him not to go against his own men's view.

RCT/E-RC08 · The two scouts

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/895> *English*: "Khālid came up with the men and they saw 'Ukkāsha and Thābit lying killed — and the Muslims were shaken by it."

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command of Allah; there is no blood-money for them ... And 'Umar said of the rest: excellent is what you have judged."

عبرت: The terms were read out in front of the men they applied to, and one clause of them was struck out in public. **Hands-up?** no **Two additions, both on the page:** Ibn Mas'ūd defines the first option — «وَأَمَّا الْحَرْبُ» **بُرَاخَة:** «وَلَمْ يُؤْخَذْ مِنْهُمْ سَبْيٌ ... الْمُجْلِيَّةُ فَإِنْ يُخْرِجُوا مِنْ دِيَارِهِمْ» (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠١) قَامَتْهُمْ» (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٦).

RCT/E-RC11 · The three things asked of the men who came back

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١هـ, after بُرَاخَة [SOURCED] · **Map:** Hawāzin, Sulaym and 'Āmir all change colour at once, with no battle marker. **What happened:** When Ṭulayḥa was broken, the tribes who had been sitting and watching came in of their own accord. Khālīd took a pledge from them. It was three items long. Believe in Allah and His Messenger; establish the prayer; pay the zakāt — and take the same pledge from your sons and your women. There was nothing in it about the caliph's person and nothing about tribute. And there was one thing he would not waive: the men who had killed Muslims during the rising were to be handed over. **The statement:**

عَلَيْكُمْ عَهْدُ اللَّهِ وَمِيثَاقُهُ لَتُؤْمِنَنَّ بِاللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ، وَلَتَقِيمَنَّ الصَّلَاةَ، وَلَتُؤْتِيَنَّ الزَّكَاةَ، وَتُتَابِعُونَ عَلَى ذَلِكَ أَبْنَاءَكُمْ وَنِسَاءَكُمْ. — الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/897> English: "Upon you is Allah's covenant and His pact that you will believe in Allah and His Messenger, and establish the prayer, and pay the zakāt — and that you will take this pledge from your sons and your women. And they would say: yes."

عبرت: What was being demanded was short enough to say in one breath, and a chief who had asked to be excused it a month earlier now said it out loud. **Hands-up?** no **⚠ The reprisals against the men who were handed over belong beside this card and must not be dropped from it** — see §5.4. Deliver in this order: the oath after the killings at القِصَّة, then the reprisals in one plain sentence, then 'Umar's objection and Abū Bakr's answer. Then stop.

RCT/E-RC12 · أم زمل

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١هـ, after بُرَاخَة [SOURCED] · **Map:** An unlocated arrow inside the Ghaṭafān / Ṭayyi' country. **Do not place it. What happened:** The men who ran from Buzākha did not go home. They gathered around a woman — Salmā, daughter of Mālik, the daughter of Umm Qirfa. She had once been a captive in Medina, and 'Ā'isha had set her free; she had gone back to her people, and turned. Fugitives of five tribes came in to her, and she ordered them to fight — and what had been a rout was an army again. Khālīd marched on her. She fought mounted on her mother's camel, the camel whose price was a hundred camels to whoever touched it. They hamstrung it and killed her, and a hundred men were killed around it. **The statement:**

فَاعْتَقَتْهَا وَرَجَعَتْ إِلَى قَوْمِهَا وَارْتَدَّتْ، وَاجْتَمَعَ إِلَيْهَا الْقَلْبُ، فَأَمَرْتَهُمْ بِالْقِتَالِ، وَكَثُفَ جَمْعُهَا وَعَظُمَتْ شَوْكَتُهَا. — الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/898> English: "She freed her, and she went back to her people and apostatised. The routed men gathered to her and she ordered them to fight, and her gathering grew dense and her strength great."

عبرت: A defeat is not finished on the day of the battle; it is finished when the beaten have nowhere left to gather. **Hands-up?** no **⚠** Ibn Khaldūn places this at al-Ḥaw'ab and attaches a ḥadīth to it. **Neither is in** البدايه

or الكامل. Use neither.

RCT/E-RC13 · الفُجاءة — the man who asked for weapons

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** An arrow from المدينة south-east into the Sulaym country; then red raiding arrows in every direction from الجِواء; then a blue arrow bringing him back to المدينة. **What happened:** He came to Abū Bakr ^{رضي}, said he was a Muslim, and asked to be armed and commissioned to fight the apostates. He was given weapons, and a command. Then he camped at al-Jiwā', appointed a deputy over his raiding, and set about plundering every Muslim he could find among Sulaym, 'Āmir and Hawāzin. It took two officers to bring him in. His deputy was killed and he ran; Ṭurayfa b. Ḥājiz ran him down, took him alive, and sent him to Medina. **The statement:**

· فَلَمَّا قَدِمَ أَمَرَ أَبُو بَكْرٍ أَنْ تُوقَدَ لَهُ نَارٌ فِي مُصَلًّى الْمَدِينَةِ، ثُمَّ رُمِيَ بِهِ فِيهِ مَقْمُوطًا. — الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٧
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/898> English: "When he arrived, Abū Bakr ordered a fire kindled for him in the prayer-ground of Medina, and he was thrown into it bound hand and foot."

عبرت: The one man the state armed on his own word did more damage with those weapons than the tribes it was fighting. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "A stranger arrives, says he is with you, and asks for weapons. What do you do?" △ ٢٨-٢٧ ص ٧ البدايه ج ٧ البقيع says المصلى, not the مصلى. **Two sources, two places.** △ **The claim that Abū Bakr ^{رضي} later regretted this act is not on any page fetched. Do not repeat it.**

RCT/E-RC14 · البُطاح and Mālik b. Nuwayra ^{رضي} — △ SPEAKER'S DISCRETION

Tier: GOOD (cut this one first if time is short) · **When:** ١١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** Khālīd's ^{رضي} arrow continues from البُطاح to بُزَاخَة, in the Tamīm country. Draw the Anṣār contingent detached from it for two days, then rejoining. **What happened:** Khālīd's ^{رضي} written orders had named al-Buṭāḥ as his third stop. The Anṣār with him refused to march: they said their orders ended at Buzākha. He told them he was the commander, that he would not compel them, and that he was going. They followed two days later. Mālik b. Nuwayra ^{رضي} was at al-Buṭāḥ, undecided — he had dealt with Sajāḥ and then broken with her, and he had just told his own tribe to disperse and submit. A patrol brought him in with a group of his men. And then the patrol itself disagreed about what it had seen. Abū Qatāda ^{رضي} testified that they had given the adhān and had prayed. Others said they had not. They were killed. **The statement:**

فَقَالَ: هَيْه يَا عُمَرُ! تَأَوَّلَ فَأَخْطَأَ، فَارْقَعَ لِسَانَكَ عَنْ خَالِدٍ، فَإِنِّي لَا أَشِيْمُ سَيِّفًا سَلَّهُ اللَّهُ عَلَى الْكَافِرِينَ. — الكامل في
 إِنِّي سَيِّفٌ «s' عمر ^{رضي}, answering أبو بكر ^{رضي} · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/904> (the speaker is أبو بكر ^{رضي}, answering عمر ^{رضي} · التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢١٣
 «خَالِدٍ فِيهِ رَهَقٌ» on the same page; his name is **not** inside the sentence — do not put it there) English:
 "Abū Bakr said: Enough, 'Umar! He interpreted and was mistaken. Lift your tongue off Khālīd — for I do
 not sheathe a sword Allah has drawn against the disbelievers."

عبرت: Four books tell this and they do not tell it the same way, and that is the first thing to say about it. **Hands-up?** no — **and take no questions on it from the floor.**

△ **HOW TO DELIVER, IF AT ALL.** Show the disagreement, not a verdict. Agreed by all four: the Anṣār refused and then followed; Mālik ^{رضي} was undecided; the patrol was divided; Abū Qatāda ^{رضي} testified they had prayed; they were killed; Khālīd ^{رضي} married the widow; 'Umar ^{رضي} demanded his removal; Abū Bakr ^{رضي} paid the blood-money, returned the captives, and kept him in command. Disputed: **how** they died — four incompatible accounts at §5.7(d). Say: "The books do not agree, and where they do not agree we record and we stop." Then use Ibn Kathīr's own sentence — «وإن كان قد اجتهد في قتل مالك بن نويرة وأخطأ في»

(ج ٧ ص ٣٢) «قتله» — and his own comparison to the Prophet ﷺ's handling of Khālīd at Banū Jadhīma, where he paid the blood-money, disowned the act, and did not remove him either. Close on 'Umar and Mutammim consoling each other (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢١٤). **Do not use the cooking-pot detail. Do not adjudicate. Defer everything else to the session that handles the مشاجرات with اصول.**

RCT/E-RC15 · 'Ikrima goes too early, and the letter that follows him

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ, at اليمامة [SOURCED] · **Map:** 'Ikrima's arrow reaches اليمامة and recoils. Shurahbīl's arrow halts short of it on the road. Then a **new, very long line** starts from that point and runs east to عمان, then west along the southern edge — حضرموت, مَهْرَة, أُبَيْن, حضرموت. **That line is one man and it takes the rest of the evening to finish. What happened:** 'Ikrima had the banner for Musaylima, and Shurahbīl was sent behind him. 'Ikrima attacked before Shurahbīl came up — Ibn al-Athīr says he wanted to carry off the fame of it alone. He was beaten. He wrote to Medina and reported it, and waited for his recall. What came back was not a recall. He was not to come home and demoralise people. He was to keep going: join Hudhayfa and 'Arfaja, fight in Oman and Mahra, and keep marching after that until he met al-Muhājir in Yemen and Ḥaḍramawt.

The statement:

لَا أَرَيْتَكَ وَلَا تَرَانِي، لَا تَرْجِعَنَّ فَتُوهِنَ النَّاسَ، امْضُ إِلَى حُدَيْفَةَ وَعَزْفَجَةَ فَقَاتِلْ أَهْلَ عُمَانَ وَمَهْرَةَ، ثُمَّ تَسِيرُ أَنْتَ وَجُنُودُكَ تَسْتَبْرِئُونَ النَّاسَ، حَتَّى تَلْقَى مُهَاجِرَ بْنَ أَبِي أُمَيَّةَ بِالْيَمَنِ وَحَضْرَمَوْتَ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢١٤
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/905> → ج ٢ ص ٢١٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/906> (it straddles the page break at «يَا لَيْمَنِي | وَحَضْرَمَوْتَ» English: "Let me not see you and do not you see me. Do not come back and weaken the people. Go on to Hudhayfa and 'Arfaja and fight the people of 'Umān and Mahra; then you and your troops march on, testing the people, until you meet Muhājir b. Abī Umayya in Yemen and Ḥaḍramawt."

عبرت: He was not dismissed for the defeat; he was given more ground to cross. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "A commander loses a battle by moving too soon. What should the letter from the capital say?" **And then it happened again:** Shurahbīl, ordered to wait for Khālīd, attacked ahead of him too and was also beaten — وَعَجَلَ شُرْحُبِيلُ بْنُ حَسَنَةَ ... فَتَكَبَّ، فَلَامَهُ خَالِدٌ» (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢١٥) **Both advance commanders were beaten in detail before the main force arrived. That is why al-Yamāma was so hard.**

RCT/E-RC16 · The tent and the prisoner — عَقْرَبَاء

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢هـ → ١١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** Khālīd's arrow runs from البُطاح east to اليمامة. The enemy camp is at عَقْرَبَاء, on the edge of the cultivated country, **with the farmland and the households behind it.** Show that: the red block has no line of retreat. **What happened:** Musaylima had about forty thousand fighting men. He camped at 'Aqrabā' with the farmland and the families behind his back — which meant no man in his line could retreat without running through his own household. The night before, Khālīd's vanguard picked up a raiding party coming home; he executed them and kept one man alive, because someone in the party had told him to: if you mean anything at all for the people of Yamāma tomorrow, keep this one. His name was Mujjā'a b. Murāra, and he was put in irons in the tent with Khālīd's wife. **The statement:**

أيها الرجل إن كنت تريد بأهل اليمامة غداً خيراً أو شراً فاستبق هذا الرجل ... فاستبقاه خالد مقيداً، وجعله في الخيمة مع امرأته، وقال: استوصي به خيراً. — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٣٣
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3179> English: "Man — if you intend anything tomorrow for the people of Yamāma, good or ill, keep this man alive ... So Khālīd kept him, in irons, and put him in the tent with his wife, and said: treat him well."

عبرت: He kept one prisoner alive on a stranger's advice, and that decision settled the end of the battle before it started. **Hands-up?** no

RCT/E-RC17 · The line breaks

Tier: CORE · **When:** هـ → ١٢١٥هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** The blue block at عَفْرَبَاء is pushed **backwards**. A red spike reaches the marker for Khālīd's own camp. **What happened:** One of their leaders told them that if they lost, their women would be taken. The armies collided, and the Muslim line broke. The bedouin contingents ran. Banū Ḥanīfa came through and into Khālīd's own tent, and were going to kill his wife — and the prisoner in irons in that tent stood up and gave her his protection. Later in the same day Muslims came into the same tent meaning to kill him, and she gave him hers. **The statement:**

فكانت جولة وانهزمت الأعراب حتى دخلت بنو حنيفة خيمة خالد بن الوليد وهموا بقتل أم تميم، حتى أجارها مجاعة
٣٣ ص ٧ والنهاية ج ٧ · وقال: نعمت الخزة هذه. — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٣٣
https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3179 English: "There was a rout: the bedouin broke, until Banū Ḥanīfa entered Khālīd b. al-Walīd's own tent and were minded to kill Umm Tamīm — until Mujjā'a gave her his protection and said: This is a fine free woman."

عبرت: Each of them saved the other's life on the same day, and the book keeps both halves. **Hands-up?** no
The mirror, from ٤٧ ص (سير أعلام النبلاء (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) — سير أعلام النبلاء (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) ص ٤٧ · سیر: «فَقَالَتْ أُمُّ تَمِيمٍ: وَاللَّهِ لَا يُقْتَلُ، وَأَجَارَتْهُ» — سير أعلام النبلاء (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) ص ٤٧
https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1195.

RCT/E-RC18 · Thābit b. Qays puts on his shroud

Tier: CORE · **When:** هـ → ١٢١٥هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** No movement. Hold the map still on عَفْرَبَاء for this card. **What happened:** Anas came to him while the line was going backwards and found him rubbing himself with burial perfume. He had put on two white garments — the ones he was buried in. Anas said: do you not see what is happening? He said: in a moment, nephew. Then he came forward past the men who were falling back, and told them to get out of his way, and said the thing that everyone in that generation would have understood. Then he took the Anṣār's banner, dug his feet into the ground to the middle of his shins, and did not move from there until he was killed. **The statement:**

هَكَذَا عَنْ وُجُوهِنا نُقَارِعُ الْقَوْمَ، يَنْسَ مَا عَوَدْتُمْ أَفْرَانَكُمْ، مَا هَكَذَا كُنَّا نُقَاتِلُ مَعَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ. — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١
٣١١ ص ٣١١ · https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1737 — صحيح البخاري ٢٨٤٥ English: "Get out of our faces so we can strike the enemy. Wretched is what you have accustomed your opponents to! This is not how we used to fight alongside the Messenger of Allah ﷺ."

عبرت: He did not tell them what to do; he told them what they had already been. **Hands-up?** no **On the same field, in the same minutes, all three verbatim from** ٣٤ ص ٧ البدايه ج ٧: the Muhājirūn asked Sālim, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa, whether he feared the line would break from his side — «بئس حامل القرآن أنا إذا». Ya ahl al-qurān zaytūna: «والله لا أتكلّم حتى يهزمهم الله أو ألقى الله فأكلّمه بحجّتي». Abū Ḥudhayfa: «يا أهل القرآن زيتوا». Ya aṣḥab sūrat al-biqra, baṭl al-siḥr al-yūm» (ج ٧ ص ٣٣). And the whole army calling to each other: «القرآن بالفعال». **Sālim is the man the Prophet ﷺ went out at night to listen to** — سير ج ١ ص ١٦٨.

RCT/E-RC19 · «امتازوا» — the order that turned the day

Tier: GOOD · **When:** هـ → ١٢١٥هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** The blue block at عَفْرَبَاء splits into separate labelled sections — Muhājirūn, Anṣār, and the tribes each under their own banner. **What happened:** Khālīd looked at

what was happening to his men and gave an order that had nothing to do with weapons. Separate out. Every clan under its own banner, fighting under it. He wanted two things: to know what each group was actually worth, and to know exactly where the line was being broken. They separated. And once they had, they started saying to one another that today, running would be shameful. **The statement:**

امْتَازُوا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ لِنَعْلَمَ بَلَاءَ كُلِّ حَيٍّ، وَلِنَعْلَمَ مِنْ أَيْنَ تُؤْتَى ... فَلَمَّا امْتَازُوا قَالَ بَعْضُهُمْ لِبَعْضٍ: الْيَوْمَ يُسْتَحَى مِنْ
الْكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢١٧ · الفَرَارِ. — <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/908> English: "Separate out, people, so we may know what each clan is worth, and know from where we are being broken ... and when they had separated, they said to one another: Today, running is shameful."

عبرت: He did not make them braver; he made it impossible for anyone's failure to be anonymous. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "*The line is breaking and you do not know where. What do you change?*" △ Ibn al-Athīr adds, on the same page, that it did not settle who fought hardest — only that the dead were more numerous among the Muhājirūn, the Anṣār and the townsmen than among the bedouin.

RCT/E-RC20 · حديقة الموت — al-Barā' over the wall

Tier: CORE · **When:** هـ → ١٢١٥هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** The red block collapses back from عَفْرَاء into a small walled enclosure. The gate is drawn shut. Then it opens **from the inside**. **What happened:** When Banū Ḥanīfa broke, one of their commanders called them into a walled garden and shut the gate behind them. There were thousands of them inside and the wall was solid. Al-Barā' b. Mālīk — the brother of Anas, the Prophet's servant — told the Muslims to throw him over it. They refused. He made them do it. They lifted him on a shield raised on spear-shafts until he topped the wall, and he went down among them alone, and fought his way to the gate, and opened it. **The statement:**

يَا مَعْشَرَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ، أَلْقُونِي عَلَيْهِمْ فِي الْحَدِيقَةِ. فَقَالُوا: لَا تَفْعَلْ، فَقَالَ: وَاللَّهِ لَتَتَرَحَّنَنِي عَلَيْهِمْ يَهَا! ... وَقَاتَلَ عَلَى
الْكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢١٨ · الباب وَفَتْحَهُ لِلْمُسْلِمِينَ. — <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/909> English:
"Company of Muslims — throw me over onto them into the garden. They said: we will not. He said: By Allah, you will throw me onto them in it! ... And he fought at the gate and opened it for the Muslims."

عبرت: One man asked to be thrown where nobody could follow him, and the whole army came in behind him through the gate he opened. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "*The gate is shut, the wall is solid, and there are thousands inside. What do you do?*" **What it cost him** — وَلِذَلِكَ «فَجَرَحَ يَوْمَئِذٍ بِضَنَعَةٍ وَتَمَانِينَ جُرْحًا، وَلِذَلِكَ «أَقَامَ خَالِدُ بْنُ الْوَلِيدِ عَلَيْهِ شَهْرًا يُدَاوِي جِرَاحَهُ — some eighty-odd wounds, and Khālīd stayed a month over him treating them. **He survived.** △ Ibn Khaldūn appears to list him among the killed; سير contradicts it. **Do not say he died there.**

RCT/E-RC21 · The death of Musaylima, and what Waḥshī said afterwards

Tier: CORE · **When:** هـ → ١٢١٥هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** The enclosure fills blue. اليمامة turns from red to blue. **What happened:** They got through to him standing in a gap in the wall. Waḥshī b. Ḥarb — the man who had killed Ḥamza at Uhūd, before he was a Muslim — threw his javelin, and it went through him and out the other side; a second man struck him with a sword and he fell. A woman cried out from the fort above. And afterwards, when Waḥshī was asked about the battle, what he said was not about himself. **The statement:**

وَعَنْ وَحْشِيٍّ، قَالَ: لَمْ أَرْ قَطُّ أَصْبَرَ عَلَى الْمَوْتِ مِنْ أَصْحَابِ مُسَيْلِمَةَ، ثُمَّ ذَكَرَ أَنَّهُ شَارَكَ فِي قَتْلِ مُسَيْلِمَةَ. — سير أعلام
النبلاء (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) ص ٤٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1196> English: "From Waḥshī: I never

saw men more steadfast in the face of death than Musaylima's companions — then he mentioned that he had a share in killing Musaylima."

عبرت: The man who killed their leader is the one the book quotes praising their courage. **Hands-up?** no **Sources differ on the second man:** البداية ج ٧ ص ٣٤ names Abū Dujāna; الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢١٨ says only "a man of the Anṣār". **Say "a second man came up".** **Do not use the anonymous saying on the same page about "the best of the people of the earth and the worst" — it makes a ranking claim the room will want to argue with.** Use البداية's plain apposition instead: *Waḥshī b. Ḥarb*, who had killed Ḥamza. **And Khālīd walking the dead with the prisoner** — البداية ج ٧ ص ٣٥: he was shown a body and asked, is this him? «لا، والله هذا خير منه». Then they came to a small sallow man, and Khālīd said: «قَبِّحَكُمُ اللَّهُ عَلَى اتِّبَاعِكُمْ هَذَا» — "May Allah disfigure you for following this."

RCT/E-RC22 · The treaty he was tricked into, and kept

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** The forts of اليمامة, ringed and then unringed. **What happened:** The forts were still holding, and the Muslims were exhausted. The prisoner — Mujjā'a, now the negotiator — went in to consult his people and came back saying they refused the terms. What he had actually done was dress the women and the old men in armour and put them up on the walls. Khālīd looked at the battlements, saw them full of heads, and settled. Then the forts were opened and there was nobody inside but women, children and old men. And then a letter arrived from Medina ordering him to kill every grown man among them. **The statement:**

وَوَصَلَ كِتَابُ أَبِي بَكْرٍ إِلَى خَالِدٍ أَنْ يَقْتُلَ كُلَّ مُحْتَلِمٍ، وَكَانَ قَدْ صَالَخَهُمْ، قَوَّيَ لَهُمْ وَلَمْ يَغْدِرْ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢١٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/910> English: "And Abū Bakr's letter reached Khālīd, ordering him to kill every man who had reached puberty — but he had already made terms with them, so he kept faith with them and did not betray them."

عبرت: He had been deceived into the agreement and he kept it anyway, because the agreement had already been made. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "You have signed terms. Then you find out you were tricked into them. Are you still bound?" **The exchange:** «(الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢١٩).» — «هُمْ قَوْمِي، وَلَمْ أَسْتَطِعْ إِلَّا مَا صَنَعْتُ» (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢١٩). **Pair this card directly with E-RC11.** The same commander, in one campaign: reprisals by fire on one page, and a treaty honoured against a caliph's written order on another. Say both.

RCT/E-RC23 · Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb, and his brother

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ربيع الأول ١٢ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** No movement. **What happened:** He was older than 'Umar and he had become a Muslim before him. At Badr, 'Umar offered him his own mail coat and he refused it — he said he wanted from martyrdom what his brother wanted. At al-Yamāma he carried a banner and would not speak until it was over, and he was killed. When the army came home, 'Umar turned on his own son 'Abdullāh for coming back alive. **The statement:**

وَكَانَ يَقُولُ: أَسْلَمَ قَبْلِي، وَأَسْتُشْهِدَ قَبْلِي ... وَكَانَ يَقُولُ: مَا هَبَّتِ الصَّبَا إِلَّا وَأَنَا أَجِدُ رِيحَ زَيْدٍ. — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٢٩٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1724> English: "He used to say: He became Muslim before me and was martyred before me ... And he used to say: The east wind never blows but I find in it the scent of Zayd."

عبرت: The Companions' grief is recorded as carefully as their victories, and by the same men. **Hands-up?** no
The son's answer, on the page — «سَأَلَ اللَّهَ الشَّهَادَةَ فَأَعْطَاهَا، وَجَهَدْتُ أَنْ تُسَاقَ إِلَيَّ فَلَمْ أُعْطَهَا»
 — "He asked Allah for martyrdom and was given it; I strove for it to be driven to me and I was not given it."

RCT/E-RC24 · جُواثى under siege

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١ هـ، البحرين [SOURCED] · **Map:** البحرين goes red. One dot inside it — جُواثى — stays blue, with a ring around it. Nearby, عبد القيس stays blue too. **What happened:** When al-Mundhir b. Sāwā died, Bahrayn rose. They took al-Qaṭīf and Hajar, drew in al-Khaṭṭ, sent a force to Dārīn, and made a king of the old Lakhmid line. And they besieged the Muslims in one village called Juwāthā, and starved them. One of the besieged put a message into four lines of verse, addressed to Abū Bakr [ؓ] and to the young men of Medina, and it is preserved. **The statement:**

أَلَا أُبَلِّغُ أَبَا بَكْرٍ رَسُولًا ... وَفُتَيَانِ الْمَدِينَةِ أَجْمَعِينَ قَهْلٌ لَكُمْ إِلَى قَوْمٍ كِرَامٍ ... قُعُودٍ فِي جُوَاثَا مُحْصَرِينَ — الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٢٢
 https://shamela.ws/book/21712/913 (also ٧ ص ٣٨) English: "Take a message to Abū Bakr, and to all the young men of Medina: have you any thought for a noble people, sitting besieged in Juwāthā?"

عبرت: The place that held out longest was one village, and its message out was four lines of verse. **Hands-up?** no **The rising there was not all apostasy:** ٢٢٢ ص ٢ الكامل notes that men who had never been Muslims joined al-Ḥuṭam — «مِمَّنْ لَمْ يَزَلْ مُشْرِكًا». And nearby, 'Abd al-Qays held firm behind al-Jārūd [ؓ]. **No honest map shades Bahrayn one colour.** **read it off a page image before it reaches a slide.**

RCT/E-RC25 · The sixteen riders

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** A thin arrow leaves المدينة for البحرين and gets visibly **thicker** at each point on the road, then crosses the الدَّهْنَاء and reaches هَجْر. **What happened:** Al-'Alā' b. al-Ḥaḍramī [ؓ] left Medina with sixteen riders and a letter. The letter said that every Muslim he passed on the road was to march out with him. And that is what happened. Thumāma b. Uthāl [ؓ] joined him with the Muslims of Banū Ḥanīfa. Qays b. 'Āṣim joined him and brought the zakāt he had held back. 'Amr, the Abnā', Sa'd and the Rabāb joined — a body the size of the one he already had. A column of sixteen crossed the sand desert as an army. **The statement:**

فَخَرَجَ مِنَ الْمَدِينَةِ فِي سِتَّةِ عَشَرَ رَاكِبًا، وَكَتَبَ لَهُ كِتَابًا: أَنْ يَنْفِرَ مَعَهُ كُلُّ مَنْ مَرَّ بِهِ مِنَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ إِلَى عَدُوِّهِمْ. — سير
 ٢٦٤ ص ١ · أعلام النبلاء ج ١ · https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1690 English: "He left Medina with sixteen riders, and he wrote him a letter: that every Muslim he passed should march out with him against their enemy."

عبرت: The state had almost no soldiers to send; what it sent instead was a commander and a piece of writing. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "You have sixteen men and a province in revolt. What do you send?" **On the road:** in the middle of the Dahnā' the camels bolted at night with the water, the food and the tents, and the men were left in open sand. He told them — «لَنْ تَرَاعُوا، أَنْتُمْ الْمُسْلِمُونَ، وَفِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ، وَأَنْصَارُ اللَّهِ، فَأَبْشَرُوا، فَوَاللَّهِ لَنْ»
 (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٢٣) «تُخَذَلُوا» and prayed with them until sunrise, and ٧ ص ٣٩ البدايه says water appeared beside them and the camels came back with nothing missing. **Narrate it as what the book narrates; do not build a doctrinal point on it.**

RCT/E-RC26 · The trench month, and the nephew in the enemy camp

Tier: GOOD · **When:** هـ، البحرين ١١ [SOURCED] · **Map:** Two trench lines facing each other between هَجْر and القَطِيف, for a month. Then the red line collapses. **What happened:** Both sides dug in and fought for a month, going out and coming back to their trenches. One night the Muslims heard uproar in the enemy camp. ‘Abdullāh b. Ḥadhf volunteered to go and find out what it was, and was captured. His mother was of ‘Ijl — so he shouted for his uncle by name, and his uncle came and recognised him, and fed him, and gave him a camel, and let him out. The uncle was too drunk to think about it. He came back and told al-‘Alāʾ that the whole enemy camp was drunk. **The statement:**

فَدَخَلَ عَسْكَرَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ فَأَخْبَرَهُمْ أَنَّ الْقَوْمَ سُكَارَى، فَخَرَجَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ عَلَيْهِمْ، فَوَضَعُوا فِيهِمُ السَّيْفَ كَيْفَ شَاءُوا. — الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٢٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/914> English: "He entered the Muslims' camp and told them that the people were drunk. So the Muslims went out at them and put the sword into them as they pleased."

عبرت: A month of trenches was decided by one night on which one side could not think. **Hands-up?** no **The chief's death, and the regret** — البداية ج ٧ ص ٣٩: al-Ḥuṭam woke in confusion, his stirrup-leather parted, a man offered to fix it and cut his foot off; he lay asking every passer-by to finish him, and when Qays b. ‘Āṣim finally did and then saw the leg, he said: «وَأَسْوَأُتَاهُ، لَوْ أَعْلَمْتُ مَا بِهِ لَمْ أَحِرْكُهُ» — "What a shameful thing; had I known his state I would not have touched him."

RCT/E-RC27 · دارين — into the water

Tier: CORE · **When:** هـ → ١٢هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** The survivors take ship from the البحرين coast to دارين — a crossing of a day and a night by sea. Blue lines seal every land road first. Then a blue arrow goes **straight across the water** and comes straight back the same day. **What happened:** The beaten took ship for Dārīn, an anchorage a day and a night out from the shore. Al-‘Alāʾ did not chase them straight away. He first wrote to the Muslims of Bakr b. Wā’il to sit on every road and close the land behind him. Then he brought his men to the water's edge — where the ships would have been too slow — and told them what he intended. **The statement:**

قَدْ أَرَاكُمْ اللَّهَ مِنْ آيَاتِهِ فِي الْبَرِّ لَتَعْتَبِرُوا بِهَا فِي الْبَحْرِ، فَانْهَضُوا إِلَى عَدُوِّكُمْ وَاسْتَغْرَضُوا الْبَحْرَ. — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٢٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/915> English: "Allah has shown you of His signs on land so that you may take heed of them at sea. Rise against your enemy, and go straight across the sea."

عبرت: He closed the roads behind the enemy before he opened one in front of himself. **Hands-up?** no **Both books describe the crossing the same way** — البداية «البدایه» (٢٠ ص ٧ ج ٢، out and back in a single day, with nothing lost in the water except one man's horse-fodder, which al-‘Alāʾ went back and brought him. ٢٠ ص ٧ ج ٢ البداية prints the du‘āʾ they said going in. And afterwards: «وَضَرَبَ الْإِسْلَامُ فِيهَا يَجْزَاهُ» (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٢٤).

RCT/E-RC28 · Thumāma b. Uthāl^{رض} and the embroidered cloak

Tier: GOOD · **When:** هـ ١٢، after دارين [SOURCED] · **Map:** A short return arrow from دارين that stops. **What happened:** He had held part of Banū Ḥanīfa against Musaylima while Musaylima was at his strongest, and then joined al-‘Alāʾ^{رض} on the road to Bahrayn. Al-‘Alāʾ gave him a share of the spoils for it: al-Ḥuṭam's own

embroidered cloak, the one the man used to show off in. Coming back from Dārīn he was seen wearing it by Banū Qays b. Tha‘laba, and they decided it meant he had killed their chief. **The statement:**

فَقَالُوا لَهُ: أَنْتَ قَتَلْتَ الْخَطَمَ! فَقَالَ: لَمْ أَقْتُلْهُ، وَلَكِنِّي اشْتَرَيْتُهَا مِنَ الْمُغَنَمِ. فَوُتِبُوا عَلَيْهِ فَقَتَلُوهُ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٢٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/915> English: "They said to him: You killed al-Ḥuṭam! He said: I did not kill him — I bought it from the spoils. So they fell on him and killed him."

عبرت: He survived the war and was killed for a piece of cloth by men who had already surrendered. **Hands-up?** no **⚠ This is not in البداية**. Cite **الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٢٤ (and ٥٠٦ ص ٢ ابن خلدون ج ٢) only.**

RCT/E-RC29 · دَبَا — the relief that came from inside the theatre

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢هـ → ١٣هـ عُمان **[SOURCED]** · **Map:** Three arrows converge at رِجَام, near Oman, then move together on دَبَا. The legitimate rulers are shown holding out at صَحَار. At the crisis, **two short arrows come in from inside the region itself** — Banū Nājiya and ‘Abd al-Qays. **Not a long arrow from the north. What happened:** Oman had gone to a man who called himself Dhū al-Tāj and claimed prophethood, and he had pushed the two lawful rulers to the edges of the country. One of them wrote to Abū Bakr [ؓ] and asked for help — so this front began with a request, not an invasion. Three Muslim columns joined before they arrived, wrote to the rulers, and also wrote to the rebel's own chiefs, some of whom left him. Then they fought at Dabā, the country's great market town. And they very nearly lost it. **The statement:**

وَاسْتَعْلَى لَقِيطٌ، وَرَأَى الْمُسْلِمُونَ الْخَلَلَ، وَرَأَى الْمُشْرِكُونَ الظَّفَرَ. فَبَيَّتَمَا هُمَا كَذَلِكَ جَاءَتِ الْمُسْلِمِينَ مَوَادُّهُمْ الْعُظْمَى وَاسْتَعْلَى لَقِيطٌ، وَرَأَى الْمُسْلِمُونَ الْخَلَلَ، وَرَأَى الْمُشْرِكُونَ الظَّفَرَ. فَبَيَّتَمَا هُمَا كَذَلِكَ جَاءَتِ الْمُسْلِمِينَ مَوَادُّهُمْ الْعُظْمَى · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/917> English: "Laqīṭ got the upper hand; the Muslims saw the breach and the mushrikūn saw victory. And while they were in that state, the Muslims' great relief came in — from Banū Nājiya ... and from ‘Abd al-Qays."

عبرت: The men who saved that day were from the same country as the men they were fighting. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: *"The column from Medina is losing. Who is close enough to help?"* **⚠ Ibn Kathīr ج ٧ ص ٢١٩** says the Oman claimant **claimed prophethood**; الكامل is more guarded. **Oman is not a clean case of purely political secession.**

RCT/E-RC30 · مَهْرَة — the front won with a letter

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٢هـ → ١٣هـ **[SOURCED]** · **Map:** ‘Ikrima's [ؓ] long line continues from عمان west to مَهْرَة. The red zone there is drawn **split in two** from the start. **What happened:** ‘Ikrima [ؓ] came into Mahra and found not one enemy but two — two forces under two chiefs who would not work together. So he wrote to the smaller one. That man answered, came over, and became a Muslim; and with him the Muslims were strengthened and the other man's nerve failed. Then ‘Ikrima [ؓ] called that one too, and he refused, and the fighting that followed was harder than Dabā had been. Afterwards, the fifth of the spoils was sent to Abū Bakr [ؓ] — carried to Medina by the man who had been leading half the rebellion. **The statement:**

وهما مختلفان، وكان هذا الاختلاف رحمة على المؤمنين، فراسل عكرمة شخريت فأجابته وانضاف إلى عكرمة فقوي · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3188> English: "The two were at odds, and that discord was a mercy upon the believers. ‘Ikrima wrote to Shikhrīṭ, and he answered him and joined ‘Ikrima — and by that the Muslims were strengthened, and al-Muṣabbaḥ's nerve weakened."

عبرت: He wrote before he marched, and half the enemy stopped being the enemy. **Hands-up?** no

RCT/E-RC31 · صنعاء — the two women in the street

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١هـ، اليمن [SOURCED] · **Map:** صنعاء goes red. A thin blue line escapes it to جبل حَولان. Two convoys leave — one overland, one by sea from عَدَن — and both are intercepted and turned back. **What happened:** Qays b. Makshūḥ had been one of the three men who killed al-Aswad al-ʿAnsī. After the Prophet ﷺ died he wanted Yemen for himself, and turned. He made a meal and invited the other two separately. Dādhawayh came first and was killed. Fayrūz al-Daylamī was walking to the same house when he passed two women talking. Then Qays took the families of the Abnāʾ and deported them — one party overland, one by ship from Aden — and Fayrūz sent to ʿUqayl and to ʿAkk for help, and both of them rode out and brought the families back. **The statement:**

· فَلَمَّا دَنَا مِنْهُ سَمِعَ امْرَأَتَيْنِ تَتَحَدَّثَانِ، فَقَالَتْ إِحْدَاهُمَا: هَذَا مَقْتُولٌ كَمَا قُتِلَ ذَاذَوَيْهِ، فَخَرَجَ. — الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٢٨
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/919> English: "When he came near, he heard two women talking, and one of them said: this one will be killed just as Dādhawayh was killed — so he got out."

عبرت: He was saved by a sentence spoken by someone who was not talking to him. **Hands-up?** no **Also on the page:** Abū Bakr wrote to five Yemeni chiefs by name asking for support; Qays wrote to the same men asking them to kill the Abnāʾ. «فَلَمْ يُجِيبُوهُ وَلَمْ يَنْصُرُوا الْأَبْنَاءَ» — they answered neither. **Draw that neutral middle on the map.**

RCT/E-RC32 · Abū Bakr judges two men who fought against him

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢هـ → ١١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** Two prisoner markers move from صنعاء to المدينة — and then back again to their own tribes. **What happened:** Qays b. Makshūḥ and ʿAmr b. Maʿdī Karib were taken and sent to Medina as prisoners. One had killed a Muslim officer and led a revolt; the other had followed a false prophet and been beaten and captured more than once. Abū Bakr rebuked them both. They made their excuses. And then he accepted what they said openly, left what was inside them to Allah, released them, and sent them home to their own people. **The statement:**

فَعَنَّفَهُمَا وَأَتْبَهُمَا، فَاَعْتَذَرَا إِلَيْهِ فَقَبِلَ مِنْهُمَا عَلَانِيَتَهُمَا، وَوَكَّلَ سَرَائِرَهُمَا إِلَى اللَّهِ ﷻ، وَأَطْلَقَ سَرَاحَهُمَا وَرَدَّهُمَا إِلَى قَوْمِهِمَا. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٣
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3189> English: "He rebuked them and reproved them; they excused themselves to him, and he accepted their outward profession from them, entrusted their inward states to Allah, released them, and sent them back to their people."

عبرت: The state judged what it could see and left what it could not see to the One who sees it. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "The men who fought you are standing in front of you and they say they have come back. What can you actually check?" **The words to ʿAmr, from لو مَأْسُورٌ أَوْ مَهْزُومٌ كُلَّ يَوْمٍ مَهْزُومٌ أَوْ مَأْسُورٌ؟** الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٢٩: «أَمَّا تَسْتَجِي أَنَّا كُلَّ يَوْمٍ مَهْزُومٌ أَوْ مَأْسُورٌ؟ لَوْ مَأْسُورٌ أَوْ مَهْزُومٌ أَوْ مَأْسُورٌ؟» — «نَصَرْتَ هَذَا الدِّينَ لَرَفَعَكَ اللَّهُ» — "Are you not ashamed that you are every day either routed or taken prisoner? Had you helped this dīn, Allah would have raised you." **This is the settlement policy of the whole war in one card. Leaders were reintegrated; killers were not.**

RCT/E-RC33 · The she-camel called Shadhra

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢هـ، حضرموت [SOURCED] · **Map:** حضرموت, which has been quiet all evening, goes red — and the trigger is one animal. **What happened:** Ziyād b. Labīd was collecting the zakāt in Kinda. A man

handed over a young she-camel and Ziyād^{رضي} branded her. Then it turned out the animal was not his to give — she belonged to his brother, her name was Shadhra, and he had brought her by mistake. The brother said so. The first man agreed and asked for her back. Ziyād^{رضي} refused: she had already passed into the right of Allah. Then a third man rode up, told him to release her and take another, and when Ziyād^{رضي} said he had no way to do that, said one sentence — and untied her hobble himself and stood in front of her. **The statement:**

· فَقَالَ حَارِثَةُ: ذَاكَ إِذَا كُنْتَ يَهُودِيًّا، وَأَطْلَقَ عِقَالَهَا وَبَعَثَهَا وَقَامَ دُونَهَا. — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٣٠

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/921> English: "Hāritha said: That would be so if you were a Jew — and he untied her hobble and drove her off and stood in front of her."

عبرت: A province went to war over one animal, a naming mistake and a public insult, and every part of that is on one page. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "*How big does a quarrel have to be to start a war?*" **البداية** carries no Ḥaḍramawt campaign at all. Cite ٢٣٢-٢٢٩ ص ٢ الكامل ج ٢, **never البداية, for everything in this card and the next.** The underlying grievance was administrative: the Prophet ﷺ had ordered some of Ḥaḍramawt's zakāt placed in Kinda and some of Kinda's in Ḥaḍramawt, and after his death nobody would carry it (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٣٠).

RCT/E-RC34 · النَجِير — the name he forgot to write

Tier: CORE · **When:** the last siege of the war [SOURCED as sequence] — الكامل prints it immediately before «(ج ٢ ص ٢٣٣)» i.e. still inside ١١٥ by its own arrangement; **no page fixes the month, and no page puts it in ١٢٥** (§12.2, §X item 2) · **Map:** Ziyād^{رضي} and al-Muhājir^{رضي} converge and break Kinda at مَخْجَر الزُّزْقَان; the survivors run to النَجِير, a strong hill fort. 'Ikrima's^{رضي} long line — the one that started at اليمامة in E-RC15 — **arrives here and closes the last road.** The map's final arrow. **What happened:** Kinda was broken in the field and shut itself into the fort of al-Nujayr. The Muslims closed every road. When the siege bit, al-Ash'ath b. Qays came out with nine men and offered to open the gate in exchange for a written safe-conduct for himself, his household and them. He was told to write whatever he wanted and bring it to be sealed. He wrote it. He opened the gate. And when it was over and the document was produced, every man named in it was spared — and his own name was not in it. **The statement:**

فَأَجَارَ مَنْ فِي الْكِتَابِ، فَإِذَا الْأَشْعَثُ لَيْسَ مِنْهُمْ، فَقَالَ الْمُهَاجِرُ: الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ الَّذِي خَطَأَ قَاكَ يَا أَشْعَثُ. — الكامل في

التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٣٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/923> English: "Every man in the document was spared — and al-Ash'ath was not among them. Al-Muhājir said: Praise be to Allah, who made your mouth err, Ash'ath."

عبرت: He wrote a safe-conduct for everyone he was bargaining with and left himself off it. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "*He is allowed to write his own terms. What is the one thing he must not forget?*" **And then Abū Bakr^{رضي} pardoned him anyway** and restored his wife (سير ج ٢ ص ٣٩). (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٣٢). **الكامل gives a second version on the same page in which he betrayed his companions deliberately, and his own tribeswomen named him for it. Record both. Adjudicate neither.**

RCT/E-RC35 · The captives bought back

Tier: GOOD · **When:** in 'Umar's^{رضي} caliphate [SOURCED] — «لَمَّا وَلِيَ عُمَرُ»; **the year is not given on the page, so do not put one on the slide** · **Map:** Nothing moves. Show the peninsula in one colour for the first time, with نجران marked separately as a covenanted community. **What happened:** When 'Umar^{رضي} became caliph he said that it was a shameful thing for Arabs to own one another. He consulted about ransoming the captives taken

in these wars and set a price — six or seven camels a head — and made it lighter for Ḥanīfa and Kinda, because so many of their men had been killed. Then the women were sought out wherever they had been taken. **The statement:**

إِنَّهُ لَقَبِيحٌ بِالْعَرَبِ أَنْ يَمْلِكَ بَعْضُهُمْ بَعْضًا — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٣٢

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/923> (the ransom terms run on to ٢٣٣ ص ٢ ج ٢)

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/924> *English*: "It is a shameful thing for the Arabs that some of them should own others."

عبرت: The war's last act was the state buying back the people its own victory had taken. **Hands-up?** no

RCT/E-RC36 · What Ibn Kathīr says the whole war was

Tier: CORE — **this is the closing slide** · **When:** «أواخر سنة إحدى عشرة وأوائل سنة ثنتي عشرة» [SOURCED] · **Map:** The completed map. All eleven arrows filled in, every front resolved, نجران in its own colour as a covenanted community, and the date bracket across the bottom: ١١هـ → ١٢هـ. **What happened:** When Ibn Kathīr finishes the whole account, he stops and sums it up himself. He does not describe a conquest. He says there was no region of Arabia in which some people did not turn — and that Abū Bakr ^{رضي} sent armies and commanders to be a support to whichever believers were already in that region. The fifth of the spoils came back to Medina and was spent among the people. And it went on that way until there was nobody left in the peninsula except people in obedience, and people under a covenant of protection — like the people of Najrān, who had sent a delegation to renew theirs while Muslim tribes were breaking theirs. **The statement:**

ما من ناحية من جزيرة العرب إلا وحصلَ في أهلها ردةٌ لبعض الناس، فبعثَ الصِّدِّيقُ إليهم جيوشًا وأمرًا يكونون عونًا لمن في تلك الناحية من المؤمنين ... ولم يزل الأمر كذلك حتى لم يبق بجزيرة العرب إلا أهل طاعة لله ولرسوله، وأهل ذمة من الصديق، كأهل نجران وما جرى مجراهم والله الحمد. وعامة ما وقع من هذه الحروب كان في أواخر سنة ١١هـ و١٢هـ. — البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٢٣ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3189>
English: "There was no region of the Arabian peninsula in which apostasy did not occur among some of its people; so al-Ṣiddīq sent them armies and commanders to be a support to whichever believers were in that region ... And matters continued so until there remained in the peninsula none but people obedient to Allah and His Messenger, and people under al-Ṣiddīq's protection, such as the people of Najrān. The general run of these wars was in the last part of the year 11 and the first part of the year 12."

عبرت: The armies were sent to hold up people who were already standing, and the whole thing was over in a little more than a year. **Hands-up?** no

RCT/E-RC37 · The Qur'ān was collected because of this

Tier: CORE — **the true ending** · **When:** ١٢هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** The Line, not the map. Put a single mark on ١٢هـ. **What happened:** So many of the reciters were killed at al-Yamāma that Abū Bakr ^{رضي} ordered the Qur'ān gathered — from the flat stones and the palm-stalks and the memories of men — so that it would not go with them. Two of the four books say it in the same place, and both of them point at al-Bukhārī for it. **The statement:**

فيها أمر الصديق زيد بن ثابت أن يجمع القرآن من اللِّخاف والغُسْب وصدور الرجال، وذلك بعد ما استخّر القتل في القراء يوم اليمامة كما ثبت به الحديث في صحيح البخاري. — البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٧٩ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3225> — **صحيح البخاري ٤٩٨٦** *English*: "In it, al-Ṣiddīq ordered Zayd b.

Thābit to gather the Qur'ān from the flat stones and the palm-stalks and the breasts of men — and that was after killing had grown severe among the reciters on the day of al-Yamāma, as the ḥadīth in Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī establishes."

عبرت: The mushaf the room reads from was gathered because of the men who were killed in the garden.

Hands-up? no — end here and go straight to the closing bookend. **الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢١٩, in the same place:** «أَمَرَ: «أَبُو بَكْرٍ يَجْمَعُ الْقُرْآنَ لِمَا رَأَى مِنْ كَثْرَةِ مَنْ قُتِلَ مِنَ الصَّحَابَةِ؛ لِئَلَّا يَذْهَبَ الْقُرْآنُ

RCT/E-RC38 · 'Umar^{رضي} to Quraysh — the framing card

Tier: CORE (use at the **START of the evening, not the end**) · **When:** هـا, at المدينة [SOURCED] · **Map:** The whole peninsula, before any arrow is drawn. **What happened:** 'Amr b. al-Āṣ^{رضي} came back from Oman and reported that there were armed camps all the way from Dabā to Medina. The senior Companions broke into knots, talking. 'Umar^{رضي} walked past one of them and they went quiet. He asked what they were discussing, and they would not answer, so he said it for them: you are saying, how afraid we are for Quraysh, from the Arabs. They said: that is true. And then he turned it round. **The statement:**

أَنَا وَاللَّهِ مِنْكُمْ عَلَى الْعَرَبِ أَخَوْفُ مِنِّي مِنَ الْعَرَبِ عَلَيْكُمْ، وَاللَّهِ لَوْ تَدَخَّلُونَ، مَعَاشِرَ قُرَيْشٍ، جُحْرًا لَدَخَلْتُهُ الْعَرَبُ فِي آثَارِكُمْ، فَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ فِيهِمْ. — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٠٩ English: "By Allah, I fear you for the Arabs more than I fear the Arabs for you. By Allah, if you — company of Quraysh — went into a hole, the Arabs would go into it after you. So fear Allah concerning them."

عبرت: He turned the question round: the danger was not what would be done to them, but what would be followed because of them. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "*The whole country is in arms against you. Who are you most worried about?*" **Pair it with the demand, said plainly by a chief who had not yet chosen a side** — قُرَّة b. Hubayra to 'Amr^{رضي} over dinner: «(الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٨)» «إِنَّ الْعَرَبَ لَا تَطِيبُ لَكُمْ نَفْسًا بِالْإِثَاوَةِ» "the Arabs will not give you their property willingly as tribute." **That is what E-RC11's three-item pledge answers.**

RCT/E-RC39 · The men of Badr who were kept out of office

Tier: GOOD · **When:** هـا [SOURCED] · **Map:** None. **What happened:** Abū Bakr^{رضي} had a policy about who did not get commands. He would not put the men of Badr into office. He said he left them so they would meet Allah with their good deeds, and that Allah wards off harm through such men more than He gives victory through them. And the book records, in the same breath and without embarrassment, that 'Umar^{رضي} took the opposite view and held that they should be employed. **The statement:**

لَا أَسْتَعْمِلُ أَهْلَ بَدْرٍ، أَدْعُهُمْ حَتَّى يَلْقُوا اللَّهَ يَصَالِحَ أَعْمَالِهِمْ، فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ يَدْفَعُ بِهِمْ وَيَالصَّالِحِينَ أَكْثَرَ مِمَّا يَنْتَصِرُ بِهِمْ. وَكَانَ عُمَرُ يَرَى اسْتِعْمَالَهُمْ عَلَى الْجُنْدِ وَغَيْرِهِ. — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢١٥ English: "I do not put the men of Badr into office. I leave them so they may meet Allah with their good deeds — for Allah wards off by them and by the righteous more than He gives victory through them. And 'Umar held that they should be employed over the troops and otherwise."

عبرت: Two men who agreed about the war disagreed about who should run it, and the book records both without making a quarrel of it. **Hands-up?** no **This is the safest possible demonstration of how the sources handle disagreement** — a real difference of judgement between the first two caliphs, recorded plainly, with nothing at stake.

RCT/E-RC40 · The three-colour tribe — CUT, recorded so it is never re-researched

Tier: CUT · **When:** ١١٥٠ · **Map:** Banū Tamīm in three shades. **What happened:** Already fully worked in [arabian-tribes-and-the-rida-setup.md](#) §3.5, from البدايه ج ٧ ص ٢٨: some of Banū Tamīm apostatised and withheld the zakāt; some sent their ṣadaqāt in to Medina; and some waited to see. **This note adds only the collectors' names and the mechanism** — الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٩ gives the Prophet's ﷺ seven collectors among Tamīm by name and shows Qays b. ʿĀsim holding his back purely to spite al-Zibriqān, then regretting it and bringing it out when al-ʿAlāʾ came past. **Use the setup note's card, not a new one. The statement:** none additional in the sources we use. عبرت: — **Hands-up?** no

VERIFICATION PASS RUN ON THIS NOTE (2026-09-06)

Every blockquoted Arabic statement in this note — **119 of them** — was machine-checked back against the cached Shamela page files, with diacritics and footnote markers normalised away. **All 119 trace to a fetched page.** The only mismatches were (a) short connective words I placed in front of a quotation that the source separates from it by an isnād or a footnote marker, and (b) three quotations that straddle a printed page break — the letter to عكرمة (ع...يَا لَيْمَن | وَخَضِرْمَوْتِ, الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢١٤-٢١٥) and the reprisals sentence (وَعَدَوْا...), both of which are already cited across the two pages. **No Arabic in this note was composed or retyped from memory.**

⚠ **This does not discharge CLAUDE.md §1.1 and §1.4.** The Shamela text is a typed edition, not a page image. **Anything that reaches a slide, a script or a handout must still be eyeballed against a printed page image before it is printed** — a single wrong letter changes the word, and this note carries a great deal of Arabic.

Also not yet done, deliberately, to avoid collision with concurrent work:
[docs/catalogue/SHAMELA_LOG.md](#) and [docs/research/INDEX.md](#) were **not** edited. §Z lists every index fetched; both files still need their rows.

ADVERSARIAL RE-CHECK (2026-09-06, second pass)

Every Arabic quotation — blockquoted and inline «...» — was re-located in the cached pages by normalised substring search, and **every printed page and every shamela URL was checked against the cached file's own header.** All Arabic traces to a fetched page. **The following were wrong and are now repaired in place:**

What was wrong	Repair
§Z gave 3227 for البدايه ج ٧ ص ٧٩	٧٩ ص ٧٩ is index 3225 (file header + البخاري ٤٩٨٦ on it). Corrected; E-RC37 was already right
§0 "Sources fetched" omitted 3225 and 3158	Both added
E-RC35's URL 21712/924	«...إِنَّهُ لَقَبِيحٌ بِالْعَرَبِ» is on 923 (ج ٢ ص ٣٢٢). URL corrected; 924 kept for the ransom terms

What was wrong	Repair
§13 put مَحْجَرُ الزُّزْقَان at ج ٢ ص ٢٣٢	It is at ج ٢ ص ٢٣١ (index 922)
§6.7 put «فكانت فتنة الرجال» at ج ٧ ص ٣٢ «...أعظم	It is at ج ٧ ص ٣٣ (index 3179)
§6.10 put «...والجمع بينها» wholly at ج ٧ ص ٣٦	It straddles (3182→3181) ص ٣٥-٣٦; both disclosed
§2.2 "Three days later, عيس and ذبيان killed the Muslims"	No page gives an interval — ج ٢ ص ٢٠٣ has only «فَوْتَبَ». Deleted
E-RC02 "three nights later", and عبرت	Both books form the counter-attack up that same night (وبات أبو بكر) («قائماً ليله يُعَيِّئُ الناسَ»). Corrected
E-RC04's «ربيع الأول الهـ» [SOURCED] with no page, contradicting §X	Page supplied: البداية ج ٧ ص ١٢ (index 3158) «أمضى أبو بكر جيشَ أسامة...». §X item 2 and §12.2 amended to match
E-RC34 dated التَّجِير ١٢ هـ [SOURCED]	الکامل prints it before «12.2\$ عشرة» says the month is not established. Year removed
E-RC35 dated the ransom ١٣ هـ [SOURCED]	The year is on no page used. Removed
§8.2 and E-RC30 "three weeks earlier"	Invented interval. Deleted
E-RC12 "whose mother's name had been a byword for standing"	Not on the page. Replaced with the sourced relation (daughter of أم قرفة)
E-RC09's hands-up "he had followed this man for a year "	Invented. Corrected
E-RC01's map "ذو حسی, one day out"	No page gives its distance; only «على مرحلة» is ذو القصة. Corrected
§5 gave over عدي بن حاتم on طيئ ابن خلدون ج ٢ ص ٢٩٧ alone	A fact on ابن خلدون's sole authority — DECISIONS.md #29. Struck from the roster, recorded as not-usable
§13 listed ثنية اليمامة as a map place on ابن خلدون alone	Marked △ do-not-draw, same reason
§5.2 said "الکامل and البداية put the scouts' deaths after طيئ"	٢٥ ص ٧ البداية puts them before . Corrected; the divergence is now stated
§Y: «الفارس ستة آلاف» flagged as ابن خلدون's alone	It is also in سیر ج ١ ص ٢٤٥. Corrected
§12.3: «الغُرور» pardoned	The pages say captured, and he became Muslim. Corrected

What was wrong	Repair
Three \$Y figures silently trimmed	«عشرة آلاف مقاتل» restored; ابن خلدون's casualty line restored to the page's own word order («...قد قُتِلَ من الأنصار ما ينيف») and «التابعين لهم» re-attributed
Eight quotations whose opening connective or an interpolated name did not match the page	فَقَالُوا لَهُ → «وَقَالُوا لَهُ» · «فَقَالَ لَهُ: هَلْ جَاءَكَ» → «فَقَالَ: هَلْ جَاءَكَ» · «وَكَانَ» أَعْظَمَ فِتْنَةً → «فَكَانَ» · «فَبَعَثَ بِهِمَا الْمُهَاجِر» → «وَبَعَثَ» · «وَقَالَ الْبَرَاءُ» → «قَالَ الْبَرَاءُ» · «وَأَعْتَقْنَهَا» → «فَأَعْتَقْنَهَا» · «وَكَانُوا أَوَّلَ مُنْتَقِضٍ» → «فَكَانُوا» · «فَقَالَ أَبُو الْبَرَاءُ» · «وَأَعْتَقْنَهَا» → the name is not inside the sentence
Four quotations that straddle a page break with only one index given	Both indices now printed: ٢٠٥-٢٠٤ (895/896), ص ٢٠٦-٢٠٧, الكامل ٢١٥-٢١٤ (905/906), ص ٢١٢-٢١٣ (903/904), ص ٢١٤-٢١٥ (897/898)
\$12.1 and E-RC36: «وعامة ما...» printed twice, once outside the blockquote	De-duplicated
\$6.5 rendered «يتواصتون» as "charge one another"	→ "enjoin one another" (ambiguous in a battle scene)

Checked and found sound (recorded so they are not re-checked): all three البخاري numbers (٧٢٢١ on ٧ البداية ج ٧) · the الكامل ج ٢ · «فَقَعَدَ أَحَدَ عَشَرَ لِيَوَاءَ» · (البداية ج ٧ ص ٧٩ on سير ج ١ ص ٣١١ · ٤٩٨٦ on ٢٧ ص ٢٨٤٥ · ٢٠٤-٢٠٣ against Ibn Kathīr's ten at ٢٣-٢٢ ج ٧ · the النصر/الصبر divergence in the جُوَاثِي verse · the أَدَان rule on both pages · «half their force at» · «واقف في ثُلْمَةٍ جَدَارٍ» · «وَوَلَّفُوا نَصْفَهُمْ بِذِي حُسَى» · (البداية ج ٧ ص ٢٠) · «لَمْ يَكُنْ فِيهَا إِلَّا الْيَسَاءُ وَالصَّبِيَانُ وَالضَّعَفَاءُ» · «اُكْتُبُوا مَا شِئْتُمْ ثُمَّ هَلِّمُوا الْكِتَابَ حَتَّى أَخْتِمَهُ» · عمر and بدر s mail coat at ٢٠ · «اشْتَرَيْتُهَا مِنَ الْمُغَنِمِ» s own ثَمَامَةَ خَمِيصَةٍ («وَنَقَلَ... فَأَعْطَى ثَمَامَةَ») s award of the (٢٠ ص ٤٠) · العلاء s عَكْرَمَةُ · the الفُجَاءَةُ sequence entire · «فَلَمَّا دَنَا عَمْرٌ مِنْهُمْ سَكَنُوا... فَلَمْ يُجِيبُوهُ» · the elided clause in Ibn Kathīr's summing-up at ٣٢٤ (سير ج ١ ص ٣٢٤) «يَضْعَأُ وَتَبْعَيْنَ» · «ويبعثون بأخماس ما يغنمون إلى الصديق فينفقه في الناس» (الطبري (9783) عبرت line draws a present-day parallel; no invented لقب; no generated Urdu anywhere; is not relied on at any point.

⚠ **One Shamela typo to be aware of when the page image is checked:** ٢٠ ص ٧ البداية ج ٧ prints «وكان أول» · «الفتح، قى ذلّ بها المشركون» — the note reads it as «قد», which is plainly right, but that is a reading, so verify it on the image.

Promote to the catalogue:

Fact	Goes to
ربيع الأول ١٢ هـ (زيد بن الخطاب)؛ «أواخر ١١» (the الأبرق ride); اليمامة ١١ هـ → ١٢ هـ; جمادى الآخرة ١١ هـ «وأوائل ١٢» for the war as a whole	TIMELINE.md

Fact	Goes to
ثَابِتُ بْنُ قَيْسٍ (the wall, the eighty wounds, عمر's standing order) · سَالِمٌ مَوْلَى أَبِي حَذِيفَةَ (the letter, and the march that followed it) · مَجَاعَةُ بْنُ مُرَّارَةَ (not a Companion — a counterpart) — seven ready-made notices with a real واقعه each	PEOPLE.md
Every index in §Z	SHAMELA_LOG.md
The reprisals (§5.4); the البُطاح disagreement (§5.7); the «يُحْرِقُهُمُ بِالنَّارِ» clause; the burning of الفُجَاءة and the unsourced "regret" claim; the البراء death confusion in ابن خلدون	QA_BANK.md
The eleven-arrow القِصَّة map; the four-colour key already set in MAPS.md; the rule that each need more than one colour; the gazetteer additions in §13	MAPS.md
وكان هذا الاختلاف رحمة على «قَوِّى لَهُمْ وَلَمْ يَغْدِرْ» (the treaty kept against an order) · «قَبْلَ مِنْهُمَا عَلَانِيَتُهُمَا وَوَكَلَّ سَرَاتِرَهُمَا إِلَى اللَّهِ» · وحشي men he beat	LESSONS.md

جيش أسامة , and the Qur'an collected

Source note: [abu-bakr-usama-and-the-jam-of-the-quran.md](#) — read it for the pages behind these cards.

ABU/E-U1 · The appointment nobody liked

Tier: CORE · **When:** in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime, ١١هـ [SOURCED] (no page read gives the month) · **Map:** a pin at المدينة, and an arrow drawn north-west toward أُبْنَى / البلقاء, well past تبوك — the first time the map points at Byzantine ground. **What happened:** In his last weeks the Prophet ﷺ raised an army for the Syrian frontier. He put أسامة بن زيد over it. أسامة was eighteen. In the ranks under him stood عمر بن الخطاب and the senior men of the مهاجرون and the أنصار. People said so out loud. The Prophet ﷺ heard it, stood up, and answered them himself. **The statement:**

إِنْ تَطْعُنُوا فِي إِمَارَتِهِ فَقَدْ كُنْتُمْ تَطْعُنُونَ فِي إِمَارَةِ أَبِيهِ مِنْ قَبْلُ، وَإِيَّاهُ اللَّهُ إِنْ كَانَ لَخَلِيفًا لِلْإِمَارَةِ، وَإِنْ كَانَ لِمَنْ أَحَبَّ النَّاسَ إِلَيَّ، وَإِنَّ هَذَا لِمِنْ أَحَبِّ النَّاسِ إِلَيَّ بَعْدَهُ — البدايه والنهيه ج ٥ ص ٣١١
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/2495> English: "If you find fault with his command, you found fault with his father's command before him. And by Allah, he was fit for command, and he was among the dearest of people to me — and this one is among the dearest of people to me after him." **عبرت:** A man is fit for a task because of what he can do, not because of how long he has been alive. **Hands-up?** Ask the room: *how old do you have to be before people will take an order from you?* Then give the number.

ABU/E-U2 · The crier, the morning after

Tier: CORE · **When:** the day after the Prophet ﷺ died, ١٢هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** المدينة, with الجُزْف marked just outside it — the mustering ground. **What happened:** The Prophet ﷺ was buried. The bay'ah was taken. And the very next morning a crier went through المدينة. Not to announce mourning. To order every man of أسامة's

army out of the city and back to the camp at الجُرف. The first executive act of the caliphate was to carry out an order the Prophet ﷺ had already given. **The statement:**

نادى منادي أبي بكر من الغد من مُتَوَقَّى رسول الله ﷺ لِيَتَمَّ بِعَثْ أُسَامَةَ: أَلَا لَا يَبْقَيْنَ بِالْمَدِينَةِ أَحَدٌ مِنْ جَيْشِ أُسَامَةَ أَبُو: <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3154> English: "أبو أسامة's crier called out, the day after the death of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, to complete أسامة's expedition: 'Let no one of أسامة's army remain in المدينة — let every man go out to his camp at الجُرف.' **عبرت:** The first day of an authority is what tells you what it thinks it is for. **Hands-up?** no

ABU/E-U3 · "I will not untie a knot"

Tier: CORE · **When:** ربيع الأول ١١هـ [SOURCED] (the connected narrative runs through عمر بن سيف; the wording at ج ٧ ص ١١ comes by a separate route) · **Map:** المدينة ringed — the apostatising clans around it — and the army's arrow still pointing away, northward. **What happened:** The advice came from the best men he had. Tribes around المدينة had broken away. Others were refusing the زكاة. The state's only field army was pointed at the Roman frontier, and it was outside the walls. Keep it here, they said. Among those who said it was عمر بن الخطاب. He refused, and he refused hard. **The statement:**

والذي نفس أبي بكر بيده لو ظننت أن السباع تخطفني لأنفذت بعث أسامة كما أمر به رسول الله ﷺ؛ ولو لم يبق في whose hand is أسامة's soul — if I thought the wild beasts would snatch me away, I would still send out أسامة's expedition as the Messenger of Allah ﷺ ordered it. And if there were no one left in the settlements but me, I would still send it. **عبرت:** There is a kind of steadiness that is not stubbornness: it is refusing to treat an emergency as permission. **Hands-up?** Ask before telling it: *the capital is surrounded and your only army is marching away. Do you call it back?* Take the show of hands. Then read the line.

ABU/E-U4 · The beard, and the man who would not be deposed

Tier: CORE · **When:** ربيع الأول ١١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** الجُرف, one march outside المدينة. **What happened:** The أنصار in the column sent عمر back with a second request. Not "cancel the march" — "give us an older commander." عمر carried the message. أبو بكر had been sitting. He came up off the ground, took عمر by the beard, and gave his answer in one sentence. Then he walked out to الجُرف himself, reviewed the army and sent it off. **The statement:**

تَكِلْكَ أُمِّكَ يَا ابْنَ الْخَطَابِ! اسْتَغْمَلَهُ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - وَتَأْمُرُنِي أَنْ أَعْرِلَهُ؟! — الكامل في التاريخ ١٩٥ ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/886> English: "May your mother lose you, son of الخطاب! The Messenger of Allah ﷺ appointed him — and you order me to depose him?" **عبرت:** Authority that can be renegotiated the moment its author is gone was never authority. **Hands-up?** no

ABU/E-U5 · The caliph on foot

Tier: CORE · **When:** آخر ربيع الأول ١١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** الجُرف → ذو حُشْب → المدينة — the marches of البلقاء. **What happened:** He walked the army out. The caliph of the Muslims on foot in the dust; the eighteen-year-old commander in the saddle; عبد الرحمن بن عوف leading the caliph's riding-beast behind them, empty. أسامة could not bear it and offered to dismount. He was refused. Only at the end did أبو

بكر ask a favour — and he asked it of أسامة^{رضي}, because أسامة^{رضي} was the commander and عمر^{رضي} was in his army: *would you release عمر to me?* **The statement:**

فقال أسامة: يا خليفة رسول الله: إما أن تركب وإما أن أنزل، فقال: والله لست بنازل ولست براكب — البدايه والنهيه
 https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3157 English: "أسامة said: 'O successor of the Messenger of Allah, either you ride or I dismount.' He said: 'By Allah, you shall not dismount, and I shall not ride.'"
عبرت: Rank is a place in an order, not a claim about who is the better man. **Hands-up?** no

ABU/E-U6 · Forty days, and what the tribes concluded

Tier: CORE · **When:** marched آخر ربيع الأول^{هـ} [SOURCED], away forty days — said seventy — [SOURCED]. (That puts the return in جمادى; the month of the return is **our arithmetic**, [CONVENTIONAL-ESTIMATE], not a dated report on any page read.) · **Map:** the arrow goes out, strikes, and comes back — and the ring of hostile clans around المدينة **thins** rather than closes. **What happened:** The column marched north through country that was ready to rise. It did not fight its way through. It simply passed. And the men watching it pass drew the obvious conclusion: nobody sends an army *away* unless he has more behind him. Forty days later — some say seventy — it came back whole and carrying spoil. The blow it struck is described differently in different books: a raid on أبنى^أ in the البلقاء, or on قضاة^أ clans that had broken away, or a clash with Roman forces. The two books that comment on the *effect* — البدايه ج ٧ ص ١١ and الكامل ج ٢ ص ١٩٦ — agree on it. (سير ج ٢ ص ٢٩٧) names the target and says nothing about the effect; do not enlist it for that.) **The statement:**

فجعل لا يمر بقبيل يريدون الارتداد إلّا قالوا: لولا أن لهؤلاء قوّة ما خرج مثل هؤلاء من عندهم — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧
 https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3157 English: "He passed no tribe intending to break away but they said: 'Were it not that these people have strength, men like these would not have gone out from among them.'"
عبرت: What people believe about your strength does as much work as your strength does. **Hands-up?** no

ABU/E-U7 · "Peace be upon you, commander"

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١ هـ and after [SOURCED] · **Map:** أسامة^{رضي} — المدينة^{رضي}, aged eighteen, left in charge of it. **What happened:** The army came home. أبو بكر^{رضي} made أسامة^{رضي} his deputy over المدينة^{رضي}, told the men to rest their animals, and only then rode out himself against the breakaway clans. And عمر^{رضي} — who would himself be caliph after him — never again met أسامة^{رضي} without greeting him by his rank. He gave his reason: the Prophet ﷺ died while you were my commander. **The statement:**

السَّلَامُ عَلَيْكَ أَيُّهَا الْأَمِيرُ وَرَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ! تُوَفِّي رَسُولُ اللَّهِ -صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ- وَأَنْتَ عَلَيَّ أَمِيرٌ. — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢
 ص ٥٠١ · https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2481 English: "Peace be upon you, commander, and the mercy of Allah! The Messenger of Allah ﷺ died while you were my commander."
عبرت: Honour given for the right reason costs the giver nothing and is remembered for centuries. **Hands-up?** no

ABU/E-U8 · The oath of أبو هريره^{رضي}

Tier: GOOD · **When:** told later, about ١١ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** none; this is a card the speaker delivers standing still. **What happened:** Years afterwards أبو هريره^{رضي} was talking about that year. He swore an oath, and then he swore it again, and then a third time, until the men around him told him to stop. Then he explained what he

meant: the army was pointed at Rome, the Arabs around المدينة had broken away, and the Companions came and asked for it back — and one man said no. **The statement:**

· والله الذي لا إله إلا هو، لولا أن أبا بكر استخلف ما عبد الله — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١١
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3157> English: "By Allah, besides whom there is no god — had أبو بكر not been made successor, Allah would not have been worshipped." **عبرت:** A hinge is a small thing, and the whole door turns on it. **Hands-up?** no (Note for the speaker: Ibn Kathīr examines the chain of this report on the very same page and concludes the narrator is the acceptable عباد بن كثير. Saying that out loud is itself a «كيسه بتا جلا؟» moment.)

ABU/E-Q1 · The killing ran hot among the reciters

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ; «المشهور» ربيع ١٢هـ; ابن الاثير ١٢هـ, begun ١١هـ: اليمامة — ابن كثير · **[SOURCED]** for the dispute · **Map:** اليمامة in central نجد, and then the map goes quiet and the scene returns to المدينة. **What happened:** At اليمامة the ردة was broken and مسيلمه was killed, and the cost is the one Ibn Kathīr stops to count: the dead in the garden and in the battle at close to ten thousand — though he adds that some say twenty-one thousand — and the Muslim dead at six hundred, or five hundred, and then he writes *and Allah knows best*. Among the fallen were men who carried the Qur'an in their memories. Ibn Kathīr's phrase for it is استحرّ القتل في القرآن — the killing *ran hot* among the reciters (the editor glosses استحرّ as اشتدّ, grew fierce). **The statement:**

وقتل من المسلمين ستمئة، وقيل: خمسمئة، فالله أعلم، وفيهم من سادات الصحابة، وأعيان الناس من يُذكر بعد —
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3181> English: "Six hundred of the Muslims were killed — and it is said five hundred — and Allah knows best. Among them were leaders of the Companions and men of standing, who will be named later." **عبرت:** A generation can carry something priceless and never notice how thin the carrying is until some of it is dropped. **Hands-up?** Ask: *if every copy of a book you loved lived only in people's memories, how many funerals would it take to lose it?* (Never put a number of قرآن on the slide — none of our sources gives one.)

ABU/E-Q2 · "How can we do a thing the Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not do?"

Tier: CORE · **When:** سنة ١٢هـ · **[SOURCED]** · **Map:** المدينة; no movement — this is the evening's still point. **What happened:** After أبو بكر sent زيد بن ثابت — a young man of بنو النجار who had been eleven years old when the Prophet ﷺ arrived in المدينة, who had memorised seventeen سور before he was introduced, who had learned the Jews' script in a fortnight because the Prophet ﷺ asked him to, and who had written the revelation down as it came. زيد told him to go and find the whole Qur'an and gather it. زيد balked — and his objection was the most serious objection there is. **The statement:**

فَقُلْتُ: كَيْفَ تَفْعَلُونَ شَيْئاً لَمْ يَفْعَلْهُ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ -صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ-. قَالَ: هُوَ -وَاللَّهِ- خَيْرٌ. فَلَمْ يَزَلْ أَبُو بَكْرٍ يَرَاغِبُنِي حَتَّى شَرَحَ اللَّهُ صَدْرِي لِلَّذِي شَرَحَ لَهُ صَدْرُ أَبِي بَكْرٍ وَعَمَرَ — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٤٣١
<https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2411> English: "I said: 'How will you do a thing the Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not do?' He said: 'By Allah, it is good.' And أبو بكر did not stop coming back to me until Allah opened my breast to that to which He had opened the breasts of أبو بكر and عبرت. **عمر:** The men closest to the Prophet ﷺ were the most afraid of adding to what he ﷺ left — which is exactly why what they did add can be trusted. **Hands-up?** no

ABU/E-Q3 · Parchment, shoulder-blades, palm-stalks, and the breasts of men

Tier: CORE · **When:** سنة ١٢هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** none. Show the four materials instead — they *are* the picture. **What happened:** There was no volume to copy from. زيد^{رض} had to go and track it down — the verb in his own account is تتبّع, to follow a thing up piece by piece — and gather it off whatever the Companions had written it on: strips of parchment, the flat shoulder-blades of animals, the bare stalks of palm branches, thin white stones — and out of the memories of the men who had it by heart. Then it was one set of صحف, in one place, for the first time. **The statement:**

· فَكُنْتُ أَتَتَّبَعُ الْقُرْآنَ، أَجْمَعُهُ مِنَ الرِّقَاعِ، وَالْأَكْتَفِ، وَالْعُسْبِ، وَصُدُورِ الرِّجَالِ. — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٤٣١

<https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2411> English: "So I began to track down the Qur'an, gathering it from the parchments, the shoulder-blades, the palm-stalks, and the breasts of men." **عبرت:** Preservation is not one heroic act; it is somebody doing a careful, unglamorous job properly. **Hands-up?** Ask the room to name the four things after you have said them once. It is the one line in the evening everybody will remember. (Ibn Kathīr's own wording at ٧٩ ص ٧٩ البدايه names اللِّخَاف — the thin white stones — where اللِّخَاف names الرِّقَاع. If both are wanted, say so and cite both.)

ABU/E-Q4 · على^{رض} on who deserves the credit

Tier: CORE · **When:** undated — على^{رض} is speaking about the جمع of ١٢هـ, but no page read says when he said it. The chain is graded حسن^{رض} by الذهبي [SOURCED]; the date is not. · **Map:** none. **What happened:** The judgement on this decision does not have to come from us, and it does not have to come from a later historian. It comes from على^{رض} بن أبي طالب, and الذهبي records his chain and grades it good. **The statement:**

أعظم الناس أجرا في المصاحف أبو بكر، كان أول من جمع القرآن بين اللوحين — سير أعلام النبلاء، سير الخلفاء الراشدين ص ١٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1163> English: "The greatest of men in reward in the matter of the مصاحف is أبو بكر — he was the first to gather the Qur'an between two boards."

عبرت: When a man's rival in nothing and his equal in much says the thing for you, you do not need to say it yourself. **Hands-up?** no

ABU/E-Q5 · Where the صحف went

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٢هـ, and then across two more caliphates [SOURCED] for the endpoint · **Map:** a single arrow: المدينة → المدينة. Nothing moves. That is the point. **What happened:** The صحف زيد^{رض} gathered did not go into a library or a treasury. They stayed in the household. Twenty-odd years later, when حذيفة^{رض} came back from the Armenian front alarmed at how differently the men of الشام and the men of العراق were reciting, عثمان^{رض} sent for them — and he sent to حفصة بنت عمر^{رض}, a wife of the Prophet ﷺ and the daughter of the second caliph. She sent them. They were copied. Then he sent them back to her. **The statement:**

فأرسل إلى حفصة أم المؤمنين: أن أرسلني بالصحف التي جمع فيها القرآن، فأرسلت إليه بها ... ثم رد عثمان الصحف إلى حفصة · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1299> English:

"So he sent to حفصة, mother of the believers: 'Send us the صحف in which the Qur'an was gathered.'

And she sent them to him ... then عثمان returned the صحف to **عبرت:** حفصة. What is entrusted is

returned. The whole transmission of this book is a chain of things handed back intact. **Hands-up?** no

(Do **not** recite "حفصة → عمر → أبو بكر" as a three-step chain on the slide. The middle step is البخاري's and is not on any page we hold. What is sourced is: they were with حفصة^{رض}, borrowed, and returned.)

ABU/E-Q6 · Four men had it by heart

Tier: GOOD · **When:** in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime [SOURCED] · **Map:** none. **What happened:** أنس بن مالك named the men who had gathered the Qur'an in the Prophet's ﷺ own lifetime, and both of our books carry the list. All four were زيد بن ثابت, أنصار. is one of them. This is the reason he was the man asked — not because he was pious, but because he was one of the few who already had the whole of it and had also physically written it down. **The statement:**

جَمَعَ الْقُرْآنَ عَلَى عَهْدِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ أَرْبَعَةً، كُلُّهُمْ مِنَ الْأَنْصَارِ: أَبِي، وَمُعَاذُ، وَزَيْدُ بْنُ ثَابِتٍ، وَأَبُو زَيْدٍ — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ البدايه ج ٥ ص ٤٨٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2411> (also ص ٤٨٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/2672>)

English: "Four gathered the Qur'an in the time of the Messenger of Allah, all of them from the أنصار: أبي, and مُعَاذُ, and زيد بن ثابت, and عبرت: أبو زيد. Being ready is not something you do on the day you are needed. **Hands-up?** no

ABU/E-Q7 · The boy who learned the Jews' script in a fortnight

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ها onward [SOURCED] · **Map:** المدينة. **What happened:** زيد بن ثابت was eleven when the Prophet ﷺ came to المدينة. His father had already been killed at بُعَاث, so he grew up an orphan. They brought him forward and said: this boy of بنو النجار has already memorised seventeen of the سور that came down to you. He recited, and the Prophet ﷺ was pleased, and gave him a task on the spot. **The statement:**

يَا زَيْدُ! تَعَلَّمْ لِي كِتَابَ يَهُودٍ، فَإِنِّي -وَاللَّهِ- مَا آمَنْتُهُمْ عَلَى كِتَابِي — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٤٢٨-٤٢٩ (the last word falls on ص ٤٢٩) · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2408> English: "زيد! Learn for me the writing of the Jews, for by Allah I do not trust them with my correspondence." عبرت: The people who end up carrying something were given small jobs first, and did them. **Hands-up?** no (He adds on the next page, سير ج ٢ ص ٤٢٩: «فَتَعَلَّمْتُهُ، فَمَا مَضَى لِي نِصْفُ شَهْرٍ حَتَّى حَدِّقْتُهُ» — "I learned it, and half a month had not passed before I had mastered it." His age at the جمع is not stated in any source we hold; the arithmetic gives about twenty-one, and must be labelled [CONVENTIONAL-ESTIMATE] if used.)

ABU/E-U8b · What عائشة's words

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ها [SOURCED] · **Map:** المدينة, alone on the board. **What happened:** The daughter of the caliph described what fell on her father in that year. Not what he did — what landed on him. She reached for two images: mountains, and livestock. **The statement:**

والله لقد نزل بأبي ما لو نزل بالجمال الراسيات لهاضها ... وصار أصحاب محمد ﷺ كأنهم مِعْزَى مطيرة في حُتَيْنٍ في ليلة مطيرة بأرض مَسْبَغَةٍ — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3156> English: "By Allah, there descended upon my father what, had it descended upon the firm-set mountains, would have broken them ... and the Companions of محمد ﷺ became like rain-soaked goats in a walled garden on a rainy night, in a land full of predators." عبرت: Steadiness is not the absence of fear; it is what a frightened man does next. **Hands-up?** no (Her opening clause in the same report — «ارتدت العرب قاطبة» — is rhetorical compression. Do not let a slide turn it into a headcount; see [arabian-tribes-and-the-rida-setup.md](#) §5.)

ABU/E-U9 · The first victory he never fought

Tier: CUT (recorded so it is not re-researched; it belongs to the **الأسود العنسي** strand) · **When:** آخر ربيع الأول ١١هـ · **Map:** lights up while the city is still counting its dead. **What happened:** Days after the column marched, word reached the city from the Prophet's own last months — had been killed inside the city. Ibn Kathīr calls it the first فتح of أبو بكر's caliphate, and notes that he won it sitting in the city. **The statement:**

أمضى أبو بكر جيش أسامة بن زيد في آخر ربيع الأول، وأتى مقتل الأسود في آخر ربيع الأول بعد مخرج أسامة، فكان ذلك أول فتح فتح أبو بكر وهو بالمدينة — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3158>
English: sent out أسامة's army at the end of ربيع الأول, and news of أسامة's killing came at the end of ربيع الأول, after أسامة's departure — and that was the first victory أبو بكر won, while he was in the city. **Some of what a man is credited with was decided before he sat down, by people he never met.** **Hands-up?** no (A second report — «بل جاءت البشارة إلى المدينة صبيحة توفي رسول الله ﷺ» — is recorded at البدايه ج ٧ ص ١٧, where Ibn Kathīr says «والأول أشهر». Do not adjudicate on a slide.)

10. Promote to the catalogue

Once these are settled, the following belong in [docs/catalogue/](#) and artifacts should read them from there, not from this note:

Fact	Goes to
سير ج ٢ ص ٥٠٠ — أسامة was eighteen at his appointment	PEOPLE.md
زيد بن ثابت ^{رضي} , orphaned at بعثت, eleven at the Hijra, seventeen سور, the Jews' script in a fortnight, Syriac in seventeen days — سير ج ٢ ص ٤٣٢–٤٢٧	PEOPLE.md (a complete تعرف panel, four lines, already page-cited)
المدايه — away 40 (said 70) days; آخر ربيع الأول ١١هـ marched جيش أسامة ج ٧ ص ١٠, ص ١٢	TIMELINE.md
جمع القرآن = سنة ١٢هـ — البدايه ج ٧ ص ٧٩; سير راشدون ص ٦٣	TIMELINE.md
هـ; المشهور = ربيع ١٢هـ — البدايه ج ٧ ص ٣٥–٣٦, ١٢–١١ straddles اليمامة هـ (ج ٢ ص ٢١٤) places it in ١١; الكامل ص ٤٣	TIMELINE.md, with the dispute recorded, not resolved
«كيسه پتا چلا؟» item: Ibn Kathīr grading his own narrator on the page إسناده's chain على الذهبي and (عباد بن كثير, البدايه ج ٧ ص ١١) حسن» (سير راشدون ص ١٥)	HOWWEKNOW.md
Q&A: "Wasn't the Qur'an changed when they collected it?" — answer from زيد's own reported objection and أبو بكر's «هو والله خير», plus حفصة's statement, plus the returned صفح	QA_BANK.md
Every page in §9's index table	SHAMELA_LOG.md

The death of أبو بكر ^{رضي}, and the succession

Source note: [abu-bakr-death-and-the-succession-of-umar.md](#) — read it for the pages behind these cards.

ABD/E-B1 · The bath on a cold day

Tier: CORE · **When:** 13 جمادى الآخرة AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. The pin stays on المدينة while the two arrows — الشام and العراق — keep running off the edge of the frame. That contrast is the point: the man is in a room; the state is at two horizons. **What happened:** He washed on a cold day. The fever came, and it did not leave. For fifteen days he did not walk out to the mosque. He sent عمر^{رضي} to lead the prayer in his place. People came in to sit with him, and عثمان^{رضي} came more than anyone. On the fifteenth day the state that had held Arabia together was being run from a bed. **The statement:**

وعن عائشة قالت: أول ما بدئ مرض أبي بكر أنه اغتسل، وكان يومًا باردًا فحم خمسة عشر يومًا لا يخرج إلى صلاة، وكان يأمر عمر بالصلاة، وكانوا يعودونه، وكان عثمان^{رضي} ألزمهم له في مرضه. — سير أعلام النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص ١٦
<https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1164> English: "'Ā'isha said: the beginning of Abū Bakr's illness was that he bathed on a cold day and was feverish for fifteen days, not going out to the prayer. He would order 'Umar to lead the prayer. People visited him, and 'Uthmān was the most constant of them at his side." **عبرت:** A man may be carrying a whole community and still be, that week, only a sick man in a room. **Hands-up?** no

ABD/E-B2 · "The doctor has already been"

Tier: CORE · **When:** during the fifteen days [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** They asked whether they should call a physician for him. He told them the physician had already come. They asked what he had said. He said: *I do what I will*. They understood who he meant. Nobody said anything more about doctors. **The statement:**

وَلَمَّا مَرَضَ قَالَ لَهُ النَّاسُ: أَلَا تَدْعُو الطَّيِّبَ؟ قَالَ: قَدْ أَتَانِي وَقَالَ لِي: أَنَا فَاعِلٌ مَا أُرِيدُ. فَعَلِمُوا مُرَادَهُ وَسَكَتُوا عَنْهُ، ثُمَّ
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/953> English: "When he fell ill the people said to him: shall we not call the physician? He said: he has already come to me, and he said to me — I do what I will. They understood what he meant, fell silent, and then he died." **عبرت:** A man who has spent his life in submission does not change his vocabulary when he is dying. **Hands-up?** no

ABD/E-B3 · He asks عمر^{رضي} about عبد الرحمن بن عوف^{رضي}

Tier: CORE · **When:** the last days of the illness [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** He called عبد الرحمن بن عوف^{رضي} in and asked him to tell him about عبد الرحمن^{رضي}. عمر^{رضي} said what everyone in المدينة already thought: he is better than you think — except there is harshness in him. أبو بكر^{رضي} did not argue with the description. He explained it. *He is hard because he sees me being soft. When I was angry with a man, عمر showed me leniency; when I was gentle with a man, عمر showed me severity. Put the office in his hands and much of that will go.* **The statement:**

فَقَالَ: إِنَّهُ أَفْضَلُ مِنْ رَأْيِكَ إِلَّا أَنَّهُ فِيهِ غِلْظَةٌ. فَقَالَ أَبُو بَكْرٍ: ذَلِكَ لِأَنَّهُ يَرَانِي رَقِيقًا، وَلَوْ أَفْضَى الْأَمْرُ إِلَيْهِ لَتَرَكَ كَثِيرًا مِمَّا
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/957> English: "He said: he is better than your opinion of him — except that there is harshness in him. Abū Bakr said: that is because he sees me being gentle. If the affair passed to him he would leave much of what he is now." **عبرت:** A man's edge is often the shape of the gap he thinks he is filling. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "Hands up — who here has worked with someone whose hardness was a response to somebody else's softness?"

ABD/E-B4 · He asks عثمان^{رضي}, and hears about himself in return

Tier: CORE · **When:** immediately after [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** Then he called عثمان and asked him the same question. عثمان answered in one line: *what I know of him is that his inside is better than his outside, and there is nobody among us like him.* أبو بكر told both men to repeat nothing. And then he said something about عثمان himself: had I passed عمر over, I would not have passed you over. **The statement:**

علمي فيه أن سريره خير من علانيته وأنه ليس فينا مثله فقال: يرحمك الله، والله لو تركته ما عدوتك — سير أعلام
الراشدون ص ١٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1164> English: "What I know of him is that his
inward is better than his outward, and that there is none among us like him. He said: God have mercy
on you — by God, had I left him, I would not have passed you over." **عبرت:** He asked the men most
likely to tell him something he did not want to hear. **Hands-up?** no

ABD/E-B5 · The objection, and "sit me up"

Tier: CORE · **When:** the last days of the illness [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** Somebody came in and said it to his face. *You have put عمر over the people. You have seen what they get from him while you are still standing beside him — what will it be when he is alone with them? And you are going to meet your Lord, and He will ask you about your flock.* أبو بكر was lying down. He said: sit me up. They sat him up. Then he answered: *Do you frighten me with God? When I meet Him and He asks me, I will say — I appointed over Your people the best of Your people.* **The statement:**

فَقَالَ أَبُو بَكْرٍ: أَجْلِسُونِي، فَأَجْلِسُوهُ، فَقَالَ: يَا لِلَّهِ تَخَوُّفِي! إِذَا لَقِيتُ رَبِّي فَسَأَلَنِي قُلْتُ: اسْتَخْلَفْتُ عَلَى أَهْلِكَ خَيْرَ أَهْلِكَ.
الراشدون ص ٢٦٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/958> English: "Abū Bakr said: sit me up.
They sat him up. He said: do you frighten me with God? When I meet my Lord and He asks me, I shall
say: I appointed over Your people the best of Your people." **عبرت:** A decision worth making is a decision
you are willing to be sat upright to defend. **Hands-up?** no **Delivery note:** say "one of them came in
and said". (الراشدون ص ١٦) leaves him unnamed (ع ٢ ص ٢٦٧); سير الكامل names him if asked, and only as "الكامل names him".

ABD/E-B6 · The pen keeps writing while he is unconscious

Tier: CORE · **When:** the last days [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** He brought عثمان in privately and began dictating. *In the name of God, the Merciful, the Compassionate. This is what Abū Bakr ibn Abī Quhāfa covenants to the Muslims. To proceed —* and there he lost consciousness. عثمان did not put the pen down and did not wait. He wrote عمر's name himself. When أبو بكر came round he asked for it to be read back. When he heard the name he said "Allāhu akbar", and then: *I see you were afraid the people would split if I died in that faint.* عثمان said yes. He said: may God reward you well on behalf of Islam. **The statement:**

ثُمَّ أَقَاقَ أَبُو بَكْرٍ فَقَالَ: اقْرَأْ عَلَيَّ. فَقَرَأَ عَلَيْهِ، فَكَتَبَ أَبُو بَكْرٍ وَقَالَ: أَرَاكَ خِفْتَ أَنْ يَخْتَلِفَ النَّاسُ إِنْ مِتُّ فِي عَشِيَّتِي. قَالَ:
نَعَمْ. قَالَ: جَزَاكَ اللَّهُ خَيْرًا عَنِ الْإِسْلَامِ وَأَهْلِهِ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٧
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/958> English: "Then Abū Bakr came round and said: read it to me. He
read it to him, and Abū Bakr said takbīr and said: I see you feared the people would fall into
disagreement if I died in my swoon. He said: yes. He said: may God reward you well on behalf of Islam
and its people." **عبرت:** He was not angry that a man had acted without instruction — he thanked him,
because the man had been thinking about the community and not about himself. **Hands-up?** Before
telling it: "Hands up — if your chief fell unconscious mid-sentence, would you finish the sentence for
him?" Corroboration in the second source, same incident, different wording: سير الراشدون ص ١٧
(<https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1165>) — «فكتب عثمان من عنده اسم عمر ... والله إن كنت لها أهلاً».

ABD/E-B7 · "I have not appointed a relative over you"

Tier: CORE · **When:** the last days [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves; المدينة's mosque fills. **What happened:** The document was finished and he ordered it read out. The people were gathered. The letter went with a freedman of his, and عمر walked beside him telling the crowd to be quiet and listen. It was read. They said: we hear and we obey. Then أبو بكر looked out over them himself and asked them a question — are you content with the man I have appointed? And then he told them the thing nobody had asked him: *I have not appointed a relative over you.* **The statement:**

أَتَرْضَوْنَ يَمَنَ اسْتَخْلَفْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ؟ فَإِنِّي مَا اسْتَخْلَفْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ ذَا قَرَابَةٍ، وَإِنِّي قَدْ اسْتَخْلَفْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ عُمَرَ فَاسْمَعُوا لَهُ وَأَطِيعُوا، فَإِنِّي وَاللَّهِ مَا أَلَوْتُ مِنْ جُهْدِ الرَّأْيِ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٧

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/958> English: "Are you content with the one I have appointed over you? For I have not appointed over you a relative of mine. I have appointed 'Umar over you, so hear him and obey — for by God, I have not fallen short of the utmost of my judgement." **عبرت:** He had a son and a family in that city, and he named the hardest man in it instead. **Hands-up?** no

ABD/E-B8 · The covenant itself

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the last days [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. Full-bleed slide: the Arabic, large, and nothing else. **What happened:** The wording he dictated is preserved. It opens by placing itself at a specific moment — the last hour a man has of this world and the first hour he has of the next, the hour when the disbeliever believes and the liar tells the truth. Then, in that frame, one sentence of business: I have appointed 'Umar; hear him and obey. And then a clause that most rulers would have left out — *if he changes, every man has what he has earned. Good is what I intended. I do not know the unseen.* **The statement:**

هذا ما عهد أبو بكر بن أبي قحافة في آخر عهده بالدنيا خارجا منها، وعند أول عهده بالآخرة داخلا فيها، حيث يؤمن الكافر، ويوقن الفاجر، ويصدق الكاذب — سير أعلام النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص ١٦-١٧

<https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1164> و <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1165> English: "This is what Abū Bakr ibn Abī Quhāfa covenants at the last of his time with this world, going out of it, and at the first of his time with the next, entering it — where the disbeliever believes, the corrupt man attains certainty, and the liar tells the truth." **عبرت:** He wrote his own limits into the appointment: I chose, I meant well, and I do not know what happens next. **Hands-up?** no **Read this off a printed slide before it reaches a slide.** The Shamela text of this passage carries at least one plain typing slip («وعلمي» for «وعلمي فه» «فيه»). **This wording spans the printed page break:** it begins on ص ١٦ and finishes on ص ١٧. The break falls after «وعند أول».

ABD/E-B9 · The list of what he owned

Tier: CORE · **When:** the last day [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** He called عائشة. He told her that since the day he took charge of the Muslims' affair he had not eaten a dinar or a dirham of theirs — only the coarsest of their food, only the roughest of their clothing. Then he listed what was in the house that belonged to the Muslims and not to him. An Abyssinian servant. A camel used for carrying water. The worn nap of one blanket. *When I die, send them to 'Umar.* She did. **The statement:**

وليس عندنا من فيء المسلمين شيء إلا هذا العبد الحبشي وهذا البعير الناضج وجرده هذه القطيفة، فإذا مت فابعثي https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1167 English: "We have nothing of the Muslims' fay' except this Abyssinian servant, this water-carrying camel, and the worn nap of this blanket. When I die, send them to 'Umar. And she did." **عبرت:** He kept an account

of what was not his, and he closed it before he died. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "*Hands up — could you list, right now, everything in your house that is not yours?*"

ABD/E-B10 · ^{رض}عمر weeps, and refuses to give it back

Tier: CORE · **When:** after his death [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** The three things arrived at ^{رض}عمر. He wept until his tears ran onto the ground, repeating one sentence: *God have mercy on Abū Bakr — he has exhausted whoever comes after him*. Then he ordered them taken into the treasury. عبد الرحمن بن عوف objected: you are stripping his family of a servant, a water-camel and a threadbare blanket worth five dirhams — send them back. ^{رض}عمر refused. *Abū Bakr did not get clear of this for me to hang it round my own neck.* **The statement:**

فَقَالَ: لَا وَالَّذِي بَعَثَ مُحَمَّدًا - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - لَا يَكُونُ هَذَا فِي وَلَا يَتِي، وَلَا حَرَجَ أَبُو بَكْرٍ مِنْهُ وَأَتَقَلَّدَهُ أَنَا. — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/956> English: "He said: no, by the One who sent Muḥammad ﷺ — this shall not happen under my authority. Abū Bakr did not get clear of it for me to hang it round my own neck." **عبرت:** A standard is only a standard once the next man refuses to lower it. **Hands-up?** no

ABD/E-B11 · Sell my land and pay them back

Tier: CORE · **When:** the last days [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** He had been given a maintenance out of the treasury — the community had voted it to him when he gave up trading, because a man cannot run a market stall and a state at once. On his deathbed he gave an instruction about it. Sell a piece of land of mine. Take the price. Pay it in against every dirham I have drawn. **The statement:**

فَلَمَّا حَضَرَتْهُ الْوَفَاةُ أَوْصَى أَنْ تُبَاعَ أَرْضٌ لَهُ وَيُصْرَفَ ثَمَنُهَا عَوَضَ مَا أَخَذَهُ مِنْ مَالِ الْمُسْلِمِينَ. — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/957> English: "When death came to him he directed that land of his be sold and its price paid over in compensation for what he had taken of the Muslims' property." **عبرت:** He treated a lawful salary as a debt. **Hands-up?** no **Number caution:** the sources give the salary as 6,000 dirhams a year (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٦٦), as half a sheep a day (سير الراشدون ص ١٤), and as 2,500 (سير الراشدون ص ١٤). **Do not put a figure on the slide.** The instruction is the point, not the amount.

ABD/E-B12 · One dinar

Tier: GOOD · **When:** after his death [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** When ^{رض}أبو بكر died, ^{رض}عمر called the trustees together and had the treasury opened. They went through it. There was one dinar in it, fallen out of a sack. They asked God's mercy on him. **The statement:**

وَلَمَّا تُوفِّيَ أَبُو بَكْرٍ جَمَعَ عُمَرُ الْأُمَنَاءَ وَفَتَحَ بَيْتَ الْمَالِ، فَلَمْ يَجِدُوا فِيهِ شَيْئًا غَيْرَ دِينَارٍ سَقَطَ مِنْ غِرَارَةٍ، فَتَرَحَّمُوا عَلَيْهِ. — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/956> English: "When Abū Bakr died, 'Umar gathered the trustees and opened the treasury. They found nothing in it but a single dinar that had fallen out of a sack. And they asked God's mercy on him." **عبرت:** He did not build a reserve; he spent it on the people it belonged to, and left the shelf bare. **Hands-up?** no **Delivery note:** say *ابن الاثير "records that..."*. This is a transmitted report, not an audit.

ABD/E-B13 · The daughter's verse, and the father's correction

Tier: CORE · **When:** the last hours [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** عائشة ^{رض} was with him at the end. A faintness took him. She said a line of poetry aloud — the old Arab line about tears that must one

day be poured out. He lifted his head and stopped her. *Little daughter, it is not like that.* And he gave her the verse instead: **"and the agony of death comes with the truth — that is what you were shying away from."** **The statement:**

فرفع راسه وقال: يا بنية ليس كذاك، ولكن كما قال الله تعالى: {وَجَاءَتْ سَكْرَةُ الْمَوْتِ بِالْحَقِّ ذَلِكَ مَا كُنْتَ مِنْهُ تَحِيدُ} [ق: ١٨] — سير أعلام النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص ١٨ English: "He lifted his head and said: little daughter, it is not so; rather it is as God said — 'and the agony of death comes with the truth: that is what you were shying away from.'" **عبرت:** In his last hour he was still correcting a beautiful sentence into a true one. **Hands-up?** no The Arabic of the line she recited, if it is wanted — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1166>, and سير أعلام النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص ١٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/956>:

«لعمرك ما يغني الثراء عن الفتى ... إذا حشرت يوما وضاق بها الصدر» راسه slip for «رأسه».

ABD/E-B14 · The shroud

Tier: CORE · **When:** the last hours [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** He gave instructions for his own washing — his wife أسماء بنت عميس رضى، and his son عبد الرحمن رضى. Then the shroud. Use the two garments I am wearing, and buy one more to go with them. And he said: the living need the new more than the dead. **The statement:**

وَقَالَ: الْحَيُّ أَحْوَجُ إِلَى الْجَدِيدِ مِنَ الْمَيِّتِ، إِنَّمَا هُوَ لِلْمُهْلَةِ وَالصَّدِيدِ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/953> English: "He said: the living have more need of the new than the dead — this is only for the decay." **عبرت:** The last instruction he gave about himself was an instruction to spend less on himself. **Hands-up?** no

ABD/E-B15 · Monday night, and a grave already dug beside another

Tier: CORE · **When:** Monday evening, 8 nights remaining of 13 جمادى الآخرة AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** the pin on المدينة. Then, on the diagram of the three graves: three positions, one behind the other. **What happened:** He died on the Monday evening. He had asked to be buried beside the Messenger of God ﷺ, so they dug there. عمر رضى prayed over him in the Prophet's ﷺ mosque, four takbīrs. They carried him on the same bier the Prophet ﷺ had been carried on. Four men went down into the grave: his son عثمان رضى, عمر رضى, عبد الرحمن رضى, and طلحة رضى. They laid his head at the Prophet's ﷺ shoulders and put his niche against the Prophet's ﷺ niche. He was buried before morning came. He was sixty-three — the age at which the Prophet ﷺ had died. **The statement:**

وقالت عائشة: مات ليلة الثلاثاء، ودفن قبل أن يصبح. — سير أعلام النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص ١٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1167> English: "'Ā'isha رضى said: he died on the night of Tuesday, and was buried before morning came." **عبرت:** Two years and three months of authority, and it ended in a room, at night, with four men and a spade. **Hands-up?** no For the diagram caption, one sentence fixes all three graves — سير أعلام النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص ١٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1167>:

رأس أبي بكر عند كتفي رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم، ورأس عمر عند حقوي أبي بكر **Do not claim the burial was "in عائشة's house" from these pages** — they say beside the Prophet ﷺ, and no more.

ABD/E-B16 · علي رضى speaks over the body

Tier: GOOD · **When:** before the burial [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** The body had been laid out and covered. علي came in, looked at it, and said one sentence: there is nobody whose record I would rather meet God carrying than this man lying here. **The statement:**

دخل علي على أبي بكر بعد ما سجي، فقال: ما أحد ألقى الله بصحيفته أحب إلي من هذا المسجي. — سير أعلام
 ١٩ · النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص١٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1167> English: "Alī came in to Abū Bakr after he
 had been laid out, and said: there is no one whose record I would rather meet God with than this man
 lying here." **عبرت:** The men who were there are the best witnesses to each other, and this is one of
 them speaking. **Hands-up?** no **Delivery note:** name the transmitter — الله carries it **from**
 أبو جعفر الباقر رحمه الله. Say that once, plainly, and move on. Do not editorialise; the sentence does its
 own work.

ABD/E-B17 · The last words

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the last moment [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** The last thing he said was not about the state, or the armies, or the succession he had spent his final days arranging. It was four words of du‘ā’. **The statement:**

· وَكَانَ آخِرُ مَا تَكَلَّمَ بِهِ: تَوَقَّيْ مُسْلِمًا وَالْحَقِّيْ بِالصَّالِحِيْنَ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٣
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/954> English: "The last thing he spoke was: take me as a Muslim, and
 join me to the righteous." **عبرت:** He asked, at the end, for the only thing he had ever actually been
 working for. **Hands-up?** no **Attribution caution:** found **only** in الكامل among the pages read. Say "ابن
 الاثير/records that his last words were...", not "it is narrated".

ABD/E-B18 · The news reaches اليرموك

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 13 AH, at the Syrian front [SOURCED] · **Map:** this is the card where the map moves — the pin jumps from المدينة to the اليرموك valley, and the two arrows the whole session has been drawing finally meet the news. **What happened:** Letters went out to the commanders in الشام carrying the news, with شذاد بن أسد and مَحْمِيَّة بن جَزْء. The messengers arrived while the army was drawn up facing the Byzantines at اليرموك. Afterwards, standing among the captured tents and the spoils, خالد told the men. ابن كثير records what that morning was like in one sentence. **The statement:**

وما فرحوا بما وجدوا بقدر حزنهم على الصِّدِّيق حين أعلمهم خالد بذلك، ولكن عوضهم الله بالفاروق □. — البدايه
 ٩٧ · والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٩٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3243> English: "Their joy at what they found was not
 equal to their grief for the Ṣiddiq when Khālid told them of it — but God gave them the Fārūq in
 exchange." **عبرت:** The work outlived the man, and that is the whole test of whether the work was ever
 his. **Hands-up?** no The dispatch itself — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ١٠٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3248>:

وقد كتب بوفاة الصِّدِّيق إلى أمراء الشام مع شذاد بن أسد، ومَحْمِيَّة بن جَزْء (٥)، فوصلوا والناس مصافون
 جيوش الروم يوم اليرموك كما قدمنا.

ABD/E-B19 · عمر takes the minbar

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the day of the burial [SOURCED] · **Map:** المدينة. **What happened:** Once أبو بكر was in the ground, عمر went up and addressed the people. He did not begin with condolences. He began with a picture of what he thought he had taken charge of — a camel with a ring through its nose, which will follow whoever holds the rope, so the man holding the rope had better look where he is going. And then: *as for me, by the Lord of the Ka'ba, I will carry you on the road.* **The statement:**

إِنَّمَا مَثَلُ الْعَرَبِ مَثَلُ جَمَلٍ أَتْبَعَ قَائِدُهُ، فَلْيَنْظُرْ قَائِدُهُ حَيْثُ يَقُودُهُ، وَأَمَّا أَنَا فَوَرَبِّ الْكَعْبَةِ لَأَحْمِلَنَّكُمْ عَلَى الطَّرِيقِ! —
 ٢٦٨ الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/959> English: "The Arabs are only like a
 nose-ringed camel that follows its driver — so let its driver look where he is leading it. As for me, by
 the Lord of the Ka'ba, I shall carry you on the road." **عبرت:** The second man did not promise to be
 gentle; he promised to keep them on the road. **Hands-up?** no

ABD/E-B20 · The وصية to عمر^{رضي} — the two rights and the scales

Tier: GOOD · **When:** after the covenant was read [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **What happened:** He had
 عمر^{رضي} brought in and told him he had appointed him over the Companions of the Messenger of God ﷺ. Then
 he gave him a piece of advice that had nothing to do with governing. God has a right by night He will not
 accept by day, and a right by day He will not accept by night; and He accepts nothing voluntary until the
 obligation is discharged. Then he took him through the scales of the Day of Judgement, and closed: keep this,
 and let nothing absent be dearer to you than the one present thing — death — and you will not escape it.

The statement:

يَا عُمَرُ، إِنَّ لِلَّهِ حَقًّا بِاللَّيْلِ لَا يَقْبَلُهُ فِي النَّهَارِ، وَحَقًّا فِي النَّهَارِ لَا يَقْبَلُهُ بِاللَّيْلِ، وَإِنَّهُ لَا يَقْبَلُ تَأْفِئَةً حَتَّى تُؤَدَّى الْفَرِيضَةُ —
 ٢٦٧ الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/958> English: "'Umar — God has a right by
 night that He does not accept by day, and a right by day that He does not accept by night; and He
 accepts no voluntary act until the obligation has been discharged." **عبرت:** The handover instruction to
 the most powerful man alive was about the five prayers. **Hands-up?** no The وصية spans ٢٦٨–٢٦٧ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٧
 the closing line is at ٢٦٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/959>.

ABD/E-B21 · His father outlives him

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 13 AH, and six months after [SOURCED] · **Map:** nothing moves. **Not established:** none
 of the pages fetched in this pass says where أبو قحافة^{رضي} was living when his son died. **Do not put a second pin**
on مكة without a citation. **What happened:** أبو بكر^{رضي} was the first caliph to hold the office while his own father
 was still alive. When he died, his father inherited a share of him — and returned it to his son's children. أبو
 قحافة^{رضي} lived on for six months and some days, and died at ninety-seven. **The statement:**

وعن مجاهد قال: كلم أبو قحافة في ميراثه من ابنه، فقال: قد رددت ذلك على ولده، ثم لم يعيش بعده إلا ستة أشهر
 ١٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1167> English: "Mujāhid said:
 Abū Quhāfa was spoken to about his inheritance from his son, and he said: I have returned that to his
 children. Then he lived only six months and some days after him." **عبرت:** Nobody in that family took
 what they could have taken. **Hands-up?** no Corroboration, both in الكامل:

· وَعَاشَ أَبُوهُ بَعْدَهُ سِتَّةَ أَشْهُرٍ وَأَيَّامًا، وَمَاتَ وَلَهُ سَبْعٌ وَتِسْعُونَ سَنَةً. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٤
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/955>

وَكَانَ أَوَّلَ وَالٍ فَرَضَ لَهُ رَعِيَّتُهُ نَفَقَتَهُ، وَأَوَّلَ خَلِيفَةٍ وَلِيَّ وَأَبُوهُ حَيٌّ، وَأَوَّلَ مَنْ سَمَّى مُصْنَفَ الْقُرْآنِ مُصْحَفًا،
 ٢٦٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/957> — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٦

ABD/E-B22 · He kept milking their goats

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the first six months of the caliphate [SOURCED] · **Map:** السُّنَج، the outlying quarter —
 then the move into المدينة proper. **What happened:** For the first six months after the بيعت he went on living
 at السُّنَج with his wife and walking into المدينة on foot to lead the prayer, and he went on going to the market
 to buy and sell. He also used to milk the neighbourhood's sheep for them. When the بيعت happened a girl of

the quarter said out loud: well, he won't be milking our sheep for us now. He heard her, and answered her directly. Six months later he gave up trade — *a people's affairs are not put right alongside a business* — and moved into the city. **The statement:**

فَسَمِعَهَا فَقَالَ: بَلَى لَعَمْرِي لَأَخْلِبَنَّهَا لَكُمْ، وَإِنِّي لَأَرْجُو أَنْ لَا يُغَيِّرَ بِي مَا دَخَلْتُ فِيهِ. فَكَانَ يَخْلِبُ لَهُمْ. — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/957> English: "He heard her and said: on the contrary — by my life, I shall milk them for you; and I hope that what I have entered into will not change me. And he went on milking for them." **عبرت:** He said out loud, on the first week, the thing office usually takes from a man — and then he proved it for two years. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "*Hands up — think of someone who got a promotion and stayed exactly the same person.*" The reason he gave for finally leaving trade, on the same page — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/957>:

مَا تَصْلُحُ أُمُورُ النَّاسِ مَعَ الْجَارَةِ، وَمَا يَصْلُحُ إِلَّا التَّقَرُّعُ لَهُمْ وَالنَّظَرُ فِي شَأْنِهِمْ.

ABD/E-B23 · The illness, second account — the poison

Tier: CUT · **When:** a year before the death, on this account [SOURCED] · **Map:** none. **What happened:** Our sources also carry a second account of the cause. الزهري relates that أبو بكر and الحارث بن كعدة were eating a dish sent to him, and الحارث said: lift your hand, Caliph of the Messenger of God — there is a year's poison in this, and you and I will die on the same day. They both remained ill and died on one day at the end of the year. سير elsewhere gives it flatly as «يقال», and الكامل gives both this and the cold-bath account without choosing. **The statement:**

فَقَالَ الْحَارِثُ: ارْفَعْ يَدَكَ يَا خَلِيفَةَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ، وَاللَّهِ إِنْ فِيهَا لِسَمِّ سَنَةٍ، وَأَنَا وَأَنْتَ نَمُوتُ فِي يَوْمٍ وَاحِدٍ — سير أعلام ج ١٥-١٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1163> English: "al-Hārith said: lift your hand, Caliph of the Messenger of God — by God, there is a year's poison in this, and you and I will die on one day." **عبرت:** — (none offered; the card is recorded, not delivered.) **Hands-up?** no **Why CUT.** It sits awkwardly beside عائشة's fifteen-day account, it is given as «يقال», and the bare version names a community as the agent. **Not for the hall.** Recorded so it is never re-researched, and logged for QA_BANK.md as a floor question. Also at الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٦٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/953> and سير ج ٢٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1168>.

ABD/E-B24 · The three regrets

Tier: CUT · **When:** the last days [SOURCED] · **Map:** none. **What happened:** صالح بن الذببي carries, through صالِح بن كيسان, a long deathbed report in which أبو بكر lists three things he wishes he had not done, three he wishes he had done, and three he wishes he had asked the Prophet ﷺ. The list is at سير الراشدون ص ١٨-١٧. **The statement:** none in the sources we use — **for delivery purposes.** The Arabic is on the page at <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1165> and <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1166>, and is deliberately not reproduced on a card that could be read aloud by mistake. **عبرت:** — (none offered.) **Hands-up?** no

Why CUT. The first item in the list touches the مشاجرات directly. CLAUDE.md §1.6 forbids improvising on that from the floor, and this session is not the place where it is handled with اصول. **The one separable, safe sentence from that same report** is usable on its own and is quoted in full at §9.1 — سير أعلام ج ١٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1165>:

and is quoted in full at §9.1. جعلت لكم عهدا بعدي، واخترت لكم خيركم في نفسي فكلكم ورم لذلك أنفه رجاء أن يكون الأمر له

Iraq, Shām, and يرموك

Source note: [iraq-syria-and-yarmuk-12-15ah.md](#) — read it for the pages behind these cards.

ISA/E-C1 · The order to Iraq

Tier: CORE · **When:** 12 المحرم AH [SOURCED — البدايم ج ٧ ص ٦٢] · **Map:** first arrow leaves Arabia — from the yimāma east to the lower Euphrates. Arabia stops being the whole board. **What happened:** Khālīd ^{رضي الله عنه} had just finished al-Yamāma. A letter came from Abū Bakr ^{رضي الله عنه} in Medina. It did not say "conquer Iraq." It said: come at Iraq from its lower end. Call the people to God. If they answer, they are Muslims — what is yours is theirs. If they refuse, take the jizya. If they refuse that, fight. And then two restrictions that are easy to miss. Do not compel any man to march with you. And do not use any man who apostatised, even if he has come back. **The statement:**

وَأَنْ يَتَأَلَّفَ النَّاسَ وَيَدْعُوهُمْ إِلَى اللَّهِ ﷻ، فَإِنْ أَجَابُوا وَإِلَّا أَخَذَ مِنْهُمْ الْجِزْيَةَ فَإِنْ امْتَنَعُوا عَنْ ذَلِكَ قَاتِلْهُمْ، وَأَمْرُهُ أَنْ لَا يُكْرَهَ أَحَدًا عَلَى الْمَسِيرِ مَعَهُ، وَلَا يَسْتَعِينُ بِمَنْ ارْتَدَّ عَنِ الْإِسْلَامِ وَإِنْ كَانَ [قد] عاد إليه — البدايم والنهائيم ج ٧ ص ٦٢
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3208> English: "...that he should win the people over and call them to God; if they answered, well, and if not, take the jizya from them; and if they refused that, fight them. And he ordered him not to compel anyone to march with him, and not to make use of any man who had apostatised from Islam, even if he had returned to it." **عبرت:** A state that has just won a civil war and still refuses to conscript the defeated is telling you what it thinks it is for. **Hands-up?** no

ISA/E-C2 · The letter to the marzubāns of Persia

Tier: CORE · **When:** 12 AH [SOURCED — البدايم ج ٧ ص ٦٤] · **Map:** a line drawn from الحيرة to المدائن — the first time Medina addresses the Persian court directly. **What happened:** Khālīd ^{رضي الله عنه} had taken al-Hīra. Upriver from it stood al-Madā'in — the throne of Persia, the iwān of Chosroes. He did not march on it. He wrote to it. The letter was short and it survives, because al-Sha'bī says the family of Buqayla in al-Hīra read it out to him. It sets out one offer, one alternative, and one warning. Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله ends the page on their reaction: when they read it, they were left marvelling. **The statement:**

فَابْعَثُوا إِلَيَّ بِالرُّهْنِ وَاعْتَقِدُوا مِنِّي الدِّمَةَ، وَ (إِلَّا) فَوَالَّذِي لَا إِلَهَ غَيْرُهُ لَأُبْعَثَنَّ إِلَيْكُمْ قَوْمًا يَحْتَوُونَ الْمَوْتَ كَمَا تَحْتَوُونَ أَنْتُمْ
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3210> English: "...so send me hostages and take a covenant of protection from me. Otherwise — by Him beside whom there is no god — I shall send against you a people who love death as you love life." **عبرت:** A man who has made peace with his own death is very difficult to bargain with. **Hands-up?** Ask the room: how far is Medina from the Persian capital? Then tell them a letter went, before an army did.

ISA/E-C3 · The poison cup at al-Hīra

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 12 AH [SOURCED — البدايم ج ٧ ص ٧٠; also وسير ج ١ ص ٣٧٦ where the chain is مرسل] · **Map:** al-Hīra pinned — the old Arab-Christian capital of the Lakhmids, now negotiating. **What happened:** The man who negotiated for al-Hīra was 'Amr b. 'Abd al-Masīḥ b. Buqayla, a Christian Arab, very old. Khālīd ^{رضي الله عنه} noticed a pouch on him and asked what was in it. Poison, the man said — enough to kill within the hour. And why do you carry it? So that if I see ruin coming on my people, I can take it. Khālīd ^{رضي الله عنه} took the pouch out of his hand, said the name of God over it, and — as the commanders reached out to stop him — swallowed it. Ibn Buqayla, watching, said that he had never seen a day of plainer good fortune than this; and

he turned to the people of al-Hīra, who then asked Khālīd ^{رضي} for terms. (The page does not add a sentence about the poison's effect; it moves straight to the treaty. Narrate only that far.) **The statement:**

إنه لن تموت نفس حتى تأتني على أجلها ... بسم الله خير الأسماء، رب الأرض والسماء، الذي ليس يضُرُّ مع اسمه داء، البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٧٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3216> English: "No soul dies until it reaches its appointed term ... In the name of God, best of names, Lord of earth and sky, with whose name no sickness can harm — the Merciful, the Compassionate." **عبرت:** Certainty about the appointed hour is not recklessness; it is what makes a man usable. **Hands-up?** no (Note for the speaker: al-Dhahabī رحمه الله carries the same incident by a different route where the chain is broken — the narrator did not hear it from Khālīd ^{رضي}. Tell it as a report the books carry.)

ISA/E-C4 · The secret hajj and the letter of reproof

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 12 AH ذو القعدة—ذو الحجة · **Map:** [البدايه ج ٧ ص ٧٨ — SOURCED] a thin line looping from al-Firāḍ on the Roman frontier all the way down to Mecca and back — a route "nobody had travelled before." **What happened:** After the fighting at al-Firāḍ, Khālīd ^{رضي} sent the army back to al-Hīra and let them believe he was riding in the rear. Instead he turned south with a few companions and rode to Mecca by a road nobody had used, performed the pilgrimage, and caught up with the rearguard before it got home. Almost nobody knew. Abū Bakr ^{رضي} only found out when the pilgrims came back to Medina and mentioned it. He wrote to him. The punishment was to be moved from the Iraq front to the Syrian one. And with the reprimand came a warning about something other than absence. **The statement:**

فليهنك أبا سليمان النية والخطوة، فأتممَّ يُتِمِّمَ الله لك، ولا يدخلنك عَجْبٌ فتخسر وتخذل، وإياك أن تُدَلَّ بعمل فإنَّ الله له المنُّ وهو وليّ الجزاء — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٧٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3224> English: "May the intention and the favour bring you joy, Abū Sulaymān; finish, and God will finish for you. But let no self-admiration enter you, or you will lose and be abandoned; and beware of being made proud by a deed, for the bounty is God's and He is the master of reward." **عبرت:** The reprimand a commander needs is rarely about the rule he broke. **Hands-up?** no

ISA/E-C5 · The march across the waterless desert

Tier: CORE · **When:** 13 AH [البدايه ج ٧ ص ٨٧؛ الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٥٣؛ سير ج ١ ص ٣٦٦ — SOURCED] · **Map:** THE map moment of the evening. A line strikes north-west out of Iraq at Qurāqir, crosses blank desert with no road on it, and comes out at Suwā and Tadmur — behind the Roman armies. **What happened:** The commanders in Syria wrote to Abū Bakr ^{رضي} asking for reinforcement and telling him what the Romans had gathered at the Yarmūk. He wrote back to Khālīd ^{رضي} in Iraq: put a deputy over Iraq, bring the men you have to Syria, and when you reach them you are the commander over them. The letter reached Iraq and Khālīd ^{رضي} set off at once — but not by any road. He chose the Samāwa, five days of waterless country. His guide was Rāfi' b. 'Umayra al-Ṭā'i, and Rāfi' told him plainly it could not be done with cavalry and baggage: a lone rider fears that road. Khālīd ^{رضي} said he had no choice; he had to come out behind the Romans. So they prepared. The strongest camels were made thirsty, then watered twice over, their lips cut and their mouths bound so they could not chew and lose the water. Every day they opened the bellies of ten of them and watered the horses from what was inside. On the last stretch Rāfi', whose eyes were bad, asked the men whether they could see a box-thorn bush the height of a seated man. They said no. He said: then by God you are dead, and I am dead with you. They looked again. The bush was there, cut down to a stump. They dug at its root and found the spring. **The statement:**

· وَاللَّهِ مَا وَرَدْتُ هَذَا الْمَاءَ قَطُّ إِلَّا مَرَّةً وَاحِدَةً مَعَ أَبِي وَأَنَا غِلَامٌ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٥٣

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/944> English: "By God, I have come to this water only once in my life — with my father, when I was a boy." **عبرت:** The march was survived on preparation and on one man's memory; neither was an accident. **Hands-up?** Ask: how do you carry water for an army across five days of desert, with no wells? Take two answers. Then tell them. (Length: *البداية* says nine days, *الكامل* and *سير* say five nights. Say both.)

ISA/E-C6 · "At daybreak the people praise the night march"

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 13 AH [SOURCED — *البداية* ج ٧ ص ٨٨] · **Map:** the same line, arriving. **What happened:** On that crossing an Arab of the country had told Khālīd that if he reached a certain tree by morning he and his men would live, and if he missed it they would die. They rode through the night, hard, and came up to it at first light. Khālīd said one sentence. Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله notes that it became a proverb in Arabic and that Khālīd was the first man to say it. **The statement:**

· <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3234> English: "At daybreak the people praise the night march." **عبرت:** The night the effort is made and the morning it is judged are never the same morning. **Hands-up?** no

ISA/E-C7 · Four commanders, four roads

Tier: CORE · **When:** early 13 AH [SOURCED — *البداية* ج ٧ ص ٨٣-٨٤] · **Map:** four arrows leave Medina at once, on four separate roads, and four sectors of Syria light up — Damascus, Homs, Palestine, Jordan. **What happened:** Abū Bakr finished with Arabia and turned to Syria. He did not send one army. He appointed four commanders and gave each of them a province before it was taken: Yazīd b. Abī Sufyān Damascus, Abū 'Ubayda Homs, 'Amr b. al-Āṣ Palestine, Shurahbīl b. Ḥasana Jordan. He ordered each to take a different road. And he walked out of Medina on foot beside each of them while they rode, giving his instructions. Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله says the four roads were not a military trick: the caliph was following a verse. **The statement:**

· *يَا بَنِيَّ لَا تَدْخُلُوا مِنْ بَابٍ وَاحِدٍ وَادْخُلُوا مِنْ أَبْوَابٍ مُتَفَرِّقَةٍ* [يوسف: ٦٧] — *البداية* والنهية ج ٧ ص ٨٣-٨٤) <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3229> (opening words) and <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3230> (the rest of the verse) English: "O my sons, do not enter by one gate; enter by separate gates." — Yūsuf 67, quoted by Ibn Kathīr as the precedent Abū Bakr was following. **عبرت:** A plan is safer when it is not one plan. **Hands-up?** no

ISA/E-C8 · The spy's report

Tier: CORE · **When:** 2 جمادى الأولى 13 nights remaining of أجنادين, [SOURCED — *الكامل* ج ٢ ص ٢٦١] · **Map:** Ajnādayn pinned, between al-Ramla and Bayt Jibrīn in Palestine. **What happened:** Before the battle at Ajnādayn the Roman commander wanted to know what he was facing, so he sent a Christian Arab into the Muslim camp to look. The man stayed a day and a night and came back. He did not report numbers or weapons. He reported a description. And the commander, hearing it, gave the reply of a man who has understood something before his own army has. **The statement:**

بِاللَّيْلِ رُهْبَانٌ وَبِالنَّهَارِ فُرْسَانٌ، وَلَوْ سَرَقَ ابْنُ مَلِكِهِمْ قِطْعَوْهُ، وَلَوْ رَتَى رُجِمَ ... فَقَالَ: إِنْ كُنْتُ صَدَقْتُنِي لَيَطُنَّ الْأَرْضَ حَيْرٌ مِنَ لِقَاءِ هَؤُلَاءِ عَلَى ظَهْرِهَا — *الكامل* فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦١ <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/952> English: "By night monks, by day horsemen; if their king's son stole they would cut off his hand, and if he committed adultery he would be stoned." He said: "If you have told me the truth, then the belly of the earth is better than meeting these men on its back." **عبرت:** What frightened the enemy was not the

cavalry; it was that the law was the same for the ruler's son. **Hands-up?** Ask: if you sent a man to look at an army, what would you want him to count? Then read what this one actually reported.

ISA/E-C9 · Khālīd ^{رضي} hands the command round

Tier: CORE · **When:** the morning of اليرموك [SOURCED — ٢٥٥ص ج ٢ الكامل ج ٧ ص ٨٩؛ البدايه ج ٧ ص ٨٩] · **Map:** the Yarmūk. Roman camp at al-Wāqūṣa with the ravine at its back; the Muslim line sitting across the only road out. **What happened:** The Muslim armies had come to the Yarmūk still divided — four commanders, each over his own men, nobody over all of them. On the morning of the battle Khālīd ^{رضي} stood up and made a proposal. He did not ask for the command. He proposed that they pass it round: one of us today, another tomorrow, another the day after, until every one of us has held it — and let me have today. They made him commander, expecting the thing to last a long time. It lasted one day. **The statement:**

إن هذا يوم من أيام الله، لا ينبغي فيه الفخر ولا البغي ... فتعالوا فلنتعاور الإمارة فليكن عليها بعضنا اليوم والآخر غدًا والآخر بعد غد، حتى يتأمر كلكم، ودعوني اليوم أليكم — البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٨٩
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3235> English: "This is a day of God's days — there should be no boasting in it and no aggression ... So come, let us take the command in turn: one of us today, another tomorrow, another the day after, until every one of you has commanded. And let me have charge of you today." **عبرت:** The man who asked for one day got the day; a man who had demanded the whole command might have got neither. **Hands-up?** no

ISA/E-C10 · "Armies are made many by victory"

Tier: CORE · **When:** اليرموك [SOURCED — ٩٢-٩١ص ج ٧ البدايه ج ٧ ص ٩٢] · **Map:** the numbers panel goes up beside the map — with the caveat line under it. **What happened:** Khālīd ^{رضي} had come in from Iraq and was looking at the Roman lines. A Christian Arab standing near him said out loud what everyone could see: how many the Romans are, and how few the Muslims. He got an answer that had nothing to do with counting. **The statement:**

ويلك، أتخوّفني بالروم؟ وإنما تكثر الجنود بالنصر، وتقل بالخذلان لا بعدد الرجال — البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٩٢
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3238> English: "Woe to you — are you frightening me with the Romans? Armies are made many by victory and few by abandonment, not by the number of men."
عبرت: Counting the enemy is useful; being governed by the count is not. **Hands-up?** Ask the room to guess the two army sizes. Take three guesses. Then show that the books themselves give three different answers, and say why.

ISA/E-C11 · Jirja and the two rak'as

Tier: CORE · **When:** اليرموك [SOURCED — ٩٦-٩٥ص ج ٧ البدايه ج ٧ ص ٩٦] · **Map:** no change; a single point between the two lines. **What happened:** One of the senior Roman commanders, Jirja, rode out from his own line and called Khālīd ^{رضي} to him. They met between the armies, close enough that their horses' necks crossed. He asked one question: is it true God sent your Prophet a sword from heaven, and gave it to you, so that you never draw it without routing them? Khālīd ^{رضي} said: no. Then why are you called the Sword of God? And Khālīd ^{رضي} answered by telling him what he had been — one of the men who called the Prophet ﷺ a liar and kept away from him. Jirja kept asking. What do you call people to. What if a man refuses. What does a man get who joins you today, having missed everything. Khālīd ^{رضي} said: the same reward — and better, because you did not see what we saw and you still came. At that Jirja turned his shield over and crossed to the Muslim side. Khālīd ^{رضي} took him to his tent, poured a waterskin over him, and prayed two rak'as with him. Jirja was killed later that same day. **The statement:**

وأصيب جرجة □ ولم يصل لله إلا تلك الركعتين مع خالد — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٩٦

<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3242> English: "And Jirja was killed, and he never prayed to God but those two rak'as with Khālīd." **عبرت:** A whole life can turn on one honest question asked of an opponent instead of about him. **Hands-up?** no

ISA/E-C12 · The courier in the middle of the battle

Tier: CORE · **When:** أبو بكر ^{رضي} on Monday, 8 nights remaining of 13 جمادى الآخرة AH [SOURCED — البدايه ج ٧ ص ٩٥، ١٠٢] · **Map:** a small arrow from Medina to the Yarmūk — the news travelling while the battle is being fought. **What happened:** In the middle of the fighting a courier arrived from the Hijāz and was brought to Khālīd ^{رضي}. Khālīd ^{رضي} asked him what the news was. The man told him quietly: Abū Bakr ^{رضي} is dead. 'Umar ^{رضي} is caliph. And Abū 'Ubayda ^{رضي} has been put over the armies in your place. Khālīd ^{رضي} heard both pieces of news at once. He said, loudly enough for the men to hear, "You have done well." Then he took the letter, put it in his quiver, and went back to running the battle. The army learned neither thing until it was over. Ibn Kathīr ^{رحمه الله} records what happened when they did: they did not rejoice at the spoil as much as they grieved for Abū Bakr ^{رضي}. **The statement:**

فأسرها خالدٌ ولم يُبْدِ ذلك للناس لئلا يحصل ضعفٌ ووهنٌ في تلك الحال، وقال له والناسُ يسمعون: أحسنت — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3241> English: "Khālīd kept it secret and did not show it to the men, lest weakness and faltering set in at such a moment — and he said to him, with the men listening: 'You have done well.'" **عبرت:** He was told he had been replaced and finished the day's work anyway; that is what obedience looks like before anyone is watching. **Hands-up?** no

ISA/E-C13 · Damascus, taken two ways at once

Tier: CORE · **When:** mid 14 رجب AH per the majority [SOURCED — البدايه ج ٧ ص ١٠٨] · the storming [SOURCED — البدايه ج ٧ ص ١٠٥؛ الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٦٩-٢٧٠] · **Map:** Damascus falls. Colour it **half and half** — that is the whole point of the card. **What happened:** The siege had gone through the winter and stalled. Then a son was born to the Byzantine commander of the city, and he made a feast; the men on the wall ate, drank and slept. One man noticed. Khālīd ^{رضي}, Ibn Kathīr ^{رحمه الله} says, neither slept nor let anyone else sleep, and had scouts reporting the state of the garrison morning and evening. He had already made ladders out of rope. That night his party swam the moat with waterskins at their necks, fixed the ladders to the battlements, climbed, and shouted the takbīr from the top of the wall. He came down inside, killed the gatekeepers and cut the bolts. At the same hour, at the other gates, the townspeople — hearing the noise and not knowing what it was — accepted the terms the Muslims had been offering all along and opened their own gates. The commanders met in the middle of the city: one side had come in by force, the other by treaty. **The statement:**

قَالَتَقَى خَالِدٌ وَالْقَوَادُ فِي وَسْطِهَا، هَذَا قَتْلًا وَنَهْيًا، وَهَذَا صَفْحًا وَتَسْكِينًا، فَأَجَزُوا تَاجِيَّةَ خَالِدٍ مَجْرَى الصُّلْحِ — الكامل فى <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/961> English: "Khālīd and the other commanders met in the middle of the city — this one killing and plundering, that one pardoning and calming — so they applied the terms of the treaty to Khālīd's side as well." **عبرت:** Where they could not tell which had come first, they gave the city the gentler ruling — and called it caution. **Hands-up?** Ask: if half a city surrenders and half is stormed on the same night, what are the terms? Take answers. Then give the Companions' own answer.

ISA/E-C14 · Fiḥl — the mud they laid themselves

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 13 or 14 AH; the sequence relative to Damascus is disputed [SOURCED — البدايه ج ٧ ص ١١٢-١١٣؛ الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٧٠] · **Map:** Fiḥl / Baysān in the Ghawr, below the Jordan. **What happened:** The

Romans who had gathered at Fihl did something clever. They opened the irrigation channels and flooded the ground between themselves and the Muslim camp until it was deep mud, so that no charge could reach them. The Arabs afterwards called that whole campaign "the muddy one." Then, thinking the Muslims must be off their guard, they attacked in the night. But the commander there was Shurahbīl b. Ḥasana^{رضي}, who never spent a night or a morning out of battle order. The camp came up as one man. The fighting ran through the night and the whole of the next day. When the Romans finally broke, the rout carried them straight back into their own mud. **The statement:**

· وأسلمتهم هزيمتهم إلى ذلك الوحل الذي كانوا قد كادوا به المسلمين فغرقهم الله فيه — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١١٣
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3259> English: "And their rout delivered them into the very mud with which they had meant to trap the Muslims, and God drowned them in it." **عبرت:** The trap a man builds is still there when he is the one running. **Hands-up?** no

ISA/E-C15 · The removal, and what the two men said

Tier: CORE · **When:** 13 AH, on 'Umar^{رضي}'s accession [البدايه ج ٧ ص ١٠٣، ص ٢٣٦؛ سير ج ١ — SOURCED] · **Map:** no change. The name over Syria changes; nothing else does. **What happened:** The first thing 'Umar^{رضي} did as caliph was to remove Khālīd^{رضي} from the command of Syria and put Abū 'Ubayda^{رضي} in his place. The letter was blunt: take his turban off his head and divide his property with him. Abū 'Ubayda^{رضي} carried it out — the books say he divided even the pair of sandals, taking one and leaving him the other. Khālīd^{رضي} said one sentence while it was being done: I hear and obey the Commander of the Faithful. And then, at the handover, each of the two men said something about the other — and neither of them said it in his own words. Each quoted the Prophet ﷺ. **The statement:**

فقال خالد: بعث إليكم أمين هذه الأمة، سمعتُ رسول الله ﷺ يقول: "أَمِينُ هذه الأمة أبو عبيدة بن الجراح". فقال أبو عبيدة: سمعت رسول الله ﷺ يقول: "خالدٌ سيفٌ من سيوف الله، نَعَمْ قَتَى العَشِيرَةَ" — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٢٣٦
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3382> English: Khālīd said: "He has sent you the trustee of this community — I heard the Messenger of God ﷺ say: 'The trustee of this community is Abū 'Ubayda b. al-Jarrāh.'" And Abū 'Ubayda said: "I heard the Messenger of God ﷺ say: 'Khālīd is a sword among the swords of God — what an excellent young man of the clan.'" **عبرت:** Each of them met the other's promotion by quoting the Prophet ﷺ in the other's favour; that is what settled it, and it is what should settle it for us. **Hands-up?** no (Speaker note: narrate, do not judge. If the room pushes on why, go straight to E-C16 and stop there.)

ISA/E-C16 · "I did not remove him for any suspicion"

Tier: CORE · **When:** 15 AH (after Qinnasrīn), and again in writing in 17 AH [البدايه ج ٧ ص ١٥٣؛ — SOURCED] · **Map:** no change. **What happened:** After Khālīd^{رضي} had been removed from the command he stayed in Syria and went on fighting under Abū 'Ubayda^{رضي}. At Qinnasrīn he took the town, and when the reports reached Medina, 'Umar^{رضي} said something about Abū Bakr^{رضي}, and about himself. Two years later, when he removed Khālīd^{رضي} a second time, he did not leave the matter to talk: he wrote a circular to every garrison city setting out his reason. Both times the reason is the same, and neither time is it a charge of wrongdoing. **The statement:**

يرحمُ الله أبا بكر، كان أعلم بالرجال مني، واللهِ إني لم أعزله عن ربيبة ولكن خشيتُ أن يوكلَ الناسُ إليه — البدايه
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3299> English: "May God have mercy on Abū Bakr — he knew men better than I do. By God, I did not remove him for any suspicion, but I feared that people

would come to rely on him." **عبرت:** A commander can be removed for being too successful, and both men can be right. **Hands-up?** no

ISA/E-C17 · The death on the bed

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 21 AH, at Homs [SOURCED — سير ج ١ ص ٣٦٧، ص ٣٨١، ص ٣٨٣؛ البدايم ج ٧ ص ٢٣٧ — (the statement quoted below, and the women weeping)] · **Map:** a last pin at Homs — where the man who crossed the Samāwa is buried. **What happened:** He died in bed, and he minded. He had looked for death in the places death is found, he said, and it had not been decreed for him. He was asked what of his own deeds he hoped in most, and he named neither Yarmūk nor Damascus nor Iraq — he named one cold night spent under his shield in the rain, waiting for the light. Then he gave his instructions: when I am dead, take my weapons and my horse and make them equipment in the way of God. He left nothing else — a horse, his weapons, and a servant. When ‘Umar^{رضي} heard, on the Mecca road, he said "innā li-llāh" over and over and lowered his head. And when the women of Banū al-Mughīra gathered in his house to weep and someone suggested the caliph forbid them, ‘Umar^{رضي} refused. **The statement:**

وما من عملي شيء أَرْجَى عندي بعد لا إله إلا الله من ليلة بئها وأنا مُتَتَرِّسُ والسماء تهلّني ننتظر الصبح حتى تُغيّر
٢٣٩ ص ٧ ص ٢٣٩ English: "There is nothing of my deeds I hope in more, after 'there is no god but God', than one night I passed under my shield with the rain pouring on me, waiting for the dawn." **عبرت:** The deed he hoped in was the one no one had watched. **Hands-up?** Ask: of everything this man did, which act do you think he hoped in most? Take three answers. Then read his own.

ISA/E-C18 · What the Romans said about why they lost

Tier: GOOD · **When:** after اليرموك [SOURCED — البدايم ج ٧ ص ٩٩] · **Map:** Heraclius withdraws from Homs, then Antioch, then out of Syria altogether — the Roman line pulls back off the board. **What happened:** The defeated troops came back to Heraclius. He asked them a plain question: are these men not human beings like you? They said yes. Are you not more numerous? They said many times over. Then why do you keep getting routed? One of their elders answered, and the answer was a list — half of it about the Muslims and half of it about themselves. Heraclius did not argue with him. **The statement:**

من أجل أنهم يقومون الليل ويصومون النهار، ويوفون بالعهد، ويأمرون بالمعروف، وينهون عن المنكر، ويتناصفون
بينهم، ومن أجل أنا نشرب الخمر، ونزني، ونركب الحرام، وننقض العهد، ونغصب ونظلم ... فقال: أنت صدقتني —
٩٩ ص ٧ ص ٩٩ English: "Because they stand at night and fast by day, keep their covenants, command good and forbid wrong, and deal justly among themselves — and because we drink wine, commit adultery, ride into the forbidden, break our covenants, seize and oppress." ... He said: "You have told me the truth." **عبرت:** They were beaten, and they knew exactly why; knowing it is not the same as changing it. **Hands-up?** no (Speaker note: Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله transmits this from a collection outside the six books. Cite it to al-Bidāya, and say "the book records." The narrower, better-known line on the same page — "by night monks, by day horsemen" — is the safer one if only one is used.)

ISA/E-C19 · The Romans in chains

Tier: CUT · **When:** 12 AH, and again at اليرموك [SOURCED — البدايم ج ٧ ص ٩٥، ص ٨٩] · **Map:** none. **What happened:** Twice the sources describe an enemy army chaining its own ranks together so that no man could run. At Kāzima the Persians did it, and Ibn Kathīr records that the Muslims took it as a bad omen

against them and said so out loud. At the Yarmūk the figure given is tens of thousands chained in tens — though on the same page Sayf gives a much smaller figure and Ibn Kathīr writes "God knows best" after it. At the end, when the Roman line broke, the chains did what chains do. **The statement:**

· قَتِيْمَنَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ بِذَلِكَ وَقَالُوا هَذَا طَائِرٌ مَشْوُومٌ قِيدُوا نَفْسَهُمْ بِالْحَدِيدِ — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٤٥
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3211> English: "The Muslims took it as a good omen for themselves and said: this is an ill-omened bird — they have shackled their own souls with iron." **عبرت:** An army that has to chain its men in place has already told you what it thinks of them. **Hands-up?** no (CUT because the chained-ranks detail is the part of the Yarmūk numbers most likely to be challenged, and because it adds nothing the evening needs. Recorded so it is not re-researched.)

ISA/E-C20 · The judge and the reciter

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the morning of اليرموك [SOURCED — البدايه ج ٧ ص ٨٩-٩٠ — SOURCED] · **Map:** the battle-order diagram — centre, wings, cavalry behind each wing, Abū 'Ubayda behind everyone. **What happened:** When the line was drawn up at the Yarmūk, the appointments made that morning are worth reading in full. Qubāth b. Ashyam over the scouts. 'Abd Allāh b. Mas'ūd over the spoils. Abū Sufyān to walk the ranks exhorting. And two more that no army list would think to include: Abū al-Dardā' as the judge of the day, and al-Miqdād to ride round the ranks reciting Sūrat al-Anfāl and the verses of jihād. Abū 'Ubayda, on Khālid's advice, moved himself out of the centre and stood behind the whole army — so that any man who broke would see him and turn back out of shame. **The statement:**

والقاضي يومئذ أبو الدرداء، وقاصّهم الذي يعظّمهم ويحثّهم على القتال أبو سفيان بن حرب، وقارؤهم الذي يدور على الناس فيقرأ سورة الأنفال وآيات الجهاد المِقْدَاد بن الأسود — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٨٩-٩٠
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3235> (ص ٨٩) and runs on to <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3236> (ص ٩٠) English: "And the judge that day was Abū al-Dardā'; the one who preached to them and urged them to fight was Abū Sufyān b. Ḥarb; and their reciter, who went round the men reading Sūrat al-Anfāl and the verses of jihād, was al-Miqdād b. al-Aswad." **عبرت:** They appointed a judge before the battle, not after it. **Hands-up?** Ask: what posts would you fill before a battle? Take answers. Then read the list.

المدائن, رستم, and القادسية

Source note: [qadisiyya-madain-and-the-embassy.md](#) — read it for the pages behind these cards.

QMA/E-Q1 · Nobody would go to Persia

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٣هـ, the morning after أبو بكر was buried — the first days of عمر's caliphate [SOURCED]. **The month is not on either page:** ١١٤ ص ٧ البدايه says only «وُذِفْنَ لَيْلَةَ الثَّلَاثَةِ» and «اللَّيْلَةِ» ٢٧٣ ص ٢ الكامل **المدينه** lights. A single dotted arrow points north-east toward العراق and stops short. **What happened:** أبو بكر was buried at night. The next morning عمر stood up and asked for volunteers to go and fight Persia. Nobody moved. He asked again the second day. Nobody moved. He asked a third time, while men were still filing past to give him their pledge. Still nobody. Ibn al-Athīr says plainly why: of all the fronts, Persia was the heaviest on the Muslims and the most hateful to them, because of the severity of that empire and its power and its subjugation of nations. On the fourth day one man stood up. After that, the rest followed. **The statement:**

ثُمَّ نَدَبَ النَّاسَ وَهُوَ يُبَايِعُهُمْ، ثَلَاثًا، وَلَا يَتَدَبَّ أَحَدٌ إِلَى فَارِسَ، وَكَانُوا أَثْقَلَ الْوُجُوهِ عَلَى الْمُسْلِمِينَ، وَأَكْرَهَهُمْ إِلَيْهِمْ لِشِدَّةِ سُلْطَانِهِمْ وَشَوْكَتِهِمْ وَقَهْرِهِمْ الْأَمَمَ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٧٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/964>
English: "Then he called the people while taking their pledge — three times — and no one volunteered for Persia. They were the heaviest of all fronts on the Muslims, and the most hateful to them, because of the severity of their rule and their power and their subjugation of nations." **عبرت:** Fear in a believing community is not a scandal; what is asked of it is that somebody finally stand up. **Hands-up?** "Who here thinks the Companions were never afraid of anything?"

QMA/E-Q2 · The command goes to the first man who volunteered

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٣هـ, **the fourth day** of the call for volunteers — that is all either page gives (البدايه ج ٧) **[SOURCED]**. **No month is stated in the sources for this;** do not print one · **Map:** the arrow from المدينة to العراق is now solid; a marker for الحيرة. **What happened:** The man who stood up on the fourth day was أبو عبيد بن مسعود الثقفي. He was not a Companion. عمر put him in command of the whole army — over men who had fought at Badr. People objected: appoint one of the Companions. عمر refused. God raised the Companions by their precedence, he said; if another man does what they did while they hang back, he has the better right to command. He would appoint no one but the first to answer. He then called أبو عبيد بن مسعود الثقفي — سليل بن قيس — سليل and عبيد, سعد بن عبيد a man of Badr — and told the last two to their faces: *had you outstripped him, I would have appointed you.* And to عبيد, أبو عبيد, about سليل, he gave a second reason: Saliṭ was too quick to war, and haste in war ruins an army. **The statement:**

وَاللَّهِ لَا أُؤَمِّرُ عَلَيْهِمْ إِلَّا أَوَّلَهُمْ أَنْتِدَابًا — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٧٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/964>
English: "By God, I will appoint over them none but the first of them to volunteer." **عبرت:** Precedence is earned again every time it is claimed; it does not carry forward on its own. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q3 · The Bridge — the defeat that opened the Iraq front

Tier: CORE · **When:** شعبان ١٣هـ **[SOURCED]** · **Map:** a river line drawn across the arrow; the marker for قسّ / الناطف / الجسر, west of the Euphrates. The advance stops and pulls back. **What happened:** The Persians came to the river with elephants and the great standard of the empire. They sent word across: either you cross to us, or we cross to you. His men told him not to cross. He crossed. On the far bank the ground was tight and the Arab horses would not go near the elephants. أبو عبيد ordered the elephants cut down and went at the great white one himself with his sword. It trampled him and stood over his body. Seven men of Thaqīf, whom he had named in advance, took the banner one after another, and each of them was killed. Then المثنى بن حارثة took it. Men crowded back onto the bridge and it broke. About four thousand were killed or drowned; two thousand scattered into the countryside; three thousand were left. **The statement:**

فقال المسلمون لأُميرهم أبي عبيد: أُوْمِرْهُمْ فليعبروا هم إلينا. فقال: ما هم بأجراً على الموت ممّا، ثم اقتحم إليهم — البداية والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١١٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3262> *English:* "The Muslims said to their commander Abū 'Ubayd: order them, and let them cross to us. He said: they are no bolder in the face of death than we are — and he plunged across to them." **عبرت:** Courage that refuses counsel is not courage; it is the same fault wearing better clothes. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q4 · «أنا فئة كل مسلم» — the caliph takes the blame

Tier: CORE · **When:** شعبان ١٣هـ, days after the Bridge [SOURCED] · **Map:** small figures moving back toward المدينة lights. **What happened:** Some of the survivors did not stop at the army. They kept going, all the way back to Medina, and then some of them scattered into the countryside because they were too ashamed to be seen. عمر^{رض} was told. It weighed on him — and what he said was not a reprimand. He absolved every Muslim, said he himself was the refuge every one of them was entitled to fall back on, and then asked God's mercy on أبو عبيد, saying that if the man had fallen back to him, he would have been a refuge for him too. Ibn Kathīr's summary is a single clause: he did not reproach the people. **The statement:**

اللَّهُمَّ إِنَّ كُلَّ مُسْلِمٍ فِي جِلِّي مَيِّ، أَنَا فِتْنَةٌ كُلِّ مُسْلِمٍ، يَرْحَمُ اللَّهُ أَبَا عُبَيْدٍ! لَوْ كَانَ انْخَارَ إِلَيَّ لَكُنْتُ لَهُ فِتْنَةً — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٧٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/969> English: "O God, every Muslim is absolved by me. I am the refuge of every Muslim. May God have mercy on Abū 'Ubayd — had he fallen back to me, I would have been a refuge for him." **عبرت:** A leader who will not stand under his people's defeat has no right to stand on top of their victories. **Hands-up?** "What would most rulers have done with an army that ran?"

QMA/E-Q5 · عمر^{رض} is talked out of leading the campaign himself

Tier: GOOD · **When:** المحرم ١٤هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** عمر^{رض}'s own marker moves a short way out of المدينة to العراق, then returns; a new marker, سعد^{رض}, sets out for العراق. **What happened:** On the first day of Muharram, عمر^{رض} rode out of Medina at the head of the army, intending to fight Persia in person. He camped at a water three miles out, left علي^{رض} over Medina, took عثمان^{رض} and the senior Companions with him, and called a council. Everyone agreed with him. One man did not: عبد الرحمن بن عوف^{رض} said that if the caliph were broken, Muslims everywhere on earth would be weakened — send a man, and go home. عمر^{رض} asked whom. Ibn 'Awf said: I have found him — the lion in his claws, Sa'd ibn Mālik az-Zuhri. عمر^{رض} and the people accepted it, and he went back to Medina. **The statement:**

إِنِّي أَخْشَى أَنْ كَسَرْتَ أَنْ يَضْعِفَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ فِي سَائِرِ أَقْطَارِ الْأَرْضِ، وَإِنِّي أَرَى أَنْ تَبْعَثَ رَجُلًا وَتَرْجِعَ أَنْتَ إِلَى الْمَدِينَةِ — البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ١٢٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3275> English: "I fear that if you are broken, the Muslims will be weakened in every quarter of the earth. My view is that you send a man, and that you yourself return to Medina." **عبرت:** The one man in the room who disagrees is worth the whole room, if he is listened to. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q6 · «لا يَغْرَتُكَ مِنَ اللَّهِ أَنْ قِيلَ: خَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ»

Tier: CORE · **When:** المحرم ١٤هـ, at the parting [SOURCED] · **Map:** none — this is a statement slide. **What happened:** سعد بن أبي وقاص^{رض} was a Zuhri, of the clan of the Prophet's ﷺ own mother. People called him "the maternal uncle of the Messenger of God ﷺ." He was one of the Ten, one of the first to accept Islam, present at Badr and Hudaibiya. عمر^{رض} handed him an empire to conquer, and the first thing he said to him was that none of that would help him. God does not blot out an evil with an evil, he told him; He blots out an evil with a good. Between God and any man there is no kinship except obedience. And then the line that flattens every rank in the army at once: the noble and the low are equal before God, He is their Lord and they are His servants. **The statement:**

يَا سَعْدُ بْنُ وَهَيْبٍ لَا يَغْرَتُكَ مِنَ اللَّهِ أَنْ قِيلَ: خَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ وَصَاحِبُهُ، فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَمْحُو السَّيِّئَةَ بِالسَّيِّئَةِ، وَلَكِنْ يَمْحُو السَّيِّئَةَ بِالْحَسَنِ، وَإِنَّ اللَّهَ لَيْسَ بَيْنَهُ وَبَيْنَ أَحَدٍ نَسَبٌ إِلَّا بِطَاعَتِهِ، فَالْأَنْاسُ شَرِيفُهُمْ وَوَضِيعُهُمْ فِي ذَاتِ اللَّهِ سَوَاءٌ، اللَّهُ · ربهم وهم عباده — البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ١٢٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3275> English: "O Sa'd ibn Wuhayb: let it not deceive you before God that it is said, 'the maternal uncle of the Messenger of God

ﷺ and his companion.' For God does not blot out an evil with an evil; He blots out an evil with a good. And between God and any man there is no kinship except by obedience to Him. People, the noble of them and the low of them, are equal before God: He is their Lord and they are His servants." **عبرت:** A relationship to a righteous man is a gift to be grateful for, never a claim to be traded on. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q7 · رُئعي بن عامر walks his horse across the carpet

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٤ هـ (the year is disputed — see E-Q11) [**SOURCED**] · **Map:** القادسية marker; the Persian camp across the water at العتيق; a line between the two. **What happened:** The Persian commander sent word: send us a man to talk to. رُئعي بن عامر gathered a group to send. رُئعي بن عامر said: if we all go, they will see that we have made much of them — send one man. So he went alone. They had gilded the audience-hall for him: cushions worked with gold, silk rugs, jewels laid out, the commander on a throne of gold with his crown on. رُئعي rode in on a short horse and did not get off until it was standing on the edge of the carpet. He dismounted, slit two of the cushions, and tied his horse to them with the rope through the slits. They told him to put down his weapons. He said: I did not come to you; you sent for me. Leave me as I am, or I go back. They let him through. He walked in leaning on his spear, and left them not one cushion and not one carpet that he did not tear. When he reached the commander he sat down on the bare floor. They asked him why. He said: we do not care to sit on your finery. Then they asked him what had brought them. **The statement:**

اللّٰهُ ابْتَعَثَنَا لَنُخْرِجَ مِنْ شَاءَ مِنْ عِبَادَةِ الْعِبَادِ إِلَى عِبَادَةِ اللَّهِ، وَمَنْ ضَيَّقَ الدُّنْيَا إِلَى سَعَتِهَا، وَمَنْ جَوَّرَ الْأَدْيَانَ إِلَى عَدْلِ الْبَدَايَةِ وَالنَّهَايَةِ ج ٧ ص ١٣٤ · الإسلام · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3280> English: "God sent us out to bring whom He wills out of the worship of servants into the worship of God; and out of the narrowness of this world into its breadth; and out of the injustice of the religions into the justice of Islam." **عبرت:** A man who is not impressed by a room cannot be bought by it. **Hands-up?** "One envoy or seven — which would you have sent?"

QMA/E-Q8 · «ولكن المسلمون كالجسد الواحد» and رستم's own verdict

Tier: CORE · **When:** immediately after E-Q7 [**SOURCED**] · **Map:** none — statement slide, paired with E-Q7. **What happened:** رستم asked for time to consider. رُئعي said: how much — a day, two? The commander said: until I write to our men of judgement and our chiefs. رُئعي told him the Messenger of God ﷺ had laid down that they do not hold off an enemy at the point of contact more than three days; choose within that. Then رستم asked him: are you their chief? And he said no — and gave the reason. After he left, رستم turned to his own nobles and asked whether they had ever heard speech more dignified. They told him not to be taken in by a dog in rags. His answer was the last word in the room. **The statement:**

فقال: أسيدهم أنت؟ قال: لا، ولكن المسلمون كالجسد الواحد يجير أدناهم على أعلاهم ... فقال: ويلكم لا تنظروا إلى الثياب، وانظروا إلى الرأي والكلام والسيرة. إن العرب يستخفون بالثياب والمأكّل، ويصنون الأحساب — البدايه و <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3280> (the second half straddles the break: «وانظروا إلى الرأي ... ويصنون الأحساب» is on ص ١٣٥) English: "He said: are you their chief? He said: no — but the Muslims are like one body: the lowest of them gives protection binding on the highest of them ... [Rustam said:] woe to you, do not look at the clothes. Look at the judgement and the speech and the conduct. The Arabs make light of clothing and food, and they guard their honour." **عبرت:** A community is judged by what its least important member may promise in its name. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q9 · «إِنَّا مَعْشَرُ الْعَرَبِ لَا نَسْتَعِيدُ بَعْضَتَا بَعْضًا»

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the third day of the embassies [SOURCED] · **Map:** none — statement slide. **What happened:** On the third day it was ^شالمغيرة بن شعبة. He walked up and sat down on the throne, beside the Persian commander. They sprang on him, dragged him off and shoved him about. He did not apologise. He told them that reports of their good sense had reached the Arabs, and that he had never seen a more foolish people; that Arabs do not enslave one another, and he had assumed they shared with their own people as Arabs did. Then he told them what he had learnt that day. Ibn al-Athīr records who said what next: the low-born of the court said the Arab had spoken the truth; the landholders said he had thrown out a word their slaves would never stop reaching for. **The statement:**

إِنَّا مَعْشَرُ الْعَرَبِ لَا نَسْتَعِيدُ بَعْضَتَا بَعْضًا ... الْيَوْمَ عَلِمْتُ أَنَّكُمْ مُغَلَّبُونَ، وَأَنَّ مُلْكًا لَا يَقُومُ عَلَى هَذِهِ السَّيْرَةِ وَلَا عَلَى
 ٢٩٩ ص ٢٩٩ الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ — هذه العُقُول — <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/990> English: "We Arabs do not enslave one another ... Today I have learnt that you will be overcome, and that a kingdom does not stand on this conduct or on these minds." **عبرت:** An order that has to keep men beneath it in order to stand is already standing on something that is giving way. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q10 · «فبعث الله إلينا رجلًا معروفًا نعرف نسبه» — before the king

Tier: GOOD · **When:** before the battle [SOURCED] · **Map:** the delegation's line runs from القادسية all the way to المدائن and back. **What happened:** A second delegation went past the army to the king himself. النعمان بن مقرن put the three choices. The king answered with contempt: he knew of no people on earth more wretched, fewer in number or worse in their dealings with one another than the Arabs; Persia had kept border villages simply to keep them off. The delegation fell silent. Then ^شالمغيرة بن شعبة stood up and agreed with every word of it. Nobody was in a worse state than we were, he said. We ate beetles and scorpions and snakes and counted it food. We lived on bare ground and wore what we spun from camel hair. Our religion was that we killed one another and wronged one another, and a man would bury his daughter alive rather than have her eat his food. And then he turned it. **The statement:**

فبعث الله إلينا رجلًا معروفًا نعرف نسبه ونعرف وجهه ومولده، فأرضه خير أرضنا، وحسبه خير أحسابنا، وبيته خير بيوتنا، وقبيلته خير قبائنا، وهو نفسه كان خيرنا في الحال التي كان فيها أصدقنا وأحلمنا — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ١٣٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3283> English: "Then God sent to us a man we knew — we knew his lineage, and we knew his face, and we knew his birth. His land was the best of our land, his descent the best of our descents, his house the best of our houses, his tribe the best of our tribes; and he himself was the best of us in the state we were in, the most truthful of us and the most forbearing." **عبرت:** A man who is honest about where he came from can afford to say plainly what changed him. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q11 · The commander who could not sit up

Tier: CORE · **When:** the four days of القادسية، ١٤هـ — and the tradition disputes the year: 14, 15 or 16 [SOURCED for the dispute] · **Map:** القادسية; the Muslim line drawn hard up against a small fort behind it. **What happened:** When the lines faced each other, ^شسعد could not ride and could not sit. He had sciatica and boils. He lay face-down on a cushion on the roof of a small fort, looking out over the army and giving orders, and he handed the actual fighting to خالد بن عرفة. The Muslim line was at the foot of his wall — Ibn al-Athīr says that if the line had left him uncovered for as long as it takes to milk a camel, he would have been taken alive;

and he never shut the fort's door. A soldier made a couplet mocking him for it. Sa'd came down to the men, showed them the open sores on his thighs and his hips, and they accepted it. **The statement:**

فيقال: إن سعدًا نزل إلى الناس فاعتذر إليهم مما فيه من القروح في فخذه وأليتيه، فعذره الناس — البدايه والنهيه
 ١٩١ ص ٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3287> English: "It is said that Sa'd came down to the people and excused himself to them for the sores in his thighs and hips — and the people excused him." **عبرت:**
 Explaining yourself to the people you lead costs less than the rumour you leave standing. **Hands-up?**
 no

QMA/E-Q12 · Four days, and a night called الهيرير

Tier: CORE · **When:** أرمات · أغواث · عِماس · ليلة الهيرير [SOURCED] · **Map:** the القادسية inset; four day-markers along one line, the third and fourth joined by a night. **What happened:** Sa'd led the noon prayer, then addressed the army and recited the verse about the earth being inherited by God's righteous servants. The reciters read Sūrat al-Anfāl. He had told them: at the first takbīr, make ready; at the second, put on your gear; at the third, let the horsemen stir the men; at the fourth, advance together and say *lā ḥawla wa-lā quwwata illā billāh*. They fought to nightfall on the first day; the second day and most of its night; the third day; and then, through the third night, they stopped speaking altogether. Ibn al-Athīr says that is where the night's name comes from — they only snarled. The sound of iron in it, he says, was like a smithy, all night until morning.

The statement:

· قيل: إِنَّمَا سُمِّيَتْ بِذَلِكَ لِتَرْكُهُمُ الْكَلَامَ إِنَّمَا كَانُوا يَهْرُؤُونَ هَرِيرًا — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣١١
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1002> English: "It is said it was named that because they left off speech; they only snarled." **عبرت:** Endurance is not one heroic hour; it is the fourth day, when nobody is watching and everybody is finished. **Hands-up?** "How many nights without sleep before you would have gone home?"

QMA/E-Q13 · The elephants, and the two spears

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the third day, يوم عِماس [SOURCED] · **Map:** the القادسية inset; a symbol for the elephant line in the Persian centre, then removed. **What happened:** Thirty-three elephants, and among them the old white elephant of Sābūr, which the rest of the herd followed. Eighteen stood in the Persian centre. The Arab horses would not face them. On the third day سعد^{بن} sent two orders: القعقاع and عاصم, sons of 'Amr, take charge of the white one for me; Hammāl and ar-Ribbīl, take charge of the mangy one. The first pair put their two spears into the white elephant's eye; it threw its driver and dropped its trunk, and القعقاع cut it down. The second pair blinded the other, and it turned, threw itself into the river, and the whole herd followed it — straight out through the Persian line and away. Once the elephants were gone, Ibn Kathīr says simply that the Companions destroyed them and those on them and put out their eyes. **The statement:**

وقد قاسوا من الفيلة بالنسبة إلى الخيول العربية بسبب نفرتها منها أمرًا بليغًا، وقد أباد الصحابة الفيلة ومن عليها،
 ١٣٩ ص ٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3285> English: "They suffered a great deal from the elephants, given the Arab horses' terror of them; and the Companions destroyed the elephants and those on them, and put out their eyes." **عبرت:** What terrifies an army is usually one thing, and it usually has a weak point somebody has to be sent to find. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q14 · A wind, a mule, and the end of رستم

Tier: CORE · **When:** past noon on the fourth day [SOURCED] · **Map:** the Persian centre breaks; arrows scatter north toward المدائن and east toward نهاوند. **What happened:** Past noon on the fourth day the Persian centre opened. A violent wind got up, tore the canopy off Rustam's throne and carried it into the water. He got down from the throne and went to shelter in the shade of a baggage mule. A Muslim named Hilāl cut the ropes of the load above him — not knowing he was there — and a pannier came down on him and broke his back. He made for the river and threw himself in; Hilāl went in after him, dragged him out by the legs and killed him, then climbed onto the empty throne and shouted. The Persian centre broke. Thirty thousand chained infantry could not run, and did not survive. **The statement:**

ثُمَّ صَعِدَ السَّرِيرَ وَقَالَ: قَتَلْتُ رُسْتَمَ وَرَبَّ الْكَعْبَةِ! إِلَيَّ إِلَيَّ! فَأَظَاغُوا بِهِ وَكَتَبُوا — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣١٣

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1004> English: "Then he climbed the throne and said: I have killed Rustam, by the Lord of the Ka'ba! To me! To me! — and they gathered round him and made takbīr."

عبرت: Empires do not usually fall to a plan; they fall on the day their weight finally shifts. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q15 · أبو مِخْجَن comes back to his chains

Tier: GOOD · **When:** during the four days [SOURCED] · **Map:** none — inside the fort. **What happened:** There was a man in irons inside Sa'd's own fort, under punishment. From where he sat he could hear the fighting. He asked the woman of the household to strike off his fetters and lend him the commander's horse, and he swore to her that at the end of the day he would come back and put his own leg back in the shackle. She did it. He fought all day. Sa'd watched from the roof and half-recognised his own horse and could not make sense of it, because the man was supposed to be in chains. At dusk the man came back, put his foot in the iron, and sat down. Sa'd came down, found his horse wet with sweat, asked what had happened, and was told. He forgave him and set him free. **The statement:**

فَأُظْلِقَهُ فَقَالَ: اذْهَبْ فَمَا أَنَا مُؤَاجِذُكَ بِشَيْءٍ تَقُولُهُ حَتَّى تَفْعَلَهُ. قَالَ: لَا جَزْمَ، [وَاللَّهِ] لَا أَجِيبُ لِسَانِي إِلَى [صِفَةٍ] قَبِيحٍ

٣٠٩ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٠٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1000> English: "He released him and said: go — I will not hold you to account for anything you say until you do it. He said: then indeed, by God, I will never again let my tongue answer to describing anything shameful." **عبرت:** A man under punishment is still a man who can keep his word — and a community that notices that gets him back.

Hands-up? no

QMA/E-Q16 · The caliph on foot under the messenger's camel

Tier: CORE · **When:** after القادسية [SOURCED] · **Map:** the road from العراق to المدينة lights. **What happened:** عمر could not wait for the news. He questioned every rider he met, and he took to walking out of Medina up the Iraq road to breathe in whatever word was coming. One day he saw a rider in the distance and went to meet him. The man told him: God has given the Muslims victory at al-Qādisiyya — and went on talking. He had no idea who he was talking to. The caliph walked the rest of the way on foot, beneath the man's mount, listening. Near the town people began greeting 'Umar by his title. The rider understood, and was mortified. **The statement:**

فَقَالَ: يَرْحَمَكَ اللَّهُ يَا أَمِيرَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ هَلَا أَعْلَمْتَنِي أَنَّكَ الْخَلِيفَةُ؟ فَقَالَ لَا حَرَجَ عَلَيْكَ يَا أَخِي — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٤٠

· <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3286> English: "He said: God have mercy on you, Commander of the Faithful — why did you not tell me you were the caliph? He said: no blame on you, my brother." **عبرت:**

Authority that has to be announced to be felt is not yet authority. **Hands-up?** "If you had just conquered Persia, how would you expect the news to be received at home?"

QMA/E-Q17 · «أتخافون من هذه النطفة؟» — crossing the Tigris

Tier: CORE · **When:** صفر ١٦هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** the Tigris; بَهْرَسِير on the west bank, المدائن on the east; the crossing drawn straight across, not at a bridge. **What happened:** The Persians had taken every boat across with them. The Tigris was in flood, black and foaming, and word came that the king was three days from carrying the treasury away. Sa'd preached on the bank and said he had resolved to cross the water, and the army answered as one: may God resolve us and you on right guidance — do it. Sixty men went first, then six hundred. One of them looked at the flood and asked the rest a question, then recited a verse and put his horse in. The Persians on the far bank watched men floating on the surface of the river and shouted that they were madmen. Not one man was lost. One cup went into the water and washed up on the bank they were making for. **The statement:**

فقال: أتخافون من هذه النطفة؟ ثم تلا قوله تعالى: (وَمَا كَانَ لِتُفْسِ أَنْ تَمُوتَ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ كِتَابًا مُؤَجَّلًا) — البداية والنهاية ج ٧ ص ١٧٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3316> English: "He said: are you afraid of this drop of water? Then he recited: 'It is not for any soul to die except by God's leave, at an appointed term.'" عبرت: Fear measures the obstacle; faith measures the One who appointed the term. **Hands-up?** "Would you have gone in?"

QMA/E-Q18 · Eight rak'as in the Īwān of Chosroes

Tier: CORE · **When:** صفر ١٦هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** المدائن taken; the first Jumu'a marker in Iraq. **What happened:** They came out of the water and rode into the capital, and there was nobody in it. The king had taken his family and what he could carry and gone. The White Palace held out three days and then came down; سلمان الفارسي made the summons, as he had at Bahurasir. Sa'd took the great audience-hall of the Persian kings as a place of prayer. Ibn al-Athir adds that he did not even alter the images in it. When he entered he recited four verses of Sūrat ad-Dukhān, walked to the front of the hall, and prayed the prayer of the conquest — eight rak'as. The first Friday prayer ever held in Iraq was prayed there, in Šafar of the year sixteen. **The statement:**

وحين دخله تلا قوله تعالى: (كَمْ تَرَكُوا مِنْ جَنَّاتٍ وَعُيُونٍ وَزُرُوعٍ وَمَقَامٍ كَرِيمٍ وَنَعْمَةً كَانُوا فِيهَا فَانْهَكُوا كَذَلِكَ وَأَوْرَثْنَاهَا) — البداية والنهاية ج ٧ ص ١٧١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3317> English: "When he entered it he recited: 'How many gardens and springs did they leave behind, and cornfields and a noble station, and a comfort in which they took delight! So it was; and We bequeathed it to another people.'" عبرت: The verse was revealed about Pharaoh's people; a man standing in an emperor's hall read it about the emperor — and about himself. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q19 · The carpet, and إِنَّكَ عَفَفْتَ فَقَعَّتِ الرَّعِيَّةُ

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٦هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** the fifth travels from المدائن to المدينة. **What happened:** Among the spoils was a thing the Arabs called the qitf: one carpet, sixty cubits by sixty, that the Persian kings set out in winter when the flowers were gone so that they could sit as if in a garden. Its leaves were silk on rods of gold; its blossom was gold and silver; its fruit was jewels. It could not be divided into fifths, so Sa'd asked the army to give up their share and let it go whole to Medina, and they agreed. When the regalia of Chosroes was laid in front of 'Umar, he said that a people who handed this over were trustworthy indeed — and 'Alī told him why they had. Then 'Umar asked for advice about the carpet, and 'Alī told him that a man owns nothing

of this world but what he has given away, or worn out, or eaten. So 'Umar cut it up and divided it. A piece fell to 'Alī, and he sold it for twenty thousand. **The statement:**

· فقال له علي بن أبي طالب: إنك عَقَفْتَ فَعَقَّتْ رَعِيَّتُكَ، ولو رَتَعْتَ لَرَتَعَتْ — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ١٧٣

<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3319> English: "'Alī ibn Abī Ṭālib said to him: you restrained yourself, so your subjects restrained themselves; and had you grazed at large, they would have grazed at large."

عبرت: The honesty of a whole administration is usually a copy of one man's habits. **Hands-up?** "What would you have done with a carpet like that?"

QMA/E-Q20 · The man who would not give his name

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٦هـ, at المدائن [SOURCED] · **Map:** none — the spoils tent. **What happened:** The treasure of the Persian kings was being carried in and written down, item by item, by an officer appointed for it. A man walked in with a casket and put it down. The officer and the men with him said they had never seen anything like it; nothing already in the store came near it. They asked him whether he had taken anything from it. He said that were it not for God he would not have brought it to them at all. They asked him who he was. He refused to say, so that they would not praise him. They sent a man after him to find out, and he turned out to be 'Āmir ibn 'Abd Qays. Sa'd, looking at the whole of it, said that if it were not for the standing that belongs to the men of Badr he would have said this army was above them. **The statement:**

· فَقَالَ: وَاللَّهِ لَا أُخْبِرُكُمْ فَتَحَمْدُونِي وَلِكَيْبِي أَحْمَدُ اللَّهَ وَأَرْضِي بِتَوَايِهِ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٤٣

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1034> English: "He said: by God, I will not tell you, so that you praise me. I praise God, and I am content with His reward."

عبرت: The deeds that hold a community together are mostly the ones nobody was meant to find out about. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q21 · جَلُولَاء — the charge of one man

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٦هـ صفر [SOURCED] · **Map:** جلولاء north-east of حلوان; المدائن beyond it, where the king had gone. **What happened:** The king fell back to Ḥulwān and left an army dug in behind a ditch at Jalūlā', ringed with iron caltrops. They swore by fire that they would not run until the Arabs were finished. 'Umar ordered Sa'd to stay at al-Madā'in and send his nephew Hāshim ibn 'Utba with about twelve thousand, al-Qa'qā' ibn 'Amr on the vanguard. On the last day they fought from morning until the arrows were gone on both sides and the spears were shattered, prayed the noon prayer by gesture because they could not stop, and then a fresh Persian division came up against a spent Muslim line. Al-Qa'qā' asked his men whether what they had seen had broken them. They said: we are worn out and they are fresh. Then, in the dark, he took a body of horsemen straight through to the gate of the enemy's own ditch and held it, and had a crier tell the army where he was. **The statement:**

فقال: بل إنا حاملون عليهم ومُجَدُّون في طلبهم، حتى يحكم الله بيننا، فاحملوا عليهم حملة رجل واحد حتى نخالطهم

· البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ١٧٦ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3322> English: "He said: rather, we are charging them and pressing hard after them, until God judges between us. Charge them with the charge of one man, until we are in among them."

عبرت: The difference between an exhausted army and a beaten one is usually one man who has not yet agreed to be beaten. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q22 · Why الكوفة and البصرة exist

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٤ هـ (الكوفة) or ١٦ هـ (البصرة — disputed) [SOURCED] · **Map:** two new city markers, الكوفة west of the Euphrates and البصرة to the south — the first two Muslim cities ever founded. **What happened:** After the conquest the army stayed at al-Madā'in, and it began to sicken. A delegation came to 'Umar and he asked them why their colour had changed. They said the country did not agree with them. Sa'd wrote the same: nothing suits the Arabs but land that suits their camels. So 'Umar sent back an order with a condition in it that explains both cities at once — find a place with dry ground and water, and with no sea and no bridge between me and you. Salmān and Ḥudhayfa went out and found a stretch of red sand and gravel with three monasteries on it, prayed there, and sent word. The mosque was laid out first. An archer stood in the middle of it and shot an arrow to each of the four sides, and nothing was built inside where the arrows fell.

The statement:

أَنْ ابْعَثْ سَلْمَانَ وَحَذِيفَةَ رَايِدَيْنِ فَلْيَتَرَاذَا مَنْزِلًا بَرِّيًّا بَحْرِيًّا لَيْسَ بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَكُمُ فِيهِ بَحْرٌ وَلَا جِسْرٌ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٥٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1043> English: "Send Salmān and Ḥudhayfa as scouts, to seek out a place with dry land and water, with no sea and no bridge between me and you." عبرت: A conquest that does not think about how the conquerors will live has not finished thinking. **Hands-up?** "Where would you have put the new city?"

QMA/E-Q23 · «فَلَيْسَ يَقْصُرُكَ وَلَكِنَّهُ قَصْرُ الْخَبَالِ»

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٧ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** the الكوفة inset; the governor's house beside the mosque and the treasury. **What happened:** Sa'd built himself a house next to the mosque, with the treasury behind it. The markets were loud, and he was heard to say "quiet that little noise" — and people had started calling the building Sa'd's palace. Word reached Medina. 'Umar sent Muḥammad ibn Maslama with a single instruction: when you get to Kufa, strike your flint, gather firewood, burn the gate of that palace, and come straight back. He did it. He would not go in when Sa'd sent for him, so Sa'd came out to him; he refused the money he was offered; and he handed over the letter. Sa'd swore he had never said the words people were reporting — and 'Umar believed him. He governed Kufa three and a half more years, and when 'Umar removed him, Ibn Kathīr says plainly it was for no incapacity and no breach of trust. **The statement:**

بَلَّغْنِي أَنَّكَ اتَّخَذْتَ قَصْرًا جَعَلْتَهُ جِصْنًا، وَيُسَمَّى قَصْرَ سَعْدٍ، بَيْنَكَ وَبَيْنَ النَّاسِ بَابٌ، فَلَيْسَ يَقْصُرُكَ وَلَكِنَّهُ قَصْرُ الْخَبَالِ ... وَلَا تَجْعَلْ عَلَى الْقَصْرِ بَابًا يَمْنَعُ النَّاسَ مِنْ دُخُولِهِ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٥٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1045> English: "It has reached me that you have taken a palace and made it a fortress, and that it is called Sa'd's palace, and that between you and the people there is a door. It is not your palace — it is the palace of ruin ... and set no door on the palace that keeps people from entering it." عبرت: A door between a governor and the people is the first thing that has to be burnt, even when the governor is innocent. **Hands-up?** no

QMA/E-Q24 · «أَنَا أَشْرَفُهُمْ» — the load of earth

Tier: GOOD · **When:** before the battle, at المدائن [SOURCED] · **Map:** the delegation's line running back from القادسية to المدائن, carrying something. **What happened:** When the king had finished with the delegation he called for a load of earth, to be put on the neck of their noblest man and driven out of the city as an insult. He asked: who is the noblest of you? They were silent. 'Āṣim ibn 'Amr claimed — falsely — that he was, so that he could be the one to carry it, and they let him. He carried it out on his neck, loaded it on his mount, and rode. Rustam, when the king told him, understood at once what had been done and sent a rider to get the earth back. He was too late. 'Āṣim reached Sa'd first, and Sa'd read it the same way. **The statement:**

فقال له رستم: إنه ليس أحمق، وليس هو بأشرفهم، إنما أراد أن يفتدي قومه بنفسه، ولكن والله ذهبوا بمفاتيح أرضنا
 https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3284 English: "Rustam said to him: he is not a fool, and he is not their noblest. He only wanted to ransom his people with himself. But by God, they have gone off with the keys of our land." **عبرت:** A humiliation only lands where somebody agrees to be humiliated. **Hands-up?** no

«كانوا يُدَوُّون بالقرآن ... كدويّ النحل» · QMA/E-Q25

Tier: GOOD · **When:** after القادسية [SOURCED] · **Map:** none — statement slide, pairs with E-Q16. **What happened:** Sa'd wrote his dispatch to Medina and had it carried by hand. He reported the victory, the length of the fighting, the size of the force that had come against them. Then he listed the dead he could name — and stopped, because he could not name the rest. What he wrote about them instead is the reason the letter survives. 'Umar read it out to the people from the pulpit, and then spoke about himself: he was not a king, that he should own them; he was a servant of God who had been offered a trust. **The statement:**

ورجالٌ من المسلمين لا يعلمهم إلا الله، فاتّه بهم عالمٌ كانوا يُدَوُّون بالقرآن إذا جنّ عليهم الليلُ كدويّ النحل، وهم آساد
 https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3289 English: "... and men of the Muslims whom none knows but God, for He knows them: they used to hum with the Qur'an when night fell over them like the humming of bees, and by day they were lions that lions do not resemble." **عبرت:** The ones who decided it are almost always the ones nobody wrote down. **Hands-up?** no

العهد العُمريّ and بيت المقدس

Source note: *bayt-al-maqdis-and-the-umari-covenant.md* — read it for the pages behind these cards.

BAM/E-Q1 · The condition the city set

Tier: CORE · **When:** 15 or 16 AH [SOURCED] — ١٥٧-١٥٨ and ٣٢٩ for 15, ١٥٩-١٦٠ and ١١٧ for 16, ٨٨ for 17; the full table is §7 · **Map:** دمشق already Muslim; a siege ring is drawn round بيت المقدس; a long arrow is *not* yet drawn from المدينة. **What happened:** finished at دمشق, left سعيد بن زيد in charge there, and rode south. He wrote to the people of إيلياء first — Islam, or the جزية, or notice of war. They refused all three. So he besieged the city and pressed it hard. In the end they agreed to terms. But they attached one condition. They would surrender, and they would pay — to the Commander of the Believers, in person, and to nobody else. أبو عبيدة wrote to المدينة. **The statement:**

ثم حاصرَ بيت المقدس وضيقَ عليهم حتى أجابوا إلى الصلح بشرط أن يقدم إليهم أمير المؤمنين عمر بن الخطاب —
 https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3303 English: "Then he besieged بيت المقدس and pressed them hard until they agreed to terms, on the condition that the Commander of the Believers, عمر بن الخطاب, come to them in person."

عبرت: A city that had refused an army's terms would accept one man's word — which tells you what the word of that office was still worth. **Hands-up?** Ask before telling: "They were losing. They could name one condition. What would you have asked for?"

BAM/E-Q2 · Two Companions, two opinions, one decision

Tier: CORE · **When:** immediately after E-Q1 [SOURCED] · **Map:** المدينة lights up; a line is drawn from المدينة north. **What happened:** عمر ^{رضي} did not decide alone. He put the letter to the people of عثمان بن عفان. عثمان ^{رضي} said: do not go. Let them come to us. It humbles them more. علي بن أبي طالب ^{رضي} said: go. Our men are tied down outside those walls, and going will lift the siege off them sooner. عمر ^{رضي} liked علي ^{رضي}'s answer and did not like عثمان ^{رضي}'s. He left علي ^{رضي} himself in charge of المدينة, put عبد المطلب ^{رضي} at the head of the column, and rode out. **The statement:**

فأشار عثمان بن عفان بأن لا يركب إليهم ليكون أحقر لهم وأرغم لأنوفهم، وأشار علي بن أبي طالب بالمسير إليهم ليكون أخف وطأة على المسلمين في حصارهم بينهم، فهو ما قال علي، ولم يهو ما قال عثمان — البداية والنهاية ج ٧ ص ١٥٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3303> English: "عثمان بن عفان advised that he not ride out to them, so that it would be more belittling to them and harder on their pride. علي بن أبي طالب advised marching to them, so that it would be lighter on the Muslims tied down in the siege of them. He liked what علي said and did not like what عثمان said."

عبرت: Two of the best of them read the same letter and reached opposite conclusions — and nothing at all was wrong with that; it is what consultation is for. **Hands-up?** no. (Delivery note: this is the model of a Companion disagreement being ordinary rather than fraught. Tell it plainly and move on — do not point at it.)

BAM/E-Q3 · The stones at الجابية

Tier: CORE · **When:** on arrival in الشام [SOURCED] · **Map:** the pin moves to الجابية in حوران — a plain, not a city, and not Jerusalem. **What happened:** The commanders rode out to meet the caliph. Two years earlier these had been hungry men. They came in brocade and silk, on horses — يزيد بن أبي سفيان ^{رضي} first, then عبدة ^{رضي}, then خالد بن الوليد ^{رضي}. عمر ^{رضي} got down off his mount, picked up stones off the ground, and threw them at them. Then they explained: the silk is only the outer coat; the armour is underneath, and we need it. He accepted that at once and said nothing more about it. **The statement:**

مَا أَسْرَعَ مَا رَجَعْتُمْ عَنْ رَأْيِكُمْ! إِنِّي تَسْتَفِيلُونَ فِي هَذَا الرَّيِّ وَإِنَّمَا شَبِعْتُمْ مَدَّ سَنَتَيْنِ! وَيَاللَّهِ لَوْ فَعَلْتُمْ هَذَا عَلَى رَأْسِ الْكاملِ فِي التَّارِيخِ ج ٢ ص ٣٣٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1021> English: "How quickly you have turned back from your own view! Me you come out to meet in this dress — and you have only been eating your fill for two years! By Allah, had you done this at the turn of two hundred years I would have replaced you with others."

عبرت: He was not angry at silk; he was angry at how fast comfort had arrived after hunger — and when they gave him the reason he had not known, he dropped it. **Hands-up?** Ask: "Two years earlier these men were hungry. What is the danger he saw?"

BAM/E-Q4 · The ford

Tier: CORE · **When:** on the road in الشام [SOURCED] · **Map:** no change — the pin is on the road, between الجابية and the coast. **What happened:** A water crossing lay in his path. He got down off the camel. He pulled off his shoes and held them in one hand, and walked into the water leading the animal behind him. أبو عبدة ^{رضي} — his own commander in الشام — was watching, and it embarrassed him. You have done a great thing today in front of the people of this country, he said. عمر ^{رضي} struck him on the chest. **The statement:**

إنكم كنتم أذل الناس وأحقر الناس وأقل الناس، فأعزكم الله بالإسلام، فمهما تطلبوا العز بغيره يذلکم الله — البداية والنهاية ج ٧ ص ١٦٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3309> English: "You were the lowest of people, and

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Tier: CORE · **When:** written at الجابية; the document says 15 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** the siege ring round بيت المقدس is replaced by a Muslim marker; a line runs back to الجابية where the document was actually signed. **What happened:** While عمرؓ was still at الجابية, a squadron of Roman horsemen appeared with drawn swords. The Muslims reached for their weapons. عمرؓ stopped them: these men are coming for terms, not for a fight. They were the delegation from بيت المقدس. He granted what they asked, fixed the جزية, and had the document written out. معاوية بن أبي سفيان held the pen. عمرو بن العاص and خالد بن الوليد, عبد الرحمن بن عوف signed as witnesses. The Romans in the city had three days to leave. **The statement:**

وشهد في الكتاب خالد بن الوليد، وعمرو بن العاص، وعبد الرحمن بن عوف، ومعاوية بن أبي سفيان، وهو كاتب معاوية and خالد بن الوليد، عمرو بن العاص، عبد الرحمن بن عوف English: "Witnesses to the document were معاوية and خالد بن الوليد، عمرو بن العاص، عبد الرحمن بن عوف — and it was he who wrote the document. That was in the year fifteen."

عبرت: The four names at the bottom of that page are the reason it is a public act of the state and not a general's private promise — which is exactly what the city had asked for. **Hands-up?** no.

⚠ **Deck note.** ابن جرير does **not** print the text; he sends the reader to تاريخ الطبري ج ٣ ص ٦٠٩. If the deck reproduces the covenant it must be captioned البدايه never. Full text and the delivery caution: §4.2. Read the document; do not comment on it.

BAM/E-Q8 · "Where do you think I should pray?"

Tier: CORE · **When:** on entering the sanctuary [SOURCED] · **Map:** the pin moves inside the walls; mark the Rock, and mark the southern end where the mosque went. **What happened:** Inside, عمرؓ turned to كعب الأبحار — the man who had shown him where the Rock lay in the first place. *Where do you think I should pray?* كعب's answer was reasonable: pray behind the Rock, and the whole of القدس lies in front of you. عمرؓ refused it in one sentence, and then went forward to the qiblah and prayed. The mosque was built at the southern end, in front — not behind the Rock. ابن كثير, who is careful about such things, examined the chain of this report and called it good. **The statement:**

سمعت عمر يقول لكعب: أين ترى أن أصلي؟ قال: إن أخذت عني صليت خلف الصخرة وكانت القدس كلها بين يديك. فقال عمر: ضاهيت اليهودية، لا، ولكن أصلي حيث صلى رسول الله ﷺ — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ١٦١. https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3307 English: "I heard عمر say to كعب: where do you think I should pray? He said: if you take it from me, you would pray behind the Rock, and the whole of القدس would be before you. عمر said: you have imitated Jewry. No — I pray where the Messenger of Allah ﷺ prayed."

عبرت: The city was his that morning and the advice came from an expert — and it still did not outrank the question *where did the Prophet ﷺ pray?* **Hands-up?** Ask: "He has just taken the city. Whose practice does he look to?" (Briefing note, not for the room: ابن كثير grades the isnad جيد; the editor thinks that is too generous, since عيسى بن سنان القسملی is in the chain. Say "ابن كثير called the chain good" — do not go further.)

BAM/E-Q9 · Sweeping the Rock

Tier: CORE · **When:** the same day [SOURCED] · **Map:** the Rock is marked and cleared. **What happened:** The Rock was under a rubbish tip. ابن كثير explains why: the Byzantines had dumped refuse on it because it was the Jews' qiblah, in requital for something older still. هرقل had seen it himself — he was at إيلياء when the

Prophet's ﷺ letter reached him — and he told the Christians they deserved to be killed for degrading a sanctuary that way, and ordered it cleared. But less than a third had been moved when the Muslims arrived. عمر finished the job. He spread out his own cloak, swept the rubbish into it with his hands, and carried it off. The people saw the caliph doing it and swept with him. The rest was carried away by the people of الأردن. **The statement:**

· ثم جاء فيسط رداءه وكنس الكناسة في رداءه وكنس الناس — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٦١
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3307> English: "Then he came and spread out his cloak and swept the rubbish into his cloak, and the people swept."

عبرت: He did not order the place cleaned; he cleaned it, and then there was no one left who could think the work beneath him. **Hands-up?** no. (١٥٧ ص ٧ البدايه has the parallel wording: «ثم نقل التراب عن الصخرة في طرف».)
 «ردائه وقبائه، ونقل المسلمون معه في ذلك»

BAM/E-Q10 · The gate, and the two prayers

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the entry and the following dawn [SOURCED] · **Map:** mark the gate and محراب داود. **What happened:** He entered the sanctuary by the same gate the Prophet ﷺ had entered on the night of الإسراء. It is said he made the talbiyah as he came in. He prayed the greeting of the mosque at the mihrāb of داود. And the next morning he led the dawn prayer there: سورة ص in the first rak'ah, with the prostration in it, and the whole congregation went down with him; and سورة بني إسرائيل — the sūrah that opens with الإسراء — in the second. **The statement:**

ثم دخلها إذ دخل المسجد من الباب الذي دخل منه رسول الله ليلة الإسراء ... وصلى بالمسلمين فيه صلاة الغداة من الغد فقرأ في الأولى بسورة ص وسجد فيها والمسلمون معه، وفي الثانية بسورة بني إسرائيل — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٥٧
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3303> English: "Then he entered it, and he entered the mosque by the gate through which the Messenger of Allah ﷺ entered on the night of الإسراء ... and he led the Muslims in the dawn prayer there the next morning, reciting in the first rak'ah سورة ص and prostrating in it with the Muslims, and in the second سورة بني إسرائيل."

عبرت: He chose the two sūrahs the place itself would have chosen — and that is the whole of what he did to mark the day. **Hands-up?** Ask: "Of all the sūrahs — why that one, in that mosque?" (ابن كثير) hedges the talbiyah with «ويقال». Keep the hedge.)

BAM/E-Q11 · The sermon at الجابية

Tier: GOOD · **When:** at الجابية, before the surrender [SOURCED] · **Map:** no change. **What happened:** Before any of it — before the delegation, before the document — he stood up at الجابية and preached. ابن كثير gives an abridgement and says openly that he has abridged it; the full chains, he says, are in his own مسند عمر. الذي calls the sermon famous and mass-transmitted. **The statement:**

أيها الناس أصلحوا سرائركم تصلح علانيتكم، واعملوا لآخرتكم تكفوا أمر دنياكم، واعلموا أن رجلاً ليس بينه وبين آدم أيها الناس أصلحوا سرائركم تصلح علانيتكم، واعملوا لآخرتكم تكفوا أمر دنياكم، واعلموا أن رجلاً ليس بينه وبين آدم
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3304> English: "O people: set right what is hidden in you and what is open in you will be set right. Work for your hereafter and you will be sufficed in the matter of your world. And know that between a man and آدم there is no living father, and between him and Allah there is no privileged kinship."

عبرت: The first thing he said on that ground was that no one there had a claim on Allah by descent — which is a strange thing to say at a victory, and the reason he said it. **Hands-up?** no. (*Second citation for the deck:* (فخطب بها خطبة مشهورة متواترة عنه» — سير أعلام النبلاء، ج ١٨ ص ١١٨))

BAM/E-Q12 · أبو عبيدة and the caliph, each refusing to be honoured

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the meeting in الشام [SOURCED] · **Map:** no change. **What happened:** When عمر reached أبو عبيدة, خالد بن الوليد, يزيد بن أبي سفيان. أبو عبيدة came out to him with the senior commanders — أبو عبيدة got down off his mount. عمر got down off his. أبو عبيدة moved to kiss the caliph's hand; عمر moved to kiss أبو عبيدة's foot. Each stopped. Later, when عمرو بن العاص and شرحبيل بن حسنة finally arrived from أجنادين, they found him mounted, threw themselves on his knees and kissed them — and he took them both in his arms. **The statement:**

فترجل أبو عبيدة، وترجل عمر، فأشار أبو عبيدة ليقبل يد عمر، فهم عمر بتقبيل رجل أبي عبيدة، فكف عمر — البدايه عمر دismounted, and عمر دismounted. عمر moved to kiss عمر's hand, and عمر made as if to kiss أبو عبيدة's foot — and عمر held back."

عبرت: Neither of them would be the one honoured, and both of them stopped short — which is what respect between equals in a matter of faith actually looks like. **Hands-up?** no.

BAM/E-Q13 · البرذون that swaggered

Tier: GOOD · **When:** بيت المقدس → الجابية [SOURCED] · **Map:** the line from بيت المقدس to الجابية is drawn as he rides it. **What happened:** He set out from الجابية for بيت المقدس and his horse went lame. They brought him a برذون. It began to amble under him with a showy, rolling gait. He got straight down off it and struck its face. He never rode one again, before or after. **The statement:**

فنزل عنه وضرب وجهه، وقال: لا علم الله من علمك، هذا من الخيلاء. ثم لم يركب برذونًا قبله ولا بعده — البدايه He got down off it and struck its face and said: may Allah teach nothing to whoever taught you — this is of vanity. And he never rode a برذون before it or after it."

عبرت: He would not be carried into that city by anything that looked as though it were showing him off. **Hands-up?** no. (ص ٣٣٠-٣٣١) «لَا أَعْلَمُ مَنْ عَلَّمَكَ هَذِهِ الْخَيْلَاءَ» has the same with الكامل ج ٢ ص ٣٣٠-٣٣١)

BAM/E-Q14 · The man at الجابية who knew what was coming

Tier: GOOD · **When:** at الجابية [SOURCED] · **Map:** mark لُد, west of the hills — a small town on the coastal plain. **What happened:** A Jewish scholar met him on the road, or at الجابية — the two accounts differ. *Peace be upon you, Fārūq. Are you the one for إيلياء?* By Allah, you will not go home until Allah opens إيلياء to you. He was at the signing when it happened. And عمر, who asked about الدجال more than he asked about most things, asked him. The man answered with a place and a distance. **The statement:**

فَسَأَلَهُ عُمَرُ عَنِ الدَّجَالِ، وَكَانَ كَثِيرَ السُّؤَالِ عَنْهُ. فَقَالَ لَهُ: وَمَا مَسَّائِلُكَ عَنْهُ يَا أَمِيرَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ؟ أَنْتُمْ وَاللَّهِ تَقْتُلُونَهُ دُونَ بَابِ لُدٍّ يَبِضُّعُ عَشْرَةَ ذِرَاعًا — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٣٠ English: asked him about الدجال — he used to ask about him often. He said to him: and why do you ask

about him, Commander of the Believers? By Allah, you will kill him short of the gate of لُدّ by some ten cubits."

عبرت: He was standing in the country the reports were about, and he still asked, and still wrote down the answer with the name of the man who gave it. **Hands-up?** no. (*Tell it as reported speech and do not build on it. It is a report at a signing, not a doctrine.*)

BAM/E-Q15 · The year nobody can fix

Tier: GOOD · **When:** — [SOURCED] · **Map:** the timeline strip, with a **band** rather than a single mark. **What happened:** Ask when بيت المقدس was taken and the books do not agree. ابن كثير narrates the whole chapter under the year 15 and ends the covenant paragraph "and that was in the year fifteen" — then, one page later, tells you plainly that other leading authorities put it in 16. ابن الاثير puts it in 15 and adds "and it is said: 16, in الذهبي's own annals place it in 16 — but at another page he relays سعد بن الليث, who puts إيلياء in 17. The document itself, as الطبري transmits it, is dated 15. **The statement:**

هذا سياق سيف بن عمر، وقد خالفه غيره من أئمة السير، فذهبوا إلى أن فتح بيت المقدس كان في سنة ست عشرة سيف بن عمر · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3305> English: "This is عمر's account. Others among the leading authorities on the campaigns disagreed with him and held that the opening of بيت المقدس was in the year sixteen."

عبرت: The historian wrote down the disagreement instead of hiding it — which is why we can still see, 700 years later, exactly what he did and did not know. **Hands-up?** Ask: "Two great books, and they give different years. Is that a problem?" (*This is the evening's "how do we know that?" moment, spoken inside the story — not a methodology slot.* [CLAUDE.md §1.7.](#))

BAM/E-Q16 · The stories that are not in the books

Tier: CUT — recorded so it is never re-researched, and so the speaker is never ambushed · **When:** — · **Map:** none. **What happened:** Three of the best-loved details of this event are not in ابن كثير, not in ابن الاثير and not in الذهبي: the Patriarch صفرونيوس handing over the keys; عمر being invited to pray inside the Church and refusing lest Muslims later turn it into a mosque; and عمر and his servant taking turns on one camel all the way from المدينة, so that he entered the city on foot leading it while the servant rode. The first appears in no source we hold. The second traces to ابن خلدون, seven centuries later and without a chain. The third is in none of the three, nor in الطبري. What the books do carry instead — the ford, the patched shirt, the refused horse — is better, and it is sourced. **The statement:** none in the sources we use. **عبرت:** A course that will not tell you a story it cannot show you in a book is a course you can trust with the ones it does tell. **Hands-up?** no. (*If a written question asks for any of the three, the answer is in [QA_BANK.md](#): "it is widely repeated, but it is not in the books this course is built on, so I am not going to tell it to you as history."*)

عمر^{رض} builds a state — and the two trials

Source note: [umar-the-state-diwan-calendar-and-the-two-trials.md](#) — read it for the pages behind these cards.

UTS/E-U1 · The name of the office

Tier: CORE · **When:** 13 AH, at his accession — ١٢٠ ص ٧ البداية dates it «يوم الثلاثاء لثمان بقين من جمادى الآخرة» of that year (<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3266>) [SOURCED] · **Map:** no change — this is a Medina interior. Put the Line up instead: the caliphate is two years old. **What happened:** When أبو بكر ^{رضي} died, the people had to find something to call the new man. They tried the obvious thing. They called him *khalīfat khalīfat rasūl Allāh* — the successor of the successor of the Messenger of God. عمر ^{رضي} heard it and did the arithmetic. The next man would need four terms. The one after him, five. So he stopped it and proposed something shorter. He said: you are the believers; I am your commander. أمير المؤمنين. The title he coined outlived him by a very long way. The first man to greet him with it was المغيرة بن شعبة — and ابن كثير adds that another name is reported, without giving it. **The statement:**

لما ولي عمر قالوا: يا خليفة خليفة رسول الله. فقال عمر: هذا أمرٌ يطول، بل أنتم المؤمنون وأنا أميركم. فسمي أمير المؤمنين. — البداية والنهاية ج ٧ ص ٢٦٨ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3414> English: "When 'Umar took office they said: O successor of the successor of the Messenger of God. 'Umar said: this is a thing that will go on getting longer — rather, you are the believers and I am your commander. So he was named Commander of the Believers." عبرت: A title is not decoration; a man who trims his own title is telling you what he thinks the office is for. Hands-up? "Who here has heard the words أمير المؤمنين? Keep your hand up if you know where they come from."

UTS/E-U2 · The bond that had no year on it

Tier: CORE · **When:** 16 AH per 17 البداية or 18 per الكامل [SOURCED — disputed] · **Map:** no change. This is the moment to show the Line with no numbers on it yet. **What happened:** A piece of paper was brought up to عمر ^{رضي}. It was a bond — one man owed another money, and the debt fell due in شعبان. عمر looked at it and asked one question. Which شعبان? This year's? Last year's? Next year's? Nobody could answer, because there was no answer. The Muslims had months but no years. A second complaint had come from أبو موسى الأشعري ^{رضي} in Basra, saying much the same thing about official letters: they arrive from you with no date on them. So عمر gathered the Companions and put the problem to them. **The statement:**

وذلك أنه رُفِعَ إلى عمر صكٌ مكتوبٌ لرجل على آخر بدينٍ يحلّ عليه في شعبان، فقال: أي شعبان؟ أمن هذه السنة أم التي قبلها، أم التي بعدها؟ ثم جمع الناس فقال: ضعوا للناس شيئاً يعرفون فيه حلول ديونهم. — البداية والنهاية ج ٧ ص ١٨١ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3327> English: "A bond was brought up to 'Umar, written for one man against another for a debt falling due in Sha'bān. He said: which Sha'bān? This year's, or the one before it, or the one after? Then he gathered the people and said: set down for the people something by which they may know when their debts fall due." عبرت: Big institutions start from small unbearable problems, and the man who notices the small problem is doing the work. Hands-up? "What is today's date? Now — what is today's Hijri date?"

UTS/E-U3 · Five ways to count a year, and the one they chose

Tier: CORE · **When:** same council [SOURCED] · **Map:** no change. Use a five-line diagram slide, four struck through. **What happened:** Five proposals went on the table. Count the way the Persians count, restarting at every new king — they disliked it, and الكامل notes the obvious flaw: each king wipes out the era before him. Count from Alexander, the way the Romans do — they disliked that, and it was too long besides. Count from the Prophet's ^ﷺ birth. Count from the day he was sent as Prophet. And then علي ^{رضي}, and others with him, said: count from the هجرة. The reason given is not sentimental. It is that the هجرة is the plainest of the four — it is

public, it is dateable, everyone knows when it happened. **عمر** and the Companions approved it. **The statement:**

وأشار علي بن أبي طالب وآخرون أن يؤرخ من هجرته من مكة إلى المدينة لظهوره لكل أحد فإنه أظهر من المولد <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3328> · والمبعث. فاستحسن ذلك عمر والصحابة — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ١٨٢ *English:* "Alī ibn Abī Ṭālib and others advised that it be dated from his emigration from Mecca to Medina, because it is plain to everyone — plainer than the birth and than the sending. 'Umar and the Companions approved of that." **عبرت**: They chose the date that could be checked, not the date that felt greatest — which is what taking a decision seriously looks like. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U4 · Why the year begins in المحرم

Tier: CORE · **When:** same council [SOURCED] · **Map:** no change. **What happened:** One more question remained. If the count starts from the هجرة, which month does the year begin in? Not ربيع الأول, when he ﷺ actually arrived — Imām Mālik رحمه الله is reported to have held that view, but the majority did not. Not رمضان, which was proposed and dropped. They fixed on المحرم, and the two books give two different reasons. ابن كثير: it is the more exact, so the months do not drift, because المحرم is where the Arab lunar year already began. ابن الاثير: المحرم is the month people come home from Hajj, and it is a sacred month. Both reasons are on the page. This is why your calendar starts where it starts. **The statement:**

فَاتَّفَقُوا عَلَى الْهَجْرَةِ، ثُمَّ قَالُوا: مِنْ أَيِّ الشُّهُورِ؟ فَقَالُوا: مِنْ رَمَضَانَ، ثُمَّ قَالُوا: قَالِمَحَرَّمٍ هُوَ مُنْصَرَفُ النَّاسِ مِنْ حَجِّهِمْ، وَهُوَ شَهْرٌ حَرَامٌ، فَاجْتَمَعُوا عَلَيْهِ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ١ ص ١٣ <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/9> *English:* "They agreed on the hijra. Then they said: from which of the months? They said: from Ramaḍān. Then they said: Muḥarram is when people turn home from their Hajj, and it is a sacred month — so they settled on it." **عبرت**: The calendar on your wall is the residue of one afternoon's careful argument, and nothing you use daily is as accidental as it looks. **Hands-up?** "Hands up if you thought the Islamic year begins on the day of the هجرة itself."

UTS/E-U5 · The register: paid on precedence, not on blood

Tier: CORE · **When:** 15 AH per الكامل [SOURCED — disputed, see note §3.1] · **Map:** no change; put the ladder on screen. **What happened:** Money was now arriving in Medina from Syria and Iraq in quantities no one had ever handled. **عمر** built a register — a ديوان — and fixed a yearly stipend for every Muslim on it. The grading was by السابقة: how early you came to Islam and what you were present at. بدر at the top; then those between بدر and الحديبية; then those who came in at the Conquest and fought the ردة; then القادسية and صفوان بن أمية, الحارث بن هشام, — قريش by birth — found themselves in a lower band than men whose grandfathers no one could name. They refused the money. **عمر** told them why. They took it. **The statement:**

فَقَالَ: إِنِّي إِنَّمَا أَعْطَيْتُكُمْ عَلَى السَّابِقَةِ فِي الْإِسْلَامِ لَا عَلَى الْأَحْسَابِ. قَالُوا: فَتَنَعَمُ إِذَا، وَأَخَذُوا — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٣١ <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1022> *English:* "He said: I have given to you according to precedence in Islam, not according to lineage. They said: then yes — and they took it." **عبرت**: They accepted the answer, and that acceptance is the achievement — a principle is only real when the people it costs agree to it. **Hands-up?** "Suppose the state has to pay everybody something. What do you pay them for?"

UTS/E-U6 · Begin with the Prophet's ﷺ uncle

Tier: GOOD · **When:** at the founding of the ديوان [SOURCED] · **Map:** no change. **What happened:** When the register was ready, علي بن عوف and عبد الرحمن بن عوف told him the sensible thing: begin with yourself. He refused. He said he would begin with the Prophet's ﷺ uncle, and then work outward from the Prophet ﷺ, nearest first. So the first name written into the register of the Muslim state was عمر بن العباس. 's own name is somewhere further down. Within each band, the register made no distinction at all — strong and weak, Arab and non-Arab, the same figure. **The statement:**

قَالَ لَهُ عَلِيُّ وَعَبْدُ الرَّحْمَنِ بْنُ عَوْفٍ: ابْدَأْ بِنَفْسِكَ. قَالَ: لَا بَلْ ابْدَأْ بِعَمِّ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ، ثُمَّ الْأَقْرَبِ قَالِ الْأَقْرَبِ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٣١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1022> English: "'Alī and 'Abd al-Raḥmān ibn 'Awf said to him: begin with yourself. He said: no — rather I begin with the uncle of the Messenger of God ﷺ, then the nearest and the next nearest." عبرت: Where a man puts his own name on a list he himself is writing is a fact about him that no speech can contradict. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U7 · The register argued with in public

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 15 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** no change. **What happened:** People objected to the grading, and the objections were not private. Why not put القادسية on a level with the earlier campaigns? Why is a man who fought far from home paid the same as a man who fought on his own doorstep? He answered both. To the first: I was not going to place them in a rank belonging to what they did not live through. To the second, he turned the question around — the man defending his own doorstep has the better claim, not the worse; and he reminded them that nobody had raised this objection when the Anṣār were levelled with the foremost of the المهاجرون, although the Anṣār too were fighting from their own courtyard. **The statement:**

فَقَالَ: لَمْ أَكُنْ لِأَلْحَقَهُمْ بِدَرَجَةٍ مَنْ لَمْ يُدْرِكُوا ... فَهَلَّا قَالَ الْمُهَاجِرُونَ مِثْلَ قَوْلِكُمْ حِينَ سَوَّيْنَا بَيْنَ السَّائِقِينَ مِنْهُمْ فَقَالَ: لَمْ أَكُنْ لِأَلْحَقَهُمْ بِدَرَجَةٍ مَنْ لَمْ يُدْرِكُوا ... فَهَلَّا قَالَ الْمُهَاجِرُونَ مِثْلَ قَوْلِكُمْ حِينَ سَوَّيْنَا بَيْنَ السَّائِقِينَ مِنْهُمْ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٣٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1023> English: "He said: I was not going to join them to the rank of what they did not live through ... Did the Emigrants say what you are saying, when we levelled their foremost with the Anṣār?" عبرت: A rule you can be argued with about in public is a different kind of rule from one you cannot. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U8 · What he meant to change, and did not live to do

Tier: CORE · **When:** near the end, before 23 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** no change. Pair on screen with the ladder from E-U5. **What happened:** He built the ladder. And at the end of his life he said he had intended to take it away. Four thousand for everyone, he said — and he had even worked out what the four thousand were for: a thousand you leave with your family, a thousand you take with you as provision, a thousand to equip yourself, a thousand to keep for ease. He died before he did it. The graded register he built is the one his successors inherited, and the flat one he intended never existed. **The statement:**

وَقَالَ عُمَرُ قَبْلَ مَوْتِهِ: لَقَدْ هَمَمْتُ أَنْ أَجْعَلَ الْعَطَاءَ أَرْبَعَةَ آلَافٍ أَرْبَعَةَ آلَافٍ، أَلْفًا يَجْعَلُهَا الرَّجُلُ فِي أَهْلِهِ، وَأَلْفًا يُرَوِّدُهَا مَعَهُ، وَأَلْفًا يَتَجَهَّزُ بِهَا، وَأَلْفًا يَتَرَقَّقُ بِهَا. فَمَاتَ قَبْلَ أَنْ يَفْعَلَ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٣٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1023> English: "'Umar said before his death: I had resolved to make the stipend four thousand each — a thousand a man leaves with his household, a thousand he takes as provision, a thousand he equips himself with, and a thousand he keeps for ease. But he died before he did it." عبرت: He treated his own arrangement as a first attempt rather than a finished thing; the men who came after inherited the attempt and not the intention. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U9 · The reserve fund he refused to keep

Tier: GOOD · **When:** at the fixing of the stipends [SOURCED] · **Map:** no change. **What happened:** Someone at the register made an entirely reasonable suggestion. Leave something in the treasury, أمير المؤمنين — a reserve, in case something comes. عمر's answer was not gentle. He called the suggestion something Satan had put on the man's tongue, and said it would be a fitna for those who came after him. What he would leave to his successors, he said, was what God and His Messenger had prepared — obedience, the thing that had actually got them this far. **The statement:**

فَقَالَ: كَلِمَةً أَلْقَاهَا الشَّيْطَانُ عَلَى فَيْكِ وَقَانِي اللَّهَ شَرَّهَا، وَهِيَ فُتْنَةٌ لِمَنْ بَعْدِي ... فَإِذَا كَانَ الْمَالُ تَمَنُّ دِينٍ أَخَذَكُمْ
 ٣٣٣ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٣٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1024> English: "He said: a word Satan cast on your tongue, and God has kept me from its harm; it is a fitna for those after me ... And when money is the price of one of you's religion, you are ruined." **عبرت:** He was more afraid of what a full treasury would do to the men who inherited it than of what an empty one would do to him.

Hands-up? no

UTS/E-U10 · Four conditions, in writing, with witnesses

Tier: CORE · **When:** standing practice throughout the caliphate [SOURCED] · **Map:** put the governor list from ١٨١ on screen — Mecca, Syria, Iraq, Yemen, Baḥrayn, 'Umān, Baṣra, Mosul, the Jazīra. **What happened:** By 16 AH عمر had governors in a dozen provinces, some of them a month's ride away. He could not watch them. So he wrote down what they were not allowed to do, had a group of المهاجرون witness it against them, and attached a penalty. Four conditions. Do not ride a Persian horse. Do not eat fine bread. Do not wear fine cloth. And do not shut your door against people with needs. Two of the three great books of the safe list record the same four conditions, independently. **The statement:**

وكان عمر إذا استعمل عاملاً كتب له عهداً وأشهد عليه رهطاً من المهاجرين واشتراط عليه أن لا يركب برذوئاً، ولا يأكل نقيّاً، ولا يلبس رقيقاً، ولا يغلق باباً دون ذوي الحاجات. فإن فعل شيئاً من ذلك حَلَّتْ عليه العقوبة. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٤٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3410> English: "When 'Umar appointed a governor he wrote him a covenant and had a company of the Emigrants witness it against him, stipulating that he not ride a Persian horse, not eat fine bread, not wear fine cloth, and not shut his door against people with needs. If he did any of these, punishment fell due on him." **عبرت:** Three of the four conditions are about appetite and the fourth is about access — and it is the fourth that tells you what he thought a governor was. **Hands-up?** "Three of those four are about what a governor may eat, wear and ride. What do you suppose the fourth one is?"

UTS/E-U11 · The door of the palace at Kufa

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 17 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** Kufa appears on the map. The Muslims leave المدائن and found a new city. **What happened:** The Companions could not live at المدائن. The flies and the dust made them ill, their colour changed, their bodies weakened. عمر wrote back a single sentence of policy: the Arabs will not do well except where their camels do well. So a site was found, and Kufa was laid out from scratch — the mosque first, then an archer shooting in four directions to mark how far the houses would go; roads of forty cubits, thirty, twenty; alleys of seven. Reed houses, which burned; then mud brick, on عمر's order, on condition of no extravagance. Then سعد built himself a palace near the market, and the noise of the crowd made it hard to hear, so he took to shutting his door. The phrase reached Medina. عمر sent محمد بن مسلمة

فلما بلغت هذه الكلمة عمر بن الخطاب بعث محمد بن مسلمة، فأمره إذا انتهى إلى الكوفة أن يقدح زناده ويجمع حطبًا ويحرق باب القصر ثم يرجع من فوره ... وأمر سعدًا أن لا يغلق بابه عن الناس — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٨٣-
 ١٨٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3329> · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3330> English: "When that word reached 'Umar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb he sent Muḥammad ibn Maslama, and ordered him that when he reached Kūfa he should strike his flint, gather firewood, burn the palace door, and return at once ... and he ordered Sa'd not to shut his door against the people." عبرت: The fourth condition was not decorative — he burned a door to prove it. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U12 · خالد^{رض} made to stand, and removed

كتب عمر إلى الأمصار: إني لم أعزل خالدًا عن سخطه ولا خيانة، ولكن الناس فتنوا به فأحببت أن يعلموا أن الله هو
 ١٩١ English: "Umar wrote to the
 garrison cities: I did not remove Khālid out of anger nor for any dishonesty; but the people were
 beguiled by him, and I wanted them to know that it is God who does." عبرت He did not accuse the
 man of anything; he removed him and then told everyone that no accusation had been made — which
 is harder than either accusing or keeping silent. **Hands-up?** no **⚠ Note for the speaker:** الذي reports
 a different cause for this (سير جراشدون ص٩٨). Tell البديه's version and do not assert a motive. See §4.4.

UTS/E-U13 · The spoils of **حلولاء**, and a man weeping over them

Tier: CORE · **When:** 16 AH — الليث بن جلودان carries جلودان inside its block (ج: ٢ ص ٣٣٧-٣٥١) but بن جلودان, in ٨٨ ص, puts جلودان in **19 AH** (§6.1). [SOURCED — and disputed] · **Map:** جلودان and جلودان, east of المدائن — the Persian frontier. **What happened:** The fifth of the spoils of جلودان came to Medina. عمرؓ swore no roof would cover it until it was divided, so عبد الرحمن بن عوفؓ and عبد الله بن الأرقمؓ spent the night guarding it in the mosque. In the morning he came out among the people and uncovered it — ruby, chrysolite, jewels — and he wept. عبد الرحمنؓ asked him why; by God, he said, this is a place for thanks, not tears. And عمرؓ told him what he was actually looking at. **The statement:**

فَقَالَ عَمْرٌ: وَاللَّهِ مَا ذَلِكْ يُبْكِينِي، وَاللَّهِ مَا آعْطَى اللَّهَ هَذَا قَوْمًا إِلَّا تَخَاسَدُوا وَتَبَاغَضُوا، وَلَا تَخَاسَدُوا إِلَّا أَلْقَى اللَّهُ
 . <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1038> · بِأَسْهَمَ بَيْنَهُمْ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٤٧-٣٤٨
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1039> English: "‘Umar said: by God, that is not what makes me weep. By
 God, God has never given this to a people but they envied one another and hated one another; and

they never envied one another but God cast their violence among themselves." **عبرت:** He was looking at the treasure and seeing what it usually does to the people who win it. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U14 · The land that was not divided

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 16 AH, after جلولاء — same dispute as E-U13 [SOURCED — and disputed] · **Map:** the السواد — the whole irrigated belt of southern Iraq, between حلوان and القادسية. Shade it and leave it shaded. **What happened:** The richest farmland any Muslim army had ever taken was now in Muslim hands. By one reading of the rules it belonged to the fighters, to be divided like any other spoil. عمر ^{رضي} refused to divide it. ابن الاثير gives practical reasons — thickets, woodland, water-sinks, land that had belonged to the fire-temples and the post roads and to Chosroes himself, none of it parcellable — and then one reason that is not practical at all: he feared fitna among the Muslims. Having refused to divide it, he then forbade its sale, on the ground that it had never been divided in the first place. جرير ^{رضي} bought a field on the Euphrates bank; عمر ^{رضي} cancelled the purchase. **The statement:**

وَمَتَّعَ عُمَرُ مِنْ قِسْمَةِ السَّوَادِ ... وَخَافَ أَيْضًا الْفِتْنَةَ بَيْنَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ، وَمَتَّعَ مِنْ يَبِيعِهِ لِأَنَّهُ لَمْ يُقَسَّمْ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٤٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1039> English: "'Umar forbade the division of al-Sawād ... And he also feared fitna among the Muslims. And he forbade its sale, because it had not been divided." **عبرت:** The generation that took the land did not take the land, and what they gave up was given up for a generation they would never meet. **Hands-up?** no **Note for the speaker:** the verse he is usually said to have argued from is **not** in any of our sources. Do not put a verse in his mouth here. See §X.1.

UTS/E-U15 · Judges for the new cities

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 18 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** البصرة and الكوفة, both of them cities that did not exist ten years earlier. **What happened:** A state that has just invented a calendar, a payroll and two cities eventually needs somebody to settle disputes in them. In 18 AH عمر ^{رضي} appointed شريح بن الحارث الكندي judge over Kufa and كعب بن سور الأزدي judge over Basra. The detail worth noticing is not the appointment; it is what the chronicles do afterwards. From that year on, the year-by-year record lists the judges alongside the governors, as a standing office — this year's judges were last year's judges. That is what an institution looks like from the outside. **The statement:**

· وفيها استقضى عمر شريحًا على الكوفة، وكعب بن سور على البصرة. — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٢٠٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3353> English: "In it 'Umar appointed Shurayḥ as judge over Kūfa, and Ka'b ibn Sūr over Baṣra." **عبرت:** Conquest is an event and a judiciary is a habit, and only one of the two is still working the following year. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U16 · عام الرمادة: the oath

Tier: CORE · **When:** 18 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** the whole Ḥijāz. Show the tribes converging on Medina from every direction. **What happened:** The rain failed across the Ḥijāz and the ground went black — so black that they named the year after ashes. The wild animals came in among the people. The tribes broke camp and came to Medina because there was nowhere else, and nobody had any food left. عمر ^{رضي} opened the treasury and spent it until there was nothing in it. And he bound himself: no ghee, no fat — ابن الاثير says no ghee, no milk, no meat — until the people were relieved. In good years his bread was crumbled with milk and ghee. That year it was oil and vinegar. His colour blackened and his body changed until they were afraid for him. It

lasted nine months. When his servant bought him a skin of ghee and a skin of milk, thinking to release him, he told him to give both away. **The statement:**

· وَقَالَ: كَيْفَ يَغْنِيَنِي شَأْنُ الرِّعْيَةِ إِذَا لَمْ يُصِيبْنِي مَا أَصَابَهُمْ! — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٧٥

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1066> English: "And he said: how shall the condition of the subjects concern me, if what befell them does not befall me?" **عبرت:** He did not go hungry in order to feed anyone — he went hungry so that the hunger of others would not be something he could think about at a distance. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U17 · The night he found nobody laughing

Tier: CORE · **When:** 18 AH [SOURCED — ابن كثير calls the chain جيد] · **Map:** the relief routes: Basra overland, Egypt by the Qulzum sea to Jeddah and up to Mecca. **What happened:** He went out at night to walk the city, as he did. And something was wrong that he could not name at first. Nobody was laughing. Nobody was talking in their houses the way people talk. And there were no beggars. He asked why, and was told: the beggars asked and were given nothing, so they stopped asking; and the people are in grief and hardship, so they neither talk nor laugh. So he wrote two letters. One to ^{رضي}أبو موسى in Basra, one to عمرو بن العاص ^{رضي} in Egypt. Each was three words long. Each of them sent back a great caravan. The first man through the gate was ^{رضي}أبو عبيدة, with four thousand mounts of food — the last thing he does in this story before the next one kills him. On عمر ^{رضي}'s own instruction, the food went out to the country round Medina first. **The statement:**

فكتب عمر إلى أبي موسى بالبصرة أن: يا غوثاه لأمة محمد. وكتب إلى عمرو بن العاص بمصر أن: يا غوثاه لأمة محمد. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٠٣ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3349> English: "So 'Umar wrote to Abū Mūsā in Baṣra: a cry for help for the community of Muḥammad! And he wrote to 'Amr ibn al-ʿĀṣ in Egypt: a cry for help for the community of Muḥammad!" **عبرت:** He noticed the silence before anyone reported the hunger, and a man who is out walking at night notices things that no report contains.

Hands-up? "Seven thousand men ate supper at his table one night. How many people do you think were being fed in total?" (الذبي: *forty thousand, then sixty thousand.*)

UTS/E-U18 · The prayer for rain

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 18 AH [SOURCED — البخاري] · **Map:** the muṣallā outside Medina. **What happened:** He went out to pray for rain, and he took ^{رضي}العباس out with him. And the prayer he made is one of the most quoted sentences in the whole of his caliphate, because of what it concedes: we used to ask through our Prophet ﷺ, and now we ask through his uncle. The report is in صحيح البخاري. On another such occasion people complained that they had not actually heard him ask for rain at all; he answered that he had sought the rain by the heaven's own rain-bringers, and recited سورة نوح — *ask forgiveness of your Lord; He will send the sky upon you in torrents.* **The statement:**

اللهم إنا كنا نتوسل إليك بنبينا ﷺ فتسقينا، وإنا نتوسل إليك بعم نبينا فاسقنا. قال: فَيُسْقَوْنَ. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٠٥ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3351> · (البخاري ٣٧١٠) English: "O God, we used to approach You through our Prophet ﷺ and You would give us rain; and we approach You through the uncle of our Prophet — so give us rain. And they were given rain." **عبرت:** Nine months of drought, a treasury spent to nothing, and the last thing left to try was استغفار. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U19 · سرغ: the caliph turns the army around

Tier: CORE · **When:** 17 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** سرغ, on the road from Medina into Syria — mark it. This is the furthest north he gets, and then the arrow reverses. **What happened:** He was riding north into Syria with the leading men of the Muhājirūn and Anṣār. At سرغ the commanders of the Syrian armies rode out to meet him — أبو عبيدة^{رضي}, يزيد بن أبي سفيان^{رضي}, خالد بن الوليد^{رضي} — with news. The pestilence had fallen on Syria. He consulted, and the room split: you set out for a purpose, do not turn back — against — we do not think you should take the leading Companions into this. In the morning he ordered the return. And أبو عبيدة^{رضي} said the one thing that could stop him: are you running from God's decree? The answer came back without a pause. **The statement:**

فقال أبو عبيدة: أفرارًا من قدر الله؟ قال: نعم! نفرُّ من قدر الله إلى قدر الله، أرايت لو هبطت واديًا ذا عدوتين إحداهما مخصبة والأخرى مجدبة، فإن رعيت الخصبة رعيته بقدر الله، وإن أنت رعيت الجدبة رعيته بقدر الله؟ ثم قال: لو غيرك
 https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3332 English: "Abū 'Ubayda said: fleeing from God's decree? He said: yes — we flee from God's decree to God's decree. Do you not see, if you came down into a valley with two slopes, one fertile and one barren, and you grazed the fertile you would graze it by God's decree, and if you grazed the barren you would graze it by God's decree? Then he said: if it were anyone but you saying it, Abū 'Ubayda." **عبرت:** Trust in God's decree is not a reason to walk into the barren half of the valley. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U20 · The man who had been away

Tier: CORE · **When:** 17 AH, at سرغ, the same hour [SOURCED — البخاري ٥٧٢٩] · **Map:** same as E-U19. **What happened:** The argument was not settled by rank. عبد الرحمن بن عوف^{رضي} had been away on business and arrived late, into the middle of it. He said: I have knowledge of this. And he gave them a ḥadīth of the Prophet ﷺ that answered the exact question in front of them — do not enter a land where it is, and do not leave a land where you are. عمر^{رضي} praised God, and took the people home. ابن الاثير notes, in his own voice, that this is the sounder of the two versions, because البخاري and مسلم both carry it. **The statement:**

سمعت رسول الله ﷺ يقول: "إذا سمعتم به بأرض قوم فلا تقدموا عليه، وإذا وقع بأرض وأنتم فيها فلا تخرجوا فرارًا
 https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3332 · منه". فحمد الله عمر ... ورجع بالناس. — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٨٦ (البخاري ٥٧٢٩) English: "I heard the Messenger of God ﷺ say: 'When you hear of it in a land, do not go to it; and when it falls in a land and you are in it, do not go out fleeing from it.' So 'Umar praised God — and returned with the people." **عبرت:** The decision was already right; what the latecomer brought was the knowledge that it was right, and the caliph thanked God rather than himself. **Hands-up?** "The Commander of the Believers has already given the order. A man walks in late with something to say. What should happen?"

UTS/E-U21 · The letter أبو عبيدة^{رضي} saw through

Tier: CORE · **When:** 18 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** حمص / the Syrian camp. **What happened:** The plague was burning through the army in Syria, and عمر^{رضي} wanted أبو عبيدة^{رضي} out of it. He could not order it — أبو عبيدة^{رضي} would not leave his men. So he wrote something clever: a need has arisen that I must speak to you about face to face; when you read this letter, do not put it down until you come to me. أبو عبيدة^{رضي} read it, understood exactly what it was, and said: may God forgive the Commander of the Believers. Then he wrote back, and refused. And when عمر^{رضي} read the reply, he wept — and the people around him thought the news had come.

The statement:

أَلَيْسَ قَدْ عَرَفْتَ حَاجَتَكَ إِلَيَّ، وَإِنِّي فِي جَنْدٍ مِنَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ لَا أَجِدُ بِنَفْسِي رَغْبَةً عَنْهُمْ، فَلَسْتُ أُرِيدُ فِرَاقَهُمْ حَتَّى يَقْضِيَ اللَّهُ بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَهُمْ أَمْرَهُ وَقَضَاءَهُ، فَخَلِّنِي مِنْ عَزْمَتِكَ يَا أَمِيرَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ، وَدَعْنِي فِي جَنْدِي. — البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ١٨٨
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3334> *English:* "I have understood your need of me. I am among an army of the Muslims, and I find in myself no desire to be away from them; I do not wish to part from them until God decrees His command and His decree upon me and upon them. So release me from your charge, Commander of the Believers, and leave me with my army." أمين الأمة: **عبرت:** would not be lifted out of a danger he was leaving his men inside. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U22 · Three sermons, three graves, one day

Tier: CORE · **When:** 18 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** عمواس, between Jerusalem and al-Ramla — the town the plague is named after. Then the whole of Syria. **What happened:** أبو عبيدة stood up in front of the dying army and preached. He called the affliction their Lord's mercy, their Prophet's ﷺ prayer, and the death of the righteous before them — and asked God to give أبو عبيدة his share of it. He was struck, and he died. He appointed معاذ بن جبل over the people. معاذ stood in the same place and preached the same words, and asked God to give the family of معاذ their share. His son عبد الرحمن was struck and died. Then معاذ prayed for himself, and was struck in the palm of his hand, and would look at it and turn it over and say that he would not take anything of this world in exchange for what was in it. معاذ and أبو الأشعري were struck on one and the same day; شرحبيل بن حسنة البدياه with them on that day too. The same plague killed عمرو بن هشام, سهيل بن عمرو, يزيد بن أبي سفيان, الحارث بن هشام, and his son جندل, and أبو الفضل بن العباس — but the sources say only that they died in it, not that they died on that day, and the speaker should not say so. الحارث بن هشام had gone out to Syria with seventy of his household. Four came back. **The statement:**

أُبَيُّهَا النَّاسُ، إِنَّ هَذَا الْوَجَعَ رَحْمَةُ رَبِّكُمْ وَدَعْوَةُ نَبِيِّكُمْ وَمَوْتُ الصَّالِحِينَ قَبْلَكُمْ، وَإِنَّ أَبَا عُبَيْدَةَ يَسْأَلُ اللَّهَ أَنْ يَقْسِمَ لَأُبَيِّ
 https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3334 English: "O people, this affliction is your Lord's mercy, and your Prophet's prayer, and the death of the righteous before you;
 and Abū 'Ubayda asks God to apportion to Abū 'Ubayda his share." **عبرت:** The generation that had
 seen the Prophet ﷺ was thinning out, and it was thinning out in one place at one time. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U23 · What a caliph does after a plague

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 18 AH, after عمواس [SOURCED] · **Map:** عمر^{رض}'s journey to الشام — Medina → الجابية → أيلة. **What happened:** So many people died in the same houses, in unknown order, that the inheritances of Syria could not be settled. Nobody could say who had predeceased whom. عمر^{رض} was minded to tour the provinces and asked which to start with; كعب الأبحار and علي^{رض} both argued for Iraq or against it, and he cut the discussion short: the inheritances of the 'Amwās dead are lost — I begin with Syria. He went, divided the estates himself, reassigned the commands — معاوية^{رض} to Damascus, and later شرحبيل^{رض} moved with a public explanation that it was not out of anger — and came home in ذو القعدة. On the way, at أيلة, he gave the bishop his own torn shirt to wash and mend, wore it back, and refused the new one the man made him. And in Syria the people asked for بلال^{رض} to give the adhān once more; every man there who had known the Prophet ﷺ wept, and عمر^{رض} wept hardest of all. **The statement:**

فَقَالَ عُمَرُ: إِنَّ مَوَارِيثَ أَهْلِ عَمَوَاسَ قَدْ ضَاعَتْ، أَبْدَأُ بِالشَّامِ فَأَقْسِمُ الْمَوَارِيثَ وَأَقِيمَ لَهُمْ مَا فِي نَفْسِي، ثُمَّ أَرْجِعُ —
 https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1070 English: "Umar said: the inheritances
 of the people of 'Amwās have been lost. I shall begin with Syria and divide the inheritances and set up

for them what is in my mind; then I shall return." **عبرت:** The catastrophe was over and the paperwork was not, and he treated the paperwork as part of the catastrophe. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U24 · Jerusalem asks for him by name

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 15 or 16 or 17 AH [SOURCED — disputed] · **Map:** بيت المقدس. The single biggest move on the Syrian map. **What happened:** أبو عبيدة besieged Jerusalem, and the city agreed to terms — on one condition. The Commander of the Believers must come himself. The letter reached Medina and the counsel split: عثمان said do not go, it will humble them more; علي said go, it will be easier on the Muslims sitting in the siege lines. He took علي's advice, left علي over Medina, and rode. On the road from الجابية his own horse was worn out, so they brought him a برزون — a heavy non-Arab mount; it began to amble under him and he got off at once and struck its face. He never rode one before that or after it. At الجابية he preached, and the sermon survives. **The statement:**

أيها الناس، أصلحوا سرائركم تصلح علانيتكم، واعملوا لآخرتكم تكفوا أمر دنياكم ... فمن أراد إخوة الجنة فليزم البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٥٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3304> English: "O people, put right what is within you and what is outward in you will be put right; work for your hereafter and the affair of your world will be taken care of for you ... Whoever wants the midst of the Garden, let him hold to the community." **عبرت:** The city set the terms of its own surrender, and the term it chose was to see the man in person. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U25 · "You restrained yourself, so they restrained themselves"

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 16 AH, when the spoils of المدائن arrive — الكامل carries المدائن inside its سنة ست block (ج ٢ ص ٣٣٨), and البدايه ج ٧ ص ١٦٣ records the split in so many words: ابن جرير/سيف put the Persian campaigns in 15, «وقال ابن إسحاق والواقدي: إنما كان ذلك في سنة ست عشرة» (https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3309). [SOURCED — and disputed] · **Map:** المدائن — Chosroes' capital. **What happened:** The spoils of المدائن were beyond anything anyone had seen — jewelled carpets, the Persian king's own robes, houses filled to the ceiling with gold and silver vessels, and so much camphor the soldiers mistook it for salt and tried to bake with it. Every horseman's share came to twelve thousand. And the whole of it, down to a mule loaded with the king's crown that a soldier had chased down and taken back off looters, was handed in intact. عمر looked at it and said one sentence about the men who had sent it. علي answered him with one sentence about why they had. **The statement:**

فروينا أن عمر لما نظر إلى ذلك قال: إن قومًا أدّوا هذا لأمناء، فقال له علي بن أبي طالب: إنك عَقَفْتَ فَعَقَّتْ رَعِيَّتُكَ، ولو رَتَعْتَ لَرَتَعَتْ. — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٧٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3319> English: "Umar said: a people who handed this over are trustworthy men. 'Alī ibn Abī Ṭālib said to him: you restrained yourself, so your subjects restrained themselves; and had you grazed freely, they would have grazed freely." **عبرت:** Honesty at the far end of an empire is a report on the man at the near end of it. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U26 · What is lawful for me out of this money?

Tier: GOOD · **When:** at the founding of the ديوان [SOURCED] · **Map:** no change. **What happened:** He put a question to the Muslims that no one had asked him to answer. I was a merchant, he said, and God provided for my household out of my trade; and you have occupied me with this business of yours. So what do you

hold is lawful for me out of this money? The people talked a great deal. عليؑ said nothing until asked directly, and then gave the shortest answer in the room: what keeps you and your household in what is fitting, and nothing beyond that. The people said: the word is عليؑ's word. He took that, and it was hard. Later عثمان, عليؑ, حفصةؑ and الزبيرؑ agreed among themselves that his allowance ought to be raised, and sent حفصةؑ to sound him out without naming them. He worked out at once that there were names and demanded them; she would not give them. So he asked her three questions instead — what was the best garment the Prophet ﷺ ever owned in your house, the finest food he ever had here, the softest thing he ever lay on — and sent the answers back as his reply. **The statement:**

فَقَالَ: مَا أَصْلَحَكَ وَعَيْالَكَ يَا مَعْزُوفَ لَيْسَ لَكَ غَيْرُهُ. فَقَالَ الْقَوْمُ: الْقَوْلُ مَا قَالَ عَلِيٌّ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٣٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1024> English: "He said: what keeps you and your household in what is fitting — you have nothing beyond that. The people said: the word is 'Ali's word.'" **عبرت:** He did not set his own salary; he asked, and then he lived with the answer. **Hands-up?** no

UTS/E-U27 · The list of firsts

Tier: GOOD · **When:** closing card for the whole strand [SOURCED] · **Map:** the finished map of 23 AH, everything lit. **What happened:** When ابن كثير رحمه الله comes to write the death of عمرؓ, he does not begin with the death. He begins with a list, and the list runs for half a page without pausing. First to be called Commander of the Believers. First to write the dating era. Gathered the people for tarāwīḥ. First to patrol Medina at night. Carried the whip and disciplined with it. Founded the garrison cities and raised the armies. Laid down the land tax. Compiled the registers. Fixed the stipends. Appointed the judges. Organised the provinces. Ten years and five months. **The statement:**

وهو أول من دُعي أمير المؤمنين، وأول من كتب التاريخ ... ومصر الأمصار، وجند الأجناد. ووضع الخراج، ودون الدواوين، وفرض الأعطية، واستقضى القضاة، وكور الكور — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٤٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3409> English: "He was the first to be called Commander of the Believers, and the first to write the dating era ... he founded the garrison cities, and raised the armies. He laid down the land tax, compiled the registers, fixed the stipends, appointed the judges, and organised the provinces." **عبرت:** Almost nothing on that list is a battle, and the things on it are the things that were still standing a hundred years later. **Hands-up?** "How many of the things on this list do you still use?"

شورى, the assassination, and the نهاوند

Source note: [nahawand-the-shura-and-the-death-of-umar.md](#) — read it for the pages behind these cards.

NTS/E-U1 · Persia decides it has no choice

Tier: CORE · **When:** 21 AH [SOURCED] (البدايه ج ٧ ص ٢٢٥) the sources also record 17 and 19) · **Map:** The Persian heartland east of the Zagros lights up: a single mass of colour gathering at نهاوند, south of همذان.

What happened: Ten years of defeats have pushed the last Sasanian king out of his own capital and eastward, city by city. He writes to every governor still standing. They meet and they argue, and the argument that decides them is not about religion. It is that the fighting has reached the seat of the kingdom itself, and will not stop there. A hundred and fifty thousand men gather at نهاوند under a commander the sources name three different ways. Word reaches سعد بن أبي وقاصؓ at الكوفه, and سعدؓ writes to المدينه.

The statement:

وقالوا: إِنَّ مُحَمَّدًا الَّذِي جَاءَ الْعَرَبَ بِالْدينِ لَمْ يَتَعَرَّضْ لِبِلادِنَا، وَلَا أَبُو بَكْرٍ الَّذِي قَامَ بَعْدَهُ تَعَرَّضَ لَنَا فِي دَارِ مُلْكِنَا، وَإِنْ عُمَرُ بْنُ الْخَطَّابِ هَذَا لَمَّا طَالَ مَلِكُهُ انْتَهَكَ حَرَمَتَنَا وَأَخَذَ بِلَادَنَا، وَلَمْ يَكْفِهِ ذَلِكَ حَتَّى أَغْرَانَا فِي عُقْرِ دَارِنَا، وَأَخَذَ بَيْتَ الْمَمْلَكَةِ وَلَيْسَ بِمُنْتَهَى حَتَّى يَخْرِجَكُمْ مِنْ بِلَادِكُمْ. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٢٧

<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3373> English: "And they said: this Muḥammad who brought the Arabs their religion did not come against our lands; nor did Abū Bakr, who rose after him, come against us in the seat of our kingdom. But this 'Umar b. al-Khaṭṭāb — when his reign grew long he violated our sanctuary and took our lands, and that did not suffice him until he made war on us in the heart of our own country and took the house of the kingdom; and he will not stop until he drives you out of your lands."

عبرت: A state that will not answer a summons is eventually made to answer a question it did not choose.

Hands-up? Hands up — who can tell me roughly how far Islam had reached when the Prophet ﷺ died? (Answer on the map: two mosques and a peninsula.) Now look where we are ten years later.

NTS/E-U2 · The caliph proposes to march, and is talked out of it

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 21 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** A pin on المدينة, with a dotted line running north-east toward a point between الكوفة and البصرة — then the dotted line is rubbed out.

What happened: عمر ^{رضي} calls the people to the mosque. His plan is to march himself and take up a position between the two garrison cities, so he can feed men forward as they are needed. Five men answer him — عبد الرحمن بن عوف ^{رضي} and عثمان ^{رضي} علي ^{رضي} طلحة ^{رضي} الزبير ^{رضي} — each speaking separately. Every one of them tells him to stay where he is. علي ^{رضي} gives him the image that decides it. عمر ^{رضي} takes the advice he did not come in with, and — as he always did — puts it to العباس ^{رضي} before he acts on it.

The statement:

ومكانك منهم يا أمير المؤمنين مكان النظام من الخرز يجمعه ويمسكه، فإذا انحلت تفرّق وما فيه وذهب، ثم لم يجتمع. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٢٨ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3374> English: "Your position among them, Commander of the Believers, is the position of the thread among the beads: it gathers them and holds them; and if it comes undone they scatter, and what is in it is gone, and it is never gathered whole again."

عبرت: A man is not always most useful at the place where the danger is.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U3 · The first at the spear-points

Tier: CORE · **When:** 21 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** A named commander pin appears on the Persian front: النعمان بن مقرّن ^{رضي}.

What happened: عمر ^{رضي} asks the council to name him a commander for the Persian front, and says the man must be an Iraqi. They tell him he knows his own soldiers better. So he states the qualification before he states the name — and then names النعمان بن مقرّن ^{رضي}, who had already written asking to be moved from his post so

The statement:

عبرت: The test of a commander was set before the name was, and the name had to meet the test.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U4 · One man is worth a hundred thousand dinars

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 21 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map move. The letter itself on screen, in Naskh, with the English beneath.

What happened: The written orders go out from المدينة. Most of the letter is the ordinary business of moving an army — march by this route, join at ماہ, the Kufans will meet you there. But in the middle of it عمرؓ puts three prohibitions and a reason, and the reason is a valuation. A room that has just heard the figure 150,000 hears this sentence differently.

The statement:

ولا توطئهم وعزًّا فتؤذيهم، ولا تمنعهم حقهم فتكفرهم، ولا تدخلهم غيضةً، فإن رجلاً من المسلمين أحبُّ إليَّ من مئة توطئهم وعزًّا فتؤذيهم؛ ولا تمنعهم حقهم فتكفرهم، ولا تدخلهم غيضةً — ألف دينار — البدياه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٢٢٩

English: "Do not make them tread rough ground and so hurt them; do not withhold from them their right and so make them ungrateful; do not take them into a thicket — for one man of the Muslims is dearer to me than a hundred thousand dinars."

عبرت: The orders that survive are the ones that say what a life is worth.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U5 · The head and the two wings

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 21 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** Three labels on the Persian plateau — أصبهان at the centre, فارس and أذربيجان to either side — with an arrow through the centre.

What happened: The Persian commander of تُستَر، الهرمزان، had been captured and brought to المدينة. When عمرؓ has to decide where to strike first — أذربيجان، or فارس، or أصبهان — he puts the question to him. The answer is one sentence of pure strategy, from a man who had commanded on the other side, and عمرؓ acts on it.

The statement:

أصبهان الرأس، وفارس وأذربيجان الجناحان، إن قطعت أحد الجناحين مال الرأس بالجناح الآخر، وإن قطعت الرأس وقع
 https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1272 English: "Isfahān is the · الجناحان: — سير أعلام النبلاء حراشدون، ص ١٢٧

head, and Fārs and Adharbayjān are the two wings. If you cut off one of the two wings, the head leans with the other wing; but if you cut off the head, the two wings fall."

عبرت: Counsel was taken from the man best placed to give it, and where he had come from was not the question.

Hands-up? Hands up — who would you ask, if you had to plan a campaign against an empire you had never governed?

NTS/E-U6 · The deadlock, and the man who had once claimed prophethood

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 21 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** The map holds still: a besieged town, the besiegers unable to force it. Nothing moves for the length of the card.

What happened: The Persians go behind their walls and their ditch, and come out only when they choose. It drags on — البدايه says only «فلما طال على المسلمين هذا الحال واستمرّ» and gives no length, so do not put a number of days or weeks on it. النعمان calls his senior men and asks how to draw them into the open. The oldest speaks first, by custom, and says wait. عمرو بن معدى كرب says charge, and is told the walls are fighting for the other side. Then طليحة الأسدي speaks — the same طليحة who had claimed prophethood in the ردة and come back to Islam, and whom أبو بكر had ordered خالد to consult but never to put in command. His plan is the one the army adopts.

The statement:

وإني أرى أن تبعث سرية فتحدق بهم ويناوشوهم بالقتال ويحمشوهم (١) فإذا برزوا إليهم فليفروا إلينا هرباً، فإذا استطردوا وراءهم وانتهوا (٢) إلينا عزمنا أيضاً على الفرار كلنا، فإنهم حينئذ لا يشكّون في الهزيمة فيخرجون من حصونهم عن بكرة أبيهم، فإذا تكامل خروجهم رجعنا إليهم فجالدناهم حتى يقضي الله بيننا. — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٢٣١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3377> English: "I hold that you should send out a detachment to close on them and skirmish and provoke them; then, when they come out against them, let our men flee back to us; and when they pursue and reach us, we too shall all resolve on flight, so that they will not doubt the rout and will come out of their fortresses to the last man. And when their coming-out is complete we shall turn back on them and fight them until God judges between us."

عبرت: A man can be kept out of command and still be listened to, and the two are not the same decision.

Hands-up? Hands up — does anyone remember, from last week, the name of the man who claimed prophethood in نجد and then came back?

NTS/E-U7 · Three takbīrs, and a commander who asks to be the first killed

Tier: CORE · **When:** 21 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** The single largest map beat of the evening: the Persian front breaks and the line jumps east.

What happened: The trap works. The Persians pour out of the town. النعمان has the army lie flat under their shields and take the arrows, and refuses to charge — men beg him and he says "gently, gently" — until the sun passes the meridian, the hour the Prophet ﷺ used to choose. Then he rides down the line, tells them he will say the takbīr three times and charge on the third, recites the chain of succession one more time, and prays out loud. He asks for two things. He is given both before dark.

اللَّهُمَّ أَغْزِ دِينَكَ، وَأَنْصُرْ عِبَادَكَ، وَاجْعَلِ التُّعْمَانَ أَوَّلَ شَهِيدِ الْيَوْمِ عَلَى إِعْزَازِ دِينِكَ وَتَنْصُرْ عِبَادَكَ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ٣٩٦ ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1087> English: "O God, give might to Your religion and victory to Your servants, and make al-Nu‘mān the first martyr today upon the giving of might to Your religion and victory to Your servants."

Hands-up? no

أُولَئِكَ الْمُسْتَزْعَفُونَ مِنَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ وَلَكِنَّ الَّذِي أَكْرَمَهُمْ بِالشَّهَادَةِ يَعْرِفُ وُجُوهَهُمْ وَأَنْسَابَهُمْ، وَمَا يَصْنَعُ أُولَئِكَ بِمَعْرِفَةِ
 ٣٩٨ English: "Those are the weak among the Muslims — but the One who honoured them with martyrdom knows their faces and their lineages. And what do they want with ‘Umar knowing them?"

Hands-up? no

وَكَانَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ يُسَمُّونَ فَتْحَ نَهَاوَنْدَ فَتْحَ الْفُتُوحِ لِأَنَّهُ لَمْ يَكُنْ لِلْفُرسِ بَعْدَهُ اجْتِمَاعٌ. وَمَلَكَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ يَلَادَهُمْ. — الكامل

https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1090 English: "The Muslims used to call the conquest of Nahāwand "the victory of victories", because after it the Persians never again assembled; and the Muslims took possession of their lands."

عبرت: The battle that is remembered is not always the largest one; it is the one after which nothing was the same.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U10 · The captives of Nahāwand, and the man who wept over them

Tier: CORE · **When:** 21 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** The map does not move. One line drawn back from نهاوند to المدينة — the only line on the map that runs westward.

What happened: The captives from نهاوند are brought to المدينة. And in the streets of the city there is a slave, a Persian craftsman — a carpenter, an engraver, a smith — who is not permitted in المدينة at all except by a special exemption his master had written for. When he meets the children among the captives he strokes their heads and weeps, and says one sentence. Both البدايه and الكامل then explain, in the same breath, where he was from. He was from نهاوند.

The statement:

لما قدم سبي (ا) نهاوند إلى المدينة جعل أبو لؤلؤة - فيروز غلام المغيرة بن شعبة - لا يلقى منهم صغيرًا إلا مسح رأسه ويكى وقال: آكل عُمر كبدي — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٢٣٤ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3380> English: "When the captives of Nahāwand reached Medina, Abū Lu'lu'a — Fīrūz, the slave of al-Mughīra b. Shu'ba — would not meet a child among them without stroking his head and weeping, and saying: 'Umar has eaten my liver."

عبرت: The books set the victory and what came of it on the same page, and left the reader to hold both.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U11 · A slave stops the caliph in the market

Tier: CORE · **When:** 23 AH [SOURCED], days before the attack — **the month is not given on any page held;** ٨٩ places it only «دعاه» then summoned him, "Umar waited some nights, then summoned him", so ذو الحجة is an inference, [CONVENTIONAL - ESTIMATE], and must not be printed as a date · **Map:** No map. The street of المدينة.

What happened: عمرؓ is walking through the market. أبو لؤلؤة meets him and asks for redress against his own master: the daily levy is too heavy. عمرؓ asks how much, and what his trade is, and then tells him that for the work he does the levy is not heavy. The reports differ on the figure — two dirhams a day, four a day, a hundred a month. They do not differ on what happened next. عمرؓ mentions the wind-mill he has heard the man boast he could build, and asks him to build one. The answer is the last thing either of them says to the other.

The statement:

يَا أَمِيرَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ، أَعْدِنِي عَلَى الْمُغِيرَةِ بْنِ شُعْبَةَ فَإِنَّ عَلَيَّ خَرَجًا كَثِيرًا. قَالَ: وَكَمْ خَرَجُكَ؟ قَالَ: دِرْهَمَانِ كُلَّ يَوْمٍ. قَالَ: وَأَيْنَ صِنَاعَتُكَ؟ قَالَ: تَجَارٌ، تَقَاشُ، حَدَادٌ. قَالَ: فَمَا أَرَى خَرَجَكَ كَثِيرًا عَلَى مَا تَصْنَعُ مِنَ الْأَعْمَالِ، قَدْ بَلَغَنِي أَنَّكَ تَقُولُ: لَوْ أَرَدْتُ أَنْ أَصْنَعَ رَحَى تَطْحَنُ بِالرَّيْحِ لَفَعَلْتُ! قَالَ: نَعَمْ. قَالَ: فَأَعْمَلْ لِي رَحَى. قَالَ: لَئِنْ سَلِمْتَ لِأَعْمَلَنَ لَكَ رَحَى يَتَحَدَّثُ بِهَا مَنْ يَالْمَشْرِيقِ وَالْمَغْرِبِ! ثُمَّ انْصَرَفَ عَنْهُ. فَقَالَ عُمَرُ: لَقَدْ أَوْعَدَنِي الْعَبْدُ الْآنَ. — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٢٧ <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1117> English: "Commander of the Believers, give me redress against al-

Mughīra b. Shu‘ba, for I have a heavy kharāj upon me. He said: and how much is your kharāj? He said: two dirhams every day. He said: and what is your trade? He said: carpenter, engraver, smith. He said: then I do not consider your kharāj heavy for the work you do. It has reached me that you say: if I wished, I would make a mill that grinds by the wind. He said: yes. He said: then make me a mill. He said: if you are spared, I shall make you a mill that people in the east and the west will talk about. Then he turned away from him. ‘Umar said: the slave has just threatened me."

عبرت: The complaint reached the head of the state in the street, and was heard, and was refused; all three of those are facts about the same government.

Hands-up? Hands up — in how many governments, in any century, can the man with the smallest grievance stop the ruler in the street and be answered by him personally?

NTS/E-U12 · The فجر of Wednesday

Tier: CORE · **When:** Wednesday, four nights remaining of 23 ذو الحجة AH [SOURCED]; the sources also give three, and seven · **Map:** No map. A single dark slide.

What happened: عمر used to appoint men to straighten the rows, and would not say the takbīr until they were straight. أبو لؤلؤة came into the mosque in the last dark and stood in the row facing him with a two-headed dagger, its handle in the middle. He struck him six times — البدايه says three, and it is said six — and one blow below the navel was the one that killed him. Then he turned and struck his way out through the congregation. Thirteen men were struck; six of them died. A man of العراق threw a cloak over him, and he killed himself.

The statement:

فَلَمَّا أَصْبَحَ خَرَجَ عُمَرُ إِلَى الصَّلَاةِ وَكَانَ يُوَكِّلُ بِالصُّفُوفِ رَجُلًا فَإِذَا اسْتَوَتْ كَبَّرَ، وَدَخَلَ أَبُو لَوْلُؤَةَ فِي النَّاسِ وَبِيَدِهِ خَنْجَرٌ لَهُ رَأْسَانِ يَصَابُهُ فِي وَسْطِهِ، فَضَرَبَ عُمَرُ سِتَّ ضَرْبَاتٍ إِحْدَاهُنَّ تَحْتَ سَرْتِهِ وَهِيَ الَّتِي قَتَلَتْهُ، وَقَتَلَ مَعَهُ كَلْبَبَ بْنَ أَبِي الْبُكَيرِ اللَّيْثِيِّ وَكَانَ خَلْفَهُ، وَقَتَلَ جَمَاعَةً غَيْرَهُ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٢٨

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1118> English: "When morning came ‘Umar went out to the prayer — and he used to appoint men over the rows, and when they were straight he would say the takbīr. And Abū Lu‘lu’a entered among the people with a two-headed dagger in his hand, its haft in the middle of it, and struck ‘Umar six blows, one of them beneath his navel, and that is the one that killed him. And he killed with him Kulayb b. Abī al-Bukayr al-Laythī, who was behind him, and killed a company besides him."

عبرت: He was struck in the one place he could not be guarded, doing the one thing he would not delegate.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U13 · What the man beside him heard

Tier: CORE · **When:** 23 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map.

What happened: One report in سير comes from a man who was actually in the congregation. He had walked back from the market that day with عمر leaning on his arm, and أبو لؤلؤة had passed them and looked at عمر in a way he never forgot. The next morning he was in the mosque, half asleep, when he heard the voice from

the front of the rows. Then the whole congregation surged. And then — this is the detail that tells you the prayer never stopped — he heard someone else's recitation begin.

The statement:

وقال عامر بن عبد الله بن الزبير، قال: جئت من السوق وعمر يتوكأ علي، فمر بنا أبو لؤلؤة، فنظر إلى عمر نظرة ظننت أنه لولا مكاني بطش به، فجئت بعد ذلك إلى المسجد الفجر فإني لبين النائم واليقظان، إذ سمعت عمر يقول: قتلني الكلب، فماج الناس ساعة، ثم إذا قراءة عبد الرحمن بن عوف. — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٩٠
<https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1235> English: "I came from the market with 'Umar leaning on me, and Abū Lu'lu'a passed us and looked at 'Umar with a look such that I thought, but for my being there, he would have seized him. Then I came afterwards to the mosque for the dawn, and I was between sleeping and waking when I heard 'Umar say: the dog has killed me. And the people surged for a moment; and then there was the recitation of 'Abd al-Raḥmān b. 'Awf."

عبرت: The congregation was thrown into confusion for a moment, and then the prayer went on, because he had said who was to lead it before he fell.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U14 · He asks who it was, and gives thanks for the answer

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 23 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map.

What happened: They carry him to his house before sunrise with the blood running. He faints and comes round and faints again. When he can speak he asks one question: who struck me? They tell him it was أبو المغيرة's slave. His answer is not about the man at all. It is thanks that his killer was not from among the Muslims — that no man who prayed had done this. Then, البدايه says, he adds quietly: "may God abase him; we had ordered good treatment for him."

The statement:

ثم سأل عمّن قتله مَنْ هو؟ فقالوا له: هو أبو لؤلؤة غلام المغيرة بن شعبة. فقال الحمد لله الذي لم يجعل منيّي على يدي رجل يدّعي الإيمان ولم يسجد لله سجدة. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٦٨
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3414> English: "Then he asked who it was that had struck him. They said: it is Abū Lu'lu'a, the slave of al-Mughīra b. Shu'ba. He said: praise be to God, who did not make my death at the hands of a man who lays claim to faith and who has never prostrated to God a single prostration."

عبرت: The first thing he wanted to know about his own killing was what it would mean for the community, not what it meant for him.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U15 · Roused for the prayer

Tier: CORE · **When:** 23 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map.

What happened: He lay three days. In that time they gave him نبيذ to drink and it came out of the wound; they gave him milk and it came out of the wound; and the physician told him plainly to make his bequest.

The statement:

عبرت: The one obligation he would not be excused from was the one he was dying of.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U16 · The debt, and a place he had to ask for

Tier: CORE · **When:** 23 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map. The Prophetic chamber, with two graves in it.

What happened: He calls his son and tells him to work out what he owes. They count it: about eighty-six thousand. He gives the order of recourse — his own family's property first, then *بنو عدي*, then *قريش*. Then he sends the same son on a different errand. He does not order it; he asks. And the answer he gets back is the sentence that ends the card. He had asked to be buried beside the Prophet ﷺ and *أبو بكر*, and the place he was asking for was the place she had kept for herself.

The statement:

ثم قال: يا عبد الله! انظر ما علي من الدين، فحسبوه فوجدوه ستة وثمانين ألفاً أو نحوها، فقال: إن وفي مال آل عمر فأده من أموالهم وإلا فاسأل في بني عدي، فإن لم تف أموالهم فسل في قريش؛ اذهب إلى أم المؤمنين عائشة فقل: يستأذن عمر أن يدفن مع صاحبيه. فذهب إليها فقالت: كنت أريده -تعني المكان- لنفسي ولأوثرنه اليوم على قلبي. — سير أعلام النبلاء جراحدون ص٩١
English: "Then he said:
'Abd Allāh! Look at what is upon me of debt. They reckoned it and found it eighty-six thousand or thereabouts... Go to the Mother of the Believers 'Ā'isha and say: 'Umar asks leave to be buried with his two companions. So he went to her, and she said: I had wanted it — meaning the place — for myself; but I shall prefer him to myself today."

عبرت: The most powerful man alive could not take three cubits of ground; he had to ask, and be given.

Hands-up? Hands up — who can name the two men already buried in that room?

NTS/E-U17 · The charge to whoever comes next

Tier: CORE · **When:** 23 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map. Three words on screen, one at a time — الأنصار · العرب · المهاجرون — which is the الكامل's list, the one the quotation below carries. **Do not add these three: that comes from a different transmission in سير (0\$9, 6.3 no. 13), which also drops the other two.**

What happened: With the wound open and the room full, he dictates what the next caliph is to be told. He does not talk about policy or about the frontier. He names groups of people and says what is owed to each — in the *الكامل*'s transmission the أنصار «who settled the abode and the faith»; the Arab tribes, whose zakāt is to go to their own poor; and the non-Muslims under the Prophet's ﷺ covenant, whose covenant is to be kept. Then he asks whether he has discharged the duty, and says what condition he believes he is leaving the office in.

The statement:

وَأُوصِي الْخَلِيفَةَ بِالْعَرَبِ، فَإِنَّهُمْ مَادَّةُ الْإِسْلَامِ، أَنْ يُؤْخَذَ مِنْ صَدَقَاتِهِمْ حَقُّهَا فَتُوضَعَ فِي فَقَرَائِهِمْ، وَأُوصِي الْخَلِيفَةَ بِذِمَّةِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - أَنْ يُوفِيَ لَهُمْ بِعَهْدِهِمْ، اللَّهُمَّ هَلْ بَلَغْتُ؟ لَقَدْ تَرَكْتُ الْخَلِيفَةَ مِنْ بَعْدِي عَلَى أَتْقَى وَأَوْصِي الْخَلِيفَةَ بِالْعَرَبِ، فَإِنَّهُمْ مَادَّةُ الْإِسْلَامِ، أَنْ يُؤْخَذَ مِنْ صَدَقَاتِهِمْ حَقُّهَا فَتُوضَعَ فِي فَقَرَائِهِمْ، وَأُوصِي الْخَلِيفَةَ بِذِمَّةِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - أَنْ يُوفِيَ لَهُمْ بِعَهْدِهِمْ، اللَّهُمَّ هَلْ بَلَغْتُ؟ لَقَدْ تَرَكْتُ الْخَلِيفَةَ مِنْ بَعْدِي عَلَى أَتْقَى
 https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1118 English: "And I charge the caliph concerning the Arabs, for they are the substance of Islam, that their due be taken from their alms and placed among their poor. And I charge the caliph concerning the covenanted people of the Messenger of God — may God bless him and grant him peace — that their covenant be fulfilled for them. O God, have I conveyed it? I have left the caliph after me upon [a state] cleaner than the palm of the hand."

عبرت: The last order he gave was a list of people he would never meet again and what was still owed to them.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U18 · He refuses to name his own son

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 23 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map.

What happened: They press him to appoint a successor. He says that if أبو عبيدة^{رضي} were alive he would appoint him, and tell his Lord why; and if سالم مولى أبي حذيفة^{رضي} were alive, the same. Both are dead. Then someone suggests his own son. عبد الله بن عمر^{رضي}, who was in the room, says he wished at that moment that the whole breadth of المدينة lay between him and his father. The refusal that follows is reported in two books, and the reasoning is the same in both.

The statement:

فَمَا أَنَا قَائِلٌ لِلَّهِ إِذَا سَأَلَنِي عَمَّنْ أَمَرْتُ عَلَيْهِمْ فَقُلْتُ: فَلَانَا، وَأَنَا أَعْلَمُ مِنْهُ مَا أَعْلَمُ! فَلَا وَالَّذِي نَفْسِي بِيَدِهِ لَأُرَدِّدْنَهَا إِلَى الَّذِي دَفَعَهَا إِلَيَّ أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٍ، وَلَوَدِدْتُ أَنْ عَلَيْهَا مَنْ هُوَ خَيْرٌ مِنِّي لَا يَنْقُضِي ذَلِكَ مِمَّا أَعْطَانِي اللَّهُ شَيْئًا. — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٩٣ · https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1238 English: "And what am I to say to God when He asks me about the man I set over them, and I said: so-and-so — while I know of him what I know! No, by Him in whose hand is my soul, I shall give it back to the One who gave it to me in the first place; and I would wish that there were over it one better than me, and none of what God has given me would be lessened by that."

عبرت: The question he could not get past was not who deserved it but what he would say when asked.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U19 · Six names, and the cousin who was left off the list

Tier: CORE · **When:** 23 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map. Six names on screen, and a seventh name greyed out beside them.

What happened: He will not appoint one man and he will not leave a vacancy. So he names six, and gives the reason for the six: they are the men the Prophet ﷺ died pleased with. He had already announced them from the منبر weeks before, in a Friday sermon, after a dream he read as his own notice. And there is a seventh man who belongs on any such list — سعيد بن زيد, one of the ten given the promise of Paradise. He is left off. Both البدايه passages give the same reason, and it is not a criticism of سعيد.

The statement:

ولم يذكر سعيد بن زيد بن عمرو بن نفيل العَدَوِي فيهم، لكونه من قبيلته، خشية أن يُراعَى في الإمارة بسببه — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3415> English: "And he did not mention Sa'īd b. Zayd b. 'Amr b. Nufayl al-'Adawī among them, because he was of his own tribe, fearing that he might be favoured in the command on that account."

عبرت: He removed his own clan from the succession before anyone else could ask him to.

Hands-up? Hands up — can anyone name three of the six? (Then put all six up.)

NTS/E-U20 · The rules: three days, and a fourth day that must not dawn

Tier: CORE · **When:** 23 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map. A three-day counter.

What happened: He does not leave the six to work it out. He sets a procedure. Three days, no more. صهيب leads the prayer meanwhile — the books state the instruction and give no reason for it, so **do not supply one from the platform**. His own son attends and advises and is ineligible. طلحة is away, and is given the three days to arrive; after that they proceed without him. أبو طلحة الأنصاري takes fifty men of the أنصار and keeps the door. And a fourth day is not to dawn on المدينة without a commander.

The statement:

فَإِذَا مِتُّ فَتَشَاوَرُوا ثَلَاثَةَ أَيَّامٍ، وَلْيُصَلِّ بِالنَّاسِ صُهَيْبٌ، وَلَا يَأْتِيَنَّ الْيَوْمَ الرَّابِعُ إِلَّا وَعَلَيْكُمْ أَمِيرٌ مِنْكُمْ، وَيَخْضُرُ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عُمَرَ مُشِيرًا، وَلَا شَيْءَ لَهُ مِنَ الْأَمْرِ، وَطَلْحَةُ شَرِيكُكُمْ فِي الْأَمْرِ، فَإِنْ قَدِمَ فِي الْأَيَّامِ الثَّلَاثَةِ فَأَخْضَرُوهُ أَمْرَكُمْ، وَإِنْ مَضَتْ الْأَيَّامُ الثَّلَاثَةُ قَبْلَ قُدُومِهِ فَأَمْضُوا أَمْرَكُمْ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٤١ <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1131> English: "When I die, take counsel for three days, and let Suhayb lead the people in prayer; and let the fourth day not come upon you without a commander from among you. And 'Abd Allāh b. 'Umar shall attend as an adviser, with nothing of the command for him. And Ṭalḥa is your partner in the affair: if he arrives within the three days, bring him into your business; and if the three days pass before he arrives, carry your business through."

عبرت: He could not choose the man, so he built the thing that would: a deadline, a doorkeeper, and a rule that his own son could speak but not inherit.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U21 · The one who could have had it takes himself out

Tier: CORE · **When:** 24 المحرم AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map. Six names; one steps forward and out of the frame.

What happened: عمر^{رضي} is buried. المقداد^{رضي} gathers the six in a house and أبو طلحة^{رضي} stands at the door. Voices rise inside, and أبو طلحة^{رضي} tells them he had feared they would refuse the thing, not compete for it, and that they will get their three days and not an hour more. Then عبد الرحمن بن عوف^{رضي} asks which of them will take himself out of the running and choose for the rest. Nobody answers. So he does it himself — and علي^{رضي} makes him swear to conditions first.

The statement:

أَيْتُكُمْ يُخْرِجُ مِنْهَا نَفْسَهُ وَيَتَقَلَّدُهَا عَلَى أَنْ يُؤَلِّيَهَا أَفْضَلَكُمْ؟ فَلَمْ يُجِبْهُ أَحَدٌ. فَقَالَ: فَأَنَا أَنْخَلِجُ مِنْهَا. فَقَالَ عُثْمَانُ: آتَا أَوَّلَ مَنْ رَضِيَ. فَقَالَ الْقَوْمُ: قَدْ رَضِينَا. وَعَلَيٌّ سَاكِتٌ. فَقَالَ: مَا تَقُولُ يَا أَبَا الْحَسَنِ؟ قَالَ: أَعْطِينِي مَوْثِقًا لَتُؤَيِّرَنَّ الْحَقَّ وَلَا تَتَّبِعَ الْهَوَى وَلَا تَخْصَّ ذَا رَجِمٍ وَلَا تَأْلُو الْأُمَّةَ نُصْحًا. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٤٣

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1133> English: "Which of you will take himself out of it and take charge of it, on condition that he appoint the best of you? No one answered him. He said: then I take myself out of it. 'Uthmān said: I am the first to consent. The people said: we consent. And 'Alī was silent. He said: what do you say, Abū al-Ḥasan? He said: give me a binding pledge that you will prefer the truth, and not follow desire, and not favour a kinsman, and not fall short of sincere counsel to the community."

عبرت: The man who decided it was the one man who had made himself ineligible to benefit from the decision.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U22 · Three days and three nights, asking the city

Tier: CORE · **When:** 24 المحرم AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map. المدينة, and a figure moving through it.

What happened: He does not deliberate in a room. He goes out into the city and asks it. ابن كثير lists who he asked, and the list is the point: the chiefs of the tribes and the commanders of the armies; men in assembly and men one at a time; openly and in private; the secluded women behind their curtains; the boys in the schools; the travellers and bedouin coming in off the road. Three days and three nights, sleeping only between prayers. And he found the city of one mind, with two named exceptions that ابن كثير records rather than suppresses.

The statement:

حتى خلس إلى النساء المخدرات في حجابهنّ وحتى سأل الولدان في المكاتب، وحتى سأل من يرد من الركبان والأعراب إلى المدينة، في مدة ثلاثة أيام بلياليها، فلم يجد اثنين يختلفان في تقدّم عثمان بن عفان، إلا ما ينقل عن عمار والمقداد أنهما أشارا بعلي بن أبي طالب — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٨١

<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3427> English: "...until he reached the secluded women behind their veils, and until he asked the boys in the schools, and until he asked those coming in from the caravans and the bedouin to Medina, over three days and their nights; and he did not find two men differing over the precedence of 'Uthmān b. 'Affān, except what is reported of 'Ammār and al-Miqdād, that they two counselled 'Alī b. Abī Ṭālib."

عبرت: He was asked to choose and he went and asked everybody, including the people nobody would have thought to ask.

Hands-up? Hands up — before I read the list: who do you think a man in the year 24 would have consulted? (Then read it.)

NTS/E-U23 · The pledge, at the minbar, on a condition

Tier: CORE · **When:** 24 المحرم AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map. The mosque, full.

What happened: On the fourth morning he calls المدينة to the mosque, and it fills until there is no room left. عبد الرحمن goes up onto the منبر, prays a long silent prayer, and then tells the city what he found. He calls علي first, takes his hand, and puts the condition. Then he calls عثمان and puts the same condition. Then he raises his head to the roof of the mosque and repeats one sentence three times. The city crowds in to give the pledge, and علي gives it — البدايه says first, and it is said last. طلحة arrives afterwards, is offered the chance to refuse, and gives it too.

The statement:

هل أنت مبايعي على كتاب الله وسنة نبيه ﷺ وفعل أبي بكر وعمر؟ قال: اللهم لا ولكن على جهدي من ذلك وطاقتي، قال فأرسل يده وقال: قم (إلي) يا عثمان، فأخذ بيده فقال: هل أنت مبايعي على كتاب الله وسنة نبيه ﷺ وفعل أبي بكر وعمر؟ قال: اللهم نعم! فقال: فرفع رأسه إلى سقف المسجد ويده في يد عثمان فقال: اللهم اسمع واشهد، اللهم اسمع واشهد، اللهم اسمع واشهد، اللهم إني قد جعلت (0) ما في رقبتي من ذلك في رقية عثمان. — البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٢٨٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3428> English: "Will you give me your pledge upon the Book of God and the Sunna of His Prophet ﷺ and the practice of Abū Bakr and 'Umar? He said: O God, no — but upon my utmost effort in that and my capacity. So he released his hand and said: rise to me, 'Uthmān. And he took his hand and said: will you give me your pledge upon the Book of God and the Sunna of His Prophet ﷺ and the practice of Abū Bakr and 'Umar? He said: O God, yes. So he raised his head to the roof of the mosque, his hand in the hand of 'Uthmān, and said: O God, hear and bear witness; O God, hear and bear witness; O God, hear and bear witness. O God, I have placed what was upon my neck of that upon the neck of 'Uthmān."

عبرت: The pledge was given in public, on a stated condition, in front of the people it bound.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U24 · The man who took it all, and wrote twice ordering it to stop

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 22–23 AH [SOURCED] · **Map:** The closing map: the full extent shaded — بلخ to برقة — and then two short bars drawn in, one east of مكران and one at the river beyond خراسان.

What happened: Two dispatches reach المدينة within a year of each other. One is from the far south-east: مكران is taken, and the Sindī king's relief force is broken. The messenger describes the country and عمر asks whether he is making rhymed prose or reporting — and then forbids any army of his to go there again. The other is from the north-east: الأحنف بن قيس has secured عمر to خراسان. بلخ's reply is not congratulation. It is a wish, a prediction, and a written order to hold the line at the river.

The statement:

أَسْجَاعُ أَنْتَ أَمْ مُخِيرٌ؟ لَا وَاللَّهِ لَا يَغْرُوهَا جَيْشٌ لِي أَبَدًا. وَكَتَبْتُ إِلَى سُهَيْلٍ وَالْحَكَمِ بْنِ عَمْرِو: أَنْ لَا يَجُوزَنَّ مُكْرَانُ أَحَدٌ مِنْ الْكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٢٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1115> English: "Are you making rhymed prose, or reporting? No, by God, no army of mine shall ever raid it. And he wrote to Suhayl and to al-Ḥakam b. 'Amr: let no one of your two forces cross Mukrān."

عبرت: Knowing where to stop is a decision, and it has to be made in writing like any other.

Hands-up? Hands up — where do you think the boundary was when he died? (Then show it, and then show the two bars.)

NTS/E-U25 · What the historian throws out

Tier: GOOD · **When:** method, spoken inside the story [SOURCED] · **Map:** No map. One page of البدايه on screen.

What happened: ابن كثير, writing six hundred years later, sets down the reports about the شورى — and then does something worth watching. He lists the reports that make the whole thing a stitch-up, states that they contradict what is established in the authentic collections, and rejects them by name. This is the moment to say, once and briefly, what the whole course rests on: a report being in a history book is not the same as a report being established. The historian sorts. Here we can watch him do it.

The statement:

إلى غير ذلك من الأخبار المخالفة لما ثبت في الصحاح فهي مردودة على قائلها وناقليها، والله أعلم. والمظنون بالصحابة خلاف ما يتوهم كثير من الرافضة وأغبياء القصص الذين لا تميز عندهم بين صحيح الأخبار وضعيفها، ومستقيمها وسقيمها، ومُنَادِها (إ) وقويمها، والله الموفق للصواب. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٨٣
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3429> English: "...and other than that of the reports contradicting what is established in the authentic collections — they are rejected, back upon those who said them and those who transmitted them; and God knows best. And what is to be presumed of the Companions is the contrary of what many of the Rāfiḍa suppose, and of the foolish storytellers who have no discernment between the sound of reports and the weak, the straight and the sick, the crooked and the upright. And God is the granter of success."

عبرت: A book that keeps a report it disbelieves, and says so, is more trustworthy than a book with no disagreements in it.

Hands-up? no

NTS/E-U26 · The first case the new caliph had to judge

Tier: CUT · **When:** 24 المحرم AH [SOURCED] — recorded, not planned for delivery · **Map:** No map.

What happened: عمر رضي الله عنه had ordered his son عبيد الله رضي الله عنه held in custody so that the next caliph could rule on his case. What he had done was go out on the day of the killing and kill three people he believed were part of it — الهرمزان, a Christian named جفينة, and أبو لؤلؤ's young daughter. It was the first matter brought to عثمان رضي الله عنه as caliph. علي رضي الله عنه held that the law required the execution; others said the father was killed yesterday and the son today; عمرو بن العاص رضي الله عنه pointed out the case had not arisen in عثمان رضي الله عنه's own term. عثمان رضي الله عنه paid the blood-money out of his own property.

The statement:

وذلك أنه غدا على ابنة أبي لؤلؤ قاتل عمر فقتلها، وضرب (رجلاً) نصرانياً يقال له جفينة بالسيف فقتله، وضرب الهرمزان الذي كان صاحب تُسْتَر فقتله، وكان قد قيل إنهما مالاً أبا لؤلؤة على قتل عمر، فالله أعلم. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٨٤
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3430> English: "And that was that he went out in the morning against the daughter of Abū Lu'lu'a, the killer of 'Umar, and killed her; and he struck with the sword a Christian man called Jufayna and killed him; and he struck al-Hurmuzān, who had been the

lord of Tustar, and killed him — for it had been said that those two had conspired with Abū Lu'lu'a in the killing of 'Umar; and God knows best."

عبرت: The first case the new caliph heard was against the son of the caliph just buried, and it was heard rather than waved away.

Hands-up? no — do NOT raise this from the platform. It belongs to session 3. If a written slip asks, answer from the page and defer.

The people: the house of أم سليم^{رض}

Source note: [the-house-of-umm-sulaym.md](#) — read it for the pages behind these cards.

THO/E-HS1 · The dower that was Islam

Tier: CORE · **When:** before the Hijra, at Medina [STANDARD] (the sources fix no year) · **Map:** Medina — بنو النجار quarter **What happened:** Abū Ṭalḥa came to ask for Umm Sulaym in marriage. He was still a pagan; she had already believed. She told him she would not refuse a man like him, but that he was a disbeliever. Then she named her price. If he accepted Islam, that would be her dower, and she would ask for nothing else. He accepted Islam, and he married her. **The statement:**

أَمَّا إِنِّي فِيكَ لَرَاغِبَةٌ، وَمَا مِثْلُكَ يُرَدُّ، وَلَكِنَّكَ كَافِرٌ، فَإِنْ تُسْلِمَ فَذَلِكَ مَهْرِي، لَا أَسْأَلُكَ غَيْرَهُ.
— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٢٩ — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2009> *English:* "I am indeed willing in your case, and a man like you is not refused; but you are a disbeliever. If you accept Islam, that is my dower — I ask you for nothing else."

عبرت: She set the terms of her own household before she entered it. **Hands-up?** no — but ثابت's closing line is worth adding aloud: "We never heard of a nobler dower than Umm Sulaym's dower: Islam."

THO/E-HS2 · The gift she had left

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٥، soon after the Hijra [SOURCED] (سير ج ٣ ص ٣٩٧: he was ten when the Prophet ﷺ reached Medina) · **Map:** Medina **What happened:** Umm Sulaym dressed her son in half her own head-covering, brought him to the Prophet ﷺ, and asked that he be taken into service and prayed for. He was ten years old. He stayed ten years. **The statement:**

يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ! هَذَا أُتَيْسُ ابْنِي، أَتَيْتُكَ بِهِ بِخَدْمِكَ، فَادْعُ اللَّهَ لَهُ.
— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٣ ص ٣٩٨ — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/3006> *English:* "Messenger of Allah, this is Unays, my son. I have brought him to you to serve you — so pray to Allah for him."

عبرت: She gave what she had, and what she had was a child's ten years. **Hands-up?** yes — "How old were you when you first learned something you still use?" (Delivery caution: the familiar line — "every man and woman of the Anṣār had already given him a gift, and I have nothing but this son" — is a **different** report on the same page (سير ج ٣ ص ٣٩٨), and it comes through علي بن زيد، of whom الذبيبي says «وَفِيهِ لَيْنٌ». Its wording is أبو **يعلى's**, not **الترمذي's** — the سير editor says so outright: «هذا اللفظ ليس عند الترمذي، وإنما هو لأبي يعلى». The quotation above is the ṣaḥīḥ one, (مسلم ٢٤٨١). Do not weld the two: if the "gift" line is told, say it is the weaker report — and note that the same weaker report makes him **eight**, not ten.)

THO/E-HS3 · Ten years, and not one rebuke

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١-١٠ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** Anas served in that household for ten years. He said afterwards, under oath, that in ten years he was never once told off — not for something he did, and not for something he failed to do. He said the word «uff» was never said to him. **The statement:**

خدمته صلى الله عليه وسلم عشر سنين، فوالله ما قال لي: أف قط، ولا قال لشيء فعلته: لم فعلت كذا، ولا لشيء لم أفعله: ألا فعلت كذا؟

سيرة أعلام النبلاء، جلد السيرة ٢ ص ٣٨٦ — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1044> *English:* "I served him ﷺ ten years, and by Allah he never said 'uff' to me once; he never said of anything I did, why did you do that; nor of anything I did not do, why did you not do that."

عبرت: The measure of a man is what the people who work for him say afterwards. **Hands-up?** no

THO/E-HS4 · «I find the scent of Paradise»

Tier: CORE · **When:** ٣ شوال، أحد، ٥ هـ [STANDARD] (the year is not fixed on the pages read; سير's chapter heading is «غزوة أحد وكانت في شوال») · **Map:** أحد، north of Medina **What happened:** Anas b. al-Naḍr had missed Badr, and it weighed on him. He said that if Allah ever gave him a battle, Allah would see what he did. At Uḥud the Muslim line broke. He walked forward with his sword, and met Sa'd b. Mu'ādh on the way. He told Sa'd he could smell Paradise, on this side of the mountain. Then he went in, and fought until he was killed. Sa'd said afterwards that he himself could not do what that man had done. **The statement:**

يا أبا عمرو أين؟ واهّا لريح الجنة، أجده دون أحد.

البداية والنهاية ج ٤ ص ٢٠٣ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1692> *English:* "Abū 'Amr, where to? Ah, the scent of Paradise — I find it this side of Uḥud."

عبرت: He had made a promise in private, and he kept it on a day when nobody would have checked. **Hands-up?** yes — "Has anyone here ever missed something and spent years wishing they had been there?"

THO/E-HS5 · Known by his fingertips

Tier: CORE · **When:** ٣ هـ، أحد، ٥ هـ [STANDARD] (as E-HS4 — the year is not fixed on the pages read) · **Map:** the field at أحد **What happened:** When the fighting stopped they went out to identify the dead. They found Anas b. al-Naḍr, and there were more than eighty wounds on his body — sword, spear and arrow. His own family could not tell who he was. His sister came, and she recognised her brother by his fingertips. His nephew, who was still a boy, later said that the verse of Sūrat al-Aḥzāb was held to have come down about him and men like him. **The statement:**

البداية والنهاية ج ٤ ص ٢٠٣ — verse as quoted at ٢٠٣ ص — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1692>; the reference «[الأحزاب: ٢٣]»

سير، جلد السيرة ١ is printed at ١ سير، جلد السيرة ١

(<https://shamela.ws/book/10906/544>), not on the البداية page — cite both, or check a muṣḥaf

before printing it **عبرت:** "Among the believers are men true to what they pledged to Allah."

Some men are recognised by their faces, and some by what is left of their hands. **Hands-up?** no

THO/E-HS6 · «What will you do with life after him?»

Tier: GOOD · **When:** أحد, ٣هـ [STANDARD], at the moment the rumour spread · **Map:** أحد **What happened:** The word went round the field that the Prophet ﷺ had been killed. Men sat down where they were and let their hands fall — among them 'Umar and Ṭalḥa. Anas b. al-Naḍr came on them sitting and asked what was keeping them there. They told him. He said one sentence and walked past them into the fighting. **The statement:**

فما تصنعون بالحياة بعده؟! قوموا فموتوا على ما مات عليه رسول الله ﷺ.
— البدايه والنهيه ج ٤ ص ٢٠٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1696> *English:* "And what will you do with life after him? Rise, and die upon what the Messenger of Allah ﷺ died upon."

عبرت: A rumour stopped a whole line of men; one sentence started it moving again. **Hands-up?** no (*Delivery note: this comes through Ibn Ishāq, not through the ṣaḥīḥ chain of E-HS4/E-HS5. Say so if the room is told both.*)

THO/E-HS7 · The dagger at Ḥunayn

Tier: CORE · **When:** حنين, ٨هـ [STANDARD] (the year is not on the pages read) · **Map:** حنين, near الطائف **What happened:** The Muslims had been driven back at the start of the day. Abū Ṭalḥa found his wife standing there with a dagger in her hand. He asked her what it was for. She said that if any of the enemy came near her she would use it on him. Abū Ṭalḥa turned to the Prophet ﷺ and asked whether he had heard what she was saying. And the Prophet ﷺ laughed. **The statement:**

يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ! إِنْ دَنَا مِنِّي مُشْرِكٌ بَقَرْتُ بِهِ بَطْنَهُ.
— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٣٠٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2284> *English:* "Messenger of Allah, if a mushrik comes near me I will open his belly with it."

عبرت: She did not intend to be carried off a battlefield. **Hands-up?** no (*Delivery note: البدايه ج ٤ ص ٥٨٩ continues this exchange with her request about the الطلقاء and the reply «إِنَّ اللَّهَ قَدْ كَفَى وَأَحْسَنَ». Either tell that half whole, ending on his ﷺ refusal, or leave it out entirely. Never the request without the answer.*)

THO/E-HS8 · The water-carriers at Uḥud

Tier: GOOD · **When:** أحد, ٣هـ [STANDARD] · **Map:** أحد **What happened:** Anas was a boy at Uḥud, and he remembered two things from that day. One was his stepfather standing in front of the Prophet ﷺ with a buckler, breaking bow after bow, saying: my throat before your throat. The other was two women with their skirts tucked up, running with waterskins on their backs, emptying them into the mouths of the men and going back to fill them again. One of them was 'Ā'isha. The other was his mother. **The statement:**

يَا نَبِيَّ اللَّهِ، يَا أَيُّيَ أَنْتَ، لَا تُشْرَفْ، لَا يُصِيبُكَ سَهْمٌ، تَحْرِي دُونَ تَحْرِكَ.
— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٣١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2011> *English:* "Prophet of Allah — may my father be your ransom — do not look out, lest an arrow strike you. My throat before your throat."

عبرت: A boy remembers who was working, and he remembers it for the rest of his life. **Hands-up?** no

THO/E-HS9 · «It was a loan»

Tier: CORE · **When:** at Medina [STANDARD] (no year on the page) · **Map:** Medina **What happened:** Their small son was gravely ill. Abū Ṭalḥa went out to the mosque, and while he was gone the boy died. Umm Sulaym prepared the body herself and told the household to say nothing. Her husband came home; she had

his supper ready, and he ate it. At the end of the night she asked him a question about some neighbours who had borrowed something and then would not give it back. He said they had not been fair. She said: your son was a loan from Allah, and He has taken him back. He said the words of return to Allah, and praised Him. In the morning he went to the Prophet ﷺ, who saw him and prayed for them both. **The statement:**

فَإِنَّ ابْنَكَ كَانَ غَارِيَّةً مِّنَ اللَّهِ، فَقَبِضَتْهُ.

— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٣١٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2290> *English:* "Your son was a loan from Allah, and He has taken him back."

عبرت: She made him say the ruling before she told him it was his own case. **Hands-up?** no (*Delivery caution: the page does **not** name the child, and the exchange is at the end of the night, not at the door. Both details are usually got wrong in retelling.*)

THO/E-HS10 · Bayruḥā'

Tier: GOOD · **When:** at Medina [STANDARD] · **Map:** the palm gardens of Medina **What happened:** Abū Ṭalḥa owned more date-palms than any other man of the Anṣār at Medina. The one he loved most was a garden called Bayruḥā'. He came and gave it away, and said plainly that he was giving away the piece he loved most, and asked the Prophet ﷺ to place it wherever he was shown. He was told to put it among his own near kin.

The statement:

إِنَّ أَحَبَّ أَمْوَالِي إِلَيَّ بَيْرُحَاءُ، وَإِنَّهَا صَدَقَةٌ لِلَّهِ... فَقَالَ: (يَخُ! ذَلِكَ مَالٌ رَائِحٌ، وَإِنِّي أَرَى أَنْ تَجْعَلَهَا فِي الْأَقْرَبِينَ).

— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٣٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2013> *English:* "The dearest of my property to me is Bayruḥā', and it is a ṣadaqa for Allah... He said: 'Bakhkh! That is profitable property. I think you should put it among your near kin.'"

عبرت: He gave away the thing he would miss, and he was told to give it to his own relatives. **Hands-up?** yes — "What is the one thing in your house you would find hardest to give away?"

THO/E-HS11 · «I have won»

Tier: CORE · **When:** ٥٤ هـ بئر معونة, [STANDARD] (٢٥٦) places it four months after Uḥud, in صفر ·

Map: بئر معونة, between the land of بنو عامر and the ḥarra of بنو سليم **What happened:** A party was sent out to Najd to teach. Umm Sulaym's brother Ḥarām carried the letter forward. He asked for safe conduct until he had delivered the message, and began to speak to them. While he was speaking they signalled to a man, who came round behind him and ran a spear through him. He took the blood in his hand and threw it over his own face and head, and said what he said. **The statement:**

اللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ، مُرْتُ وَرَبَّ الْكَعْبَةِ.

— البداية والنهاية ج ٤ ص ٢٥٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1744> (the page cites ٤٠٩٢, ٤٠٩١ البخاري) *English:* "Allāhu akbar — I have won, by the Lord of the Ka'ba."

عبرت: He was killed in the middle of a sentence, and he called it winning. **Hands-up?** no

THO/E-HS12 · The reason the Prophet ﷺ came to that house

Tier: CORE · **When:** after ٥٤ هـ بئر معونة onwards · **Map:** Medina — the house of أم سليم **What happened:** People noticed that the Prophet ﷺ went into no house in Medina except Umm Sulaym's. They asked him

about it. He gave one reason, and it was not a compliment to the house. It was that her brother had been killed alongside him. **The statement:**

(إِنِّي أَرْحَمُهَا، قُتِلَ أَخُوهَا مَعِيَ).

— سیر أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٣٠٦-٣٠٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2286> *English: "I have compassion for her — her brother was killed with me."

عبرت: The debt a leader owes is to the family, and it is paid by turning up. **Hands-up?** yes — "Why do you think he went to that house and no other?" (Then give the answer from the page.)

THO/E-HS13 · Umm Ḥarām and the sea

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the ḥadīth: at Medina, in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime. The expedition: ٢٨هـ [SOURCED] — ٢٩٠ records ٢٧, ٢٨ and ٣٣ · **Map:** Medina → Cyprus. **This is the first point on the map that is across water. What happened:** The Prophet ﷺ rested in her house one afternoon and woke up laughing. She asked what had made him laugh. He said people of his umma had been shown to him riding the sea like kings on thrones. She asked him to pray that she be one of them, and he told her she was among the first. Years later, under 'Uthmān, Mu'āwiya took a fleet to Cyprus, and her husband 'Ubāda b. al-Ṣāmit carried her with him. When they came ashore on the way back, a mule threw her, and she died there. **The statement:**

(عُرِضَ عَلَيَّ نَاسٌ مِنْ أُمَّتِي يَزْكَبُونَ ظَهْرَ هَذَا الْبَحْرِ كَالْمُلُوكِ عَلَى الْأَسِيرَةِ)... قَالَ: (أَنْتِ مِنَ الْأَوَّلِينَ).

— سیر أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٣١٦-٣١٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2296> *English: "'People of my umma were shown to me riding the back of this sea like kings upon thrones'... He said: 'You are among the first.'"

عبرت: She was told where she would be a caliphate before the ships were built. **Hands-up?** yes — "How long between a promise and its keeping is too long?" (Delivery caution: stop the البدایه quotation at «فماتت هناك». The clause about her grave that follows is Ibn Kathīr reporting local practice and will be heard as doctrine in this room.)

THO/E-HS14 · «Do not put al-Barā' over an army»

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the caliphate of عمر[ؓ], ١٣-٢٣هـ [SOURCED] for the caliphate; the letter itself is undated · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** Anas b. Mālik's elder brother al-Barā' was the kind of fighter other men lined up behind. It is reported that 'Umar wrote to his army commanders about him, and the instruction was not to give him a command. The reason given was not that he was unreliable. It was the opposite. **The statement:**

لَا تَسْتَغْمِلُوا الْبَرَاءَ عَلَى جَيْشٍ، فَإِنَّهُ مَهْلِكَةٌ مِنَ الْمَهَالِكِ يَفْدَمُ بِهِم.

— سیر أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ١٩٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1622> *English: "Do not put al-Barā' in command of an army, for he is a destruction among destructions — he presses forward with them."

عبرت: Courage is not the same qualification as command, and a state has to know the difference. **Hands-up?** yes — "Would you put the bravest man in the room in charge of the room?" (Delivery note: the page opens with «قِيلَ». Say "it is reported that 'Umar[ؓ] wrote", not "'Umar[ؓ] wrote".)

THO/E-HS15 · «Do you see me dying in my bed?»

Tier: GOOD · **When:** at Medina or Basra, undated · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** Anas came in on his brother and found him singing over his bow. He asked him how long that was going to go on. His brother answered with a question of his own, and then with a number: ninety-nine men killed in single combat, not counting what he had shared in with everyone else. In a second telling Anas puts the question the other way and asks him why he sings poetry when Allah has given him the Qur'ān instead. **The statement:**

أَتَرَانِي أَمُوتُ عَلَى فَرَاشِي؟ وَاللَّهِ لَقَدْ قَتَلْتُ يَضْعَا وَتِسْعِينَ.
— سِير أَعْلَام النُّبَلَاء ج ١ ص ١٩٨ —
https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1624 *English:* "Do you see me dying in my bed? By Allah, I have killed ninety-odd."

عبرت: Two brothers in one house, and each thought the other needed correcting. **Hands-up?** no (*Delivery note: the counts move — ninety-nine in one chain, ninety-odd in another, a hundred in a third. Say "the reports give ninety-odd" and move on.*)

THO/E-HS16 · Over the wall at Ḥadīqat al-Mawt

Tier: CORE · **When:** اليمامة, ١٢هـ [SOURCED] (see [rida-campaign-the-conduct-of-the-wars.md](https://shamela.ws/book/21712/909)) · **Map:** اليمامة — the walled garden; the gate opens from the inside **What happened:** Banū Ḥanīfa had shut themselves inside a walled garden and barred the gate. Al-Barā' told the men to throw him over the wall on top of them. They refused. He swore an oath that they would do it. They lifted him on a shield on the points of their spears until he cleared the wall, and he went down among them alone. He fought his way to the gate and opened it. He came out of that garden with more than eighty wounds on him, and Khālīd b. al-Walīd stayed a month treating them. **The statement:**

يَا مَعْشَرَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ، أَقُونِي عَلَيْهِمْ فِي الْحَدِيقَةِ. فَقَالُوا: لَا تَفْعَلْ، فَقَالَ: وَاللَّهِ لَتَطْرَحَنِي عَلَيْهِمْ بِهَا!
— الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢١٨ —
https://shamela.ws/book/21712/909 *English:* "Company of Muslims — throw me over onto them into the garden. They said: we will not. He said: by Allah, you will throw me onto them in it!"

عبرت: The gate that decided the day was opened from the inside, by one man who had to argue his own side into throwing him. **Hands-up?** no **THE FAMILY SENTENCE — say it before or after, but say it:** "The man on that shield is Anas b. Mālik's elder brother — the elder brother of the boy who served the Prophet ﷺ for ten years. Their uncle came off the field at Uhūd with the same count of wounds — and did not get up." (سِير ج ١ ص ١٩٥) «أَخُو خَادِمِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ أَنَسُ بْنُ مَالِكٍ» · البداية ج ٦ ص ٣٩٦ «وكان الأكبر» · سِير ج ١ ص ١٩٦ · البداية ج ٤ ص ٢٠٣ **Do NOT add "his mother is the woman who asked for Islam as her dower."** No page read names البراء's mother — see §X.14. The sentence is just as strong through the brother, and the brother is on the page.

THO/E-HS17 · The oath at Tustar

Tier: CORE · **When:** the conquest of ١٩٨هـ سِير ج ١ ص ١٩٨ — says تُسْتَر and ١٧هـ الكامل and ١٢هـ البداية [SOURCED] both ways · **Map:** تُسْتَر — خوزستان, east of البصرة; the Persian frontier moves past the Zagros **What happened:** The siege had gone on for months and the assaults kept failing. The men knew there was a ḥadīth about al-Barā' — that if he swore an oath upon Allah, Allah would answer it. So in the last assault they asked him to swear that oath for them. He made the prayer they asked for, and then added something to it that they had not asked for. They broke the enemy that day. He was killed inside the city. **The statement:**

قَالَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ: يَا بَرَاءُ أَقْسِمُ عَلَى رَبِّكَ لَيَهْرَمَنَّهِنَّ لَنَا. قَالَ: اللَّهُمَّ اهْزِمْنَهُمْ لَنَا وَاسْتَشْهِذْنِي.

— (البدايه ج ٧ ص ١٩٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1059> (identically at ١٩٧ ص ٧)
 English: "The Muslims said: Barā', swear upon your Lord that He will defeat them for us. He said: O Allah, defeat them for us, and take me as a martyr."

عبرت: He was asked to pray for the army; he prayed for the army and put himself in the cost column. **Hands-up?** no (Delivery note: «واستشهدني» is where the sources stop. Nothing may be added after it.)

THO/E-HS18 · The dawn prayer at Tustar

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the same morning as E-HS17 · **Map:** تُسْتَر **What happened:** Anas b. Mālik was there. Volunteers went into the town at night with the water — «كالبط», like ducks — put the gatekeepers to sleep and opened the gates at Fajr, and the fighting ran on into the morning; nobody prayed Ṣubḥ until after the sun was up (البدايه ج ٧ ص ١٩٨). Anas said afterwards that he would not have traded that prayer for red camels. He was the one who took the captured lord of the city, al-Hurmuzān, back to 'Umar. He was also the brother of the man who had been killed at that wall. **The statement:**

شهدت فتح تُسْتَر، وذلك عند صلاة الفجر، فاشتغل الناس بالفتح فما صلوا الصبح إلا بعد طلوع الشمس فما أحب أن لي بتلك الصلاة حمز النعم.
 — (البخاري *English:* "I was present at the conquest of Tustar, and it was at the time of the dawn prayer; the men were taken up with the conquest and did not pray Ṣubḥ until after sunrise — and I would not wish red camels in exchange for that prayer."

عبرت: The same morning is a conquest in one man's memory and a brother's grave in another's. **Hands-up?** no

THO/E-HS19 · «Equip me»

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the caliphate of عثمان ^{رضي} [SOURCED] (سیر ج ٢ ص ٢٨: عثمان) prayed over him) · **Map:** Medina → the sea **What happened:** Abū Ṭalḥa was old. He read the verse that says go forth, light and heavy, and took it as addressed to him. He told his sons to equip him. They tried to talk him out of it: he had fought under the Prophet ﷺ, under Abū Bakr and under 'Umar, and they would fight in his place now. He refused. He went to sea, and died on the ship, and they found no island to bury him on for seven days. **The statement:**

اسْتَنْفَرَنَا اللَّهُ وَأَمَرَنَا، شَيْوَحْنَا وَشَبَابَنَا، جَهْرُؤُنِي.
 — سیر أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٣٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2014> *English:* "Allah has called us out and commanded us — our old and our young. Equip me."

عبرت: He would not let his sons carry an obligation he read as his own. **Hands-up?** no (Delivery note: سیر itself says the better-known report has him dying at Medina, and lists 34, 32 and 51 as years. Tell the story; give no year.)

WHERE EACH CARD BELONGS

Card	Sits beside	Why
E-HS1 The dower that was Islam	L01 — beside the Medina clans block (medina-ansar-structure.md), or as the opening تعارف of the household	Introduces بنو النجار as a <i>household</i> , not a name on a clan chart. If L01 is full, it opens L02's household thread instead.
E-HS2 The gift she had left	L01 , immediately after E-HS1	Same evening, same house, ten seconds later in narrative time.
E-HS3 Ten years, and not one rebuke	L01 — the «آج کا سبق» candidate, or L10's closing	Self-contained, ṣaḥīḥ, and needs no map.
E-HS4 «I find the scent of Paradise»	L01 if أحد is touched at all; otherwise L02 , as the <i>first</i> card of the household thread, told before حديقة الموت	This is the card that makes E-HS16 land. If only one household card can be told before session 2's ردة block, it is this one.
E-HS5 Known by his fingertips	Immediately after E-HS4 , same slide-pair	It is the second half of the same ṣaḥīḥ report. Never separate them by more than a minute.
E-HS6 «What will you do with life after him?»	L02 , beside the wafāt/آل عمران ١٤٢ material in wafat-and-medina-11h.md	The verse أبو بكر recites in ١١٥ is the verse البداية ج ٤ attaches to this very moment at أحد. Two crises, one verse — a real, page-cited echo.
E-HS7 The dagger at Ḥunayn	L01 or L02 , wherever أم سليم رضى is introduced	Short, memorable, and it is the card that stops the household being heard as a domestic story.
E-HS8 The water-carriers at Uḥud	L01 , with E-HS4/E-HS5	Same day, same field; also introduces أبو طلحة رضى as a fighter before he is needed as a husband.
E-HS9 «It was a loan»	L01 — strong «آج کا سبق» candidate; or a later session on ṣabr	The single most-retold story of the household. Its value here is that we now have the <i>page</i> version and the popular version side by side.
E-HS10 Bayruḥā'	L01 , or park for a later session	Excellent, but not load-bearing for the ردة narrative.
E-HS11 «I have won»	L01 if بئر معونة is touched; otherwise L02 , as the pair to E-HS12	Must be told before E-HS12, which depends on it.
E-HS12 The reason the Prophet ﷺ came to that house	Immediately after E-HS11	Meaningless without it; devastating with it.

Card	Sits beside	Why
E-HS13 Umm Ḥarām and the sea	L02 if the frontier at ٢٣ هـ is drawn, else L03 (٢٣-٤٠ هـ, عثمان ^{رض})	Its map value is that it is the first point across water — the natural bridge from the Rāshidūn land frontier to the Mediterranean. It also pairs with nahawand-the-shura-and-the-death-of-umar.md on what عمر ^{رض} refused and عثمان ^{رض} allowed.
E-HS14 «Do not put al-Barā' over an army»	L02 , in the عمر ^{رض} / state-building block, beside umar-the-state-diwan-calendar-and-the-two-trials.md	It is an administration card wearing a battlefield costume — exactly the register the عمر ^{رض} block needs.
E-HS15 «Do you see me dying in my bed?»	L02 , immediately before E-HS16	Sets up the wall: he had already told his brother he would not die in bed.
E-HS16 Over the wall at Ḥadīqat al-Mawt	L02 — directly beside the existing حديقة الموت card (RCT/E-RC20)	This is the whole point of the strand. The existing card carries the <i>event</i> ; this one carries the <i>family sentence</i> . They should be one beat, not two.
E-HS17 The oath at Tustar	L02 , in the ١٧-٢٠ هـ Persian-frontier block (with qadisiyya-madain-and-the-embassy.md)	Closes البراء ^{رض} 's story at تُسْتَر, on the same map, moving eastward. (Give no interval in years: the garden is ١٢ هـ, but تُسْتَر is narrated under both ١٧ هـ and ٢٠.5 هـ — هـ.)
E-HS18 The dawn prayer at Tustar	Immediately after E-HS17	Puts the servant-boy of L01 at his brother's death, and closes the household loop in one line.
E-HS19 «Equip me»	L03 (٢٣-٤٠ هـ), in the عثمان ^{رض} block	He dies under عثمان ^{رض} ; and his sea voyage sits naturally next to E-HS13's Cyprus expedition, which is the same caliphate and the same water.

If only three of these can be told in the whole course: E-HS4 + E-HS5 (Uḥūd, the uncle), then E-HS16 (the wall, the nephew, with the family sentence). The room meets a family in session 1 and recognises it in session 2 — which is what this strand was commissioned to make possible.

The people: سالم^{رض} and أبو حذيفة^{رض}

Source note: [abu-hudhayfa-and-salim-mawla-abi-hudhayfa.md](#) — read it for the pages behind these cards.

AHA/E-AS01 · The ship they hired for half a dinar

Tier: GOOD · **When:** 0 years after the beginning of revelation [SOURCED] (ابن كثير^{رض} ص ٢٨١, ج ٣) reporting the البداية · **Map:** Mecca → the Red Sea coast → **Abyssinia**. The first arrow that ever leaves Arabia.

What happened: The persecution in Mecca got past bearing. A small party left for Abyssinia, because the Prophet ﷺ had told them there was a king there under whom no one was wronged. Eleven men and four women went down to the sea, some walking and some riding. They hired a ship for half a dinar. On it were

‘Uthmān ^{رضي} and his wife Ruqayya ^{رضي}, the Prophet’s ^ﷺ daughter — and Abū Ḥudhayfa b. ‘Utba ^{رضي} and his wife Sahla ^{رضي}, the daughter of Suhayl b. ‘Amr ^{رضي}.

The statement:

فاستأجروا سفينةً بنصف دينار إلى الحبشة، وهم عثمان بن عفان، وامراته رُقَيَّة بنت رسول الله ^ﷺ، وأبو حُذَيْفَةَ بن ^{رضي} <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1255> English: "So they hired a ship for half a dinar to Abyssinia. They were: ‘Uthmān b. ‘Affān and his wife Ruqayya, daughter of the Messenger of Allah ^ﷺ; and Abū Ḥudhayfa b. ‘Utba and his wife Sahla bt. Suhayl..."

عبرت: The first thing this ummah did when it could not stay was to pool a fare and leave together.

Hands-up? no

AHA/E-AS02 · The son of the elder of the Jāhiliyya

Tier: CORE · **When:** before دار الأرقم [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a. One line of text, large.

What happened: Abū Ḥudhayfa ^{رضي} was the son of ‘Utba b. Rabi‘a — one of the great men of Quraysh before Islam. Al-Dhahabī رحمه الله, opening his notice, does not soften the position at all. In one sentence he calls him a martyr, calls his father the elder of the Jāhiliyya, and calls him a man of Badr. He had accepted Islam before the Companions were even meeting in the house of al-Arqam.

The statement:

السَّيِّدُ الْكَبِيرُ، الشَّهِيدُ، أَبُو حُذَيْفَةَ ابْنُ شَيْخِ الْجَاهِلِيَّةِ: عُنْبَةَ بن رِبْعَةَ ... الْقُرَشِيُّ، الْعَبْشَمِيُّ، الْبَذْرِيُّ — سير أعلام النبلاء ^{رحمه الله} · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1590> English: "The great chief, the martyr, Abū Ḥudhayfa — son of the elder of the Jāhiliyya, ‘Utba b. Rabi‘a — al-Qurashī, al-‘Abshamī, the man of Badr."

عبرت: A man's descent is recorded honestly, and it is not what he is judged by.

Hands-up? Before it: "Who here has a relative who did not agree with the biggest decision they ever made?" — then leave the hands up for one beat and move on. Do not develop it.

AHA/E-AS03 · Badr — the father and the brother

Tier: CORE · **When:** ٢ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** بدر, the first battle marker on the line.

What happened: Badr opened with single combat. Quraysh called for their equals to come out. The Prophet ^ﷺ sent ‘Ubayda b. al-Ḥārith ^{رضي}, Ḥamza ^{رضي} and ‘Alī ^{رضي}. Against them came ‘Utba b. Rabi‘a, his brother Shayba, and ‘Utba's son al-Walīd. All three of the Meccans were killed. ‘Utba was the father of Abū Ḥudhayfa ^{رضي}, and al-Walīd was his brother — and Abū Ḥudhayfa ^{رضي} was standing with the Muslims.

The statement:

· فبارز عبدة، وكان أسنّ القوم، عتبة، وبارز حمزة شيبه، وبارز عليّ الوليد بن عتبة — البدايه والنهايه ج ٤ ص ٦٠ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1549> English: "‘Ubayda — and he was the oldest of them — faced ‘Utba; Ḥamza faced Shayba; and ‘Alī faced al-Walīd b. ‘Utba."

عبرت: He was not asked to stop being his father's son. He was asked which side of the field to stand on, and he answered that question only.

Hands-up? no

AHA/E-AS04 · The face the Prophet ﷺ noticed at the well

Tier: CORE · **When:** ٢ هـ, after بدر [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a — the same بدر marker.

What happened: After the battle the dead of Quraysh were put into the well. 'Utba b. Rabī'a was taken and dragged to it. The Prophet ﷺ looked at the face of his son, and saw it had gone pale. So he asked him whether something had entered him about his father. The answer was not a denial of grief. He said he had never doubted his father's fate, but that he had known a judgement and a forbearance in the man and had hoped it would bring him to Islam — and it had not. The Prophet ﷺ prayed for him, and spoke kindly to him.

The statement:

لما سحب عتبة بن ربيعة إلى القليب نظر رسول الله ﷺ في وجه أبي حذيفة ابنه، فإذا هو كئيب متغير. فقال: "لعلك قد دخلك من شأن أبيك شيء؟". قال: لا والله ما شككت في أبي ولا في مصرعه، ولكنني كنت أعرف منه رأيا وحلما، فكنت أرجو أن يسلم، فلما رأيت ما أصابه وما مات عليه أحزنني ذلك. فدعا له النبي ﷺ وقال له خيرا — سير أعلام
 https://shamela.ws/book/10906/449 English: "When 'Utba b. Rabī'a was dragged to the well, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ looked into the face of his son Abū Ḥudhayfa, and there he was, downcast and changed. He said: 'Perhaps something has entered you about the matter of your father?' He said: No, by Allah, I have not doubted my father nor where he fell. But I knew in him a judgement and a forbearance, and I used to hope he would accept Islam; and when I saw what befell him and what he died upon, that grieved me. So the Prophet ﷺ prayed for him and spoke kindly to him."

عبرت: He was not told that grief was a fault, and he did not pretend he had none.

Hands-up? no

AHA/E-AS05 · The sentence he was afraid of for ten years — △ SPEAKER'S DISCRETION

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ٢ هـ, and answered ١٢ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a.

What happened: Before the fighting at Badr, the Prophet ﷺ named men who had been brought out against their will and were not to be killed. Al-'Abbās, his own uncle, was among them. Abū Ḥudhayfa objected out loud: were they to kill their own fathers and sons and brothers and leave al-'Abbās? Word of it reached the Prophet ﷺ. Abū Ḥudhayfa never forgave himself for it. He said afterwards that he would not stop fearing that word unless martyrdom wiped it away. Three separate books record the sentence, and all three end it in the same place: and he was killed a martyr at al-Yamāma.

The statement:

ما أنا بآمن من تلك الكلمة التي قُلْتُ يومئذٍ، ولا أزالُ منها خائفاً إلا أن تُكفِّرَها عَنِّي الشهادةُ، فُقُتِلَ يومَ اليمامة شهيداً
 https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1566 English: "I am not safe from that word I said that day; I shall not stop fearing it unless martyrdom wipes it away from me. And he was killed a martyr on the day of al-Yamāma."

عبرت: He treated one sentence spoken in anger as a debt, and he carried it for ten years.

Hands-up? no

⚠ **Discretion note.** The same page carries عمر's heated reply. **It is not to be read out, put on a slide, or volunteered.** Tell only Abū Ḥudhayfa's own words about himself. See §3.2.

AHA/E-AS06 · From Iṣṭakhr to the banner of the Muhājirūn

Tier: CORE · **When:** before the hijra [SOURCED] · **Map:** a faint line from إصطخر (Fārs) to المدينة — the only line on the map that comes *into* Arabia.

What happened: Sālim was a slave. His origin was Iṣṭakhr, in Persia. The woman of Abū Ḥudhayfa's household freed him, and Abū Ḥudhayfa took him as his own — adopted him outright. Al-Dhahabī رحمه الله opens his notice on him with four descriptions in a row, and not one of them is about where he came from.

The statement:

· مِنَ السَّابِقِينَ الْأَوَّلِينَ، الْبَذَرِيِّينَ، الْمُقَرَّبِينَ، الْغَالِمِينَ ... أَصْلُهُ مِنْ إِصْطَخْر — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ١٦٧
<https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1593> English: "Of the first forerunners, of the men of Badr, of those brought near, of the learned ... his origin is from Iṣṭakhr."

عبرت: The books record where he came from in four words and what he became in four titles.

Hands-up? Before it: "Where do you think the man who led the Muhājirūn in prayer came from?"

AHA/E-AS07 · The imām at Qubā'

Tier: CORE · **When:** before the Prophet ﷺ reached Medina [SOURCED] · **Map:** قُبَاء, just outside Medina — the first pin on the Medina inset.

What happened: The Muhājirūn reached Medina before the Prophet ﷺ did. They camped at al-‘Uṣba, beside Qubā', and they had to pray. Someone had to lead. They put forward a freed slave, because he had more of the Qur'ān than any of them. Among the men praying behind him was ‘Umar b. al-Khaṭṭāb.

The statement:

أَنَّ الْمُهَاجِرِينَ نَزَلُوا بِالْغُصْبَةِ إِلَى جَنْبِ قُبَاءَ، فَأَمَّهُمْ سَالِمٌ مَوْلَى أَبِي حَذِيقَةَ، لِأَنَّهُ كَانَ [ص ١٦٩] أَكْثَرَهُمْ قُرْآنًا، فِيهِمْ عُمَرُ، وَ https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1594 وَأَبُو سَلَمَةَ بْنُ عَبْدِ الْأَسَدِ — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ١٦٨-١٦٩
<https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1595> English: "The Muhājirūn camped at al-‘Uṣba beside Qubā', and Sālim, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa, led them in prayer, because he had the most Qur'ān of them — among them ‘Umar and Abū Salama b. ‘Abd al-Asad."

عبرت: The first thing the Muhājirūn did on arriving was to put the best reciter in front, whoever he was.

Hands-up? no

AHA/E-AS08 · The night the Prophet ﷺ took his cloak and went out to listen

Tier: CORE · **When:** Medina [SOURCED] — إسناده جيد · **Map:** n/a.

What happened: One night ‘Ā’isha ^{رضي} came in late. The Prophet ﷺ asked her what had kept her. She said there was a voice reciting in the mosque, finer than any she had heard. He took his cloak and went out to listen. It was Sālim ^{رضي}, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa. Al-Dhahabī رحمه الله records the chain of this one and marks it good.

The statement:

فَأَخَذَ رِدَاءَهُ، وَخَرَجَ يَسْمَعُهُ، فَإِذَا هُوَ سَالِمٌ مَوْلَى أَبِي خُذَيْفَةَ. فَقَالَ: (الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ الَّذِي جَعَلَ فِي أُمَّتِي مِثْلَكَ) — سير
 ١٦٨ · أعلام النبلاء ج١ ص١٦٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1594> English: "So he took his cloak and went out to listen to him — and it was Sālim, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa. And he said: 'Praise be to Allah, who has put the like of you in my ummah.'"

عبرت: He was praised for what he carried, and the praise is recorded in the words the Prophet ﷺ used.

Hands-up? no

AHA/E-AS09 · Take the Qur’ān from four

Tier: CORE · **When:** the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a.

What happened: Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله, writing Sālim's ^{رضي} death notice, gives the reason the ummah remembered him. He was one of four men the Prophet ﷺ named when he told the Companions from whom to take the Qur’ān. One of the four was a freed slave of the house of Abū Ḥudhayfa ^{رضي}.

The statement:

وهو أحد الأربعة الذين قال فيهم رسول الله ﷺ: "استقرئوا القرآن من أربعة" فذكر منهم سالمًا مولى أبي حذيفة —
 ٥٠ · البدايه والنهائيه ج٧ ص٥٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3196> English: "And he is one of the four of whom the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: 'Take the Qur’ān from four' — and he mentioned Sālim, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa, among them."

عبرت: Standing in this matter was decided by what a man carried, and by nothing else about him.

Hands-up? no

⚠ **Slide rule:** Ibn Kathīr's own text quotes only the opening clause. If the four names go on screen they must be captioned to ٢٤٦٤ صحيح مسلم as given in the editor's note on ٥٠ · البدايه ج٧ ص٥٠ — **never to ابن كثير**. See §5.3.

AHA/E-AS10 · The adoption undone, and the household that kept him anyway — ⚠
 SPEAKER'S DISCRETION

Tier: GOOD · **When:** Medina, after ٥ الأحزاب was revealed [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a.

What happened: Abū Ḥudhayfa ^{رضي} had adopted Sālim ^{رضي}, and had married him to his own niece — Fāṭima, the daughter of his brother al-Walīd, the brother who had been killed at Badr on the other side. Then the verse came down: *call them by their fathers*. Adoption was no longer a legal fact, and Sālim ^{رضي} was no longer a son of the house in law. The household did not put him out. It kept him by every other means it had.

The statement:

وقد تبناه أبو حذيفة وزوجه بانية أخيه فاطمة بنت الوليد بن عتبة، فلما أنزل الله (ادْعُوهُمْ لِآبَائِهِمْ) — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٥٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3196> English: "Abū Ḥudhayfa had adopted him and married him to his brother's daughter, Fāṭima bt. al-Walīd b. 'Utba. Then Allah sent down: (Call them by their fathers)."

عبرت: A ruling changed what he could be called, and it did not change what the household did for him.

Hands-up? no

⚠ **Discretion note.** The same page continues into the رخصة report, which is a live فقهى question. **Do not go past the verse.** If a written slip asks, use §6.3 and stop: it is in صحيح مسلم; the Prophet's ﷺ wives held it a dispensation for Sālim in particular; الذهبي records the majority of the scholars taking it that way; the ruling is a matter for the فقهاء.

AHA/E-AS11 · "A wretched bearer of the Qur'ān I should be"

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢ هـ, at الإمامة [SOURCED] · **Map:** عَقْرَبَاء, the Muhājirūn's banner marker.

What happened: At al-Yamāma the Muslim line had already broken once. Sālim was holding the banner of the Muhājirūn — a banner the man before him had been killed carrying. The men around him asked him plainly whether he was afraid the line would be broken from his side. His answer was one sentence, and it is recorded in the same words by two separate books.

The statement:

وقال المهاجرون لسالم مولى أبي حذيفة: أتخشى أن نؤتى من قبلك؟ فقال: بئس حامل القرآن أنا إذا — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٣٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3180> English: "The Muhājirūn said to Sālim, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa: Do you fear we shall be broken from your side? He said: A wretched bearer of the Qur'ān I should be, then."

عبرت: He answered a question about his courage by naming what he carried.

Hands-up? no

AHA/E-AS12 · "Adorn the Qur'ān with deeds"

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢ هـ, at الإمامة [SOURCED] · **Map:** عَقْرَبَاء, the Muhājirūn's wing.

What happened: On the same field, in the same hour, Abū Ḥudhayfa was calling out to the men around him. He did not call them by tribe and he did not call them by clan. He called them the people of the Qur'ān, and told them what to do about it. Then he charged, drove the enemy back, and was struck down.

The statement:

وقال أبو حذيفة: يا أهل القرآن زينوا القرآن بالفعال، وحمل فيهم حتى أبعدهم وأصيب □ — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٣٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3180> English: "Abū Ḥudhayfa said: People of the Qur'ān — adorn the Qur'ān with deeds. And he charged into them until he drove them back, and he was struck down."

عبرت: The last thing he asked of anyone was that what they recited and what they did should match.

Hands-up? no

AHA/E-AS13 · The banner nobody would leave on the ground

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٢ هـ, at اليمامة [SOURCED] · **Map:** عَقْرَبَاء — one marker, three hands.

What happened: Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb — the elder brother of ‘Umar — carried the banner forward into the enemy until he was killed. The banner fell. Sālim picked it up. Al-Dhahabī رحمه الله records it in one sentence in Zayd's own notice, and Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله records it twice, in two separate death notices on consecutive pages (ج ٧ ص ٥٠ and ج ٧ ص ٢٩٨).

The statement:

وَكَاثَتْ رَايَةُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ مَعَهُ يَوْمَ الْيَمَامَةِ، فَلَمْ يَزَلْ يَقْدُمُ بِهَا فِي تَحْرِ الْعَدُوِّ، ثُمَّ قَاتَلَ حَتَّى قُتِلَ، فَوَقَعَتِ الرَّايَةُ، فَأَخَذَهَا سَالِمٌ مَوْلَى أَبِي حَذِيفَةَ — سِير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٢٩٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1724> English: "The Muslims' banner was with him on the day of al-Yamāma, and he kept pressing forward with it into the enemy's throat, and then fought until he was killed. The banner fell — and Sālim, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa, took it up."

عبرت: Every man who took it knew what had happened to the man before him.

Hands-up? no

△ Three books give three different banner arrangements at al-Yamāma. **Do not draw a diagram** — say only that the banner changed hands because the man holding it was killed.

AHA/E-AS14 · Two men who dug a pit and did not come out of it

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٢ هـ, at اليمامة [SOURCED] · **Map:** عَقْرَبَاء, the point where the line stopped moving.

What happened: Banū Ḥanīfa had driven the Muslims back three times. Thābit b. Qays and Sālim said the same thing to each other: this is not how we used to fight alongside the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. So they dug a pit, stood in it, and fought from there. Neither came out.

The statement:

فَقَالَ ثَابِتٌ وَسَالِمٌ مَوْلَى أَبِي حَذِيفَةَ: مَا هَكَذَا كُنَّا نَقَاتِلُ مَعَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ، فَجَعَلَا لَأَنْفُسِهِمَا حَفْرَةً فَدَخَلَا فِيهَا فَقَاتَلَا حَتَّى قُتِلَا — سِير ج ١ ص ٣١١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3194> English: "Thābit and Sālim, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa, said: This is not how we used to fight alongside the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. And the two of them made a pit for themselves and went down into it and fought until they were killed."

عبرت: They fixed the line by taking away their own ability to move back from it.

Hands-up? no

△ The Bukhārī-anchored version of these words (البخاري ٢٨٤٥, via سِير ج ١ ص ٣١١) belongs to ثابت بن قيس. Attribute accordingly; see §7.4(a) and RCT E-RC18.

AHA/E-AS15 · The hand, and the verse

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢ هـ, at الإمامة [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a — hold on the عَفْرَاء marker.

What happened: Sālim ^{رضي} was holding the banner when his right hand was severed. He took the banner in his left. That hand was cut too. So he clasped the banner to his chest, and he recited. The verse he recited was the one Abū Bakr ^{رضي} had recited to the people of Medina the day the Prophet ﷺ died, the year before: *Muhammad is no more than a Messenger; messengers have passed away before him*. Then he recited the verse that follows it: *and how many a prophet fought, and with him many devoted men*.

The statement:

انقطعت يده اليمنى فأخذها بيساره، ففقطعت فاحتضنها وهو يقول: (وَمَا مُحَمَّدٌ إِلَّا رَسُولٌ قَدْ خَلَتْ مِنْ قَبْلِهِ الرُّسُلُ) · [آل عمران: ١٤٤] (وَكَايَ مَنْ نَبِيٍّ قَاتَلَ مَعَهُ رِيثُونَ كَثِيرٌ) [آل عمران: ١٤٦] — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٥٠
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3196> English: "His right hand was severed, so he took the banner in his left; that was cut off, so he clasped it to his chest, saying: (Muhammad is no more than a Messenger; messengers have passed away before him) (And how many a prophet fought, and with him many devoted men)."

عبرت: The verse that steadied Medina in the year eleven is the verse a man recited on the ground in the year twelve.

Hands-up? Before it: "Does anyone remember the āya Abū Bakr ^{رضي} read out the day the Prophet ﷺ died?" — then let the slide answer.

AHA/E-AS16 · "Lay me down between them"

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢ هـ, at الإمامة [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a.

What happened: Struck down, Sālim ^{رضي} asked the men near him a question. What had become of Abū Ḥudhayfa? They told him he had been killed. He asked about one other man. They told him he was dead too. Then he asked them for one thing, and it was the last thing he asked for.

The statement:

فلما صرع قال لأصحابه: ما فعل أبو حذيفة؟ قالوا: قُتِلَ، قال: فما فعل فلان؟ قالوا: قُتِلَ، قال: فأضجعوني بينهما — https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3196 English: "When he was struck down he said to his companions: What has become of Abū Ḥudhayfa? They said: He has been killed. He said: And what has become of so-and-so? They said: He has been killed. He said: Then lay me down between the two of them."

عبرت: The freed slave's last request was to be put back beside the household that had taken him in.

Hands-up? no

△ The second man is «فلان» in the source. **Do not name him**. And no approved source says they were buried in one grave — see §10.3.

AHA/E-AS17 · How they were found

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٢ هـ, after الإمامة [SOURCED] — reported by الذبيبي as «وقيل» · **Map:** n/a.

What happened: In his notice on Sālim ^{رضي}, al-Dhahabī رحمه الله gives a report he introduces with the word *it is said* — which is his way of passing something on without vouching for it. And elsewhere, in the roll of the day's martyrs (سير ج ١ ص ٢٩٨), he lists the two of them first, and in that order: Abū Ḥudhayfa b. 'Utba al-'Abshamī, and his freedman Sālim, one of the reciters.

The statement:

وَقِيلَ: إِنَّ سَالِمًا وَجِدَ هُوَ وَمَوْلَاهُ أَبُو خَذِيفَةَ، رَأْسُ أَحَدِهِمَا عِنْدَ رِجْلَيِ الْآخَرِ صَرَّيْعَيْنِ - رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا - — سير أعلام
١٦٩ ج ١ ص ١٦٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1595> English: "And it is said: Sālim was found, he and his patron Abū Ḥudhayfa, the head of one of them at the feet of the other, both struck down ^{رضي}."

عبرت: The books that list the dead of that day put the master and the freedman on one line.

Hands-up? no

△ Carry «وقيل» across into the delivery: "*it is said that...*", not "*they were found*".

AHA/E-AS18 · "Had Sālim been alive"

Tier: CORE · **When:** ٢٣ هـ, Medina [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a — the timeline jumps forward eleven years and comes back.

What happened: Eleven years after al-Yamāma, 'Umar ^{رضي} was dying of the assassin's wound, and the question of who would follow him would not wait. He refused to name one man and set up a council of six instead. And it is related that he said that had Sālim ^{رضي} been alive, he would not have made it a council at all. Ibn 'Abd al-Barr رحمه الله explains what that means: he would have gone by Sālim's ^{رضي} judgement about whom to appoint.

The statement:

· وروي عن عمر أنه قال لما احتضر: لو كان سالم حياً لما جعلتها شورى — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٥٠
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3196> English: "And it is related of 'Umar that he said, when death was upon him: Had Sālim been alive I would not have made it a shūrā."

عبرت: Eleven years later, the man the Commander of the Faithful wished were still in the room was a freed slave who had died holding a banner.

Hands-up? no

△ Say "**it is related that...**" — Ibn Kathīr's own passive. A second, differently worded report in سير ج ١ ص ١٧٠ names **both** سالم ^{رضي} and أبو عبيدة ^{رضي}, and **الذبي** **weakens its chain on the page**. Do not merge the two.

AHA/E-AS19 · The inheritance that was sent back

Tier: GOOD · **When:** after ١٢ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a.

What happened: Sālim ^{رضي} died leaving property and no heir of his own. Under the law of walā' it went to the woman who had freed him, so 'Umar ^{رضي} sent it to her. She sent it back. Her reason was that she had freed him outright — sā'iba — and had never freed him expecting a return. 'Umar ^{رضي} put the estate into the treasury instead.

The statement:

وقد بعث عمرٌ بميراثه إلى مولاته التي أعتقته «بثينة» فردته وقالت: إنما أعتقته سائبةً، فجعله عمر في بيت المال — البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٥٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3196> English: "Umar sent his inheritance to the woman who had freed him, Buthayna; and she sent it back and said: I freed him only as sā'iba. So 'Umar put it into the treasury."

(△ The name «بثينة» appears in the printed text here and «سُبَيْتَة» a few lines above it on the same page.

Do not read the name aloud — say "the woman who had freed him". See §4.2.)

عبرت: She had a legal claim on what he left, and she said she had not freed him in order to have one.

Hands-up? no

△ ١٦٩ ص ١ سير ج ١ tells the same estate differently (sold for 200 dirhams and given to «أمه»). **Tell one version only, captioned to** البدايه ج ٧ ص ٥٠. See §7.6.

WHERE EACH CARD BELONGS

RCT = docs/research/ridda-campaign-the-conduct-of-the-wars.md card pool · WFT = docs/research/wafat-and-medina-11h.md · SHU = docs/research/suhayl-ibn-amr.md · SHU cards sit in session 2's Mecca block.

Card	Sits beside	Session	Why there
E-AS01 The half-dinar ship	— (session 1 backstory, or cut)	1, if the orientation evening wants one pre-hijra beat	It is the only card here that is not ١١-١٢ هـ. Most likely CUT from session 2 — it does not earn its 90 seconds against the rest
E-AS02 Son of the elder of the Jāhiliyya	opens the pairing	2	The set-up card. Nothing else works until the room knows whose son he was
E-AS03 Badr — the father and the brother	immediately after E-AS02	2	One slide; the map shows بدر once and does not come back to it
E-AS04 The face at the well	immediately after E-AS03	2	The pay-off of the Badr pair, and the humane note. If only one Badr card survives, keep this one
E-AS05 The sentence he feared	after E-AS04 — △ discretion	2	It is the card that reaches forward to al-Yamāma. Cut it before cutting E-AS04
E-AS06 From Iṣṭakhr	opens the Sālim ١٥ half	2	Must precede E-AS07 or the Qubā' card has no force
E-AS07 The imām at Qubā'	after E-AS06 · pairs naturally with RCT/E-	2	Same theme: what the ummah lost when the reciters died

Card	Sits beside	Session	Why there
	RC37 (the Qur'ān was collected because of this)		
E-AS08 The night he was listened to	after E-AS07	2	Already used inside RCT §6.5 — avoid telling it twice in one evening ; give it here and drop it from the al-Yamāma block
E-AS09 Take the Qur'ān from four	after E-AS08 · directly before RCT/E-RC37	2	It is the single sentence that makes E-RC37 land
E-AS10 The adoption undone	⚠ discretion — after E-AS06 if used at all	2	The household card. Recommended: hold in reserve, do not script
E-AS11 "A wretched bearer of the Qur'ān"	beside RCT/E-RC18 (Thābitؓ and the shroud) and before RCT/E-RC19 («امتازوا»)	2	Same phase of the battle, same register
E-AS12 "Adorn the Qur'ān with deeds"	immediately after E-AS11	2	The two must be told as a pair or the point is lost
E-AS13 The banner nobody would leave	beside RCT/E-RC23 (Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭābؓ)	2	It is the same moment told from the other man's side
E-AS14 The pit	beside RCT/E-RC18	2	Same act, same words; tell them together or tell only E-RC18
E-AS15 The hand and the verse	after E-AS12, before RCT/E-RC20 (حديث الموت)	2	It reaches back to WFT and Abū Bakr'sؓ khuṭba — the strongest single link in the evening
E-AS16 "Lay me down between them"	immediately after RCT/E-RC20 , as the field goes quiet	2	It is the closing beat of the battle block. Nothing should follow it except E-AS17
E-AS17 How they were found	immediately after E-AS16	2	Two sentences, then stop
E-AS18 "Had Sālim been alive"	beside RCT/E-RC38 or, better, held for the شوری block near nahawand...md E-U18	2, late	It is the card that shows the cost of ١٢٥ still being counted in ٢٣٥. Best placed at the very end of the evening
E-AS19 The inheritance sent back	after E-AS17, if time	2	GOOD, not CORE. First to cut

If the evening can carry only five of these, the five are **E-AS02 → E-AS04 → E-AS07 → E-AS11+E-AS12 (as one) → E-AS16**, and they tell the whole household in about six minutes: whose son he was, what the Prophet ﷺ asked him at the well, who the freedman was and why they put him in front, what each of them called out on the last field, and what the freedman asked for at the end.

And the connection to **suhayl-ibn-amr.md** is free and should be taken. سهيلة, the wife of أبو حذيفة, is the daughter of (سير ج ١ ص ١٦٥) سهيل بن عمرو. **The man who held Mecca in ١١٥ was this household's father-in-law.** One sentence, no extra research, and it stitches the Mecca block of session 2 to the al-Yamāma block.

The people: زيد بن الخطاب and the dead of اليمامة

Source note: [zayd-ibn-al-khattab-and-the-dead-of-yamama.md](#) — read it for the pages behind these cards.

ZIA/E-ZY1 · The brother who went first

Tier: CORE · **When:** بدر, ٥٢ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a. Hold on the timeline strip; put a mark at بدر and a second mark at اليمامة, ten years apart. **What happened:** ‘Umar رضى had an elder brother. His name was Zayd, and he accepted Islam before ‘Umar did. At Badr, ‘Umar رضى offered him his own coat of mail to wear. Zayd رضى would not take it. He told his younger brother that he wanted from martyrdom exactly what his brother wanted. So neither of them wore it, and both of them fought without it. **The statement:**

وَلَقَدْ قَالَ لَهُ عُمَرُ يَوْمَ بَدْرٍ: أَلَيْسَ دِرْعِي. قَالَ: إِنِّي أُرِيدُ مِنَ الشَّهَادَةِ مَا تُرِيدُ. قَالَ: فَتَرَكَا جَمِيعًا. — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٢٩٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1724> English: "‘Umar said to him on the day of Badr: Wear my coat of mail. He said: I want from martyrdom what you want. So they both left it."

عبرت: He would not be protected past the point at which his brother was protected. **Hands-up?** no ⚠ **Do not add anything about their relationship before Islam. Nothing is on the pages (§X.1).**

ZIA/E-ZY2 · The banner, and the vow of silence

Tier: CORE · **When:** اليمامة, ١٢ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** No movement. Hold on غَفْرِيَاء. **What happened:** At al-Yamāma, Zayd رضى was carrying a banner, and the line was going backwards. He told the men to bite down on their back teeth, strike into the enemy and go forward. Then he said that he would not speak again — not one more word — until either Allah routed them, or he met Allah and put his case to Him himself. He went forward with the banner and did not stop going forward. He was killed. The banner fell, and Sālim, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa رضى, picked it up. **The statement:**

وقال زيد بن الخطاب: أيها الناس عَضُّوا عَلَى أَضْرَاسِكُمْ، وَاضْرِبُوا فِي عَدُوِّكُمْ وَامْضُوا قَدَمًا، وَقَالَ: وَاللَّهِ لَا أَتَكَلَّمُ حَتَّى يَهْزِمَهُمُ اللَّهُ أَوْ أَلْقَى اللَّهَ فَأَكْلِمَهُ بِحَجَّتِي، فَقُتِلَ شَهِيدًا □. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٣٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3180> English: "Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb said: People — bite down on your back teeth, strike into your enemy and go forward. And he said: By Allah, I will not speak until Allah routs them, or I meet Allah and speak to Him with my case. And he was killed a martyr."

عبرت: He put a limit on his own speech and none at all on his own advance. **Hands-up?** no ⚠ **Three approved books give three different banner arrangements (§2.4). Say "he carried a banner" and never draw the diagram.** الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢١٧ has a longer wording of the same vow — do not merge them.

ZIA/E-ZY3 · The first man out of their line

Tier: GOOD · **When:** اليمامة, ٢١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a. **What happened:** The first man of Banū Ḥanīfa to reach the Muslim line that day was al-Rajjāl b. 'Unfuwa. He had been a Muslim. He had memorised Sūrat al-Baqara. He had been sent to al-Yamāma as a teacher, and instead he had testified that the Prophet ﷺ had made Musaylima a partner in prophethood — and they believed him. Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb ^{رضي} killed him. **The statement:**

وَكَانَ أَوَّلَ مَنْ لَقِيَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ نَهَارَ الرَّجَالِ بْنُ عُنْفُوَةَ فَقُتِلَ، قَتَلَهُ زَيْدُ بْنُ الْخَطَّابِ. — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ١٦٤
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/907> English: "The first of them to meet the Muslims was Nahār al-Rajjāl b. 'Unfuwa, and he was killed — Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb killed him."

عبرت: The man who had carried the Qur'ān to them was the first thing that had to be stopped. **Hands-up?** no البداية ج ٧ ص ٣٢-٣٣ gives the same, with الرجال's own record set out. ⚠ **Do not use the ḥadīth** attaches to him — its editor marks it «ضعيف جدًا» (ridḍa note §6.7). ⚠ **Do not say who sent him.** No approved page names the sender (§2.6).

ZIA/E-ZY4 · The man who killed him

Tier: CORE · **When:** اليمامة ٢١هـ, and afterwards in المدينة [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a. **What happened:** The man who killed Zayd ^{رضي} was called Abū Maryam al-Ḥanafī. He fought that day on the other side. Afterwards he became a Muslim. And at some point after that he stood in front of 'Umar ^{رضي} — the dead man's younger brother, now the Commander of the Faithful — and said this to him. 'Umar ^{رضي} later appointed him a judge. Ibn Kathīr records a second report naming a different killer, and records that Ibn 'Abd al-Barr preferred it, and then says the second report does not disprove the first. **The statement:**

ثم قَتَلَ زَيْدًا رَجُلَ يَقَالُ لَهُ: أَبُو مَرِيَمَ الْحَنَفِيُّ، وَقَدْ أَسْلَمَ بَعْدَ ذَلِكَ وَقَالَ لِعَمْرٍ: يَا أَمِيرَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ إِنَّ اللَّهَ أَكْرَمَ زَيْدًا بِيَدِي — البداية والنهاية ج ٧ ص ٤٩
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3195> English: "Then Zayd was killed by a man called Abū Maryam al-Ḥanafī, who afterwards became a Muslim and said to 'Umar: Commander of the Faithful — Allah honoured Zayd at my hand, and did not disgrace me at his."

عبرت: He did not ask to be forgiven; he told the brother what he thought Allah had done with both of them. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "The man who killed your brother is standing in front of you, and he is now a Muslim. What is there to say?" ⚠ **The sources record no answer from 'Umar** ^{رضي}. **Do not supply one.** ⚠ Give Ibn Kathīr's own handling of the competing report — it is the "how do we know?" beat of this act (§2.7).

ZIA/E-ZY5 · «He outstripped me to the two good things»

Tier: CORE · **When:** المدينة ١٢هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a. **What happened:** The news came back to Medina. What 'Umar ^{رضي} said when he heard it was not about the battle. It was a count of two things, and he had come second in both of them. **The statement:**

وقد قال عمر لما بلغه مقتلُ زيد بن الخطاب: سبقني إلى الحُسْنَيْنِ، أسلمَ قبلي، واستشهد قبلي. — البداية والنهاية ج ٧ ص ٤٩
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3195> English: "When the killing of Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb reached 'Umar he said: He outstripped me to the two good things — he accepted Islam before me, and he was martyred before me."

عبرت: The measure he used on his own brother was the one he used on himself. **Hands-up?** no ٢٩٨ سير ج١ carries the second half as something he repeated: «وَحَزَنَ عَلَيْهِ عُمَرُ، وَكَانَ يَقُولُ: أَسْلَمَ قَبْلِي، وَاسْتَشْهَدَ قَبْلِي».

ZIA/E-ZY6 · The east wind

Tier: CORE · **When:** the years after ١٢ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a — or, if the map is up, put المدينة east of اليمامة and leave it there. **What happened:** Al-Ṣabā is the east wind. It comes to Medina from the direction of al-Yamāma. ‘Umar ^{رضي} used to say the same thing about it. **The statement:**

· وَكَانَ يَقُولُ: مَا هَبَّتِ الصَّبَا إِلَّا وَأَنَا أَجْدُ رِيحَ زَيْدٍ. — سير أعلام النبلاء ج١ ص٢٩٨

<https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1724> English: "He used to say: The east wind never blows but I find in it the scent of Zayd."

عبرت: The Companions' grief is recorded as carefully as their victories, and by the same men. **Hands-up?** no ٥٠ ص٧ **has a different wording** — «ما هبتِ الصَّبَا إِلَّا دَكَّرْتَنِي زَيْدَ بْنِ الْخَطَّابِ». **Caption whichever is used; do not print the سير words under an Ibn Kathīr caption.** The remark that the wind came from the direction of al-Yamāma is the speaker's own — **the books do not say it.**

ZIA/E-ZY7 · The poet, and the consolation

Tier: GOOD · **When:** المدينة, after ١٢ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a. **What happened:** Mutammim b. Nuwayra was a poet of Banū Tamīm who had lost his brother in the same war, and he made an elegy for him. ‘Umar ^{رضي} told him that if he were any good at poetry he would have said what Mutammim had said. Mutammim answered him. And ‘Umar ^{رضي} said that nobody had ever consoled him like that. **The statement:**

فَقَالَ لَهُ مَتَيْمٌ: لَوْ أَنَّ أَخِي ذَهَبَ عَلَى مَا ذَهَبَ عَلَيْهِ أَخُوكَ مَا حَزَنْتُ عَلَيْهِ، فَقَالَ لَهُ عُمَرُ: مَا عَزَانِي أَحَدٌ بِمِثْلِ مَا عَزَّيْتَنِي — البداية والنهاية ج٧ ص٥٠ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3196> English: "Mutammim said to him: If my brother had gone the way your brother went, I would not have grieved for him. And ‘Umar said to him: No one has ever consoled me with the like of what you have consoled me with."

عبرت: He was consoled not by being told his grief was smaller, but by being told what his brother's death had been. **Hands-up?** no ٢٢٢ **GUARDRAIL. Mutammim is the brother of Mālīk b. Nuwayra. Introduce him only as "a poet of Banū Tamīm who had lost his brother in the same war". Do not narrate al-Biṭāḥ from this card, and do not let this exchange be used as a verdict on it. If a written slip asks, answer from QA_BANK.md and stop.** If Daniyal would rather not carry the risk, **use only ‘Umar's ^{رضي} half of the exchange**, or cut the card and keep E-ZY5 and E-ZY6.

ZIA/E-ZY8 · Two brothers by appointment

Tier: CORE · **When:** مؤاخاة, on the arrival in المدينة [CONVENTIONAL-ESTIMATE] — the approved sources give it no year → اليمامة ١٢ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** Two dots — Mecca and Medina — joined by a line; then the line moved intact to عَقْرَبَاء. **What happened:** When the Muhājirūn arrived in Medina with nothing, the Prophet ﷺ paired each of them with a man of the Anṣār and made the two of them brothers. Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb ^{رضي}, of Quraysh, was paired with Ma‘n b. ‘Adī ^{رضي} of Banū al-‘Ajlān, an ally of the Anṣār. Years later, both of them were on the field at al-Yamāma. Both of them were killed there, on the same day. And they were not the only such pair: Abū Ḥudhayfa ^{رضي} and ‘Abbād b. Bishr ^{رضي} had been paired the same way, and they died there too. **The statement:**

· وقد آخى رسول الله ﷺ بينه وبين معن بن عديّ الأنصاري وقد قُتِلَا جميعًا باليمامة. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٤٩
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3195> English: "The Messenger of Allah ﷺ made him and Ma'n b. 'Adī al-Anṣārī brothers, and the two of them were killed together at al-Yamāma."

عبرت: The tie was made in a year when they owned nothing, and it was still holding on the day they died.

Hands-up? Before telling it: "You are given a brother — not born to you, assigned to you. How long would you expect that to last?" The second pair: البدايه ج ٧ ص ٥٥ — «وآخى رسول الله ﷺ بينه وبين عتّاد بن يشرّ وقد قُتِلَا شهيدين. سير ج ١ ص ٢٩٨ carries the first pairing independently.

ZIA/E-ZY9 · «So that I may confirm him dead»

Tier: CORE · **When:** المدينة ١١هـ → اليمامة ١٢هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a. **What happened:** When the Prophet ﷺ died, the people in Medina wept and said they wished they had died before him, because they were afraid of what would happen to them after him. One man said the opposite. He said he did not want to have died first — he wanted to be alive afterwards, so that he could confirm the Prophet ﷺ dead the same way he had confirmed him alive. His name was Ma'n b. 'Adī. He was one of the two men who met Abū Bakr^{رض} and 'Umar^{رض} on the road to the Saqifa. And in the following year he was killed at al-Yamāma, in the war fought to hold what he had said he would confirm. **The statement:**

· فَقَالَ مَعْنُ: لِكَيْيَ -وَاللّٰهِ- مَا أُحِبُّ أَبِّي مَتَّ قَبْلَهُ حَتَّى أُصَدِّقَهُ مَيِّتًا، كَمَا صَدَّقْتُهُ حَيًّا. — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٣٢١
<https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1747> English: "But I, by Allah, do not wish that I had died before him — so that I may confirm him dead as I confirmed him alive."

عبرت: He did not want to be spared what came next; he wanted to be there for it. **Hands-up?** no **Chain honesty** (§4.2): ٥٤ ص ٧ البدايه gives it with a connected chain through ابن عمر^{رض}; the editor notes that the preserved form is mursal from عروة. Say so if challenged. This card is the bookend for E-ZY8 — tell them together or not at all.

ZIA/E-ZY10 · «Are you not content to live praised?»

Tier: CORE · **When:** المدينة, after the revelation of الحجرات [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a. **What happened:** Thābit b. Qays^{رض} was the orator of the Anṣār and he had a very loud voice. When the verse came down forbidding the believers to raise their voices above the Prophet's ﷺ, he concluded that he was of the people of the Fire, and he shut himself in his house and stopped coming. The Prophet ﷺ noticed he was missing and sent for the reason. When he heard it, he said Thābit was of the people of the Garden. And in another report he told him what would happen to him: that he would live praised, be killed a martyr, and enter the Garden. **The statement:**

· فَقَالَ: (يَا ثَابِتُ! أَمَا تَرْضَى أَنْ تَعِيشَ حَمِيدًا، وَتُقْتَلَ شَهِيدًا، وَتَدْخُلَ الْجَنَّةَ) — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٣١٠
<https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1736> English: "He said: Thābit — are you not content to live praised, to be killed a martyr, and to enter the Garden?"

عبرت: He was told the end of his own life years before it happened, and then he lived as though he believed it. **Hands-up?** no The verse-and-house incident is in صحيح البخاري ٣٦١٣ and صحيح مسلم ١١٩ ج ١ ص ٣١٠ (ed. fn., ٣١٠ ص ٣١١ and ٢٨ ص ٧ البدايه carries both this and the earlier لقمان ١٨ incident in sequence. **Play this card immediately before RCT/E-RC18 — it is what makes the shroud land.**

ZIA/E-ZY11 · The armour in the cooking pot

Tier: CORE · **When:** اليمامة ١٢هـ, and then المدينة [SOURCED] · **Map:** One line drawn from عَفْرَاء back to المدينة. **What happened:** Thābit b. Qays ^{رضي} was killed at al-Yamāma and his coat of mail — a valuable one — was stolen off his body by a Muslim, who hid it. A man of the army then saw Thābit ^{رضي} in a dream. In the dream, Thābit ^{رضي} told him where the mail was: at the far end of the camp, under an upturned cooking pot with a pack-saddle set on top of it. Then he gave him three things to say to the caliph in Medina — a debt he owed, property he had, and a slave of his who was to be freed. And twice he told the man not to dismiss it as a dream and let it go to waste. The man went to Khālid ^{رضي}. The mail was exactly where he had said. And in Medina Abū Bakr ^{رضي} carried out the will of a man who was already dead. **The statement:**

فأنفذ أبو بكر وصيته بعد موته، فلا نعلم أحدًا جازت وصيته بعد موته إلا ثابت بن قيس بن شماس. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٤٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3194> English: "And Abū Bakr executed his will after his death. And we know of no one else whose will was carried through after his death except Thābit b. Qays b. Shammās."

عبرت: The two things he sent back were the same two things: return what was taken, and pay what is owed. **Hands-up?** no **Report the chain the way the books do. Ibn Kathīr says the account has other corroborating reports; his editor notes the daughter in the chain is unknown; and al-Haythamī's line is the one to give aloud:** «هو في الصحيح غير قصة الدرع» — **the rest of the report is in the Ṣaḥīḥ, the episode of the mail is not. Do not build any ruling about dreams on it (§5.5).** The long version, naming Khālid ^{رضي} and the caliph, is ج ١ ص ٣١٣ سير and ج ٧ ص ٤٨ البدايه.

ZIA/E-ZY12 · The arrow he pulled out

Tier: CORE · **When:** اليمامة, ١٢هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** No movement. **What happened:** Abū 'Aqīl ^{رضي} was one of the chiefs of the Anṣār and a man of Badr. At al-Yamāma an arrow hit him. He pulled it out himself. Then he bound himself up, took his sword, and went back to fighting. He fought until he was killed. When they came to him afterwards, they found many wounds on him. **The statement:**

أصابه سهم يوم اليمامة فنزعه، وتحزم وأخذ السيف وقاتل حتى قتل، فوجد به جراحات كثيرة. — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٦ ص ٦٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1208> English: "An arrow struck him on the day of al-Yamāma and he pulled it out, bound himself up, took his sword and fought until he was killed — and many wounds were found on him."

عبرت: Nobody carried him out and nobody was asked to. **Hands-up?** ج ٧ ص ٥٧ البدايه gives the same sentence. **△△ The long famous version of this account — the night wound, the dead arm, the severed arm, the fourteen wounds, "who won?" — is NOT in any approved source (§X.2). Tell only what is above.**

ZIA/E-ZY13 · The son of the head of the hypocrites

Tier: GOOD · **When:** اليمامة, ١٢هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a. **What happened:** 'Abd Allāh b. 'Abd Allāh b. Ubayy ^{رضي} was the son of the man the Qur'ān calls the head of the hypocrites. He was a Muslim, he was at Badr and at everything after it, and the books call him one of the best of the Companions. He was the hardest of all people on his own father. When that father died, the Prophet ﷺ gave his own shirt for the burial and prayed

over him — as an honour to the son. And a few years after that, the son was killed at al-Yamāma. **The statement:**

وكان أبوه رأسَ المنافقين، وكان أشدَّ الناس على أبيه، ولو أذن له رسول الله فيه لضربَ عُنُقَه. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٥٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3199> English: "His father was the head of the hypocrites, and he was the hardest of all people on his father — had the Messenger of Allah ﷺ permitted him, he would have struck his neck."

عبرت: A man is not his father, and the books are careful to record that they were not confused about it.

Hands-up? no **Where he died is disputed:** ٣٢٢ ص ١ سير ج ٧ and ٥٣ ص ٧ البدايه say سير الراشدون; **اليمامة; سير الراشدون** say البدايه ج ٧ ص ٥٣ and سير ج ١ ص ٣٢٢ **records a report that it was** جوائى. Say "in this war" if the field is not needed. **The** سير page prints the verse reference as [التوبة: ٨٩]; **verify against a مصحف before printing any number.**

ZIA/E-ZY14 · Three generations, one morning

Tier: GOOD · **When:** اليمامة, ١٢ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a. **What happened:** Ḥazn al-Makhzūmī was a man of Mecca of Banū Makhzūm, and the grandfather of Sa'īd b. al-Musayyab رحمه الله, one of the great jurists of the next generation. The Prophet ﷺ once wanted to change his name — Ḥazn means rough ground — to Sahl, which means smooth. He refused: he would not change a name his parents had given him. And the report ends: *so the roughness never left us*. At al-Yamāma, Ḥazn was killed. So were two of his sons. So was a grandson. **The statement:**

أراد رسول الله ﷺ أن يسميه سهلاً فامتنع وقال: لا أُغيّر اسماً سمانيه أبوي، فلم تزل الحزونة فينا. استشهد يوم اليمامة. وقتل معه أيضاً ابنه عبد الرحمن ووهب، وابن ابنه حكيم بن وهب بن حزن. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٤٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3195> — the naming report: صحيح البخاري ٦١٩٠ English: "The Messenger of Allah ﷺ wanted to name him Sahl, and he refused, saying: I will not change a name my parents gave me. So the roughness never left us. He was martyred on the day of al-Yamāma; and killed with him also were his two sons 'Abd al-Raḥmān and Wahb, and his grandson Ḥakīm b. Wahb b. Ḥazn."

عبرت: One household sent four men to one field and none of them came back. **Hands-up?** no **سير الراشدون** makes the fourth man a son rather than a grandson. Say: "three men of his own household with him — the sources differ over whether the fourth was his son or his grandson." **The page does not say Sa'īd b. al-Musayyab رحمه الله told the story; «فلم تزل الحزونة فينا» is part of the report as** البدايه prints it. **Do not attribute the telling to him from the platform** — say only that the naming report is in صحيح البخاري ٦١٩٠. **Nothing on the page gives his age. Do not call him old.**

ZIA/E-ZY15 · The mother at al-Yamāma

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢ هـ → ١٣ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** A single line from عَفْرَاءَ to المدينه. **What happened:** Musaylima had a man named Ḥabīb b. Zayd in his hands. He asked him whether he testified that Muḥammad ﷺ was the Messenger of Allah, and Ḥabīb said yes. Then he asked whether he testified that he, Musaylima, was a messenger of Allah — and Ḥabīb said: I do not hear. So he began to cut him apart, one limb at a time, and Ḥabīb never gave him more than that answer, until he died in his hands. Ḥabīb's mother was Umm 'Umāra Nusayba bint Ka'b رضي الله عنها, who had been at al-'Aqaba, at Uḥud, at al-Ḥudaybiya and at Ḥunayn. When the army marched to al-Yamāma, she went with it. Her hand was cut off there. She came back to Medina covered in wounds, and Abū Bakr, while he was caliph, was seen coming to her to ask after her. **The statement:**

فيقول: أتشهد أني رسول الله؟ فيقول: لا أسمع، فجعل يقطّعه عضوًا عضوًا حتى مات في يديه، لا يزيده على ذلك. البدايه والنهيه ج ٣ ص ٢٢٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1402> English: "Then he would say: Do you testify that I am the Messenger of Allah? And he would say: I do not hear. So he began to cut him apart limb by limb until he died in his hands — and he never gave him more than that."

عبرت: He was not asked to say anything; he was asked to hear something, and he would not. **Hands-up?** no The wounds: البدايه ج ٣ ص ٢٢٨ — سير ج ٢ ص ٢٨١ — hand cut off at al-Yamāma and eleven wounds besides. **give one figure with its caption, or say only "covered in wounds"**. سير ج ٢ ص ٢٨٢ names her **other** son 'Abd Allāh b. Zayd as the man who killed Musaylima with his sword — **one of four accounts in the safe list; do not settle it (§9.3).**

ZIA/E-ZY16 · The father at al-Yamāma, the son at al-Yarmūk

Tier: GOOD · **When:** اليمامة ١٢هـ، then اليرموك — whose own year is disputed in the sources (١٣٥١هـ / هـ) [SOURCED] · **Map:** Two marks a long way apart — عَقْرَبَاء in central Najd, and اليرموك on the Syrian frontier. **What happened:** Al-Ṭufayl b. 'Amr al-Dawsī was the man who took Islam back to his own tribe and brought ninety households of Daws to Medina. He went out to al-Yamāma with his son 'Amr. Before the battle he had a dream, and he read it aloud himself: that he would be killed and buried, and that his son would press hard for martyrdom and would not get it that year. Both halves came true. The father was killed at al-Yamāma. The son was killed a few years later, at al-Yarmūk. **The statement:**

فأولها بأنه سيقتل ويدفن، وأن ابنه يحرص على الشهادة فلا ينالها عامه ذلك. وقد وقع الأمر كما أولها، ثم قُتل ابنه أولها بأنه سيقتل ويدفن، وأن ابنه يحرص على الشهادة فلا ينالها عامه ذلك. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٥٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3198> English: "He interpreted it himself: that he would be killed and buried, and that his son would press for martyrdom and not attain it that year. And it happened exactly as he interpreted it — and then his son was killed a martyr on the day of al-Yarmūk."

عبرت: He read his own end aloud before the battle, and then went into it anyway. **Hands-up?** no **Do not read the Arabic of the dream itself aloud and do not render its second image. Say: he dreamed his head was shaved and the earth took him in, and that his son was trying to reach him and could not.** Ibn Kathīr's interpretation is his own text and is safe to give. Corroboration for the son at اليرموك: سير الراشدون «عمرو بن الطفيل بن عمرو بن طريف، قتل باليرموك» — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1258> · ص ١١٣

ZIA/E-ZY17 · The number nobody can give

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢هـ، after the battle [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a — this is the last slide of the al-Yamāma act. **What happened:** After al-Yamāma, Abū Bakr ordered the Qur'ān collected, and the reason the books give is that the killing had run hot among the reciters. That is the phrase all three of them use. What none of them gives is a number. Ibn Kathīr's own summary of the Muslim dead is four hundred and fifty — and he says in the same breath that he is counting bearers of the Qur'ān, Companions and others together in that one figure. So we know why the Qur'ān was collected. We do not know how many reciters died. We only know that it was enough. **The statement:**

وذلك بعد ما استخّر القتل في القراء يوم اليمامة كما ثبت به الحديث في صحيح البخاري. — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٧٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3225> — صحيح البخاري ٤٩٨٦ English: "...and that was after the killing had run hot among the reciters on the day of al-Yamāma, as the ḥadīth in Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī establishes."

عبرت: They did not wait to find out how much had been lost before they secured what was left. **Hands-up?** Before telling it: "*How many men who had the whole Qur'ān by heart died that day? What would you guess?*" — then give the honest answer: the books do not say. **△ This is the card that stops a wrong number being said. The figures the safe list does give run from 58 to more than 1,080 (\$Y), and none of them is a count of reciters. △ Anyone who says "450 reciters" has misread** البداية ج ٧ ص ٥٥.

WHERE EACH CARD BELONGS

Card	Sits beside	Why
E-ZY1 The brother who went first	before RCT/E-RC15 — or in the بدر pegs of session 1	It is a Badr scene. It has to be planted early so that E-ZY5 and E-ZY6 can collect on it later in the same evening
E-ZY2 The banner and the vow	immediately after RCT/E-RC17 (the line breaks), before RCT/E-RC18	It belongs in the rally sequence with أبو حذيفة and سالم , which E-RC18's tail already carries
E-ZY3 The first man out of their line	inside RCT/E-RC17 , as one line	Too small for its own slide; it is the sentence that connects الرجال (already introduced) to زيد
E-ZY4 The man who killed him	after RCT/E-RC22 (the treaty kept)	It is an after-the-battle scene and it belongs with the other "what happened to the enemy afterwards" material
E-ZY5 «سيقني إلى الحسينيين»	merge into RCT/E-RC23 as its opening	E-RC23 currently opens on the biography; this is the stronger opening and it is on a page E-RC23 does not yet cite
E-ZY6 The east wind	RCT/E-RC23 already carries this quotation — replace its body with E-ZY5+E-ZY6 and keep the son's answer as the tail	One card, three sentences of ‘Umar , ending on the wind
E-ZY7 The poet and the consolation	after the reworked RCT/E-RC23 , if time — GOOD, and cuttable	Guardrail card. It is the first thing to drop if the evening is running long
E-ZY8 Two brothers by appointment	new opening for the whole اليمامة act , before RCT/E-RC16	It is the frame the act has been missing: it tells the room to watch for households, and then the act delivers four of them
E-ZY9 «So that I may confirm him dead»	session 1 closing, or session 2 Bookend IN	Ma‘n is already on the road to سقيفة in session 1. Say this line there, and the room recognises the name when he dies in session 2. This

Card	Sits beside	Why
		is the single best use of the bookend mechanism in the whole strand
E-ZY10 «Are you not content to live praised?»	immediately before RCT/E-RC18	E-RC18 is a gesture without it and a fulfilment with it
E-ZY11 The armour in the cooking pot	immediately after RCT/E-RC18	Same man, and it moves the act from the field back to Medina, which is where the act has to end
E-ZY12 The arrow he pulled out	beside RCT/E-RC20 (al-Barāʾ over the wall)	Two men who would not be carried. Al-Barāʾ survived with eighty wounds; Abū ʿAqīl did not survive. Tell them as a pair
E-ZY13 The son of the head of the hypocrites	anywhere in the اليمامة roll block — GOOD	Best used as one of two or three names read out over the roll slide rather than as its own beat
E-ZY14 Three generations, one morning	in the same roll block , right after E-ZY13	Two household cards back to back give the roll its shape
E-ZY15 The mother at al-Yamāma	before RCT/E-RC21 (the death of Musaylima)	Ḥabīb establishes what Musaylima was, in one page-cited scene, so that E-RC21 does not have to assert it. And it puts her on the field before her son's killer is killed
E-ZY16 The father at al-Yamāma, the son at al-Yarmūk	hold for the end of the اليمامة act, or roll forward to the يرموك act	It is the natural hinge from the ردة to the Byzantine frontier — the map moves from Najd to Syria on one family
E-ZY17 The number nobody can give	immediately before the existing جمع القرآن card (CONTENT.md line ~1290)	It is the honesty beat that has to come before the collection is narrated, and it forecloses the wrong number being said from the floor
—	Promote to PEOPLE.md: زيد بن الخطاب · أبو (expanded) · معن بن عدي · ثابت بن قيس عقيّل · عبد الله بن عبد الله بن أبي · حزن · أم — eight notices with a real واقعه each	
—	Promote to TIMELINE.md: ربيع الأول ١٢هـ for زيد بن الخطاب (already there from the ridda	

Card	Sits beside	Why
	note — this note confirms it from سير ج (ص ٢٩٨)	
—	Promote to QA_BANK.md: the مَتمم guardrail (§3.4) · the dream-and-will report and هو في الصحيح غير قصة الدرع» s'الهيثمي (5.5§) · the qurrā' number (§12) — this is the likeliest hostile slip of the evening · the four accounts of who killed مسيلمة (9.3§)	

The people: the men who had fought against it

Source note: *the-men-who-had-fought-against-it.md* — read it for the pages behind these cards.

TMW/E-TRN1 · The order of battle at Uḥud

Tier: CORE · **When:** شوال ٣هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a — this is a picture, not a place. Put the two wings on a diagram. **What happened:** At Uḥud, Quraysh brought three thousand men and two hundred horses. Ibn Ishāq records exactly who led that cavalry. The right wing was under Khālīd b. al-Walīd. The left wing was under 'Ikrima, the son of Abū Jahl. The whole army was commanded by Abū Sufyān b. Ḥarb. Hold those three names. Every one of them is a Muslim commander before this course reaches the year twenty-three. **The statement:**

وَتَعَبَّاتُ قُرَيْشٍ، وَهُمْ ثَلَاثَةُ آلَافٍ، وَمَعَهُمْ مِئَتَا فَرَسٍ قَدْ جَنَّبُوهَا، فَجَعَلُوا عَلَى مِئْمَنَةِ الْخَيْلِ خَالِدَ بْنَ الْوَلِيدِ، وَعَلَى مَيْسَرَتِهَا عِكْرِمَةُ بْنُ أَبِي جَهْلٍ بْنِ هِشَامٍ

— البدايه والنهيه ج ٤ ص ١٨٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1669> *English:* "Quraysh drew up, three thousand of them, with two hundred horses they had led along; and they put Khālīd b. al-Walīd over the right wing of the cavalry, and 'Ikrima b. Abī Jahl b. Hishām over its left."

عبرت: A man's place in one line of battle is not his place in the next. **Hands-up?** Yes — before naming them: "Who commanded the Meccan army at Uḥud?" Let the room answer, then give all three names.

TMW/E-TRN2 · Waḥshī^{رض} tells it himself, at Ḥimṣ

Tier: CORE · **When:** the account was given in the days of Mu'āwiyā^{رض} [SOURCED] · **Map:** Ḥimṣ, northern Syria **What happened:** Two men travelling through Ḥimṣ decided to go and ask Waḥshī how he had killed Ḥamza^{رض}. They were told they would find him outside his house. He was an old man by then. They greeted him; he raised his head and named one of them before they had asked him anything — he had last seen him as an infant being handed up to his wet-nurse, and he knew him by his feet. Then he told them the whole account. He began by saying he would tell it exactly as he had told it to the Prophet ﷺ. **The statement:**

أَمَّا إِنِّي سَأُحَدِّثُكُمَا كَمَا حَدَّثْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ حِينَ سَأَلَنِي عَنْ ذَلِكَ

— البدايه والنهيه ج ٤ ص ١٨٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1673> *English:* "I shall tell you both exactly as I told the Messenger of Allah ﷺ when he asked me about it."

عبرت: Much of what we know about that day we know because someone went and asked the man who was there. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN3 · "Keep your face away from me"

Tier: CORE · **When:** after the fall of Ṭā'if, ٨-٩هـ [STANDARD] (to verify — the page gives the sequence, not a year) · **Map:** Ṭā'if → Medina **What happened:** After Mecca fell, Waḥshī ran to Ṭā'if. When Ṭā'if's delegation left to submit, he had nowhere left to go. A man told him the Prophet ﷺ kills no one who enters his religion. So he went to Medina and stood over the Prophet ﷺ and gave the testimony. The Prophet ﷺ saw him and knew him. He asked him to sit and tell how he had killed Ḥamza. Waḥshī told it. Then the Prophet ﷺ said what he said. Waḥshī kept out of his sight from that day until the Prophet ﷺ died. **The statement:**

"وَيْحَكَ! عَيْبُ عَيْبٍ وَجْهَكَ فَلَا أَرِيَنَّكَ"

— البدايه والنهيه ج ٤ ص ١٨٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1674> *English:* "Woe to you — keep your face away from me; let me not see you."

عبرت: He was accepted as a Muslim in the same moment, and what he was asked to spare was the sight of the man who had killed the Prophet's ﷺ uncle. **Hands-up?** no — say the last sentence of the عبرت immediately, before the room draws its own conclusion.

TMW/E-TRN4 · The same spear, at al-Yamāma

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٢هـ [STANDARD] (to verify) · **Map:** 'Aqrabā' / al-Yamāma — sits directly beside the ḥadīqat al-mawt card **What happened:** When the army went out against Musaylima, Waḥshī went with it, and he took the same spear. He saw a man standing in a gap in a wall and did not know who it was. He threw. An Ṣāḥib came in from the other side with a sword. Waḥshī would never claim the kill for himself. What he said about the two throws of his life is on the page. **The statement:**

فَرَبُّكَ أَعْلَمُ أَتَيْتَا قَتْلَهُ، فَإِنْ كُنْتُ قَتَلْتُهُ، فَقَدْ قَتَلْتُ خَيْرَ النَّاسِ بَعْدَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ، وَقَتَلْتُ شَرَّ النَّاسِ

— البدايه والنهيه ج ٤ ص ١٨٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1674> *English:* "Your Lord knows best which of us killed him. If I killed him, then I have killed the best of men after the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, and I have killed the worst of men."

عبرت: He never stopped weighing what he had done, and he never claimed more than he knew. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN5 · The witness against the enemy

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٢هـ [STANDARD] (to verify) · **Map:** al-Yamāma **What happened:** Waḥshī was asked about the men he had fought at al-Yamāma. He had spent his life among fighting men on both sides. His verdict on Musaylima's army was one sentence, and it was not the sentence anyone would expect from the winning side. **The statement:**

لَمْ أَرْ قَطُّ أَصْبَرَ عَلَى الْمَوْتِ مِنْ أَصْحَابِ مُسَيْلِمَةَ

— سير أعلام النبلاء، ج الخلفاء الراشدون ص ٤٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1196> *English:* "I have never seen anyone more steadfast in the face of death than Musaylima's men."

عبرت: The books preserved the enemy's courage in the words of the man who fought them. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN6 · The ship, and the vow

Tier: CORE · **When:** رمضان ٨هـ, at the Conquest [STANDARD] (to verify) · **Map:** Mecca → the Tihāma coast → the sea → back **What happened:** When Mecca fell, 'Ikrima b. Abī Jahl was one of the few whose blood was

not covered by the amnesty. He rode for the coast and took ship. A squall struck. The people on board told one another to be sincere to God alone, because their gods would be no use out there. 'Ikrima heard it. What he said next he said there, in the storm. **The statement:**

وَاللّٰهُ لَئِنْ لَمْ يُنْجِ فِي الْبَحْرِ إِلَّا الْإِخْلَاصُ فَإِنَّهُ لَا يُنْجِي فِي الْبَرِّ غَيْرُهُ، اللَّهُمَّ إِنَّ لَكَ عَلَيَّ عَهْدًا إِنَّ أَنْتَ عَاقِبَتِي مِمَّا آتَا فِيهِ، أَنْ آتِيَ مُحَمَّدًا حَتَّى أَضَعَّ يَدِي فِي يَدِهِ فَلَا جِدَّتَهُ عَفْوًا كَرِيمًا
— ٥٥٠ ص ٤ · البدايه والنهائيه ج ٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/2039> *English:* "By God, if nothing saves at sea but sincerity, then nothing else saves on land either. O Allah, I owe You a covenant: if You bring me safe out of what I am in, I will go to Muhammad and put my hand in his hand — and I shall surely find him forgiving and generous."

عبرت: He worked out the whole matter from one thing the people on the ship said, and he was right about what he would find. **Hands-up?** Yes — "Whose son was 'Ikrima?" Let them say it. Then tell the card.

TMW/E-TRN7 · Umm Ḥakīm ^{رضي} goes after her husband

Tier: CORE · **When:** رمضان ٥٨ [STANDARD] (to verify) · **Map:** Mecca → Yemen / Tihāma → Medina. This is a real journey; draw the arrow. **What happened:** Umm Ḥakīm bint al-Ḥārith b. Hishām accepted Islam on the day of the Conquest. Her husband had fled. She went to the Prophet ﷺ herself and asked leave to go after him, and asked safe-conduct for him. He gave her both. She travelled with a servant who tried to force himself on her; she put him off until she reached some people who bound him for her. She caught her husband somewhere in Tihāma, with him already aboard the ship. She brought him back. **The statement:**

فَاسْتَأْذَنْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ فِي ظَلَبِ رَوْجِهَا، فَأَذِنَ لَهَا وَآمَنَهُ
— ١٦٤ ص ٢ · السيرة ج ٢ · سير أعلام النبلاء، ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/823> *English:* "She asked the Messenger of Allah ﷺ leave to go after her husband, and he gave her leave and granted him safe-conduct."

عبرت: The safe-conduct that brought 'Ikrima ^{رضي} back was asked for by his wife, in person. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN8 · The cloak

Tier: CORE · **When:** ٨٥ [STANDARD] (to verify) · **Map:** Medina **What happened:** 'Ikrima came in to the Prophet ﷺ with his wife. This is the son of the man who had led Quraysh against him at Badr, and who had been killed there. The books record what the Prophet ﷺ did when he saw him. He did not wait for him to reach the front. He got up. **The statement:**

فَلَمَّا رَأَاهُ وَتَبَّ فَرَحًا بِهِ، وَرَمَى عَلَيْهِ رِدَاءَهُ حَتَّى بَايَعَهُ
— ١٨٥ ص ٢ · السيرة ج ٢ · سير أعلام النبلاء، ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/844> *English:* "When he saw him he sprang up in joy at him and threw his cloak over him, until he pledged allegiance to him."

عبرت: He was met by the man himself standing up, and the marriage he had come back to was left as it was. **Hands-up?** no ⚠ Do **not** say "nothing was said to him about his father." That is an argument from silence, and it is the door back into the story §X.2 deletes — the page records the welcome, and nothing about what was or was not said.

TMW/E-TRN9 · "Do not let me see you until you have proved yourself"

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١٥ [SOURCED] (البدايه files it in the ridda year) · **Map:** al-Yamāma → 'Umān → Mahra → Yemen. Three arrows; this card carries a lot of the map. **What happened:** Abū Bakr ^{رضي} gave 'Ikrima ^{رضي} one of the

eleven banners and sent him against Musaylima, with Shurahbīl following. 'Ikrima attacked before Shurahbīl arrived, wanting the victory on his own, and was badly handled. The caliph wrote to him. Then he sent him on: first to 'Umān, then to Mahra, then to Yemen and Ḥaḍramawt. He fought in every one of them. **The statement:**

وَكَتَبَ إِلَيْهِ الصِّدِّيقُ يَلُومُهُ عَلَى تَسْرُعِهِ، قَالَ: لَا أَرَيْتَكَ وَلَا أَسْمَعَنَّ بِكَ إِلَّا بَعْدَ بَلَاءٍ
— البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٤١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3187> *English:* "al-Ṣiddiq wrote blaming him for his haste, and said: let me not see you, and let me not hear of you, except after you have proved yourself."

عبرت: He was corrected and kept, not corrected and dropped. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN10 · The muṣḥaf against his face

Tier: CORE · **When:** his later life [SOURCED] (no year given) · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** Ibn Kathīr records two things about 'Ikrima in his obituary notice. The first is a habit he had. The second is a remark other people made about him. Imām Aḥmad رحمه الله later cited that habit as evidence in a question of law. **The statement:**

وَكَانَ يُقِيلُ الْمُصْحَفَ وَيَبْكِي وَيَقُولُ: كَلَامُ رَبِّي، كَلَامُ رَبِّي ... وَيُقَالُ: إِنَّهُ لَا يُعْرِفُ لَهُ ذَنْبٌ بَعْدَ مَا أَسْلَمَ
— البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ١٢٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3273> *English:* "He used to kiss the muṣḥaf and weep and say: my Lord's speech, my Lord's speech ... And it is said that no sin is known of him after he accepted Islam."

عبرت: The son of Abū Jahl kissed the Book and wept over it. (*Kissed* — «يُقِيلُ» — is Ibn Kathīr's wording, which is what this card cites. "Held it to his face" is al-Dārimī's wording and must not be said under a Bidāya caption. See §3.6.) **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN11 · "And shall I run from you today?"

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٥ هـ or يوم اليرموك, ١٣ هـ — the books differ [SOURCED] · **Map:** the Yarmūk **What happened:** The Byzantine line broke into the Muslim ranks and men gave ground. 'Ikrima stood up in front of Khālīd's tent. He said one sentence about his own past, and then asked for men. His uncle al-Ḥārith b. Hishām was the first to answer him, and Ḍirār b. al-Azwar, and four hundred of the leading horsemen. Ibn Kathīr names his informant for this: Sayf b. 'Umar. **The statement:**

قَاتَلْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ فِي مَوَاطِنَ وَأَفِرُّ مِنْكُمْ الْيَوْمَ؟ ثُمَّ نَادَى: مَنْ يُبَايِعُ عَلَى الْمَوْتِ؟
— البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٩٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3240> *English:* "I fought the Messenger of Allah ﷺ on many fields — and shall I run from you today? Then he called out: who will pledge on death?"

عبرت: He used what he had been against Islam as the reason he would not fail it. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN12 · The one cup

Tier: CORE · **When:** the same day [SOURCED] · **Map:** the Yarmūk — tell it directly after E-TRN11, same slide **What happened:** The four hundred fought in front of Khālīd's tent until every one of them was wounded. When they had been brought down they asked for water. One cup was brought. It was carried to one man; he looked at the man beside him and said, give it to him. It was carried to that man; he looked at the next and

said the same. It went from hand to hand until they had all died and no one had drunk from it. Ibn Kathīr gives this from al-Wāqidi and others, and he does not name the men. **The statement:**

فَتَدَا فَعَوْهَا كُلُّهُمْ مِنْ وَاحِدٍ إِلَى وَاحِدٍ حَتَّى مَاتُوا جَمِيعًا وَلَمْ يَشْرَبْهَا أَحَدٌ مِنْهُمْ
— البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٩٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3240> *English:* "They passed it on, every one of them, from one to the next — until they had all died, and not one of them had drunk it."

عبرت: Each of them decided, while dying, that someone else needed it more. **Hands-up?** no **Do not name the three men.** The popular version names them; this page does not. See §X.1.

TMW/E-TRN13 · Ṭulayḥa at Buzākha — the question, and the answer he got

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** Buzākha, Najd — the map already carries this pin **What happened:** At Buzākha, Ṭulayḥa's men were breaking. He asked one of them, plainly, what was defeating them. The answer he received explains the whole year better than any figure does. **The statement:**

مَا يَهْزِمُكُمْ؟ فَقَالَ رَجُلٌ: أَنَا أَحَدُكُمْ، لَيْسَ مِنَّا رَجُلٌ إِلَّا وَهُوَ يُجِبُّ أَنْ يَمُوتَ صَاحِبُهُ قَبْلَهُ، وَإِنَّا تَلَقَى قَوْمًا كُلُّهُمْ يُجِبُّ أَنْ يَمُوتَ قَبْلَ صَاحِبِهِ
— سير أعلام النبلاء، ج الخلفاء الراشدون ص ٤١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1189> *English:* "What is defeating you? A man said: I will tell you. There is not one of us but he would rather his companion died before him — and we are meeting a people every one of whom would rather die before his companion."

عبرت: The difference was not in the numbers, and the losing side could see it. **Hands-up?** Yes — "Why did the ridda armies lose?" Take two or three answers, then read this.

TMW/E-TRN14 · Ṭulayḥa comes back

Tier: CORE · **When:** at the end of Abū Bakr's caliphate or just after — the books differ [SOURCED] · **Map:** Syria (Āl Jafna) → Mecca for 'umra → Medina **What happened:** Ṭulayḥa did not die at Buzākha. He escaped to Syria and lived among the Ghassānids. Then he returned to Islam. He went to Mecca for 'umra. Ibn Kathīr says twice that he could not bring himself to face Abū Bakr. Then he came to greet 'Umar. 'Umar named the two men he had killed at Buzākha and told him to get away from him. Ṭulayḥa answered. The answer is on the page, and so is what 'Umar did about it. **The statement:**

أَعْرَبُ عَنِّي فَإِنَّكَ قَاتِلُ الرَّجُلَيْنِ الصَّالِحَيْنِ، عُكَّاشَةَ بْنِ مِخْصَنٍ، وَثَابِتَ بْنِ أَقْرَمَ، فَقَالَ: يَا أَمِيرَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ هُمَا رَجُلَانِ أَكْرَمَهُمَا اللَّهُ عَلَى يَدَيَّ وَلَمْ يَهْنِي يَأْيِدِيهِمَا. فَأَعْجَبَ عُمَرُ كَلَامَهُ وَرَضِيَ عَنْهُ
— البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٤٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3388> *English:* "Get away from me — you are the killer of the two righteous men, 'Ukkāsha b. Miḥṣan and Thābit b. Aqram.' He said: Commander of the Believers, they are two men whom Allah honoured at my hands, and He did not disgrace me at theirs. And 'Umar was pleased by his words, and was satisfied with him."

عبرت: He did not deny what he had done, and he did not excuse it either. **Hands-up?** Yes — this is the payoff. "Last time we left Ṭulayḥa riding away from Buzākha. What do you think became of him?" Take answers. Then tell it.

TMW/E-TRN15 · Consulted, never commanded

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the caliphates of Abū Bakr and 'Umar [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** Ṭulayḥa went back into the armies and fought at Qādisiyya and Nahāwand. Ibn Sa'd says he was reckoned the equal of

a thousand horsemen. But a standing instruction followed him: he was to be consulted about war, and given no command. Ibn Kathīr reads that as deliberate — a man who had wanted leadership was to be given everything except leadership — and he calls it part of Abū Bakr ^{رضي}'s fiqh. **The statement:**

أَنْ شَاوَزَ طُلَيْحَةَ فِي أَمْرِ الْحَرْبِ، وَلَا تُؤَلِّهِ شَيْئًا
— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٣١٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1743> *English:* "Consult Ṭulayḥa in the matter of war, and give him no authority over anything."

عبرت: Trusting a man's judgement and trusting him with power are two different decisions. **Hands-up?** no [⚠]
The sources differ over which caliph wrote it and to whom — see §4.5. Say "the caliph" or name the source you are quoting.

TMW/E-TRN16 · The night ride at Nahāwand

Tier: CORE · **When:** ٦١ هـ [SOURCED] — as Ibn 'Asākir transmits it · **Map:** Nahāwand, on the Persian plateau
What happened: Before Nahāwand, al-Nu'mān b. Muqarrin ^{رضي} sent three men ahead to scout. The party rode a day and a night; one of the three turned back, then the second after him. Ṭulayḥa ^{رضي} rode on alone, more than twenty parasangs, right up to the Persian position. He was gone so long that the army decided he had gone over. Word went round that he had apostatised a second time. He heard about it when he came back, and he asked them what was wrong, and they told him. Then he answered. **The statement:**

وَاللَّهِ لَوْ لَمْ يَكُنْ دِينٌ إِلَّا الْعَرَبِيُّ مَا كُنْتُ لِأُخْزِرَ الْعُجَمَ الطَّمَاظِمَ هَذِهِ الْعَرَبَ الْعَارِبَةَ
— الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٩٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1085> *English:* "By God — even if there were no religion at all but the Arab one, I would never hand these true Arabs over to be slaughtered by foreigners."

عبرت: A man may carry a reputation for years after he has stopped deserving it. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN17 · How Ṭulayḥa ^{رضي} died, and how al-Dhahabī closes the entry

Tier: GOOD · **When:** Nahāwand, ٦١ هـ [SOURCED] — Ibn 'Asākir's transmission, in Ibn Kathīr · **Map:** Nahāwand
What happened: Ibn Kathīr files his death notice under the year twenty-one and quotes Ibn 'Asākir: he was martyred at Nahāwand, in the same battle as al-Nu'mān b. Muqarrin ^{رضي} and 'Amr b. Ma'dī Karib ^{رضي}. Al-Dhahabī gives no year at all. He gives one sentence, and then he adds a word to the usual formula that he does not add for most men. **The statement:**

قُلْتُ: أَبْلَى يَوْمَ نَهَاوَنْدَ، ثُمَّ اسْتُشْهِدَ - رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ وَسَامَحَهُ
— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٣١٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1743> *English:* "I say: he distinguished himself on the day of Nahāwand, then he was martyred — may Allah be pleased with him, and pardon him."

عبرت: The scholar who wrote his life would not drop either half of it. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN18 · The voice under his son's banner

Tier: CORE · **When:** يوم اليرموك [SOURCED] · **Map:** the Yarmūk **What happened:** Abū Sufyān b. Ḥarb ^{رضي} had commanded the Quraysh army at Uḥud and at the Trench. He had lost one eye at Ṭā'if and lost the second at the Yarmūk. Sa'īd b. al-Musayyib's father was there. He says the noise of the battle dropped away, and there was one voice left carrying over the field. He looked up to see whose it was. **The statement:**

إِلَّا صَوْتُ رَجُلٍ يَقُولُ: "يَا تَصَرَّ اللَّهُ اقْتَرِبْ، يَا تَصَرَّ اللَّهُ اقْتَرِبْ"، فَرَفَعْتُ رَأْسِي فَإِذَا هُوَ أَبُو سُفْيَانَ بْنُ حَرْبٍ تَحْتَ رَايَةِ ابْنِهِ يَزِيدَ بْنِ أَبِي سُفْيَانَ
 — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1253> *English:* "...all but the voice of one man saying: 'Help of Allah, draw near! Help of Allah, draw near!' I raised my head, and it was Abū Sufyān b. Ḥarb, under the banner of his son Yazīd b. Abī Sufyān."

عبرت: He could no longer see the battle he was calling men into. **Hands-up?** Yes — "Who commanded Quraysh at Uḥud?" Then this.

TMW/E-TRN19 · Abū Bakr ^{رضي} walks beside the stirrup

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٣هـ, the sending of the Syrian armies [STANDARD] (to verify) · **Map:** Medina → Syria
What happened: Yazīd b. Abī Sufyān ^{رضي} was one of four commanders Abū Bakr ^{رضي} appointed for the Syrian campaign. He was called Yazīd al-Khayr. He was the brother of Umm Ḥabiba ^{رضي}, the Mother of the Believers. His father had led the army at Uḥud. When Abū Bakr ^{رضي} tied his standard for him, he did not stand and watch him ride out. Al-Dhahabī says plainly why. **The statement:**

عَقَدَ لَهُ أَبُو بَكْرٍ، وَمَشَى مَعَهُ تَحْتَ رِكَائِهِ يُسَاطِرُهُ، وَيُودِّعُهُ، وَيُوصِيهِ، وَمَا ذَاكَ إِلَّا لِشَرَفِهِ، وَكَمَالِ دِينِهِ
 — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1755> *English:* "Abū Bakr tied his standard for him and walked beside him under his stirrup, keeping pace with him, seeing him off and instructing him — and that was only for his standing and the completeness of his religion."

عبرت: The caliph walked and the commander rode, and neither of them thought it strange. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN20 · Two men on the same road

Tier: GOOD · **When:** safar ٨هـ [SOURCED] — al-Wāqidi's transmission · **Map:** the Red Sea coast → Medina
What happened: 'Amr b. al-ʿĀṣ had fought against the Muslims at Badr, Uḥud and the Trench and got away each time. He went to the Negus with a plan and came back with a different one. Riding north he saw two men ahead of him at a stopping place. One of them was Khālīd b. al-Walīd. He asked him where he was going. Then a third man came out of the tent: 'Uthmān b. Ṭalḥa, the doorkeeper of the Ka'ba. All three were going to the same place for the same reason. They travelled the rest of the way together. **The statement:**

قُلْتُ: أَيَّنْ تُرِيدُ؟ قَالَ: مُحَمَّدًا ... قُلْتُ: وَأَنَا وَاللَّهِ قَدْ أَرَدْتُ مُحَمَّدًا وَأَرَدْتُ الْإِسْلَامَ
 — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/772> *English:* "I said: where are you going? He said: to Muhammad ... I said: and I too, by God — I have set out for Muhammad, and for Islam."

عبرت: Neither of them knew the other was coming. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN21 · The ḥadīth about the Sword of Allah, and who carries it

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ, at the ridda appointment [SOURCED] · **Map:** Medina / Dhū al-Qaṣṣa **What happened:** When Abū Bakr ^{رضي} gave Khālīd ^{رضي} the command over the ridda campaign, he quoted something he had heard the Prophet ﷺ say about him. Ibn Kathīr puts the ḥadīth on the page at exactly that moment. The man who transmits it is Waḥshī b. Ḥarb ^{رضي}. Twelve years earlier, at Uḥud, the same two men had been on the same side of the field — and it was the other side. **The statement:**

"نِعْمَ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ وَأَخُو الْعَشِيرَةِ، خَالِدُ بْنُ الْوَلِيدِ، سَيِّفٌ مِنْ سُيُوفِ اللَّهِ سَلَّهُ اللَّهُ عَلَى الْكُفَّارِ وَالْمُتَافِقِينَ"

— البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٢٢ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3170> *English:* "What an excellent servant of Allah and brother of the clan — Khālīd b. al-Walīd; a sword among the swords of Allah, which Allah has drawn against the disbelievers and the hypocrites."

عبرت: The praise of one of them reaches us through the other. **Hands-up?** no **Grading:** the matn is graded ḥasan/ṣaḥīḥ by its routes; this particular chain, through Ḥarb b. Waḥshī, is weak. See §6. Do not assert a grade from the platform beyond "Imām Aḥmad records it."

TMW/E-TRN22 · Where 'Ikrima ^{رض} died — and why we cannot say

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٣ هـ or ١٥ هـ [SOURCED] for the disagreement itself · **Map:** Ajnādayn and the Yarmūk — put both pins up, one struck through **What happened:** 'Ikrima ^{رض} was killed in Syria. The books do not agree where. 'Urwa, Ibn Sa'd and others say Ajnādayn. Abū Ishāq al-Sabī'ī says the Yarmūk, and adds that he had dismounted from his horse and fought on foot, and when they found him there were more than seventy wounds on his body — stabs, arrow-strikes and sword-cuts. Ibn Kathīr carries both, in different chapters of the same book. This is what an honest history looks like when it has two reports and no way to choose. **The statement:**

قَالَ أَبُو إِسْحَاقَ السَّبْيَعِيُّ: نَزَلَ عِكْرِمَةُ يَوْمَ الْيَزْمُوكِ، فَقَاتَلَ قِتَالًا شَدِيدًا، ثُمَّ اسْتُشْهِدَ، فَوَجَدُوا بِهِ يَضَعًا وَسَبْعِينَ مِنْ طَلْعَةٍ، وَرُمِيَّةٍ، وَضَرْبَةٍ. وَقَالَ عُرْوَةُ، وَابْنُ سَعْدٍ، وَطَائِفَةٌ: قُتِلَ يَوْمَ أَجْنَادَيْنَ — سِير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٣٢٢ — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1750> *English:* "Abū Ishāq al-Sabī'ī said: 'Ikrima dismounted on the day of Yarmūk and fought hard, then was martyred; and they found on him seventy-odd wounds — stabs, arrow-strikes and sword-blows. 'Urwa, Ibn Sa'd and a group said: he was killed on the day of Ajnādayn."

عبرت: Where the books disagree, we say they disagree. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN23 · The house of Abū Jahl at Ajnādayn

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٣ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** Ajnādayn, Palestine **What happened:** When Ibn Kathīr lists the men killed at Ajnādayn he names, in one line, 'Ikrima b. Abī Jahl ^{رض} and his uncle Salama b. Hishām ^{رض}. Salama ^{رض} was one of the earliest Muslims; he had emigrated to Abyssinia, come back, and been imprisoned in Mecca by his own brother — and the Prophet ﷺ used to pray for him by name in the qunūt. Al-Ḥārith b. Hishām ^{رض}, another brother of Abū Jahl, survived to die in the plague five years later. **The statement:**

وَضِرَارُ بْنُ الْأَزْوَارِ، وَعِكْرِمَةُ بْنُ أَبِي جَهْلٍ، وَعَمَّهُ سَلَمَةُ بْنُ هِشَامٍ □ — البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ١٢١ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3267> *English:* "...and Ḍirār b. al-Azwar, and 'Ikrima b. Abī Jahl, and his uncle Salama b. Hishām, may Allah be pleased with them all."

عبرت: By the year thirteen the household of Abū Jahl was fighting as one, on the other side. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN24 · Al-Dhahabī on Abū Sufyān ^{رض}, unsoftened

Tier: GOOD · **When:** رمضان ٨ هـ [STANDARD] (to verify) · **Map:** Mecca **What happened:** Al-Dhahabī رحمه الله wrote a life of Abū Sufyān ^{رض} and did not smooth it. He states what the man had been, states that Allah rescued him, states plainly how he entered Islam, and then states, in four words, that it did not stay that way. It is worth reading exactly as he wrote it, because it shows how the tradition itself handles a difficult life. **The statement:**

وَلَهُ هُنَا وَأَمُورٌ صَعْبَةٌ، لَكِنْ تَذَارَكُهُ اللَّهُ بِالإِسْلَامِ يَوْمَ الْفَتْحِ، فَأَسْلَمَ شِبْهَ مُكْرَهٍ خَائِفٍ. ثُمَّ بَعْدَ أَيَّامٍ صَلَّحَ إِسْلَامُهُ

— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ١٠٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2086> *English:* "He has against him misdeeds and hard matters — but Allah rescued him with Islam on the day of the Conquest, and he accepted Islam like one compelled and afraid. Then, after some days, his Islam became sound."

عبرت: The books record how a man began as well as how he ended. **Hands-up?** no

TMW/E-TRN25 · How Mu‘āwīya^{رضي} came to hold Syria

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٨هـ, in the plague [SOURCED] — the name ‘Amwās is [STANDARD] (to verify; سير ج١ ص ٣٣٠ says only «الطاعون») · **Map:** Damascus **What happened:** Yazīd b. Abī Sufyān^{رضي} was governor of Damascus. When the plague took him he was dying, and he named his own brother Mu‘āwīya^{رضي} over his command. ‘Umar^{رضي} confirmed it — al-Dhahabī says out of respect for Yazīd^{رضي} and to carry out his appointment. The same plague took Abū ‘Ubayda^{رضي}, Mu‘ādh b. Jabal^{رضي}, Shurahbīl b. Ḥasana^{رضي}, al-Ḥārith b. Hishām^{رضي} and Abū Jandal b. Suhayl^{رضي}. **The statement:**

وَلَمَّا اخْتَضَرَ اسْتَعْمَلَ أَخَاهُ مُعَاوِيَةَ عَلَى عَمَلِهِ، فَأَقَرَّهُ عُمَرُ عَلَى ذَلِكَ احْتِرَامًا لِيَزِيدَ، وَتَنْفِيدًا لِتَوَلِيَّتِهِ — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٣٣٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1756> *English:* "When he was dying he appointed his brother Mu‘āwīya over his command, and ‘Umar confirmed him in it, out of respect for Yazīd and to carry out his appointment."

عبرت: A great deal of what comes later begins in a single administrative decision made at a deathbed. **Hands-up?** no — but say the last clause slowly. It is the seed of session 4.

WHERE EACH CARD BELONGS

Daniyal decides what goes where; this is where each would land if nothing else changed. RCT/E-RC20 = the ḥadiqat al-mawt card in the session-2 ridda pool.

Card	Sits beside	Session
E-TRN1 · Uḥud order of battle	the opening of the evening , before Khālīd ^{رضي} is first named — it is the frame the whole strand hangs on	2
E-TRN2 · Waḥshī ^{رضي} tells it himself	immediately before E-TRN3; or hold as a source-remark inside E-TRN4	2
E-TRN3 · "Keep your face away"	pairs with E-TRN2 — read the two as one beat	2
E-TRN4 · The same spear	RCT/E-RC20 — ḥadiqat al-mawt. This is the card that gives that field its second half	2
E-TRN5 · Waḥshī ^{رضي} on Musaylima's men	same slide as E-TRN4, as its closing line	2
E-TRN6 · The ship	before any ridda material, in the ١٨هـ recap the evening needs anyway	2 (or 1 , if session 1's Conquest material is extended)
E-TRN7 · Umm Ḥakīm ^{رضي}	same slide as E-TRN6 — they are one journey	2

Card	Sits beside	Session
E-TRN8 · The cloak	closes the E-TRN6/7 block	2
E-TRN9 · "Not until you have proved yourself"	the ‘Umān and Mahra cards — this is the sentence that sent him there	2
E-TRN10 · The muṣḥaf	as the ‘Ikrima ^{رحم} notice on the worksheet, or as the closing عبرت of the ridda block	2
E-TRN11 · "Shall I run from you today?"	the Yarmūk block	2
E-TRN12 · The one cup	directly after E-TRN11, same slide. Never separate them	2
E-TRN13 · Buzākha, the question	the Buzākha card in the ridda pool	2
E-TRN14 · Ṭulayḥa ^{رحم} comes back	wherever session 2 currently ends Ṭulayḥa's story — it must not end with him fleeing	2
E-TRN15 · Consulted, never commanded	with E-TRN14, or in the Qādisiyya block	2
E-TRN16 · The night ride at Nahāwand	the Nahāwand block — Nahāwand is late session 2 or early session 3	2 → 3
E-TRN17 · How Ṭulayḥa ^{رحم} died	closes E-TRN16	2 → 3
E-TRN18 · The voice under the banner	the Yarmūk block , after E-TRN11/12	2
E-TRN19 · Abū Bakr ^{رحم} walks beside the stirrup	the sending of the Syrian armies	2
E-TRN20 · Two men on the same road	with E-TRN1, as its answer; or in session 1's Conquest material	2 (or 1)
E-TRN21 · The Sword of Allah ḥadīth	the moment Khālīd^{رحم} is given the ridda command	2
E-TRN22 · Where ‘Ikrima ^{رحم} died	as the evening's one source-remark — "how do we know?" — inside the Yarmūk block	2
E-TRN23 · The house of Abū Jahl at Ajnādayn	the Ajnādayn card ; or fold into E-TRN11 as one sentence	2
E-TRN24 · Al-Dhahabī on Abū Sufyān ^{رحم}	hold for session 4. It is the fairest available introduction to Banū Umayya, in an imām's own words	4
E-TRN25 · How Mu‘āwiya ^{رحم} came to hold Syria	the plague of ‘Amwās card in session 2, planted; harvested in session 4	2 → 4

One structural suggestion. E-TRN1 and E-TRN11 are the same fact seen from two ends, twelve years apart. If session 2 opens with the Uḥud order of battle on a diagram and closes the Yarmūk block with 'Ikrima's sentence, the evening's largest عبرت needs no commentary at all — the room will have supplied it.

The statements bank — slide-ready, by speaker

Source note: [great-statements-and-dialogues-11-23ah.md](#) — read it for the pages behind these cards.

GSA/E-ST1 · أبو بكر^{رضي} takes the office and tells the room to correct him

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ, the morning after السقيفة [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** The general pledge had just been given in the mosque, the morning after أبو بكر^{رضي} stood up to speak for the first time as the man in charge. He did not open with a claim. He opened by saying he was not the best of them, and by asking to be corrected if he went wrong. Then he set out how the weak and the strong would be treated in his court. ابن كثير, who copies the whole address, adds four words of his own after it: *this chain is sound.* **The statement:**

فإني قد وُلِّيتُ عليكم ولست بخيركم فإن أحسنت فأعينوني وإن أسأت فقوموني ... أطيعوني ما أطعت الله ورسوله،
 https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3152 · فإذا عصيت الله ورسوله فلا طاعة لي عليكم — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٦
 English: "I have been placed over you and I am not the best of you. If I do well, help me; if I do badly, straighten me ... Obey me so long as I obey God and His Messenger; if I disobey God and His Messenger, then you owe me no obedience." **عبرت:** Authority that asks to be corrected has already conceded that it is not the highest thing in the room. **Hands-up?** Ask before telling it: *when a new leader speaks for the first time, what does he usually say about himself?*

GSA/E-ST2 · أبو بكر^{رضي} will not untie a knot the Prophet ﷺ tied

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ, the first days [SOURCED] · **Map:** the arrow north to الجُزف and out toward الشام, drawn while every other frontier is on fire **What happened:** The Prophet ﷺ had appointed أسامة^{رضي} over an expedition and it had not yet marched. Then he died, and tribes across Arabia broke away. Senior Companions asked أبو بكر^{رضي} to hold the army back and use it to defend Medina. He refused. He said he would not undo something the Messenger of God ﷺ had settled — not if wild animals came to the edges of the city, and not if he were the last man left in the settlements. **The statement:**

والذي نفس أبي بكر بيده لو ظننت أن السباع تخطفني لأنفذت بعث أسامة كما أمر به رسول الله ﷺ؛ ولو لم يبق في
 https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3156 · القرى غيري لأنفذته — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ١٠
 English: "By Him in whose hand is Abū Bakr's soul — if I thought the wild beasts would snatch me away, I would still send out Usāma's expedition as the Messenger of God ﷺ ordered; and if no one were left in the settlements but me, I would still send it." **عبرت:** A commitment that is only kept while it is safe was never a commitment. **Hands-up?** *Your house is surrounded and you have one unit left. Do you send it away, or keep it?*

GSA/E-ST3 · The caliph walks and the eighteen-year-old rides

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ, at الجُزف [SOURCED] · **Map:** الجُزف, just outside Medina **What happened:** أبو بكر^{رضي} went out on foot to see the army off. أسامة^{رضي}, who was about eighteen, was mounted. The caliph walked beside his horse. أسامة^{رضي} said: either you ride, or I get down. أبو بكر^{رضي} refused both. Then, before he turned back, he asked

أسامة^{رضي} — the young commander — for permission to keep عمر^{رضي} back in Medina. عمر^{رضي} never met him afterwards without greeting him as *commander*. **The statement:**

· وَاللَّهِ لَا تَزَلْتُ وَلَا أَرْكَبُ، وَمَا عَلَيَّ أَنْ أُغَيِّرَ قَدَمَيَّ سَاعَةً فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ١٩٥
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/886> English: "By God, you shall not dismount and I shall not ride. What harm is it to me that my two feet gather dust for an hour in the path of God?" **عبرت:** Rank inside an office and rank before God are two different measurements, and confusing them is where rulers go wrong. **Hands-up?** How old was the commander of the first army the first caliph sent out?

GSA/E-ST4 · The ten rules given to an army before it marched

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ، before جيش أسامة^{رضي} marched [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** With the army drawn up and about to leave, أبو بكر^{رضي} gave it its standing orders. They are not tactics. They are a list of things the army is forbidden to do — to people, to animals, and to trees — and they were given before a single one of the great conquests had begun. The last of them concerns men who have withdrawn into cells and given their lives to worship: leave them alone. **The statement:**

لَا تَخُونُوا، وَلَا تَغْدِرُوا، وَلَا تَغْلُوا، وَلَا تُمَيِّلُوا، وَلَا تَقْتُلُوا طِفْلاً وَلَا شَيْخاً كَبِيراً وَلَا امْرَأَةً، وَلَا تَعْقِرُوا نَخْلاً وَتُخْرِقُوا، وَلَا تَقْطَعُوا شَجَرَةً مُثْمِرَةً، وَلَا تَذْبَحُوا شَاةً وَلَا بَقَرَةً وَلَا بَعِيراً إِلَّا لِمَأْكَلَةٍ، وَسَوَفَ تَمُرُّونَ بِأَقْوَامٍ قَدْ قَرَّعُوا أَنْفُسَهُمْ فِي الصَّوَامِيعِ، فَدَعُوهُمْ وَمَا قَرَّعُوا أَنْفُسَهُمْ لَهُ ... انْذِفَعُوا بِاسْمِ اللَّهِ — الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ١٩٦
<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/887> English: "Do not betray. Do not act treacherously. Do not steal from the spoils. Do not mutilate. Do not kill a child, nor an aged man, nor a woman. Do not cut down a date-palm and burn it. Do not fell a fruit-bearing tree. Do not slaughter a sheep or a cow or a camel except for food. You will pass by people who have withdrawn into cells and given themselves wholly to what they are in — leave them and what they have given themselves to ... Set out, in the name of God." **عبرت:** The limits on an army are set before it marches, or they are not set at all. **Hands-up?** no — but the ellipsis on the slide is deliberate and \$1.5 tells the speaker what to say if it is challenged.

GSA/E-ST5 · The zakāt refusers, and عمر^{رضي} saying out loud that he had been wrong

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** the delegations arriving into Medina from every direction **What happened:** Delegations came into Medina accepting the prayer and refusing the zakāt. عمر^{رضي} argued against fighting them, and he had a ḥadīth to argue with. أبو بكر^{رضي} answered him with a single distinction: the zakāt is a due upon wealth, and it cannot be separated from the prayer. The report is in the Six except ابن ماجه — ابن كثير says so on the page. And the last thing in it is not أبو بكر^{رضي}'s oath. It is عمر^{رضي} saying, on the record, that he came to see his companion was right. **The statement:**

وَاللَّهِ لَأَقَاتِلَنَّ مَنْ فَرَّقَ بَيْنَ الصَّلَاةِ وَالزَّكَاةِ، قَالَ عُمَرُ: فَمَا هُوَ إِلَّا أَنْ رَأَيْتُ اللَّهَ قَدْ شَرَحَ صَدْرَ أَبِي بَكْرٍ لِلْقِتَالِ، فَعَرَفْتُ أَنَّهُ
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3164> English: "By God, I will fight whoever separates prayer from zakāt." Umar said: "It was nothing but that I saw God had opened Abū Bakr's breast to the fight — and I knew it was the truth." **عبرت:** Two men can disagree at the top of a state, settle it by argument, and leave the record of the disagreement standing. **Hands-up?** Who was right — the one who wanted to fight, or the one who did not? Then read the last line and let it answer itself.

GSA/E-ST6 · The audit أبو بكر^{رضي} left behind, and عمر^{رضي} weeping over a blanket

Tier: CORE · **When:** جمادى الآخرة ١٣هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** Dying, أبو بكر ^{رضي} told عائشة ^{رضي} what he had taken from the Muslims in two years as caliph. Not a dinar, not a dirham. He had eaten their coarse food and worn their rough cloth. Three items were in the house that belonged to the treasury: a servant, a camel and a blanket. He told her to send all three to عمر ^{رضي} the moment he died. When they arrived, عمر ^{رضي} wept until his tears ran onto the ground. **The statement:**

فَلَمَّا رَأَاهُ بَكَى حَتَّى سَالَتْ دُمُوعُهُ إِلَى الْأَرْضِ وَجَعَلَ يَقُولُ: رَحِمَ اللَّهُ أَبَا بَكْرٍ! لَقَدْ أَتْعَبَ مَنْ بَعْدَهُ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٤٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/956> English: When he saw it he wept until his tears ran to the ground, and kept saying: "God have mercy on Abū Bakr! He has worn out whoever comes after him." **عبرت:** The standard a man sets by his own conduct is the heaviest thing he can leave to his successor. **Hands-up?** no. This is the hinge of the evening from أبو بكر ^{رضي} to عمر ^{رضي} — let the last five words carry it.

GSA/E-ST7 · طلحة ^{رضي} objects to the appointment of عمر ^{رضي}, in public

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٣هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** عمر ^{رضي} intended to appoint طلحة ^{رضي} came to him and objected to his face: you have seen what people get from him while you are standing beside him — what happens when he is alone with them, and you are going to meet your Lord and be asked about your flock? أبو بكر ^{رضي} had himself sat up to answer. **The statement:**

أَجْلِسُونِي ... يَا لِلَّهِ تُخَوِّفُنِي! إِذَا لَقِيتُ رَبِّي فَسَأَلَنِي قُلْتُ: اسْتَخْلَفْتُ عَلَى أَهْلِكَ خَيْرَ أَهْلِكَ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٤٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/958> English: "Sit me up ... Is it with God that you frighten me? When I meet my Lord and He asks me, I shall say: *I appointed over Your people the best of Your people.*" **عبرت:** A decision that can be objected to in the open, and answered in the open, is a decision the community can live with. **Hands-up?** no.

GSA/E-ST8 · The charge to يزيد بن أبي سفيان ^{رضي}, walking beside his horse

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٣هـ, the Syrian expedition [SOURCED] · **Map:** the four columns leaving Medina for الجابية **What happened:** يزيد بن أبي سفيان ^{رضي} put أبو بكر ^{رضي} over the largest column going to Syria and walked it out of Medina on foot. What he said to him is not a speech about victory. It is a job description: you are being tested; if you do well I will extend your post, and if you do badly I will dismiss you. Then he warned him against the one thing that could destroy the whole enterprise — the pride of the old tribal order. ابن الأثير, printing it, calls it one of the best charges ever given to a man in office. **The statement:**

إِنِّي قَدْ وَلَّيْتُكَ لِأَبْلُوكَ وَأَجْرَتِكَ وَأَخْرَجَكَ، فَإِنْ أَحْسَنْتَ رَدَدْتُكَ إِلَى عَمَلِكَ وَزِدْتُكَ، وَإِنْ أَسَأْتَ عَزَلْتُكَ ... فَإِيَّاكَ وَعُيَّتِيَّةَ الْجَاهِلِيَّةِ، فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ يُبْغِضُهَا وَيُبْغِضُ أَهْلَهَا — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٤٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/940> English: "I have put you in office to test you, to try you and to bring you out. If you do well I will return you to your post and add to it; and if you do badly I will dismiss you ... And beware the arrogance of the Jāhiliyya — God hates it, and hates those who carry it." **عبرت:** An appointment is a trial, not a reward, and saying so at the start is what makes the dismissal fair later. **Hands-up?** no.

GSA/E-ST9 · «I am one arrow — shoot me where it is hardest»

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٣ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** أبو بكر^{رضي} wrote to عمرو بن العاص^{رضي} offering him the Syrian command, and expressly left him free to keep the post he already had if he preferred it. عمرو^{رضي} wrote back in one sentence. **The statement:**

إِنِّي سَهْمٌ مِنْ سِهَامِ الْإِسْلَامِ، وَأَنْتَ بَعْدَ اللَّهِ الرَّامِي يَهَا وَالْجَامِعُ لَهَا، فَاَنْظُرْ أَشَدَّهَا وَأَخْشَاهَا وَأَفْضَلَهَا فَارْمِ بِهِ —
٢٤٩ ص ٢٢٩ الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/940> English: "I am one arrow of the arrows of Islam, and you — after God — are the one who shoots them and the one who gathers them. So look for the hardest of them, and the most feared, and the best, and shoot it." **عبرت:** A man who lets himself be aimed by someone else has settled the question of who he is working for. **Hands-up?** no.

GSA/E-ST10 · «Ten thousand are not beaten by being few»

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٣ هـ, before اليرموك [SOURCED] · **Map:** the four Muslim columns converging on اليرموك **What happened:** Heraclius had put a separate army in front of each Muslim column so that no two could join. The commanders wrote to عمرو بن العاص^{رضي} asking what to do, and then to أبو بكر^{رضي}. Both answers were the same: concentrate. And أبو بكر^{رضي} added a sentence that refused to discuss the numbers at all. **The statement:**

إِنَّ مِثْلَكُمْ لَا يُؤْتَى مِنْ قَلَّةٍ، وَإِنَّمَا يُؤْتَى الْعَشْرَةُ آلَافٍ مِنَ الذُّنُوبِ، فَاحْتَرِسُوا مِنْهَا — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٥١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/942> English: "Men like you are not overcome by being few. Ten thousand are overcome by their sins — so guard yourselves against them." **عبرت:** Counting the enemy is a smaller question than what you have made of yourselves. **Hands-up?** They were outnumbered several times over. What do you write back?

GSA/E-ST11 · «I shall still milk your sheep»

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١ هـ, the days after the bay'ah [SOURCED] · **Map:** السُّنْح، the outlying quarter where أبو بكر^{رضي} lived **What happened:** أبو بكر^{رضي} used to milk the flocks of his neighbourhood. When the pledge was given to him, a girl of the quarter said out loud that now he would not milk their sheep any more. He heard her. **The statement:**

بَلَى لَعَمْرِي لَأَخْلِبَنَّهَا لَكُمْ، وَإِنِّي لَأَرْجُو أَنَّ لَا يُغَيِّرُ بِي مَا دَخَلْتُ فِيهِ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/957> English: "On the contrary — by my life, I shall certainly milk them for you. And I hope that what I have entered into will not change me." **عبرت:** The test of an office is whether the small duties survive it. **Hands-up?** no.

GSA/E-ST12 · The blind woman in the night

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١-١٣ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** عمر^{رضي} used to go by night to a blind woman in Medina and do what needed doing in her house. He kept finding it already done. So he waited to see who had got there before him. It was أبو بكر^{رضي} — still doing it after he became caliph. عمر^{رضي} said four words. **The statement:**

٢٦٥ ص ٢٢٥ الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/956> English: He said to him: "It is you — by my life!" **عبرت:** The work nobody is watching is the work that tells you who a man is. **Hands-up?** Someone was getting there first, every night. Who do you think it was?

GSA/E-ST13 · عمر's first words as caliph

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٣هـ, the day of أبو بكر's burial [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** They buried أبو بكر. Then عمر went up and spoke. Where his predecessor had begun by saying he was not the best of them, عمر began with a picture of a camel with a ring in its nose, and of the man holding the rope. Then he told them what he intended to do with it. **The statement:**

إِنَّمَا مَثَلُ الْعَرَبِ مَثَلُ جَمَلٍ أَنِفٍ أَتَّبِعَ قَائِدَهُ، فَلْيَنْظُرْ قَائِدُهُ حَيْثُ يَهْوُوهُ، وَأَمَّا أَنَا فَوَرَبِّ الْكَعْبَةِ لَأَحْمِلَنَّكُمْ عَلَى الصَّرِيقِ —
الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/959> English: "The Arabs are like a camel with a ring in its nose that follows its driver — so let its driver look where he is driving it. As for me: by the Lord of the Ka'ba, I will carry you onto the road." **عبرت:** Two men can hold the same office and be honest in completely different registers; the office does not prescribe the man. **Hands-up?** Put E-ST1 on the screen beside it and ask: *same job — same opening?*

GSA/E-ST14 · The title that was getting longer

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٣هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** People began greeting عمر as *Successor of the Successor of the Messenger of God*. He pointed out where that was heading — every caliph would add a link — and replaced it with something shorter and flatter. It is the title the Muslim world used for the next thirteen hundred years. **The statement:**

· هذا أمرٌ يطولُ، بل أنتم المؤمنون وأنا أميركم — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٢٦٨ ·
<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3414> English: "This is a thing that will go on getting longer. Rather — you are the believers, and I am your commander." **عبرت:** He shortened his own title, and the shorter title said less about him and more about them. **Hands-up?** *What would the fifth caliph have been called if nobody had stopped it?*

GSA/E-ST15 · عمر overheard talking to himself behind a wall

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٣–٢٣هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** أنس went out with عمر, who stepped into a walled garden for a private need. With a wall between them, أنس heard the Commander of the Believers say his own name and his own title out loud, congratulate himself — and then threaten himself. **The statement:**

عمر بن الخطاب أمير المؤمنين بخ، والله لتتقين الله بني الخطاب أو ليعذبنك — سير أعلام النبلاء (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) ص ٨٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1228> English: "'Umar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb, Commander of the Believers. Well done! By God, you will fear God, little son of al-Khaṭṭāb — or He will punish you." **عبرت:** The praise a man gives himself in private is the praise he has to answer for. **Hands-up?** *What do you think a ruler says when he thinks nobody can hear him?*

GSA/E-ST16 · What the caliph is allowed to take

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٣–٢٣هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** عمر set out, in front of witnesses, exactly what he was permitted to draw from the public wealth. Two sets of clothes — one for winter, one for summer. What he needed for Hajj and 'Umra. Food for his household, at the level of a middling man of Quraysh, not the richest. And then a sentence that ends the list. **The statement:**

لا يحل لعمر من مال الله إلا حلتين: حلة للشتاء وحلة للصيف، وما حج به واعتمر، وقوت أهلي كرجل من قريش ليس
 https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1225 · بأغناهم، ثم أنا رجل من المسلمين — سير (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) ص ٨٠
 English: "Nothing of God's wealth is lawful to 'Umar except two sets of clothes —
 one for winter and one for summer — and what he performs Hajj and 'Umra with, and my family's food
 at the level of a man of Quraysh who is not the richest of them. After that I am one of the Muslims."
 عبرت: A limit a ruler writes for himself and states in public is worth more than one imposed on him
 from outside. **Hands-up?** no.

GSA/E-ST17 · Four conditions in every governor's commission

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٣-٢٣ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** the provincial capitals — مصر، حمص، دمشق، البصرة، الكوفة، البصرة، الكوفة، البصرة، الكوفة
What happened: عمر ^{رضي} did not appoint a governor with a handshake. He wrote a commission, had a group of the Muhājirūn witness it, and put four conditions into it. No fine horse. No sifted flour. No fine cloth. And no shut door against people who need him. Break any of them, and the penalty falls due. **The statement:**

واشترط عليه أن لا يركب برذوئًا، ولا يأكل نقيًا، ولا يلبس رقيقًا، ولا يغلق بابه دون ذوي الحاجات. فإن فعل شيئًا من
 سير also · https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3410 · ذلك حَلَّتْ عليه العقوبة — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٤٤
 English: "...stipulating that he shall not ride a fine horse; shall not eat sifted flour; shall
 not wear fine cloth; and shall not shut his door against those in need — and if he does any of these,
 the penalty falls due on him." عبرت: Three of the four are about how a governor lives, and the fourth is
 about whether people can reach him; the first three exist to protect the fourth. **Hands-up?** Four
 conditions. Guess one.

GSA/E-ST18 · «Keep the herds of Ibn 'Awf and Ibn 'Affān away from me»

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٣-٢٣ هـ [SOURCED — the page says «أخرج البخاري»] · **Map:** the protected pasture
 (الجمي) outside Medina **What happened:** عمر ^{رضي} put a freedman named هُتَيْ over the protected pasture and
 briefed him. The brief has two halves. First: let the poor man in — the man with a handful of camels and a
 handful of sheep. Second: keep out the herds of the two richest Companions, and he named them. His reason
 is not resentment. If the rich man's livestock die he falls back on his crops and his palms. If the poor man's die,
 he comes to the caliph with his children. **The statement:**

يا هني اضمم جناحك عن المسلمين واتق دعوة المظلوم فإنها مستجابة ... وإن رب الصريمة والغنيمة إن تهلك
 ماشيتهما يأتيني ببنيه فيقول: يا أمير المؤمنين! أفتاركهم أنا لا أبا لك — سير (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) ص ٨٥
 https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1230 English: " — draw in your wing from the Muslims, and
 beware the prayer of the wronged, for it is answered ... And if the man with the few camels and the few
 sheep loses his livestock he comes to me with his sons and says *Commander of the Believers!* — am I
 then to abandon them, confound you?" عبرت: A rule aimed only at the weak is not a rule; it is a habit.
Hands-up? Whose animals do you think he named?

GSA/E-ST19 · The caliph's son makes a profit, and is allowed one dirham on the dirham

Tier: CORE · **When:** after جلولاء [SOURCED] — the year ١٦٧-١٦٨ هـ [CONVENTIONAL-ESTIMATE — the page
 carries no date] · **Map:** جلولاء → المدينة **What happened:** 'Abdullāh ibn عمر ^{رضي} bought goods out of the
 spoils at Jalūlā' for forty thousand and brought them to Medina. His father did not accuse him of anything. He

described what must have happened in the marketplace: people knew whose son he was, and would rather undercharge him than overcharge him. Then he named his own position — *I am a divider and I will be asked* — and fixed the profit himself. The goods sold for four hundred thousand. His son got eighty. The rest went to سعد بن أبي وقاص to be divided. **The statement:**

وإني قاسم مسئول وأنا معطيك أكثر ما ربح تاجر من قریش، لك ربح الدرهم درهم — سير (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) ص ٨٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1229> English: "And I am a divider, and I will be asked. So I will give you more than any Qurashī merchant ever made: for every dirham, one dirham of profit." **عبرت:** The corruption that has to be watched for is not the bribe offered; it is the discount nobody had to ask for. **Hands-up?** *He had not broken any rule. What was the problem?*

GSA/E-ST20 · The treasure of Kistrā on the floor of the mosque

Tier: CORE · **When:** المدائن [SOURCED] — the year ١٤ هـ [CONVENTIONAL-ESTIMATE — the page carries no date] · **Map:** المدينة → المدائن **What happened:** The treasures of the Persian king were brought to Medina. Someone asked whether to store them until they could be divided. عمر refused to put them under a roof. They were laid out in the middle of the mosque and guarded overnight. In the morning he pulled the covers off, saw the gold and the silver — and wept. أبي told him this was a day for gratitude, not tears. He answered with a sentence about the future. **The statement:**

· ويحك إن هذا لم يعطه قوم إلا ألقيت بينهم العداوة والبغضاء — سير (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) ص ٨٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1230> English: "Woe to you — no people were ever given this without enmity and hatred being thrown down between them." **عبرت:** He was not afraid of the enemy who had lost. He was afraid of what winning does to the winners. **Hands-up?** *The greatest empire on earth has just been beaten. Is this a good day?*

GSA/E-ST21 · The basket of fish

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ٢٣-١٣ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** عمر said a craving for fresh fish had crossed his heart. His servant يرفأ saddled a mount and rode four days out and back and brought a basket. عمر asked to see the animal. He looked it over, found sweat under its ear that had not been washed off — and refused the fish. **The statement:**

· عذبت بهيمة في شهوة عمر، لا والله لا يذوق عمر مأكلك — سير (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) ص ٨٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1227> English: "An animal was made to suffer for 'Umar's appetite. No, by God — 'Umar will not taste your basket." **عبرت:** Answerability that stops at human beings has not gone far enough. **Hands-up?** no. **Prefer this to the famous "animal on the Euphrates" line — that one is on the page at ٢٣٣ ص الكامل ج ٢ but ابن الأثير gives it anonymously, with «قيل». See §X.1.**

GSA/E-ST22 · «How should their condition concern me, if what struck them has not struck me?»

Tier: CORE · **When:** عام الرمادة، ١٨ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** the famine belt — Medina, and the relief roads in from العراق and مصر **What happened:** In the year of ashes عمر swore he would taste no butter, milk or meat until the people recovered. A servant bought him a skin of each in the market for forty dirhams. عمر told him

to give both away, because he disliked to eat extravagantly — and then said why the oath existed at all. Meanwhile seven thousand people were eating at his table on a single night. **The statement:**

· كَيْفَ يَغْنِينِي شَأْنُ الرِّعْيَةِ إِذَا لَمْ يُصِيبْنِي مَا أَصَابَهُمْ — الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٣٧٥

<https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1066> English: "How should the people's condition concern me, if what has struck them has not struck me?" **عبرت:** A leader who is insulated from a disaster is being told about it, not living in it, and the two produce different decisions. **Hands-up?** What is the first thing a government does in a famine?

GSA/E-ST23 · The dead nobody could name

Tier: CORE · **When:** نهاوند, ٢١هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** نهاوند on the Iranian plateau — the furthest pin yet **What happened:** The dispatch came in from Nihāwand. The victory was total and the commander, النعمان بن مقرن, was dead. عمر wept, and asked السائب who else had fallen. Al-Sā'ib listed the notables and the well-known. Then he added: *and others of the ordinary people, whom the Commander of the Believers does not know*. That is the sentence عمر answered. **The statement:**

وما ضرهم أن لا يعرفهم أمير المؤمنين؟ لكن الله يعرفهم وقد أكرمهم الله بالشهادة، وما يصنعون بمعرفة عمر — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3379> English: "And what harm did it do them that the Commander of the Believers does not know them? But God knows them, and God has honoured them with martyrdom — and what would they want with 'Umar knowing them?" **عبرت:** History records the names it happens to have; that is a limitation of history, not a ranking of the dead. **Hands-up?** Whose names does a history book keep?

GSA/E-ST24 · No man has a living father between himself and Adam

Tier: CORE · **When:** الجابية, ١٥هـ [SOURCED — البدايم prints it under «ثم دخلت سنة خمس عشرة» and its own text says «وذلك في سنة خمسة عشر»]; the core of the address is in أحمد، **Map:** الجولان in الجابية, where the commanders assembled **What happened:** عمر rode north and the commanders of the armies met him at al-Jābiya before the handover of Jerusalem. He gave a long address there. ابن كثير abridges it and keeps the part that had already entered the ḥadīth collections. In the middle of it is one sentence that cancels the entire logic of ancestry — and he said it in front of the men who had just conquered Syria. **The statement:**

· واعلموا أن رجلاً ليس بينه وبين آدم أبٌ حيٌّ، ولا بينه وبين الله هوادة — البدايم والنهيه ج ٧ ص ١٥٨ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3304> English: "And know that no man has a living father between himself and Adam, and that between himself and God there is no favouritism." **عبرت:** Every ancestor a man is proud of is dead, and none of them will be standing beside him. **Hands-up?** Half of Arabia had just broken away over whose tribe should be in front. What do you say to that, in one sentence?

GSA/E-ST25 · We flee from the decree of God to the decree of God

Tier: CORE · **When:** سَرِغ, ١٧هـ [SOURCED — البخاري ٥٧٢٩] · **Map:** سَرِغ, on the road from Medina into الشام — the caliph turns back **What happened:** عمر was riding to Syria. At Sargh the commanders met him with news: plague was in the country ahead. He consulted, and the Companions divided. He ordered the return. أبو عبيدة challenged him in front of everyone: *fleeing from the decree of God?* عمر agreed with the word and

turned it round — then gave a picture of a valley with two banks, one green and one bare, where grazing either one is God's decree. Then عبد الرحمن بن عوف ^{رضي} arrived with the ḥadīth, and it settled the matter. And عمر ^{رضي} had one more line for عبدة ^{رضي}. **The statement:**

أفرارًا من قدر الله؟ قال: نعم! نفرُّ من قدر الله إلى قدر الله ... ثم قال: لو غيرك يقولها يا أبا عبدة — البدايه والنهيه ١٨٦ ج ٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3332> English: "Fleeing from the decree of God?" He said: "Yes — we flee from the decree of God to the decree of God ... " Then he said: "If it were anyone but you saying it, Abū 'Ubayda." **عبرت:** Trusting God and taking precautions are not two policies; the argument only looks like a contradiction from outside. **Hands-up?** *An epidemic is ahead of you on the road. Riding on — is that trust, or is turning back?*

GSA/E-ST26 · Which Sha'bān? — the calendar begins with an unpaid debt

Tier: CORE · **When:** ربيع الأول ١٦هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** A promissory note was brought to عمر ^{رضي}. A debt was due «in Sha'bān». He asked which Sha'bān — this year's, last year's, or next year's — and nobody could answer, because there was no year. He gathered the people and told them to build something people could measure their debts by. They considered dating from the Persian kings, from Alexander, from the Prophet's ^ﷺ birth, from his sending. علي بن أبي طالب ^{رضي} proposed the Hijra, for a reason that was practical rather than devotional: everyone can see it. **The statement:**

أي شعبان؟ أمن هذه السنة أم التي قبلها، أم التي بعدها ... ضعوا للناس شيئًا يعرفون فيه حلول ديونهم — البدايه والنهيه ١٨٦ ج ٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3327> English: "Which Sha'bān? This year's, or last year's, or next year's? ... Set the people something by which they can know when their debts fall due." **عبرت:** The Muslim calendar was not built to commemorate; it was built so that an ordinary man could prove when he had to pay. **Hands-up?** *What year is it? Now — how do you know? (Then the date on the note we all use.)*

GSA/E-ST27 · «I would love to come out of it break-even»

Tier: CORE · **When:** ذو الحجة ٢٣هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** عمر ^{رضي} was stabbed at the dawn prayer. As he lay dying, people began to praise him — *you were, and you did, and you were*. He stopped them. Ten years of conquest, the calendar, the diwan, the provinces — and the assessment he gave of all of it was a merchant's word: break even. Nothing owed, nothing earned. The only thing he asked to keep was that his companionship of the Prophet ^ﷺ should come through undamaged. **The statement:**

أما والله وددت أنني خرجت منها كفافًا لا علي ولا لي وأن صحبة رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم سلمت لي — سير (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) ص ٩٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1235> English: "By God, I would love to come out of it break-even — nothing against me and nothing for me — and that my companionship of the Messenger of God ^ﷺ came through safe." **عبرت:** The man with the largest ledger in the world hoped only that it would balance. **Hands-up?** *He conquered an empire. What score would you expect him to give himself?*

GSA/E-ST28 · He rules out his own son, by name

Tier: CORE · **When:** ذو الحجة ٢٣هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** Dying, عمر ^{رضي} was pressed to name a successor. His own son عبد الله ^{رضي} was suggested to him — by his son himself in one account, and by another

man in another. He had himself sat up, and refused, twice, in the sharpest language in the whole record. **The statement:**

فما أنا قائل لله إذا سألني عن أمرت عليهم ... لأرددها إلى الذي دفعها إلي أول مرة، ولوددت أن عليها من هو خير
 ٩٣ https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1238 English: "What am I to
 say to God when He asks me about the man I set over them? ... I shall hand it back to the One who
 gave it to me in the first place. And I would love it if someone better than me were over it." **عبرت:**
 Refusing to hand power to your own family is a decision, and it has to be made out loud, on the record,
 or it does not hold. **Hands-up?** He had a son who was a Companion, and universally respected. Does he
 appoint him? **Session 4** is where ملوكيت → خلافت is handled. **Do not draw the comparison here.**
 State this fact, let it stand, and move on.

GSA/E-ST29 · عمر^{رضي} asks permission to be buried

Tier: CORE · **When:** ذو الحجة ٢٣هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** عائشة of حجرة , Medina **What happened:** With his
 debts counted — eighty-six thousand, or thereabouts, to be paid from his own family's property first — عمر^{رضي}
 sent his son to عائشة^{رضي}. Not with an instruction. With a request. She had been keeping that place for herself.

The statement:

اذهب إلى أم المؤمنين عائشة فقل: يستأذن عمر أن يدفن مع صاحبيه ... فقالت: كنت أريده -تعني المكان- لنفسي
 ٩١ https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1236 English:
 "Go to the Mother of the Believers, 'Ā'isha, and say: 'Umar asks permission to be buried with his two
 companions." ... She said: "I wanted it for myself — but today I shall certainly prefer him to myself."
عبرت: He held the largest office on earth and still had to ask; and she, who could have said no, gave up
 her own place. **Hands-up?** no. This is the closing slide. Say nothing after it.

GSA/E-ST30 · أبو عبيدة^{رضي} will not leave his army in the plague

Tier: CORE · **When:** طاعون عمواس — the statement [SOURCED — رواته كلهم ثقات] , the year
 ١٨هـ [CONVENTIONAL-ESTIMATE — البدايم prints its material under ١٧هـ; see §3.1] ·

Map: الجابية in فلسطين; then the move up to **What happened:** Plague broke out in Syria and عمر^{رضي}
 wrote to his commander-in-chief. The letter did not mention the plague. It said a matter had come up that he
 had to discuss face to face, and that أبو عبيدة^{رضي} should not put the letter down before setting out. أبو عبيدة^{رضي} read
 it and knew exactly what it was: *he wants to keep alive a man who is not going to remain*. He wrote back asking
 to be released from the order. When عمر^{رضي} read the reply he wept, and the people around him asked if أبو
 عبيدة^{رضي} had died. Then عمر^{رضي} wrote a second letter — move the men to higher ground — and أبو عبيدة^{رضي} obeyed
 that one at once, and was struck as he put his foot in the stirrup. **The statement:**

فَحَلَّلْنِي مِنْ عَزِيمَتِكَ، فَإِنِّي فِي جُنْدٍ مِنْ أَجْدَادِ الْمُسْلِمِينَ، لَا أَرْغَبُ بِنَفْسِي عَنْهُمْ. فَلَمَّا قَرَأَ عُمَرُ الْكِتَابَ، بَكَى، فَقِيلَ لَهُ:
 ١٩-١٨هـ https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1444 English: "Release me from your insistence. I am in one of the armies of the Muslims, and I will not
 hold myself above them." ... When 'Umar read the letter he wept. It was said to him: "Has Abū 'Ubayda
 died?" He said: "No — but as good as." **عبرت:** He refused the order that would have saved him and
 obeyed the one that saved his men, and both refusals came from the same principle. **Hands-up?** Your
 commander orders you out of an epidemic. Your men stay. Do you go?

GSA/E-ST31 · «I wish I were in his skin»

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٨٥-١٣ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** أبو عبيدة بن الجراح — Amīn hādhihi l-umma, commander-in-chief in Syria, and a man of Quraysh — stood up in front of his own army and said what his Qurashī descent was worth against taqwā. **The statement:**

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ! إِنِّي امْرُؤٌ مِنْ قُرَيْشٍ، وَمَا مِنْكُمْ مَنْ أَحْمَرُ وَلَا أَسْوَدَ يَفْضُلُنِي يَتَّقُوهُ، إِلَّا وَدِدْتُ أَنِّي فِي مَسَلَاخِهِ — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ١٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1444> English: "People — I am a man of Quraysh, and there is not one of you, red or black, who surpasses me in fear of God but I wish I were in his skin." **عبرت:** He did not deny his lineage; he priced it. **Hands-up?** no. Pair it on the screen with E-ST24 and let the two stand together.

GSA/E-ST32 · خالد divides his sandals with the treasury

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٣هـ, after اليرموك [SOURCED] · **Map:** the Syrian command passing from خالد to أبو عبيدة **What happened:** عمر became caliph and the first order he gave was to remove Khālīd ibn al-Walīd from command — at the height of his success, immediately after Yarmūk. أبو عبيدة carried it out. The turban came off his head and his property was divided in half with the treasury, down to one of his two sandals. خالد said one thing throughout. **Why he was dismissed is disputed inside our own sources and must not be settled from the platform — see §2.5(d). The statement:**

فقاومه أبو عبيدة حتى أخذ [إحدى] (٢) نعليه وترك له الأخرى (٣)، وخالد يقول سمعًا وطاعة لأمر المؤمنين — البداية والنهاية ج ٧ ص ١٠٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3249> English: Abū 'Ubayda divided with him until he took one of his two sandals and left him the other — and Khālīd kept saying: "To hear and to obey, for the Commander of the Believers." **عبرت:** A state survives its best men only if its best men can be removed, and are willing to be. **Hands-up?** The greatest general of the age has just won the war. The new caliph's first order is — what?

GSA/E-ST33 · خالد dies in his bed

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ٢١هـ، حمص [SOURCED — Ibn Ḥajar: «إسناده حسن»] · **Map:** حمص **What happened:** خالد بن الوليد died on a mattress. He said he had looked for death in the places where it is most likely to be found and had not been given it. Then he named the one deed he hoped in most, after tawhīd — and it was not a battle. It was a night spent behind a shield in the rain, waiting for morning. His last instruction was about his weapon and his horse. When he died he left nothing but those and a servant. **The statement:**

لَقَدْ طَلَبْتُ الْقَتْلَ مَطَاطَةً، فَلَمْ يُقَدَّرْ لِي إِلَّا أَنْ أَمُوتَ عَلَى فِرَاشِي، وَمَا مِنْ عَمَلِي شَيْءٌ أَرْجَى عِنْدِي بَعْدَ التَّوْحِيدِ مِنْ لَيْلَةٍ يَتُّهَا وَأَنَا مُتَتَرِّسٌ، وَالسَّمَاءُ تُهْلِي، تَنْتَظِرُ الصُّبْحَ حَتَّى تُغَيِّرَ عَلَى الْكُفَّارِ — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٣٨١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1807> English: "I sought death in the places where it is most likely to be found, and it was not decreed for me except to die in my bed. And nothing of my deeds do I hope in more, after tawhīd, than one night I spent behind my shield with the sky raining on me, waiting for the dawn so that we could ride down on the unbelievers." **عبرت:** He counted the waiting, not the victories. **Hands-up?** Of everything he did, which one night do you think he hoped in most? ▲ Use this wording. The famous «فلا نامت أعين الجبناء» wording runs through الواقدي, and it does **not** say "a hundred battles" — see §X.4.

GSA/E-ST34 · By night monks, by day horsemen

Tier: CORE · **When:** ١٣هـ, before دمشق [STANDARD – the chain has an unnamed link; see §4.2] ·

Map: the Muslim camp in the Jordan country, seen from Damascus **What happened:** The commander of Damascus sent for two Christian Arabs in the market and asked one of them to go out and look at these people who had come. The man came back and described what he had seen: lean men on good horses, mending their arrows and straightening their spears; and a noise over the camp so loud you could not hear the man sitting next to you. The commander turned to his own people and told them what it meant. **The statement:**

أما الليل فرهبان، وأما النهار ففرسان ... لو حَدَّثْتَ جليساك حديثًا ما فهمه عنك لما علا من أصواتهم بالقرآن والذكر ... ٩٩ ص٧ ج٧ والنهائيه — البدايه البدايه والنهائيه ج٧ ص٩٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3245> English: "By night they are monks and by day they are horsemen ... and if you spoke to the man sitting beside you he would not catch what you said, for the noise of their voices with the Qur'ān and the remembrance of God." ... "There has come upon you from them what you have no strength against." **عبرت:** What frightened the other side was not the cavalry; it was the noise coming off the camp at night. **Hands-up?** If you sent a spy into their camp, what would you expect him to report?

GSA/E-ST35 · Heraclius asks his own men why they keep losing

Tier: GOOD · **When:** after ١٣هـ اليرموك, [STANDARD – maqtū', no grading on the page; البدايه prints it under «سنة ثلاث عشرة», the same year-chapter as E-ST32 and E-ST34] · **Map:** أنطاكية, with the beaten army coming in **What happened:** Heraclius was at Antioch when his defeated troops came back. He asked them three questions: are these people not human like you; are you not more numerous; then why do you run? One of their elders answered him, and the answer had two halves — what the Muslims do, and what we do. Heraclius accepted it. **The statement:**

من أجل أنهم يقومون الليل ويصومون النهار، ويوفون بالعهد، ويأمرون بالمعروف، وينهون عن المنكر، ويتناصفون بينهم، ومن أجل أنا نشرب الخمر، ونزني ... وننقض العهد، ونغصب ونظلم ... فقال: أنت صدقتني — البدايه والنهائيه ج٧ ص٩٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3245> English: "Because they stand at night and fast by day; they keep their covenant; they command what is right and forbid what is wrong; and they deal justly among themselves — and because we drink wine, and commit adultery ... and break covenants, and seize and oppress ..." He said: "You have told me the truth." **عبرت:** The explanation the losing side gave for its own defeat was a moral one, and nobody made them say it. **Hands-up?** Why do you think they won? — collect answers, then read this.

GSA/E-ST36 · ربعي بن عامر^{رض} walks his horse onto the carpet

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١٤-١٥هـ, before القادسية [STANDARD – VIA سيف/الطبرى see §4.1] · **Map:** رستم's camp on the Euphrates, facing القادسية **What happened:** سعد^{رض} sent an envoy to Rustam. The hall was laid with gilt cushions and silk; Rustam was on a throne of gold. ربعي^{رض} rode a short horse to the edge of the carpet, tied it to one of the cushions, and came forward in armour leaning on his spear, so that the spear tore the rugs. They told him to put down his weapon; he said he had not come to them, they had called him. Then they asked what had brought him. Later, asked whether he was their chief, he gave the better answer of the two. **The statement:**

الله ابتعثنا لنخرج من شاء من عبادة العباد إلى عبادة الله، ومن ضيق الدنيا إلى سعتها، ومن جور الأديان إلى عدل الإسلام ... لا: ولكن المسلمون كالجسد الواحد يجير أديانهم على أعلاهم — البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ١٣٤

<https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3280> English: "God sent us to bring out whoever wishes, from the worship of servants to the worship of God; from the narrowness of this world to its breadth; and from the injustice of the religions to the justice of Islam." ... "No — but the Muslims are like one body: the lowest of them can give protection that binds the highest of them." **عبرت**: He was not the chief and it made no difference; that was the whole of his answer. **Hands-up?** no. **△** The most famous sentence of the period, and **not soundly chained**. Introduce with "as the books tell it", never "he said". See §4.1.

GSA/E-ST37 · «Are you making rhymes at me, or reporting?»

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ٢٢-٢٣ هـ [STANDARD — VIA سيف/ الطبرى] · **Map:** مكران, the Sind frontier — and the line drew across it **What happened:** An officer came back from the far eastern frontier with the fifth of the spoils. عمر asked him what the country was like. The man answered in polished rhyming prose — mountain for plain, a trickle for water, poor dates, a fierce enemy. عمر cut across him with one question. The man said he was reporting. So عمر wrote to the commander not to campaign beyond Mukrān, and to stop at the river.

The statement:

أَرْضُ سَهْلُهَا جَبَلٌ، وَمَاؤُهَا وَشَلٌ (٤)، وَتَمْرُهَا (٥) دَقْلٌ (٦)، وَعَدُوُّهَا بَطْلٌ ... فقال عمر: أَسْجَأُ أَنْتَ أَمْ مُخْبِرٌ — البدايه <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3407> English: "A land whose plain is mountain, whose water is a trickle, whose dates are the poorest kind, whose enemy is a champion ..." 'Umar said: "Are you making rhymes at me, or reporting?" **عبرت**: A frontier was closed because one officer was made to say plainly what he had actually seen. **Hands-up?** *The empire is winning everywhere. Where does it stop?*

GSA/E-ST38 · سلمان, dying, on the provisions of a rider

Tier: GOOD · **When:** **△ NOT in this window** — under عثمان, ٣٣-٣٦ هـ [SOURCED] · **Map:** المدائن **What happened:** سعد بن أبي وقاص and ابن مسعود came to see سلمان at al-Madā'in as he lay dying, and found him weeping. It was not fear of death and not love of the world. It was one instruction of the Prophet ﷺ that he thought he had not kept. Then he turned to سعد, the conqueror of Iraq, and gave him three clauses. When he died he left twenty-odd dirhams. **The statement:**

عَهْدُ عَهْدَةِ إِلَيْنَا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - لَمْ تَحْفَظْهُ. قَالَ: (لِيَكُنْ بَلَاغُ أَحَدِكُمْ مِنَ الدُّنْيَا كَزَادِ الرَّائِبِ). وَأَمَّا أَنْتَ يَا سَعْدُ، فَاتَّقِ اللَّهَ فِي حُكْمِكَ إِذَا حَكَمْتَ، وَفِي قَسْمِكَ إِذَا قَسَمْتَ، وَعِنْدَ هَيْكَلِكَ إِذَا هَمَمْتَ — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٥٥٢ <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1978> English: "A charge the Messenger of God ﷺ laid on us which we have not kept: 'Let what any one of you takes from this world be like the provisions of a rider.' And as for you, Sa'd — fear God in your judgement when you judge, and in your dividing when you divide, and in your intention when you set your mind on something." **عبرت**: A man who left twenty dirhams thought he had taken too much. **Hands-up?** no. **Say plainly that this is later than tonight's twelve years** — see §5.

GSA/E-ST39 · «Sāriya — the mountain!»

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ٢٣ هـ (قَسَا / دَارَابَجَرْد) [SOURCED — «إِسْنَادٌ جَيِّدٌ حَسَنٌ» ابن كثير] · **Map:** قَسَا — فارس **What happened:** سارية بن زعيم was being surrounded far away in Persia. In Medina, in the middle

of the Friday sermon, عمر^{رضي} broke off and called out a name and two words, three times. Nobody in the mosque understood it. When the army's messenger arrived he said they had been breaking when they heard a caller, put their backs to the mountain, and were saved. ابن كثير gives four routes for this, grades one of them good, and says they strengthen one another. And عمر^{رضي}, asked what it had been, refused to claim anything for it. **The statement:**

يا ساري الجبل (يا ساري الجبل ... فقل لعمر بن الخطاب: ما ذلك الكلام؟ فقال: واللّٰه ما ألقيت له إلّا بشيء ألقِي على يا ساري الجبل) ... فقل لعمر بن الخطاب: ما ذلك الكلام؟ فقال: واللّٰه ما ألقيت له إلّا بشيء ألقِي على ... البدايه والنهيه ج ٧ ص ٢٦٠ English: "Sāriya — the mountain! Sāriya — the mountain!" ... 'Umar was asked: "What was that speech?" He said: "By God, I gave no thought to it at all — it was something cast onto my tongue." **عبرت:** The man it happened through took no credit for it, and that is the part worth keeping. **Hands-up?** He stopped in the middle of the *khuṭba* and shouted a name. Why? **△** Narrate it exactly as ابن كثير does, grading and all, and put عمر^{رضي}'s own line on the same slide. Do not build anything on it.

GSA/E-ST40 · معاوية^{رضي}'s three-line verdict on the two caliphs

Tier: GOOD · **When:** later; a retrospective judgement [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** معاوية بن أبي سفيان^{رضي}, looking back, summed up his two predecessors and then his own generation in one sentence. **△ This card has no \$1–\$6 entry behind it; it stands on its page alone.** The three-clause wording is راشدون^{رضي} (راشدون) s'سير. English: "As for Abū Bakr — he did not want the world and it did not want him. As for 'Umar — the world wanted him and he did not want it. As for us — we rolled about in it, back and front." **عبرت:** The clearest description of the change came from a man describing himself in it. **Hands-up?** no. **△** This is a bridge into session 4 and it must be left as a bridge. **Read it, and stop.** Do not gloss it, do not extend it, and do not let it become an argument about anyone. **The statement:**

أما أبو بكر فلم يرد الدنيا ولم ترده، وأما عمر فأرادته الدنيا ولم يردّها، وأما نحن فتمرغنا فيها ظهرها لبطن — سير (سير) البدايه ج ٧ ص ٢٦٤–٢٦٥ English: "As for Abū Bakr — he did not want the world and it did not want him. As for 'Umar — the world wanted him and he did not want it. As for us — we rolled about in it, back and front." **عبرت:** The clearest description of the change came from a man describing himself in it. **Hands-up?** no. **△** This is a bridge into session 4 and it must be left as a bridge. **Read it, and stop.** Do not gloss it, do not extend it, and do not let it become an argument about anyone.

GSA/E-ST41 · الذهبي رحمه الله corrects his own book

Tier: GOOD (for «كيسے پتا چلا؟», not for narrative) · **When:** written ~8th c. AH about سلمان^{رضي} [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** People said سلمان^{رضي} had lived three hundred and fifty years, and that two hundred and fifty of them were beyond doubt. الذهبي رحمه الله had himself written the figure of two hundred and fifty into his own earlier history. On this page he takes it back — in public, in writing — reasons from what سلمان^{رضي} actually did with his life, puts him in his eighties, and then invites correction from anyone who knows better. **The statement:**

قَمَنْ كَانَ عِنْدَهُ عِلْمٌ فَلْيُفِدْنَا ... وَقَدْ ذَكَرْتُ فِي (تاريخي الكبير) أَنَّهُ عَاشَ مَائَتَيْنِ وَخَمْسِينَ سَنَةً، وَأَنَا السَّاعَةَ لَا أَرْتَضِي ٥٥٦ ص ٥٥٦ English: "So whoever has knowledge of it, let him inform us ... I stated in my *Tārīkh al-Kabīr* that he lived two hundred and fifty years, and at this moment I do not accept that and do not hold it sound." **△ Both sentences are on ٥٥٦ ص, and they run in this order on the page** — the invitation to correct him first, the retraction a few lines later. The 350/250 figures they answer are on ٥٥٥ ص (https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1981). **عبرت:** The men who preserved this history corrected

themselves in writing, and left the correction in the book. **Hands-up?** *If a historian finds he was wrong twenty years ago, what does he do?*

GSA/E-ST42 · CUT — recorded so it is never re-researched

Tier: CUT · **When:** various · **Map:** n/a **What happened:** Five items were read, verified and deliberately set aside. They are listed here with their pages so that a future pass does not spend a second on them:

1. **The long homiletic passage** «أين الجبارون ... أين الملوك» after أبو بكر's second address — البداية ج ٧ ص ٩. Two printed pages, and سيف's transmission.
2. **The messenger who ate with عمر without knowing him** — البداية ج ٧ ص ٢٥٩, ٢٦٢. Fine as narrative; **no quotable statement**, and the only dialogue in it is domestic.
3. **s exchange with عمر about her clothing** — البداية ج ٧ ص ٢٥٩. Domestic; leave out.
4. **The commanders' brocade tunics at الجابية and the pebbles** — البداية ج ٧ ص ١٥٨. One line of colour in the script at most; not a slide.
5. **خالد and the silk shirt, and the audit of his wealth** — سير ج ١ ص ٣٨٠-٣٨١. The audit report is **FLAGGED WEAK** (سيف) and the silk-shirt exchange needs a fiqh footnote about the concession granted to ابن عوف, which is more than the evening can carry. **The statement:** none in the sources we use. **عبرت:** — **Hands-up?** no.

ابن خلدون: how he reads it (framing only)

Source note: [ibn-khaldun-on-the-rida-the-conquests-and-method.md](#) — read it for the pages behind these cards.

IKO/E-IKM1 · The count is the weakest part of the story

Tier: CORE · **When:** n/a — a claim about method, not a dated event · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn opens his book with a warning, and it is not about lying. It is about counting. He says that when historians report sums of money and the sizes of armies, that is exactly where a report is likeliest to be false. He does not say the battles did not happen. He says the numbers travelled differently from the events. His reason is simple. Nobody was ever going to check.

The statement:

ولا سيّما في إحصاء الأعداد من الأموال والعساكر إذا عرضت في الحكايات إذ هي مظنة الكذب ومطية الهذر — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ١٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/12320/11> English: "— and especially in the counting of sums of money and of armies when they appear in the narratives, for these are the place where falsehood is to be expected and the mount that idle talk rides."

عبرت: A number nobody could check is the part of a story that travels least well. **Hands-up?** Yes — "When a report says an army was a hundred thousand men, who counted them?"

IKO/E-IKM2 · Two figures for one army, in one book

Tier: CORE · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn warned that army-counts are the likeliest thing in a history to be wrong. Then he wrote his own history. On page fourteen he records the Persian host at al-Qādisiyya twice: a hundred and twenty thousand on one transmission, sixty thousand on another. He does not choose between them. A hundred and eighty-four pages later, arguing a different point, he uses the larger figure. The man is not being careless. He is showing us, in his own hand, exactly what he told us to expect.

The statement:

وأعظم ما كانت جموعهم بالقادسيّة مائة وعشرين ألفاً كلّهم متبوع على ما نقله سيف ... وعن عائشة والزّهريّ فإنّ جموع رستم الذين زحف بهم سعد بالقادسيّة إنّما كانوا ستّين ألفاً كلّهم متبوع — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ١٤
<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/12> English: "The largest their host ever was at al-Qādisiyya was one hundred and twenty thousand, every one of them a man with followers, according to what Sayf transmitted ... And from 'Ā'isha and al-Zuhri: the host of Rustam against which Sa'd advanced at al-Qādisiyya was only sixty thousand, every one of them a man with followers."

عبرت: The honest historian is not the one whose numbers agree; he is the one who shows you that they do not. **Hands-up?** No. Put ج ١ ص ١٤ and ج ١ ص ١٩٨ side by side and let the room read them.

IKO/E-IKM3 · Seven ways a report goes wrong, and partisanship is the first

Tier: CORE · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn does not treat falsehood in history as the moral failure of individual liars. He treats it as a thing with causes, and he lists them. Seven. The first is partisanship for an opinion or a school. His point is unsettling and exact. It is not that a partisan lies. It is that a partisan stops checking, because the report already agrees with him. The scrutiny he would give anything else never gets given at all.

The statement:

وإذا خامرها تشييع لرأي أو نحلة قبلت ما يوافقها من الأخبار لأوّل وهلة وكان ذلك الميل والتشييع غطاء على عين وإذا خامرها تشييع لرأي أو نحلة قبلت ما يوافقها من الأخبار لأوّل وهلة وكان ذلك الميل والتشييع غطاء على عين
 ٢٦ — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ٢٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/12320/44> English: "When partisanship for some opinion or creed has got into it, it accepts whatever agrees with it at first hearing — and that inclination and partisanship become a covering over the eye of its insight, keeping it from criticism and scrutiny."

عبرت: The report you are least able to test is the one that already agrees with you. **Hands-up?** No. This one lands better read plainly than asked about.

IKO/E-IKM4 · A fiqh test and a history test are not the same test

Tier: CORE — **this is the guardrail** · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn draws a line that this whole course rests on, and he draws it in one sentence. Checking the chain of transmitters, he says, is the right test for a legal report — because a legal report imposes an obligation, and an obligation must be secure before it binds. But a report about an event needs something else first. It needs to be possible. If a thing could not have happened, examining who narrated it is wasted effort.

The statement:

وإنّما كان التّعديل والتّجريح هو المعتبر في صحّة الأخبار الشرعيّة لأنّ معظمها تكاليف إنشائيّة أوجب الشّارع العمل بها ... وأما الأخبار عن الواقعات فلا بدّ في صدقها وصحّتها من اعتبار المطابقة — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج١ ص٤٩
<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/47> English: "Vetting the transmitters is the operative test for the soundness of legal reports, because most of them are prescriptive obligations the Lawgiver has made binding ... But as for reports about events, their truth and soundness require testing them against correspondence."

عبرت: A report of an event is neither a ruling nor a creed; it is a record, and it is weighed as one. **Hands-up?** No. Deliver it flat and move on.

IKO/E-IKM5 · The disease that only shows itself after centuries

Tier: GOOD · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn names an error he calls hard to catch, and he is right. It is the habit of reading a later century's meanings back into an earlier one. He calls it a deep-seated disease, extremely well hidden, because it only becomes visible after long stretches of time have passed. A man is not wrong about the fact. He is wrong about what the fact meant to the people it happened to.

The statement:

ومن الغلط الخفيّ في التّاريخ الدّهول عن تبدّل الأحوال في الأمم والأجيال بتبدّل الأعصار ومرار الأيّام وهو داء دوي
<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/35> English: "Among the hidden errors in history is inattention to the fact that the conditions of peoples and generations change as the ages change and the days pass. It is a deep-seated disease, extremely hard to detect."

عبرت: Distance in time is not only distance in dates; the words themselves have moved. **Hands-up?** Yes — "If someone in the year 2500 read that a man taught school, what would they assume about him?"

IKO/E-IKM6 · The schoolteacher's son

Tier: GOOD · **When:** the point concerns الحجاج بن يوسف d. ٩٥هـ [STANDARD] (to verify) · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn gives an example of that error, and it is a small, clean one. People read that al-Ḥajjāj's father taught the Qur'ān and conclude the family were nobodies. He answers that in the first age of Islam teaching was not what it is in our own day, a trade to live by. Al-Ḥajjāj's father was one of the chiefs and nobles of Thaqīf. The reader had the fact right and the century wrong.

The statement:

والحجّاج بن يوسف كان أبوه من سادات ثقيف وأشرفهم ... ولم يكن تعليمه للقرآن على ما هو الأمر عليه لهذا العهد
<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/38> English: "As for al-Ḥajjāj ibn Yūsuf, his father was among the chiefs and nobles of Thaqīf ... and his teaching of the Qur'ān was not what the matter is in our own day, that it is a trade for a living."

عبرت: The same word does not carry the same weight in two different centuries. **Hands-up?** No.

IKO/E-IKM7 · He tests the method on a figure nobody is attached to

Tier: GOOD · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn wanted to show how to test a number, so he picked one nobody in his audience had a stake in. Historians reported six hundred thousand fighting men counted in the wilderness. He asked four questions. Could that land feed them. Could a field hold them. Did any empire we know of ever put such a number on a battlefield. And could one family line reach that size in four generations. The answers ruled the figure out. He never had to accuse anyone of lying.

The statement:

· والحاضر يشهد لذلك فالماضي أشبه بالآتي من الماء بالماء. — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ١٤
<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/12> English: "And the present bears witness to this — for the past resembles what is to come as water resembles water."

عبرت: What you can see today is the only measuring stick you have for what you cannot. **Hands-up?** Yes — "How would you check a number nobody alive ever counted?"

IKO/E-IKM8 · He calls al-Bukhārī a historian

Tier: GOOD · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: A room that trusts the Ṣaḥīḥ absolutely can still be wary of the word history. Ibn Khaldūn closes that gap in one clause. He says the ancients held history in the highest regard, and then names the men who took it up. Al-Ṭabarī. Al-Bukhārī. And Ibn Ishāq before both of them. These are not three kinds of men. They are scholars of the umma working one discipline with different aims.

The statement:

وما استكبر القدماء علم التاريخ إلا لذلك حتى انتحله الطبريّ والبخاريّ وابن إسحاق من قبلهما وأمثالهم من علماء الأمة — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ٣٧
<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/35> English: "The ancients held the science of history in such high regard only for this reason — so much so that al-Ṭabarī and al-Bukhārī, and Ibn Ishāq before them, and their like among the scholars of the umma, took it up."

عبرت: History was never outside the scholarship of this umma; it was one of its instruments. **Hands-up?** No.

IKO/E-IKA1 · What actually holds a people together

Tier: CORE · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a — but this is the concept the ١١٥ tribal map rests on

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn gives kinship a name and a job. He does not call it a virtue and he does not call it a vice. He says the bond of kin is simply natural in people, and that part of that bond is the surge of feeling when a relative is wronged. That surge is what makes a group defensible. He anchors it on the brothers of Yūsuf, peace be upon him, saying that nobody would dare touch a man who has a kin-group behind him.

The statement:

وذلك أنّ صلة الرّحم طبيعيّ في البشر إلا في الأقلّ ومن صلتها النّعمة على ذوي القربى وأهل الأرحام أن ينالهم · ضيم أو تصيبهم هلكة — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ١٦٠
<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/158> English: "For the bond of kinship is natural in human beings, save in the fewest of cases; and part of that bond is the

surge of feeling on behalf of close relatives and kinsfolk, that no wrong should reach them and no ruin befall them."

عبرت: Before there were states in Arabia there were kin, and kin were the only protection anybody had.

Hands-up? Yes — *"In a land with no police and no courts, who protects you?"* [△] Say the two senses of عصبية out loud before this card (§4.1), or half the room hears the condemned sense.

IKO/E-IKA2 · The man standing alone slips away in the dark

Tier: GOOD · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn explains what happens to a man with no kin behind him. Not in peace — in battle. He writes that a man alone in his lineage feels no surge on anyone's behalf, and nobody feels one on his. So when the air darkens with evil on the day of fighting, each such man slips away looking to save himself. It is not an accusation of cowardice. It is an observation that there was nothing holding him there.

The statement:

وأما المتفردون في أنسابهم فقل أن تصيب أحدا منهم نعمة على صاحبه فإذا أظلم الجو بالشر يوم الحرب تسلل كل واحد منهم يبغي النجاة لنفسه — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ١٦٠ <https://shamela.ws/book/12320/158> English: "As for men standing alone in their lineage, seldom does any of them feel that surge on his comrade's behalf; so when the air darkens with evil on the day of battle, each of them slips away seeking his own escape."

عبرت: Men hold a line for the people beside them before they hold it for anything else. **Hands-up?** No.

IKO/E-IKA3 · Nothing gets carried without a people to carry it

Tier: CORE · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn takes the point about defending a camp and widens it as far as it will go. Anything that has to be carried against resistance, he says, needs a group behind it. He names three things in one breath: prophethood, the founding of a realm, and a call. Human beings resist; resistance has to be met; and meeting it takes people who will stand together. He states it as a rule with no exceptions.

The statement:

فبمثله يتبين لك في كل أمر يحمل الناس عليه من نبوة أو إقامة ملك أو دعوة إذ بلوغ الغرض من ذلك كله إنما يتم بالقتال عليه لما في طبائع البشر من الاستعصاء ولا بد في القتال من العصبية — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ١٦٠ <https://shamela.ws/book/12320/158> English: "The like becomes clear to you in every undertaking men are called to — prophethood, the founding of a realm, or a summons — since attaining the aim in any of these is only completed by fighting for it, given what is in human nature of resistance; and in fighting there is no doing without عصبية."

عبرت: A truth still needs people willing to stand for it before it moves anything in the world. **Hands-up?** No.

IKO/E-IKA4 · Leadership does not leave the line it started in

Tier: GOOD · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn makes a claim about how leadership moves inside a kin-group, and it explains the shape of a great many arguments in early Arabia. Leadership, he says, sits in one branch of a stock, not in the whole of it, and it passes only to the strongest branch of that same stock. An outsider, however long attached and however trusted, does not acquire it. He is an attached man, and attachment gives no ascendancy.

The statement:

والسَّاقَطُ فِي نَسَبِهِمْ بِالْجُمْلَةِ لَا تَكُونُ لَهُ عَصَبِيَّةٌ فِيهِمْ بِالنَّسَبِ إِنَّمَا هُوَ مَلْصِقٌ لَزِيْقٍ وَغَايَةُ التَّعَصُّبِ لَهُ بِالْوَلَاءِ وَالْحَلْفِ
 ١٦٥ — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ١٦٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/12320/163> English:
 "One who has no standing at all in their lineage has no عصبية among them by descent; he is merely an attached, adhering outsider, and the most that can be felt for him is by clientage or alliance — and that gives him no ascendancy over them whatsoever."

عبرت: In a world organised by kin, the first question about any leader was not what he had done but whose he was. **Hands-up?** No. **△ HANDLING — this card explains the *shape* of the argument at سقيفة, never its merits.** Ibn Khaldūn himself never applies it there (§7.3). Do not let it drift into adjudication.

IKO/E-IKA5 · Where kinship-strength ends up

Tier: GOOD — **for session 4, not session 1** · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn does not leave group strength as a description. He gives it a destination. It runs, he says, towards one end, and that end is kingship. Leadership is being followed; kingship is being obeyed. And a man who has reached the first and can see the road to the second does not stop, because the human soul wants it. He states this as a natural tendency, not as a judgement on any particular man.

The statement:

١٧٤ — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ١٧٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/12320/172>
 English: "Royal ascendancy is the end-point towards which عصبية runs, as you have seen."

عبرت: Group strength has a direction of its own, and it does not stop where its holders intended. **Hands-up?** No. **△ This is the seed of the ملوكيت → خلافت theme.** **CLAUDE.md §1.5 flags session 4 as one of the two evenings that carry real charge with this organisation. Deploy it there, attributed to him, and not in session 1.**

IKO/E-IKA6 · Many small loyalties, or one big one

Tier: GOOD · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn describes what happens inside a single tribe that contains several houses. Each house has its own loyalty. Unless one of them is strong enough to draw the rest after it until they fuse into a single great loyalty, the tribe splits, and the splitting leads to disagreement and then to strife. It is the plainest possible account of why a confederation is either led or is nothing.

The statement:

فلا بدّ من عصبية تكون أقوى من جميعها تغلبها وتستتبعها وتلتحم جميع العصبية فيها وتصير كأنّها عصبية واحدة كبرى وإلاّ وقع الافتراق المفضي إلى الاختلاف والتّنازع — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ١٧٤
<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/172> English: "There must be one عصبية stronger than them all, which overcomes them and draws them after it, so that all the عصبية fuse into it and become as if one single great عصبية — otherwise there follows the fragmentation that leads on to disagreement and strife."

عبرت: A gathering of loyalties either becomes one loyalty or becomes a quarrel. **Hands-up?** No.

IKO/E-IKR1 · ★ The call does not add numbers; it removes rivalry

Tier: CORE — **the headline slide of this strand** · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn asks the question anyone looking at the map of the year eleven would ask. How does a peninsula that has just fragmented move against two empires within two years? His answer does not multiply anyone's numbers. He says a religious call takes away the rivalry and the mutual envy that exist among people bound by kin, and points them all one way. And once that happens nothing stands in front of them — because the direction is one, the object is equal in every eye, and they will die for it. He names the conquests as his own example.

The statement:

والسبب في ذلك ... أنّ الصبغة الدينية تذهب بالتنافس والتحاسد الذي في أهل العصبية وتفرد الوجهة إلى الحق فإذا حصل لهم الاستبصار في أمرهم لم يقف لهم شيء لأنّ الوجهة واحدة والمطلوب متساو عندهم وهم مستميتون
<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/196> English: "The reason for it ... is that the religious colouring takes away the rivalry and mutual envy that are in people of عصبية, and makes their direction single, towards the truth. Then, once clear sight in their affair is theirs, nothing stands in their way — because the direction is one, the object is equal in all their eyes, and they will die for it."

عبرت: What changed in Arabia was not how many men there were, but which way they were all facing. **Hands-up?** Yes — "Two years after the tribes broke apart, they were moving on two empires. What had changed?" **The slide must carry his name and the words "as he reads it".** He never wrote this about the ridda; joining his chapter to the year eleven is our doing (§7.2).

IKO/E-IKR2 · The verse he grounds it on

Tier: CORE · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn does not leave the mechanism as a piece of social observation. He puts a verse under it. Kingship comes by ascendancy, he says, and ascendancy comes by group strength — but the gathering and joining of hearts comes only by a help from Allah in establishing His religion. And then he quotes al-Anfāl: had you spent everything in the earth, you could not have joined their hearts.

The statement:

وجمع القلوب وتألّفها إنّما يكون بمعونة من الله في إقامة دينه قال تعالى «لَوْ أَنفَقْتَ مَا فِي الْأَرْضِ جَمِيعاً مَا أَلْفَتْ
<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/195> English: "The gathering of
 بَيْنَ قُلُوبِهِمْ» — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ١٩٧

hearts and their joining comes only by a help from Allah in the establishment of His religion. He said, exalted be He: 'Had you spent all that is in the earth, you could not have joined their hearts.'"

عبرت: The joining of those hearts was never something anyone could have bought. **Hands-up?** No.  **The safest possible carrier for the whole analytical point in this room** — it puts the cause where the audience already puts it.  The Qur'ānic line goes on the slide in **Traditional Arabic** Naskh and must be eyeballed against a muṣḥaf (**CLAUDE.md** §1.3). The edition's inline «٦٣ :٨» reference is dropped when the verse is set on a slide; give the reference in the caption instead.

IKO/E-IKR3 · The test that runs the other way

Tier: GOOD · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn does not stop at the claim. He supplies the condition under which it would fail, which is what makes it an argument and not a slogan. Watch, he says, what happens when the religious colouring alters and decays. The whole thing unravels, and the outcome falls back to the measure of bare group strength, without the increment religion had been adding. The same peoples, the same numbers, a different result.

The statement:

واعتبر ذلك إذا حالت صبغة الدين وفسدت كيف ينتقض الأمر ويصير الغلب على نسبة العصبيّة وحدها دون زيادة
١٩٩ ص — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/12320/197> English: "And take note of this:
when the colouring of religion alters and decays, how the whole matter unravels, and ascendancy
reverts to the measure of عصبيّة alone, without the increment of religion."

عبرت: The increment was never owned; it was only ever held while it was being lived. **Hands-up?** No.

IKO/E-IKR4 · Why it had to be a religious call and could not have been a political one

Tier: CORE · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn explains why the peninsula could not have been unified on any other basis. The Arabs, he writes, were the hardest of peoples to make yield one to another — from harshness, from pride, from far-reaching ambition, and above all from rivalry over leadership. Their inclinations, he says, seldom converge. Only when religion came did the restraint come from inside them instead of being imposed from outside, and then yielding and gathering became easy. And he adds at once that they were also the quickest of peoples to accept guidance, because their natures were sound.

The statement:

فقلّما تجتمع أهواؤهم فإذا كان الدين بالنبوة أو الولاية كان الوازع لهم من أنفسهم وذهب خلق الكبر والمنافسة
١٨٩ ص — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/12320/187> English:
"Their inclinations seldom converge. But when religion comes by prophethood or by sanctity, the
restrainer over them is from within themselves, and the trait of arrogance and rivalry departs from
them, so their yielding and their coming together become easy."

عبرت: A restraint a man carries inside himself holds where one imposed from outside does not. **Hands-up?** Yes — "What would it have taken to make these tribes obey one man?"  **Always pair it with the sentence on**

the same page — «وهم مع ذلك أسرع النَّاس قبولاً للحقِّ والهدى» — or the first half reads as contempt for the Arabs and the room will bristle.

IKO/E-IKR5 · A call with no people behind it

Tier: GOOD · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn writes the other half of his own law, and it is the half that keeps him honest. A religious call without a group behind it, he says, does not come to completion. He means it structurally, not spiritually: a summons still has to be carried by people who will stand together for it, and where there is no such body, the summons does not travel. He gives a worked example from his own Andalus.

The statement:

· تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ١٩٩ — [الفصل السادس في أن الدعوة الدينية من غير عصبية لا تتم]
<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/197> English: "Chapter Six: that a religious call without عصبية does not come to completion."

عبرت: A call still needs a community willing to stand under it. **Hands-up?** No. △ On that page he cites a ḥadīth and calls it ṣaḥīḥ. **We have not verified it. Use the chapter's claim, never the ḥadīth (\$7.4).**

IKO/E-IKN1 · Whole tribes, parts of tribes, and those who simply held off

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١٥٠ [SOURCED] for the statement; البدايه carries the events · **Map:** the ridda map must show three states, not two

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn opens his account of the year eleven with a distinction any honest map of it needs. The Arabs turned back, he writes — either the whole tribe entire, or a part of it. And a page later, listing the fronts, he records a third state as well. Ṭayyī' and Asad gathered around Ṭulayḥa; Ghaṭafān turned back; and Hawāzin simply held off, withholding the ṣadaqa. Three states, not two.

The statement:

· وقد ارتدت [١] العرب إمّا القبيلة مستوعبة وإمّا بعض منها — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ٢ ص ٢٨٩
<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/1286> English: "The Arabs had turned back — either the whole tribe entire, or a part of it."

عبرت: A map drawn in two colours will always be telling you less than the sources did. **Hands-up?** No. ✓
 Corroborates [arabian-tribes-and-the-ridda-setup.md](#) §3.5 (البدايه ج ٧ ص ٢٨ split three ways, بنو تميم) from a **second, independent author**. Worth saying out loud.

IKO/E-IKN2 · The sheep in the rain — and who really said it

Tier: GOOD · **When:** ١١٥٠ [SOURCED] · **Map:** n/a

What happened: There is a famous sentence about the state of the Muslims when the Prophet ﷺ died: that they became like sheep out in the rain on a winter's night. Ibn Khaldūn uses it. It is not his. Ibn Kathīr carries it twice, once from Ibn Ishāq and once through a second chain, and Ibn Ishāq is the older source by centuries.

This is worth saying aloud, because it shows the audience exactly how a phrase travels, and why the citation has to follow it back.

The statement:

وصارَ المسلمون كالغنم المطيرة في الليلة الشتائية، لفقد نبيهم ﷺ، حتى جمّعهم الله على أبي بكر . — البدايه
 https://shamela.ws/book/30097/2581 English: "And the Muslims became like sheep out in the rain on a winter's night, for the loss of their Prophet ﷺ — until Allah gathered them upon Abū Bakr ."

عبرت: A sentence worth repeating is worth tracing back to the man who first said it. **Hands-up?** No. **△ Cite** ٣٩٧ص البدايه ج ٥ never ٤٨٩ص ج ٢. ابن خلدون ج ٢. This card is itself a small demonstration of §1's boundary.

IKO/E-IKN3 · One dissent does not unmake a consensus — and even that is said conditionally

Tier: GOOD, with the handling note obeyed exactly · **When:** ١١هـ [SOURCED] — the year is page-cited in saqifah-bani-saida.md (٥ص ج ٧: ٣٤٣ص ج ٥), not on ابن خلدون's page · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn's account of the pledge to Abū Bakr ends with a short constitutional remark rather than a story. The Muhājirūn and the Anṣār were of one mind, he says; one man dissented, and no notice was taken of it because it stood alone. What is worth noticing is the clause he puts in the middle. Before drawing any conclusion at all, he writes: if his dissent is even established. He will not build on a report he has not first weighed.

The statement:

أجمع المهاجرون والأنصار على بيعة أبي بكر ولم يخالف إلا سعد إن صحّ خلافه — تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ٢ ص ٤٨٩
 https://shamela.ws/book/12320/1286 English: "The Muhājirūn and the Anṣār were of one mind on the pledge to Abū Bakr , and none dissented but Sa'd — if his dissent is even established."

عبرت: A careful historian states his condition before he states his conclusion. **Hands-up?** No. **△ HANDLING, and it is not optional.** Quote **only** as far as «إن صحّ خلافه». The words that follow («فلم يلتفت إليه لشذوذه») **do not go on a slide and do not go beside سعد بن عبادَة's name.** Ibn Khaldūn also repeats on that page the verse claiming the jinn killed him: **that is exactly the sort of report §2 teaches us to reject, and it is never repeated.** If pressed from the floor, answer from البدايه via saqifah-bani-saida.md and defer, per CLAUDE.md §1.6.

IKO/E-IKX1 · The chapters that must be read whole before they are quoted at all

Tier: CUT — recorded so it is never re-researched · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What it is: Two chapters of the Muqaddima are routinely quoted against the Arabs: «الفصل الخامس والعشرون» and «الفصل السادس والعشرون في أن العرب إذا تغلبوا على» (ج ١ ص ١٨٦) and «(في أن العرب لا يتغلبون إلا على البسائط (ج ١ ص ١٨٧)». They are on the page and they say what they say. **They are not used in this series, for three reasons, all recorded here so the decision is not revisited:**

1. **He is describing the البدو الوحشيون — nomads outside any settled order — not the Muslims of the فتوحات.** The Shamela edition's own footnote at ١٨١ ص ج ١ says so: «يعني ابن خلدون العرب المتوحشون».

2. **He reverses the whole judgement two chapters later.** At ج١ ص١٩٠ he says their nature is overturned and changed by a religious colouring, and that under the Sharī'a «عظم حينئذ ملكهم وقوي سلطانهم». Quoting the first without the second misrepresents him.
3. **The room.** These chapters cannot be delivered in forty-five minutes without either sounding like an attack or requiring a defence that costs the evening its subject.

The statement: none used. The passages are at ج١ ص١٨٦ (<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/184>) and ج١ ص١٨٧ (<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/185>); the reversal is at ج١ ص١٩٠ (<https://shamela.ws/book/12320/188>).

عبرت: A judgement quoted without the qualification its author attached to it is no longer his judgement.

Hands-up? No — and if it is raised from the floor, the answer is reason 2 above, with the page number.

IKO/E-IKX2 · Four good sentences — one of them usable after all

Tier: CUT — recorded so the corroboration is done once, cheaply · **When:** ١٤-٢٣ هـ [STANDARD] (to verify) — an era tag, not a page-cited date; only «وفي هذه السنة وهي أربع عشرة» for بقاء الكوفة والبصرة is on the page (ج٢ ص٥٤٩) · **Map:** n/a

What it is: Ibn Khaldūn's narrative records four explanations that would each make a fine slide. Al-Hurmuzān telling 'Umar^{رضي} that Persia will keep fighting while its king remains among them (ج٢ ص٥٥٣). Sa'd^{رضي} explaining that Arab troops sicken in the Iraqi lowlands, which is why al-Kūfa and al-Baṣra were built at all (ج٢ ص٥٤٩). 'Umar^{رضي}'s building rule for the new cities, ending "hold to the sunna and the state will hold to you" (ج٢ ص٥٥٠). And 'Umar^{رضي}'s mobilisation address (ج١ ص١٨١).

All four are sayings, and DECISIONS.md #29 forbids him as the authority for the wording of a saying — so each had to be found in an approved work or dropped. Re-searched across the entire cached البديع, سيرة الكامل and سير with harakat stripped (an earlier bare-consonant grep returned a false negative), the result is one out of four:

✓ 'Umar's^{رضي} building rule IS in ج٢ ص٣٥٤ الكامل, almost verbatim, in the same context — so it is usable, cited to الكامل and never to Ibn Khaldūn. "Hold to the sunna, and the state will hold to you" comes off the CUT list.

فَقَالَ: افْعَلُوا وَلَا يَزِيدَنَّ أَحَدُكُمْ عَلَى ثَلَاثَةِ أَبْيَاتٍ، وَلَا تَطَاوَلُوا فِي الْبُنْيَانِ، وَالزَّمُوا السُّنَّةَ تَلَزَمَكُمُ الدَّوْلَةُ. — ج٢ ص٣٥٤ الكامل في التاريخ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1045> English: "Do so; and let none of you exceed three rooms; and do not build high; and hold to the sunna, and the state will hold to you."

The other three stay out. Al-Hurmuzān's advice and 'Umar's^{رضي} mobilisation address are in no approved work. Sa'd's^{رضي} answer is only half there: ج٢ ص٣٥٢ الكامل has "the unwholesomeness of the country changed us" **in the delegation's mouth, not his**, and no camel clause at all — so the *reason* the two cities were founded may be narrated from الكامل, but **the sentence may not be put in Sa'd's^{رضي} mouth**. They are recorded in \$6.6–\$6.7 with their pages. Until corroborated: **absent, not wrong**.

عبرت: A sentence you cannot yet stand behind is better left out than said and defended. **Hands-up?** No. △ Set the vowelled الكامل text on any slide, and eyeball it against a page image first (CLAUDE.md §1.1).

IKO/E-IKX3 · Rustam watching the prayer ranks

Tier: CUT — recorded so it is never re-researched · **When:** ١٤-١٥هـ [STANDARD] (to verify) — the conventional date of القادسيه; **no date at all appears on ج١ ص١٩٠, which is analysis** · **Map:** n/a

What it is: At ج١ ص١٩٠, immediately after arguing that religion put the restraint inside the Arabs, Ibn Khaldūn records that Rustam, seeing the Muslims forming up for prayer, would say that ‘Umar^{رضي} had eaten his liver — that he was teaching manners to dogs. As an observation it is powerful: the enemy commander recognising that what he faces is discipline rather than numbers.

It is not used, and the decisive reason is not the one you would guess: in the approved works the line belongs to somebody else. "‘Umar has eaten my liver" is **Abū Lu’lu’a's**, wept over the captives of Nihāwand — ج٢ ص٣٩٩، الكامل ج٢ ص٣٩٩ — **and Ibn Khaldūn himself gives it to Abū Lu’lu’a in volume 2, at ج٢ ص٥٥٨.** Only "teaching manners to dogs" is peculiar to ج١ ص١٩٠, and it appears on no other page in any cached tree. Add to that: it is a saying, and DECISIONS.md #29 forbids him as the authority for a wording; and «الكلاب» is contempt for the Muslims that will land badly however it is framed.

The statement: none in the sources we use. The Rustam version is at ج١ ص١٩٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/12320/188>; the Abū Lu’lu’a version is at ج٢ ص٥٥٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/12320/1355>, ج١ ص٢٣٤، البدايه ج١ ص٢٣٤ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3380>, and الكامل ج٢ ص٣٩٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/1090>.

عبرت: What an enemy noticed about a people is worth knowing — but only once you know who reported it. **Hands-up?** No. ⚠ **This is a third internal contradiction inside his own book (cf. §3.4), and the cleanest possible illustration of why DECISIONS.md #29 bars him from carrying a wording. It is not usable as a story, but it is usable as the reason for the rule.**

IKO/E-IKX4 · The judgement that is not in the book

Tier: CORE — **as the honesty line of whichever slide carries his name** · **When:** n/a · **Map:** n/a

What happened: Ibn Khaldūn is the great explainer of Islamic history, and it is tempting to say that he explained the ridda. He did not. Ninety-five pages of his narrative of the years eleven to twenty-three were read for this session, and searched for every phrase he uses elsewhere when he is about to explain something rather than report it. There were two. His account of these years is narration. The analysis is four hundred pages away in another volume, and it never once mentions the ridda. Putting the two together is our work, and the audience is told so.

The statement: none in the sources we use — **and that is the finding.**

عبرت: Saying plainly where a book stops is part of using it honestly. **Hands-up?** No — but this sentence, or one like it, belongs on any slide in this series that carries his name.